



张巍GRE

阅读机经 440篇

(2026年)
(题型分类版)

答案获取方式

关注公众号“张巍GRE”，输入“阅读机经440篇答案”。

解析获取方式

关注公众号“张巍GRE”，输入“jjpassage1”代表第一篇文章的解析，以此类推。

关注公众号
「张巍GRE」



张巍GRE阅读机经440篇

原机经420篇+补充机经20篇

编写说明：本资料在之前最受欢迎的《GRE阅读机经420篇》的基础上删除了已经不考的题目，并新增了2025年和2026年的精选最新机经。同时还修订了之前个别打印错误，并对解析进行了升级。所有题目均有答案和解析。

答案获取方式：关注微信公众号“张巍GRE”，输入“阅读机经440篇答案”。

解析获取方式：关注微信公众号“张巍GRE”，输入“jjpassage1”代表第1篇文章的解析，以此类推。



-扫码进入微信公众号-

张巍老师介绍：真经GRE创始人，GRE行业大牛老师，多年在线GRE授课经验，累计培训学员超过100000人，深入研究GRE真题和教学方法，著有《GRE填空机经2000题》和解析，《GRE阅读机经440篇》和解析，《GRE数学170难题》，《GRE数学回忆机经360》，《GRE数学满分宝典》，《GRE最新数学机经900题》和解析，《GRE镇考机经词》，《GRE等价词汇总》《GRE镇考3000词》等学生喜爱的资料。

谨防假冒：市面上有很多机构或个人直接把张巍的资料复制加上自己的水印就当成了自己的资料。更有甚者在此资料的基础之上加上一些OG和官方150真题等“伪机经”就构成了新的机经资料，还声称张巍抄袭。我相信考GRE的学生都是有自己的判断力的，此资料除了有440篇机经，还有30多万字的解析，这些都是张巍团队辛勤劳动的成果，不容忍别人的亵渎。资料的唯一正版解析都在“张巍GRE”的公众号上，网上传的PDF版本是盗版，里面有一些答案错误，希望大家能够支持正版资料。

真经GRE 资料一览图



GRE Verbal资料



《张巍GRE阅读机经440篇》
(2026年) (题型分类版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 按题型分类, 针对性训练, 市面唯一。



《张巍GRE填空机经2000题》
(2026年) (难度分级版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 最新机经难度分级, 配套最新最全解析。

GRE模考资料



《张巍GREVerbal模考套题50套》(改革后)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 难度系数标注, 真实考试高度还原verbal题目和出题顺序, 配套详细解析。备考必刷!



《真经GRE新版模考套题》
(3套) (改革后)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 改革后的考试套题, 自适仿真结构。高度还原真实考试。

GRE数学资料



《张巍GRE最新数学机经900题》
(2026年) (难度分级版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 最新真题, 难度分级, 针对性训练。



《GRE数学170难题4.0》
(2026年版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 高分必备, 难题合集, 冲击170。



《GRE数学回忆版机经360》

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 考场回忆版真题, 贴近考试难度和思路。



《GRE数学满分宝典3.0》
(2026年版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 涵盖所有数学知识点考点, 最完整的数学知识体系教材。



《真经GRE| 数学考点分类真题练习册》

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 分最新真题收录、考点的模块化训练, 针对性训练。

GRE写作资料



《2026 issue官方题库》

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 官方最新题库汇总。



《GRE issue 范文精析》

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 高分范文的分析和梳理, 掌握写作逻辑。



《Issue万能素材》

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 扩充素材库, 深挖素材每个解析角度, 丰富论证过程!



《改革后issue题库公式匹配》

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: Issue题库中所有题目的公式匹配和题目思路, 秒出思路!

GRE单词资料



《GRE镇考3000词》
(2026年版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 紧跟考试趋势, 最新选词, 配备视频讲解。



《GRE镇考机经词7.0》
(2026年版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: GRE核心高频词, 真题机经答案词, 配套视频讲解。



《真经GRE等价词汇总》
(2026年版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

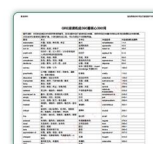
推荐理由: 六选二等价词必背词汇。



《真经GRE数学词汇汇总》

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 按照知识点分类整理GRE全部数学专有名词。



《GRE阅读机经核心词汇》

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: GRE阅读中词汇扩展, 阅读必备词汇。



《张巍GRE熟词僻义汇总》
(2026年版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: GRE常考的160多个熟词僻义。

01

王牌冲分班

性价比之王

COST PERFORMANCE



02

极速提分小班

极速杀G

EXTREME SPEED



03

个性化一对一

专属定制&专治各种“疑难杂症”

VVVVVIP



题型分类目录

分类说明：GRE 阅读对于大部分同学来说都是整个 GRE 备考中最难的部分，不仅文章内容复杂，而且题型多样，而每一种题型的切入方法和解题思路又各不相同的。所以为了让考生们更好地去按照不同题型分类的思路去进行刷题，真经 GRE 特将我们的王牌机经《GRE 阅读机经 440 篇》进行了全方位的题型分类。共分为主旨题，事实信息题（包括细节题），推断题，句子作用题，词汇题，可多选题，组织结构题，归纳题，逻辑单题（包括削弱题，加强题，假设题，填空题，句子作用题，推理题）。

题目分类对于学生针对性训练 GRE 阅读题型是非常有帮助的，可以说这又是 GRE 阅读提分的一大利器！此资料也是市面上唯一按题型细分的资料。

题号 1-1 代表 passage1 第 1 题，以此类推。本次为 2.0 版本，后续还会不断优化更新，请大家关注微信公众号：张巍老师 GRE，获取最新信息。

主旨题题号

1-1 4-1 5-1 7-1 9-1 21-1 28-1 29-2 35-1 43-1 50-1 51-1 55-1 57-1 58-4
61-1 62-1 64-1 69-1 71-1 81-1 84-1 87-1 103-1 107-1 109-1 114-1 117-1
123-6 128-1 130-1 132-1 135-1 139-1 141-1 142-1 145-1 147-1 148-1 149-1
151-1 152-1 154-1 184-2 190-1 191-1 197-1 205-1 206-1 212-1 213-1 214-1
218-1 219-1 224-1 227-1 237-1 242-4 244-3 250-3 256-3 257-3 283-1
291-1 294-2 308-1 311-4 322-1 330-1 332-1 341-1 346-1 348-1 358-1
370-1 373-1 375-1 378-1 379-1 380-1 387-1 391-1 392-1 393-1 405-1 418-1
419-1 426-1 428-1 431-1 433-1 436-1

事实信息题题号

4-2 5-3 6-2 19-1 25-1 30-1 34-2 36-2 41-1 47-1 49-2 53-2 53-3 53-4 53-5
58-2 61-2 62-2 66-1 66-2 68-1 68-3 84-2 87-3 88-1 88-2 95-1 100-2
102-1 103-2 104-2 107-2 108-1 109-3 112-1 113-1 117-3 123-1 123-2
126-3 127-1 135-2 140-1 143-2 146-2 147-2 153-1 154-2 172-1 176-1
176-2 184-3 187-1 187-2 189-1 190-2 191-3 193-1 194-1 198-1 198-3
201-1 202-2 203-2 204-2 204-3 208-3 209-1 211-1 214-2 217-1 219-2
221-2 226-2 227-2 236-1 237-2 238-2 240-1 240-2 242-2 242-3 243-2
244-2 248-1 248-2 249-2 253-2 257-2 257-3 260-1 262-2 265-2 267-1
274-1 274-2 280-1 281-2 285-1 285-2 291-3 291-4 292-1 292-2 301-1
304-1 304-2 308-2 308-3 314-1 318-2 320-1 321-2 322-2 323-2 325-1
332-3 334-2 340-1 346-2 355-2 358-2 362-2 370-2 371-1 377-1 395-3
396-1 399-1 400-1 403-1 404-2 408-1 410-3 414-1 417-2 419-2 424-2
431-3 434-3

推断题题号

1-2 1-3 2-2 5-2 7-2 7-4 11-2 11-3 13-1 14-2 15-1 15-2 17-2 17-4 18-1
 19-2 20-1 20-2 27-1 27-2 28-2 29-1 35-2 36-3 40-3 52-1 52-2 57-3 59-1
 60-2 62-3 63 64-2 64-3 68-2 69-3 71-2 71-3 72-2 81-2 84-3 87-2 94
 95-2 102-2 103-3 104-1 110-1 110-2 111-2 113-2 114-5 114-6 116-1 119-2
 120-1 123-5 124-2 125-2 126-2 128-3 130-2 130-3 132-3 133-3 134-1
 134-2 137-2 138-1 139-3 141-2 141-3 142-3 144-2 147-3 149-3 150-1 151-2
 151-3 152-2 152-3 153-2 172-2 172-3 172-4 176-3 178-1 181-1 193-2 196-1
 198-2 200-1 201-2 201-3 202-3 203-1 204-1 205-2 208-1 212-3 215-1
 216-1 216-2 218-2 219-3 222-1 222-2 223-1 224-2 225-1 227-3 239-2
 243-1 245-2 245-3 249-1 250-1 250-2 251-2 252-1 252-2 253-1 254-2
 255-2 255-3 256-1 256-2 260-2 265-1 266-1 268-2 279-2 281-1 281-3 282-1
 283-2 292-3 294-1 296-2 301-2 304-3 305-1 307-2 309-1 309-2 311-1 311-2
 311-3 313-1 313-2 316-1 318-1 322-3 323-1 325-2 325-3 327-1 328-1
 329-1 330-2 334-1 337-1 337-2 337-3 338-2 347-1 348-3 352-2 355-3
 356-2 358-3 360-1 362-1 362-3 367-1 369-1 370-3 373-2 373-3 375-2
 375-3 376-2 378-3 380-2 381-2 386-1 387-2 388-1 389-1 389-2 390-1 390-2
 391-2 391-3 393-2 394-1 395-1 395-2 396-2 396-3 399-2 400-2 401-1 404-1
 406-2 409-1 409-2 410-1 412-1 417-1 418-2 418-3 419-3 420-1 420-2 421-1
 423-1 426-2 427-1 427-2 428-3 432-2 434-1 434-2 435-1 437-1 438-3

选句子题题号

2-1 18-2 22-2 40-2 41-2 55-2 58-1 148-2 175-1 207-1 220-2 223-2 224-3
 228-1 267-2 305-2 376-1 435-2

句子作用题题号

9-2 23-1 23-2 31-1 38-3 48 54-2 57-2 67-2 100-1 106-1 118-2 122-1
 124-1 125-1 131-1 133-2 139-2 143-1 144-1 154-3 180-1 209-2 210-2
 217-2 221-1 226-1 242-1 245-4 251-1 255-1 260-3 272-2 282-2 284-1
 286-2 288-1 306-1 320-2 327-2 335-1 345-2 347-2 352-1 369-2 381-1
 384-1 388-2 390-3 404-3 408-2 416-2 426-3 436-2

信息目的题题号

31-2 33-2 34-1 36-1 44-2 49-1 50-2 53-1 58-3 60-1 67-1 70-2 90-2 92
109-2 111-1 114-3 114-4 115-1 121-2 123-3 126-1 133-1 138-2 142-2
145-2 146-1 149-2 154-4 172-6 173-1 184-1 208-2 211-2 213-2 220-1
240-3 252-3 254-1 272-1 291-2 293-1 293-2 296-1 302-1 314-2 321-1
331-1 340-2 340-3 346-3 348-2 355-1 364-1 371-2 374-1 378-2 379-2
386-2 387-3 392-2 398-2 401-2 405-2 410-2 413-1 414-2 416-1 421-2 424-1
428-2 430-2 432-1 433-2 438-1 438-2

组织结构题题号

35-3 117-2 123-4 191-2 194-2 205-3 212-2 244-1 338-1 356-1 430-1
431-2 433-3

词汇题题号

11-4 42-2 45-2 51-3 55-3 73-2 79-2 83-2 106-2 112-2 129-2 140-2 177-2
180-2 197-2 200-2 225-2 228-2 245-1 260-4 262-1 268-1 273-2 276-2
280-2 286-1 289-2 297-2 344-2 360-2 367-2 403-2 406-3 412-2 416-3
437-2

可多选题题号

6-1 11-1 13-2 14-1 17-3 21-2 22-1 25-2 30-2 33-1 37-1 37-2 38-1 38-2
38-4 40-1 42-1 43-2 43-3 44-1 45-1 47-2 49-3 51-2 54-1 56-1 56-2
59-2 66-3 67-3 67-4 70-1 72-1 73-1 79-1 83-1 88-4 90-1 105-2 108-2
114-2 116-2 118-1 120-2 122-2 127-2 128-2 129-1 131-2 136-1 136-2
137-1 150-2 172-5 173-2 175-2 177-1 178-2 181-2 183-1 183-2 196-2 206-2
207-2 215-2 215-3 238-1 239-1 266-2 273-1 276-1 279-1 284-2 289-1
297-1 299-1 299-2 302-2 306-2 307-1 316-2 328-2 329-2 331-2 332-2
335-2 341-2 344-1 345-1 364-2 374-2 377-2 380-3 384-2 394-1 398-1 399-2
403-1 406-2 412-1 417-2 423-2 427-1 432-2 434-3 435-1

归纳题(包括逻辑单题)题号

7-3 17-1 75 88-3 231 317 342 354 359 402

逻辑单题-加强题题号

8 119-1 164 165 166 180-3 199 232 233 234 235 258 259 275 295 319
365 385 440

逻辑单题-削弱题题号

24 32 74 82 85 93 99 115-2 132-2 159 160 182 185 186 202-1 229
241 246 261 264 269 271 283-3 287 310 330-3 333 349 351 361 368
372 382 397

逻辑单题-填空题题号

46 101 167 168 169 170 171 174 179 263 277 278 290 303 315 324
339 357 363 383 407 422

逻辑单题-假设题题号

3 12 16 39 78 80 86 89 98 162 163 192 195 210-1 230 270 300 326
343 350 366 247 411 425 429

逻辑单题-句子作用题题号

65 76 77 97 298 306 312 336 353 439

逻辑单题-推理题题号

157 188 415

目录

Passage 1	15
Passage 2	16
Passage 3	16
Passage 4	17
Passage 5	18
Passage 6	19
Passage 7	20
Passage 8	21
Passage 9	21
Passage 10	22
Passage 11	22
Passage 12	23
Passage 13	24
Passage 14	25
Passage 15	26
Passage 16	27
Passage 17	27
Passage 18	29
Passage 19	30
Passage 20	31
Passage 21	32
Passage 22	33
Passage 23	34
Passage 24	35
Passage 25	36
Passage 26	37
Passage 27	38
Passage 28	39
Passage 29	40
Passage 30	41
Passage 31	42
Passage 32	43
Passage 33	44
Passage 34	45

Passage 35	46
Passage 36	47
Passage 37	48
Passage 38	49
Passage 39	50
Passage 40	50
Passage 41	51
Passage 42	52
Passage 43	53
Passage 44	54
Passage 45	54
Passage 46	55
Passage 47	55
Passage 48	56
Passage 49	57
Passage 50	58
Passage 51	59
Passage 52	60
Passage 53	61
Passage 54	62
Passage 55	63
Passage 56	64
Passage 57	65
Passage 58	66
Passage 59	67
Passage 60	68
Passage 61	69
Passage 62	70
Passage 63	71
Passage 64	72
Passage 65	73
Passage 66	73
Passage 67	75
Passage 68	76
Passage 69	77
Passage 70	78

Passage 71	79
Passage 72	80
Passage 73	81
Passage 74	81
Passage 75	82
Passage 76	82
Passage 77	83
Passage 78	83
Passage 79	84
Passage 80	84
Passage 81	85
Passage 82	86
Passage 83	86
Passage 84	87
Passage 85	88
Passage 86	88
Passage 87	89
Passage 88	90
Passage 89	91
Passage 90	91
Passage 91	92
Passage 92	92
Passage 93	93
Passage 94	94
Passage 95	94
Passage 96	95
Passage 97	95
Passage 98	96
Passage 99	96
Passage 100	97
Passage 101	98
Passage 102	99
Passage 103	100
Passage 104	101
Passage 105	102
Passage 106	103

Passage 107	104
Passage 108	105
Passage 109	106
Passage 110	107
Passage 111	108
Passage 112	109
Passage 113	110
Passage 114	111
Passage 115	113
Passage 116	114
Passage 117	115
Passage 118	116
Passage 119	117
Passage 120	118
Passage 121	119
Passage 122	120
Passage 123	121
Passage 124	123
Passage 125	124
Passage 126	125
Passage 127	126
Passage 128	127
Passage 129	128
Passage 130	129
Passage 131	130
Passage 132	131
Passage 133	132
Passage 134	133
Passage 135	134
Passage 136	135
Passage 137	136
Passage 138	137
Passage 139	138
Passage 140	139
Passage 141	140
Passage 142	141

Passage 143	142
Passage 144	143
Passage 145	144
Passage 146	145
Passage 147	146
Passage 148	147
Passage 149	148
Passage 150	149
Passage 151	150
Passage 152	151
Passage 153	152
Passage 154	153
Passage 155	154
Passage 156	154
Passage 157	155
Passage 158	155
Passage 159	156
Passage 160	156
Passage 161	157
Passage 162	157
Passage 163	158
Passage 164	158
Passage 165	159
Passage 166	159
Passage 167	160
Passage 168	160
Passage 169	161
Passage 170	161
Passage 171	162
Passage 172	163
Passage 173	165
Passage 174	165
Passage 175	166
Passage 176	167
Passage 177	168
Passage 178	169

Passage 179	169
Passage 180	170
Passage 181	171
Passage 182	171
Passage 183	172
Passage 184	173
Passage 185	174
Passage 186	174
Passage 187	175
Passage 188	175
Passage 189	176
Passage 190	176
Passage 191	177
Passage 192	178
Passage 193	178
Passage 194	179
Passage 195	180
Passage 196	180
Passage 197	181
Passage 198	182
Passage 199	183
Passage 200	183
Passage 201	184
Passage 202	185
Passage 203	186
Passage 204	187
Passage 205	188
Passage 206	189
Passage 207	189
Passage 208	190
Passage 209	191
Passage 210	192
Passage 211	193
Passage 212	194
Passage 213	195
Passage 214	196

Passage 215	197
Passage 216	198
Passage 217	199
Passage 218	200
Passage 219	201
Passage 220	202
Passage 221	202
Passage 222	203
Passage 223	203
Passage 224	204
Passage 225	205
Passage 226	205
Passage 227	206
Passage 228	207
Passage 229	207
Passage 230	208
Passage 231	208
Passage 232	208
Passage 233	209
Passage 234	209
Passage 235	210
Passage 236	210
Passage 237	211
Passage 238	211
Passage 239	212
Passage 240	213
Passage 241	214
Passage 242	215
Passage 243	216
Passage 244	217
Passage 245	218
Passage 246	219
Passage 247	220
Passage 248	221
Passage 249	222
Passage 250	223

Passage 251	224
Passage 252	225
Passage 253	226
Passage 254	227
Passage 255	228
Passage 256	229
Passage 257	230
Passage 258	231
Passage 259	231
Passage 260	232
Passage 261	233
Passage 262	233
Passage 263	234
Passage 264	234
Passage 265	235
Passage 266	236
Passage 267	236
Passage 268	237
Passage 269	237
Passage 270	238
Passage 271	238
Passage 272	239
Passage 273	239
Passage 274	240
Passage 275	240
Passage 276	241
Passage 277	241
Passage 278	242
Passage 279	242
Passage 280	243
Passage 281	244
Passage 282	245
Passage 283	246
Passage 284	247
Passage 285	248
Passage 286	249

Passage 287	249
Passage 288	250
Passage 289	250
Passage 290	251
Passage 291	252
Passage 292	253
Passage 293	254
Passage 294	255
Passage 295	255
Passage 296	256
Passage 297	257
Passage 298	257
Passage 299	258
Passage 300	259
Passage 301	260
Passage 302	261
Passage 303	262
Passage 304	263
Passage 305	264
Passage 306	265
Passage 307	266
Passage 308	267
Passage 309	268
Passage 310	269
Passage 311	270
Passage 312	271
Passage 313	272
Passage 314	273
Passage 315	274
Passage 316	275
Passage 317	276
Passage 318	277
Passage 319	278
Passage 320	279
Passage 321	280
Passage 322	281

Passage 323	282
Passage 324	283
Passage 325	284
Passage 326	285
Passage 327	286
Passage 328	287
Passage 329	288
Passage 330	289
Passage 331	290
Passage 332	291
Passage 333	292
Passage 334	293
Passage 335	294
Passage 336	295
Passage 337	296
Passage 338	297
Passage 339	298
Passage 340	299
Passage 341	300
Passage 342	301
Passage 343	302
Passage 344	303
Passage 345	304
Passage 346	305
Passage 347	306
Passage 348	307
Passage 349	308
Passage 350	309
Passage 351	310
Passage 352	311
Passage 353	312
Passage 354	313
Passage 355	314
Passage 356	315
Passage 357	315
Passage 358	316

Passage 359	317
Passage 360	318
Passage 361	318
Passage 362	319
Passage 363	320
Passage 364	320
Passage 365	321
Passage 366	322
Passage 367	323
Passage 368	324
Passage 369	325
Passage 370	326
Passage 371	327
Passage 372	328
Passage 373	329
Passage 374	330
Passage 375	331
Passage 376	332
Passage 377	333
Passage 378	334
Passage 379	335
Passage 380	336
Passage 381	337
Passage 382	338
Passage 383	339
Passage 384	340
Passage 385	341
Passage 386	342
Passage 387	343
Passage 388	344
Passage 389	345
Passage 390	346
Passage 391	347
Passage 392	348
Passage 393	349
Passage 394	350

Passage 395	351
Passage 396	352
Passage 397	353
Passage 398	353
Passage 399	354
Passage 400	355
Passage 401	356
Passage 402	356
Passage 403	357
Passage 404	358
Passage 405	359
Passage 406	360
Passage 407	360
Passage 408	361
Passage 409	362
Passage 410	363
Passage 411	364
Passage 412	364
Passage 413	365
Passage 414	366
Passage 415	367
Passage 416	368
Passage 417	369
Passage 418	370
Passage 419	371
Passage 420	372
Passage 421	373
Passage 422	373
Passage 423	374
Passage 424	375
Passage 425	376
Passage 426	377
Passage 427	378
Passage 428	379
Passage 429	380
Passage 430	381

Passage 431	382
Passage 432	383
Passage 433	384
Passage 434	385
Passage 435	386
Passage 436	386
Passage 437	387
Passage 438	388
Passage 439	389
Passage 440	389

Passage 1

Although social learning (the acquisition of specific behaviors by observing other individuals exhibiting those behaviors) is well documented among fish, few studies have investigated social learning within a developmental context in these taxa. Rather than investigating the development of a particular skill, Chapman, Ward, and Krause investigated the role of group density during development in later foraging success in laboratory-housed guppies. When raised with a small number of conspecifics (members of the same species), guppies were quicker to locate food by following a trained adult guppy than were guppies raised in large groups. This counterintuitive finding is explained by the fact that guppies reared in the high-density condition were less likely to shoal (swim in a group) with others and, therefore, were less likely to learn the benefits of social learning. Instead, fish reared in high-density situations may learn that conspecifics are to be viewed as competitors, rather than as potential sources of adaptive information. This finding suggests that at least for guppies, the early social environment may have an effect on the capacity for social learning, if not on the socially learned behaviors themselves. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. note a flaw in a scientific finding.
 - B. describe a particular scientific study.
 - C. present an interpretation of a finding.
 - D. note a difference between two scientific findings.
 - E. contrast two conditions in which a particular phenomenon has been observed.
2. Regarding research on fish, it can be inferred from the passage that
 - A. research studies of the acquisition of important skills by fish have only recently begun to document the role of conspecifics in the learning process.
 - B. research on social learning in guppies suggests that guppies differ in important ways from most other fish in the means by which they learn particular skills.
 - C. research on social learning in fish has generally focused on the acquisition of skills other than foraging.
 - D. research has established that social learning occurs in some fish species without investigating the development context in which it occurs.
 - E. research to investigate social learning has been done more extensively on fish than on other aquatic animals.
3. Which of the following can be inferred about the study by Chapman, Ward, and Krause?
 - A. It was initially designed to investigate something other than social learning.
 - B. It required researchers to observe individual guppies at multiple points in their life spans.
 - C. It pointed to the possibility that population density may have little to do with guppies' social learning.
 - D. It required the observation of guppies under conditions that closely mimicked the conditions of guppies in the wild.
 - E. It indicated that guppies gain adaptive information from being reared with a relatively large number of conspecifics.

Passage 2

As it was published in 1935, *Mules and Men*, Zora Neale Hurston's landmark collection of folktales, may not have been the book that its author first had in mind. In this anthropological study, Hurston describes in detail the people who tell the stories, often even inserting herself into the storytelling scene. Evidently, however, Hurston had prepared another version, a manuscript that was recently discovered and published after having been forgotten since 1929. This version differs from *Mules and Men* in that it simply records stories, with no descriptive or interpretive information. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

While we cannot know for certain why Hurston's original manuscript went unpublished during her lifetime, it may have been because publishers wanted something more than a transcription of tales. Contemporary novelist and critic John Edgar Wideman has described Black literature as the history of a writing that sought to escape its frame, in other words, as the effort of Black writers to present the stories of Black people without having to have a mediating voice to explain the stories to a non-Black audience. In this, Hurston may have been ahead of her time.

1. Select the sentence that suggests a possible reason why Hurston wrote the version of *Mules and Men* that was published in 1935.
2. The passage suggests that Hurston may have done which of the following in preparing her original version?
 - A. discussed her mode of presentation with her publisher before writing the first draft, in order to reduce the possibility of misunderstanding
 - B. shortened her presentation of the stories to the bare minimum in order to be able to present more folklore material
 - C. put it aside for several decades in order to maximize its potential audience when it was published
 - D. reluctantly agreed to reshape it in order to take out various elements with which her publisher had been dissatisfied
 - E. chose not to include editorial commentary, in order to present the stories on their own terms

Passage 3

A decrease in face-to-face social contact can precipitate depression. Time spent using the Internet cannot be spent in face-to-face social contact, so psychologists have speculated that sharply increasing Internet use can cause depression. Studies of regular Internet users have found a significantly higher incidence of depression among those who had recently doubled the amount of time they spent using the Internet than among those whose use had not increased. Hence, the psychologists' speculation is correct. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

- A. In general, the reason that the people in the studies had doubled their Internet use was not that they had earlier experienced a significant decrease in opportunities for face-to-face social contact.
- B. A sharp decrease in face-to-face social contact is the only change in daily activity that can lead to an increased incidence of depression.
- C. Using the Internet presents no opportunities for people to increase the amount of face-to-face social contact they experienced in their daily lives.
- D. Regular Internet users who are depressed will experience an immediate improvement in mood if they sharply decrease the amount of time they spend on the Internet.
- E. Before they doubled the time they spent on the Internet, the people who did so were already more prone to depression than are regular Internet users in general.

Passage 4

African American drama has, until recently, been rooted in the mimetic tradition of modern American naturalism. The most distinctive attribute of this tradition is the mechanistic, materialistic conception of humanity. Naturalism sees each individual as inextricably bound to the environment and depicts each person as someone controlled by, instead of controlling, concrete reality. As long as African American drama maintained naturalism as its dominant mode, it could only express the “plight of African American people”. Its heroes might declare the madness of reality, but reality inevitably triumphed over them.

The surrealistic plays of Adrienne Kennedy mark one of the first departures from naturalism by an African American dramatist. The overall goal of her work has been to depict the world of the soul and the spirit, not to mirror concrete reality. Within this framework, Kennedy has been able to portray African American minds and souls liberated from their connections to the external environment. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best states the central idea of the passage?

- A. African American drama has been primarily influenced by naturalism's emphasis on the materialistic.
- B. African American drama has traditionally acknowledged the relationship between the individual and the environment.
- C. African American drama, traditionally naturalistic, has been little influenced by dramatist Kennedy's spiritual and psychological approach to drama.
- D. The work of Kennedy suggests a shift away from a commitment to strict naturalism in African American drama.
- E. The work of Kennedy best exemplifies the current interest of African American artists in the spiritual and psychological worlds.

2. According to the passage, Kennedy is concerned with depicting the

- A. internal rather than the external life of her characters.
- B. madness of reality rather than the effects of reality.
- C. effects of materialism on African American minds and souls.
- D. relationship between naturalism and the human spirit.
- E. effects that her characters have on the environment.

3. Which of the following statements, if true, would most strengthen the author's assertion that Kennedy's work marks a serious departure from the tradition described in the first paragraph?

- A. Kennedy places the action in a real-life setting that is nevertheless unfamiliar to the average viewer or reader.
- B. Kennedy movingly portrays the lives and struggles of prominent African Americans in the United States.
- C. Kennedy uses characters found only in ancient African legends and mythology.
- D. Kennedy provides insights into American mimetic tradition and dramatic convention.
- E. Kennedy depicts the events in a style reminiscent of a television documentary.

Passage 5

Although many hypotheses have been proposed to explain why some plant communities are more susceptible than others to invasion by nonnative species, results from field studies have been inconsistent and no general theory of invasibility has yet emerged. However, a theory based on fluctuating resource availability could integrate most existing hypotheses and successfully resolve many of the **apparently conflicting and ambiguous results** of previous studies. The suggested theory is that a plant community becomes more susceptible to invasion whenever there is an increase in the amount of unused resources.

The diversity in the range of resource-release mechanisms could partly explain the absence of consistent ecological correlates of invasibility. In particular, the theory predicts that there will be no necessary relationship between the species diversity of a plant community and its susceptibility to invasion, since near-complete exploitation can each occur in both species-rich and species-poor communities. Though Lonsdale found a positive association between species richness and invasion, this may arise from the tendency of diverse plant communities to be nutrient poor and therefore more responsive to the effects of human-caused influxes of nutrients. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is primarily concerned with
 - A. assessing the empirical success of a theory.
 - B. explaining why no consistent theoretical account of a phenomenon has been possible.
 - C. advocating a potential solution to a theoretical impasse.
 - D. deducing testable predictions from a proposed theory.
 - E. describing the difficulties involved in explaining certain empirical results.
2. It can be inferred that the author would most likely agree with which of the following assessments of the results from field studies
 - A. Many of the results contradicted predictions of susceptibility to invasion that are based on the availability of resources unused by the community.
 - B. If fluctuating resource availability were taken into account, many of the apparent inconsistencies among the results could be explained.
 - C. The apparent inconsistencies and ambiguities in the results are caused by trying to make them fit an inadequate general theory of invasibility.
 - D. No general theory of invasibility has emerged because none of the studies has been able to assess the degree of an invasion accurately.
 - E. The results tend to show a degree of susceptibility to invasion that is lower than would be expected given the prevalence in the wild of nonnative species.
3. According to the author, the theory based on fluctuating resource availability might resolve “apparently conflicting and ambiguous results” because
 - A. It explains how a particular circumstance can produce disparate effects.
 - B. It does not assume that all of the results are instances of the phenomenon that the theory is intended to explain.
 - C. It predicts that seemingly minor variations in research methodology can have a dramatic effect on results.
 - D. Its account is based on a statistical tendency rather than on the supposition that the results arise from a causal connection.
 - E. It indicates why a similar outcome may be preceded by very different circumstances on different occasions.

Passage 6

Although some skeptics points to Arctic places such as the high latitudes of Greenland, where temperatures seem to have fallen, a recent scientific report concludes that in recent decades average temperatures have increased faster in the Arctic than elsewhere. Scientists have long suspected that several factors lead to greater temperature swings at Earths polar regions than elsewhere. First, most of the Arctic is covered in snow and ice, which are highly reflective; if snow and ice melt, the exposed soil, which absorbs heat, serves to accelerate warming. Second, the polar atmosphere is thin, so little energy is required to warm it. Third, less solar energy is lost in evaporation at the frigid poles than in the tropics. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

The passage mentions which of the following as factors that might lead to large temperature swings in Earths polar regions?

- A. the amount of energy lost due to evaporation at the poles
- B. soil exposure due to melting snow
- C. the relatively thin atmosphere at the poles

2. In pointing to the apparent temperature change in the high latitudes of Greenland, the skeptics mentioned in the passage intend to raise as a question whether

- A. Greenland is less likely to experience extreme temperature changes than are other areas of the Arctic.
- B. Those more localized temperature drops might indicate an important trend not captured by the upward trend of average Arctic temperatures.
- C. There might be a reversal of the temperature trend in the high latitudes of Greenland.
- D. The factors that cause temperature change in the high latitudes of Greenland are different from those that affect the rest of the Arctic.
- E. Greenland has more ice and snow on the ground than do other areas of the Arctic.

Passage 7

Among many historians a belief persists that Cotton Mather's biographies of some of the settlers of the *Massachusetts Bay Colony* (published 1702) are exercises in hagiography, endowing their subjects with saintly piety at the expense of historical accuracy. Yet modern studies have profited both from the breadth of information that Mather provides in, for example, his discussions of colonial medicine and from his critical observations of such leading figures as Governor John Winthrop. Mather's wry humor as demonstrated by his detailed descriptions of events such as Winthrop's efforts to prevent wood-stealing is overlooked by those charging Mather with presenting his subjects as extremely pious. The charge also obscures Mather's concern with the settlers' material, not just spiritual, prosperity. Further, this pejorative view underrates the biographies' value as chronicles: Mather amassed all sorts of published and unpublished documents as sources, and his selection of key events shows a marked sensitivity to the nature of the colony's development. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. argue against a theory universally accepted by historical researchers.
 - B. call attention to an unusual approach to documenting a historical era.
 - C. summarize research on a specific historical figure.
 - D. counter a particular view about the work of a biographer.
 - E. point out subtle differences among controversial historical reports.
2. The author of the passage implies that an argument for the historical accuracy of Mather's works is most strongly supported by which of the following?
 - A. surviving documents that corroborate Mather's detailed descriptions of his subjects
 - B. Mather's firsthand personal acquaintance with those about whom he wrote
 - C. Mather's frank and straightforward accounts of the lives and times of people about whom he had conducted extensive research
 - D. Mather's ability to detail important historical events in the religious context of which they were a part
 - E. the quantity and nature of the sources from which Mather obtained his information.
3. Information in the passage best supports which of the following statements about Mather's biographies of the settlers of the Massachusetts Bay Colony?
 - A. Annals written by Mather and others were censored by later historians, thus detracting from their value as full and accurate accounts of the period.
 - B. Mather's description of Governor Winthrop includes all of Winthrop's shortcomings, such as a tendency toward levity at inappropriate times.
 - C. Mather's descriptions of the Massachusetts Bay colonists were based primarily on firsthand experiences.
 - D. Many historians believe that Mather's biographies are poor sources of historical information because biography is an inherently unreliable genre of historical writing.
 - E. Mather's writings reflect an interest in the degree of economic success achieved by early Massachusetts Bay colonists.
4. It can be inferred from the passage that many historians believe that Mather's biographies primarily
 - A. disclose important historical data from the settlers' private diaries
 - B. glorify the early colonists of the Massachusetts Bay Colony
 - C. provide a fuller picture of the multifaceted characters of such historical figures as John Winthrop
 - D. indicate the salutary effects of the settlers' religious practices on colonial life
 - E. reveal that the settlers considered their lives to be similar to those of the saints

Passage 8

An alarming number of Mediterranean monk seals, an endangered species, have recently died. Postmortem analysis showed the presence of an as yet unidentified virus, as well as evidence of a known bacterial toxin. Seawater samples from the area where the seals died did contain unusually high concentrations of the toxic bacterium. Therefore, although both viruses and bacterial toxins can kill seals, it is more likely that these deaths were the result of the bacterial toxin. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, provides additional evidence to support the conclusion?

- A. Viruses are much more difficult to identify in postmortem analysis than bacteria are.
- B. Mediterranean monk seals are the only species of seal in the area where the bacterium was found.
- C. The bacterium is almost always present in the water in at least small concentrations.
- D. Nearly all the recent deaths were among adult seals, but young seals are far more susceptible to viruses than are adult seals.
- E. Several years ago, a large number of monk seals died in the same area as a result of exposure to a different bacterial toxin.

Passage 9

An Irish newspaper editorial encouraging women to participate in the non-importation movement launched in Ireland in 1779 appears consistent with a perception that the political use of the consumer boycott originated in North America and spread eastwards across the Atlantic to Ireland. This is a view that most historians have concurred with. For example, T.H. Breen argued that the consumer boycott was a brilliantly original American invention. **Breen did acknowledge that a few isolated boycotts may have taken place in other countries.** However, Mary O'Dowd argues that from the late seventeenth century, Irish political discourse advocated for the nonconsumption of imported goods and support for home manufactures by women in ways that were strikingly similar to those used later in North America. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is primarily concerned with

- A. resolving a dispute
- B. advocating a course of action
- C. tracing the evolution of a practice
- D. citing competing views of an issue
- E. chronicling a series of events

2. In the context of the passage, the highlighted sentence serves to

- A. qualify a point made in the preceding sentence
- B. correct an erroneous assumption
- C. provide evidence in support of a perception cited in the opening sentence
- D. provide a rationale for the view expressed in the following sentence
- E. establish the popularity of a point of view

Passage 10

A law has been proposed requiring the cargo boxes of trucks carrying gravel to be covered by a tarpaulin, because vehicles driving close behind open-topped gravel trucks can be damaged by gravel flying off these trucks. The law is unlikely to substantially reduce such damage, however: flying gravel is much less likely to come from the cargo box itself than from the grooves of the tires, in which gravel can become wedged during loading. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, provides the strongest support for the argument given?

- A. The drivers of vehicles behind a gravel truck are more likely to remain close behind the truck if the truck's cargo box is covered than if it is uncovered.
- B. Most trucks that carry gravel already carry tarpaulins that their drivers use to cover the cargo box when they are carrying sand, which can blow out of the cargo box in significant quantities.
- C. Of all the damage that occurs to vehicles on the highway, debris that flies off trucks is the cause of only a very small fraction.
- D. The proposed law allows open-topped trucks on the highway to have uncovered cargo boxes whenever their cargo boxes are empty.
- E. Because of the great weight of a load of gravel, the driver of a gravel truck is often driving much more slowly than most of the other vehicles on the road.

Passage 11

Before feminist literary criticism emerged in the 1970s, the nineteenth-century United States writer Fanny Fern was regarded by most critics (when considered at all) as a prototype of weepy sentimentalism—a pious, insipid icon of conventional American culture. Feminist **reclamations** of Fern, by contrast, emphasize her nonsentimental qualities, particularly her **sharply humorous social criticism**. Most feminist scholars find it difficult to reconcile Fern's sardonic social critiques with her effusive celebrations of many conventional values.

Attempting to resolve this contradiction, Harris concludes that Fern employed flowery rhetoric strategically to disguise her subversive goals beneath apparent conventionality. However, Tompkins proposes an alternative view of sentimentality itself, suggesting that sentimental writing could serve radical, rather than only conservative ends by swaying readers emotionally, moving them to embrace social change. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The passage suggests which of the following about the contradiction mentioned in the highlighted sentence?

- A. It was not generally addressed by critics before the 1970s.
- B. It is apparent in only a small number of Ferns writings.
- C. It has troubled many feminist critics who study Fern.

2. It can be inferred from the passage that Tompkins would be most likely to agree with which of the following about the critics mentioned in the passage?

- A. They accurately characterize the overall result Fern is aiming to achieve.
- B. They are not as dismissive of Fern as some feminist critics have suggested.
- C. They exaggerate the extent to which Fern intended her writing to serve a social purpose.
- D. They wrongly assume that sentimental must be a pejorative term.
- E. They fail to recognize the role that sentimental rhetoric plays to reader's emotions.

3. It can be inferred that the author of the passage mentions Fern's "sharply humorous social criticism" primarily in order to
- A. contrast Fern's apparent intentions with the impression her writing made on Harris
 - B. suggest that many feminist critics have attributed to Fern intentions that she may not have had
 - C. identify an aspect of Fern's writing that strikes some scholars as incompatible with other attributes of her writing
 - D. help account for the effect Fern's writing had on critics of her own time
 - E. identify the aspects of Fern's writing for which she was primarily known prior to the 1970s
4. In the context in which it appears, "reclamations" most nearly means
- A. reformations
 - B. rehabilitations
 - C. recapitulations
 - D. retractions
 - E. reiterations

Passage 12

A plant-based automobile fuel has just become available in Ternland. A car can be driven as far on a gallon of the new plant-based fuel as a car can be driven on a gallon of gasoline, but a gallon of the plant-based fuel both costs less and results in less pollution. Therefore, drivers in Ternland who switch to it will reduce the amount they spend on fuel in a year while causing less environmental damage. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument relies?

- A. There is no expense associated with operating an automobile that is higher when the automobile uses the plant-based fuel than when it uses gasoline.
- B. Automobiles that have been operated using the plant-based fuel can no longer be operated using regular gasoline.
- C. The environmental damage attributable to automobiles is due almost entirely to the production and combustion of fuel automobiles use.
- D. The advantages of the plant-based fuel over gasoline will not lead those who switch to the plant-based fuel to do more driving.
- E. Most drivers in Ternland will switch from gasoline to the plant-based fuel.

Passage 13

Biologists have long debated about whether egg production in birds is biologically highly costly, some theorizing that egg production is energetically or nutritionally demanding. Lack, however, suggested that clutch size—the number of eggs a bird lays per breeding cycle—is far below the potential limit of egg production. He suggested that clutch size had instead evolved in relation to the number of young that the parents could successfully rear. Subsequently, most studies focused on limitations operating during chick rearing, particularly among altricial species (species in which the parents feed their young in the nest). Lack later recognized that in precocial species (species in which young feed themselves), clutch size might be explained by different factors—the availability of food for egg-laying females, for example. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage suggests that biologists who say egg production in birds is biologically highly costly would agree that clutch size is determined primarily by
- A. the nutritional and energy demands of egg production
 - B. the number of young that the parents can rear successfully
 - C. reproductive limitations operating during chick rearing
 - D. the availability of food for newly hatched chicks
 - E. the differences between altricial and precocial species

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The passage suggests that Lack would agree with which of the following statements about factors affecting clutch size in birds?
- A. In altricial species, clutch size is determined primarily by factors operating after eggs are laid.
 - B. In precocial species, clutch size is determined primarily by factors operating after eggs are laid.
 - C. In many bird species, clutch size generally remains well below the potential limit of egg production.

Passage 14

Carla L. Peterson's *Doers of the Word* (1997), a study of African American women speakers and writers from 1830-1880, is an important addition to scholarship on nineteenth-century African American women. Its scope resembles that of Frances Smith Foster's 1993 study, but its approach is quite different. For Foster, the Black women who came to literary voice in nineteenth-century America were claiming their rights as United States citizens, denying that anything should disqualify them from full membership in an enlightened national polity. Peterson sees these same women as having been fundamentally estranged from the nation by a dominant culture unsympathetic to Black women, and by a Black intelligentsia whose male view of race concerns left little room for Black female intellect. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The passage indicates that Peterson identifies which of the following as obstacles faced by the women included in her study?

- A. the attitudes of Black male intellectuals toward female intellectual work
- B. the discriminatory attitudes faced by Black women in nineteenth-century America as a whole
- C. disagreements among Black women speakers and writers themselves about the impact of the Black intelligentsia

2. It can be inferred that Peterson's study and Foster's study are similar with respect to which of the following?

- A. the writers that each takes up for examination
- B. the degree to which each has influenced other scholars
- C. the assumptions that each brings to nineteenth-century African American literature
- D. their analysis of the nineteenth-century Black intelligentsia
- E. their interpretation of nineteenth-century America's dominant culture

Passage 15

David Belasco's 1912 Broadway production of *The Governor's Lady* created a sensation with a scene set in a Childs cafeteria, a chain restaurant that was an innovator in food standardization and emblematic of modern everyday life. While Belasco's meticulously detailed reproduction of an immediately recognizable setting impressed the public, it was derided by progressive theater critics who championed the New Stagecraft theories of European artists like Max Reinhardt. The New Stagecraft rejected theatrical literalism; it drew inspiration from the subjectivity and minimalism of modern painters, advocating simplified sets designed to express a dramatic text's central ideas. Such critics considered Belasco a craftsman who merely captured surface realities: a true artist eliminated the inessential to create more meaningful, expressive stage images. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage implies which of the following about Belasco's production of *The Governor's Lady*?

- A. It was dismissed by certain theater critics who misunderstood Belasco's conception of modernity.
- B. It was intended to marshal elements of the New Stagecraft to serve Belasco's predilection for realistic staging.
- C. It demonstrated that theatrical literalism could be used effectively to express a dramatic text's central ideas.
- D. It elicited responses that reflected a discrepancy between popular tastes in entertainment and the tastes of progressive theater critics.
- E. It relied on the appeal of an impressively realistic stage set to compensate for weaknesses in other aspects of the production.

2. It can be inferred that the theater critics would be most likely to agree with which of the following statements about the theatrical productions?

- A. Theatrical productions that seek to eliminate the inessential also often eliminate theatrical elements that enhance the expressiveness of a play.
- B. Theatrical productions that faithfully recreate the visual details of everyday life are unlikely to do justice to a good play's central ideas.
- C. Theatrical productions that employ the minimalism characteristic of modern paintings may have greater appeal to modern audiences than productions that rely on theatrical literalism.
- D. Theatrical productions that aim to represent truths about modern life should not attempt to employ elements of the New Stagecraft.
- E. Theatrical productions that attempt to produce authentic-looking scenes of everyday reality are likely to fail in that goal because of the theaters inherent limitations.

Passage 16

Currently, Sulandian television journalists are twice as likely as other workers to support the Blue Party, and Sulandian journalism students are significantly more likely to support the Blue Party than working television journalists are. Therefore, assuming that these students do not change their political affiliations as they get older, the disparity between the political affiliations of Sulandia's television journalists and those of the rest of the working population will increase as current Sulandian journalism students enter the profession. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

- A. Few of the television journalists currently working in Sulandia were trained in Sulandian journalism schools.
- B. Journalists in Sulandia whose political affiliations differ from those of the general population tend to allow their political views to affect the way they report news about politics.
- C. Most of the television journalists currently working in Sulandia who support the Blue Party also supported the Blue Party when they were students.
- D. Support for the Blue party is not significantly less common among those current Sulandian journalism students who intend to become television journalists than it is among current Sulandian journalism students as a whole.
- E. Classes in Sulandian journalism schools are not taught mainly by working Sulandian journalists.

Passage 17

Early naturalists believed two species of beaver lived in North America: dam beavers and bank beavers. The bank species was thought to resemble the muskrat in behavior, living in burrows or lodges and unable to build dams. In fact, dams are primarily a strategy for dealing with annual variations in water levels. If water levels fall in summer, as they do in most of North America, then beavers lodge entrances may be exposed. With stabilized water levels, their homes are much safer. Along deep rivers, where bank beavers are found, this problem seldom arises. But these beavers do know how to build dams, and do so if the need arises, as may occur if they are forced to relocate after felling and consuming all nearby trees. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage provides support for which of the following statements about beaver dams?

- A. One important function of these dams is to protect beavers' homes.
- B. Most are built prior to burrow construction.
- C. They are found mostly along deep rivers.
- D. They are routinely abandoned as nearby forests are depleted.
- E. They mainly protect beavers from rising water levels.

2. The passage implies which of the following about beavers?

- A. Bank beavers are unable to successfully compete with dam beavers when resources become scarce.
- B. Differences in dam-building behavior among beavers do not necessarily imply multiple beaver species.
- C. Building dams eventually causes beavers to deplete nearby resources.
- D. When conditions permit, beavers are more likely to build dams than burrows or lodges.
- E. In beavers, dam-building is an acquired rather than an innate skill.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

3. The passage provides support for which of the following statements about beaver dams?

- A. One important function of these dams is to protect beavers' homes.

- B. They are less likely to be found along deep rivers.
- C. They are routinely abandoned before nearby forests are depleted.

4. It can be inferred from the passage that early naturalists considered which of the following criteria when classifying beavers?

- A. The genetic similarity of beavers and muskrats
- B. The propensity of beavers to relocate
- C. The depth of water beavers occupied
- D. Beavers' dam-building capabilities
- E. Beavers' degree of exposure to danger

Passage 18

Biographies are more popular than ever, selling in numbers that have made them attractive to publishers and authors alike. Surprisingly, among the most popular are historical biographies. Often written by journalists, talented amateurs without doctorates, or Ph.D.s who do not have academic appointments, these books have helped rekindle the lay public's interest in history. But most professional historians—especially younger scholars—avoid biographical projects. In part, this is because the professional expectation that scholars produce something new makes biography appear unsophisticated. It is also because producing a definitive one that meets the high standards of the profession can be a daunting task requiring many years of research. The **tragedy** here is that biographies of historical subjects require a professional historian's touch.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The “tragedy” mentioned has to do with which of the following?

- A. Too much biographical research is being done on historical figures not worthy of full-scale biographical treatment.
- B. Excessively high standards are keeping professional historians from producing innovative academic studies.
- C. Professional historians are not tending to undertake work in an important area of scholarship that would benefit from their participation.
- D. Standards for historical research are not being clearly articulated to those engaged in biographical work.
- E. Professional historians are not receiving the kind of training that would enable them to do skilled biographical research.

2. Select the sentence that identifies a positive consequence of the popularity of historical biographies.

Passage 19

Astronomers studying a certain kind of supernova (exploding star) were surprised to find the supernovas were fainter than expected. Seeking explanations, they discounted the possibility that cosmic dust might be screening out some of the light, because it would filter out blue light more than red, causing the supernovas to appear redder than they really are. Also, unless spread very smoothly throughout space, the dust would introduce large variations in the **measurements**. Another possibility is gravitational lensing, the bending of light rays as they skirt galaxies en route. Such lensing occasionally causes brightening, but most often it contributes to the dimness of distant supernovas. Calculations show, however, that this effect becomes important only for sources more distant than the supernovas studied. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, the astronomers rejected gravitational lensing as an explanation for their findings because
 - A. gravitational lensing can cause supernovas to appear brighter than they really are.
 - B. their calculations showed a negligible effect of gravitational lensing for light rays from distant sources.
 - C. light rays traveling from the supernovas studied did not have to skirt galaxies.
 - D. the effect of gravitational lensing on the appearance of supernovas is unpredictable.
 - E. the supernovas studied were too near for gravitational lensing to have the observed dimming effect.
2. The passage implies which of the following about the measurements made by the astronomers?
 - A. There were small calculation errors in their measurements.
 - B. There were no large variations in their measurements.
 - C. Their measurements were skewed by unevenly spread cosmic dust.
 - D. Their measurements were incomplete because cosmos dust screened out some of the light.
 - E. It was possible to take more measurements of red light than of blue light.

Passage 20

Irish traditional music has benefited from state-sponsored performance competition. Competitions promote music instruction, motivate young musicians to practice, and encourage informal gatherings where musicians learn from one another. Winning an All-Ireland championship carries great national and international prestige and can help launch a professional music career. However, some musicians express concern about competitions **long-range effects**. Irish traditional music is based on diverse, individual interpretations of melodies, while objective judgment relies on constant, clearly defined standards. Competitions may have a homogenizing effect because competitors are required to perform certain nationally recognized types of tunes, such as jigs and reels, and are not allowed to play certain more obscure regional musical forms. Some also feel that competitions encourage performers to gravitate toward a flashy, performance-oriented style that is authentic only to certain regions. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred that the “long-range effects” that some musicians see as cause for concern include which of the following?
 - A. the dilution of Ireland's musician's tradition through the introduction of modern musical influences.
 - B. the encouragement of idiosyncratic interpretations of tradition melodies
 - C. a weakening of the standards by which performances of traditional music are judged
 - D. a loss of interest in traditional music among young people
 - E. a decline in the diversity of Irish music
2. The passage suggests that some critics of state-sponsored competitions would probably endorse which of the following changes in the way competitions are conducted?
 - A. Amateur and professional musician would be allowed to compete for the same awards.
 - B. Judging standards would not favor a flamboyant performance of a particular tune if that style did not reflect the performance traditions of the tune's region of origin.
 - C. All competitors would be required to play the same set of tunes so that judges would not be influenced by individual's choice of pieces.
 - D. Competition judges would be required to have proficiency in the playing of several different traditional Irish instruments.
 - E. Competitors would be evaluated less on their technical ability than on the expressiveness of their performance

Passage 21

Since 1989, the size of Porcupine caribou herd in Alaska has undergone a steady downward trend, declining at a rate of 3 to 4 percent a year. Just why this is happening is not clear. Biologists have not observed marked changes in birthrate or calf survival, nor has there been an increase in the number of predators. Consequently, some biologists have turned their attention to global warming. The rise in spring temperatures may be changing conditions along the migration route in ways that make life difficult for caribou. For example, prematurely soggy snow might force the animals up onto windswept ridge tops, where they are easier prey for wolves. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to

A. consider possible causes of the decrease in the size of the Porcupine caribou herd since 1989.

B. propose a solution to one of the problems faced by the Porcupine caribou herd as a result of global warming.

C. advocate a hypothesis about the nature of the Porcupine caribou herd prior to 1989

D. discuss how different migration routes affect the Porcupine caribou herd.

E. predict changes to the Porcupine caribou herd that will occur as a result of global warming.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply

2. The passage suggests which of the following about the migration of the Porcupine caribou herd in Alaska?

A. Prior to 1989, the herd had not been preyed upon by wolves during migration.

B. Prior to the rise in spring temperatures, the herd typically did not travel along windswept ridge tops while migrating.

C. The herd has altered its migration pattern in response to predation.

Passage 22

Most twentieth-century critics read Melville's *Pierre* as a parody of the sentimental novel. They point to its overblown prose and hyperbolic rendering of domestic manners to argue that *Pierre* is a barbed critique of bourgeois politesse. A variation of this reading stresses Melville's strategic sentimentalism, positing the *Pierre*'s romantic-familial plot was meant to engage superficial readers, while the book's deeper elements were aimed at his true audience. Both readings emphasize Melville's aloofness and authorial control, imagining the writer **by turns mocking and hoodwinking a feckless readership**. Such a strategy, however, implies a cool detachment of the artist from his creation, when in fact Melville is never more personally involved or more in earnest than he is in *Pierre*. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

For the following question, consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. According to the passage, twentieth-century critics cite which of the following in support of the idea that in *Pierre*, Melville is “by turns mocking and hoodwinking a feckless readership”?

- A. Melville's personal involvement in his creation
- B. Melville's use of an extravagant writing style
- C. Melville's exaggerated depiction of bourgeois society

2. Select the sentence that presents a reason for questioning twentieth century reading of *Pierre*.

Passage 23

New underwater tunnel projects increasingly rely upon immersed tube technology, which involves digging a channel in the seabed and then sinking prefabricated tunnel sections into it. As well as being more resilient in earthquakes, immersed tubes are generally faster and less expensive to build than traditional bored tunnels. **To begin with, problems with one section of tunnel won't necessarily delay the entire project, and because immersed tubes can have a rectangular cross-section, they are a more efficient shape than circular tunnels for side-by-side railway lines.** And while bored tunnels are usually considered stable only if their depth under the seabed at least equals their diameter, immersed tubes can sit immediately under the seafloor, allowing shallower approach gradients. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The highlighted sentence performs which of the following function in the passage?
- A. It helps explain how tunnels built for trains differ from those built primarily for automobiles.
 - B. It points out some of the advantages of bored tunnel technology.
 - C. It lists several attributes of immersed tube tunnels that support the previous sentence's assertion.
 - D. It emphasizes the extent to which unanticipated delays can add to a project's cost.
 - E. It introduces evidence that challenges certain claims about bored tunnels made earlier in the passage.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. It can be inferred from the passage that which of the following is characteristic of bored tunnels?
- A. They are the preferred option for crossing shallower spans of water.
 - B. Their stability suffers if they are not built deeply enough.
 - C. The shape of their cross-sections cannot be rectangular.

Passage 24

Many shipwrecks dating from the period between A.D.300 and 600 have been discovered in the Ramian Sea. Well over half of those ships were carrying cargo stored in large ceramic jars, many of which were preserved largely intact on the ocean floor. During that period, such jars carried only liquid. Therefore, liquid cargo was probably carried by a majority of the cargo ships that navigated the Ramian Sea during that period. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

The force of the evidence cited in the passage is most seriously weakened if which of the following is true?

- A. For ships on the Ramian Sea during the period, a full load of liquid cargo stored in large ceramic jars was not likely to be significantly heavier than a full load of other kinds of cargo that were typical of the period.
- B. There are no surviving records dating from the period that detail specific cargoes shipped across the Ramian Sea.
- C. The ratio of liquid to solid cargo shipped across the Ramian Sea did not vary significantly over the period.
- D. The presence of a sizable quantity of large ceramic jars on the ocean floor is so visually striking that a shipwreck of a ship carrying such jars is more likely to be noticed and reported than are shipwrecks of ships carrying other cargoes.
- E. During the period, grain and other solid cargo was shipped across the Ramian Sea in containers made from material other than clay.

Passage 25

Livestock-grazing programs in arid zones that are based on the equilibrium view of rangelands—that grazing-induced land degradation will occur if livestock numbers exceed the availability of food—have failed. Contrary to the equilibrium view, traditional pastoral systems of land use are more appropriate. Such systems involve a high degree of opportunism to cope with unpredictable rainfall and fluctuating food distribution. Livestock mobility relieves areas of concentration and allows herds to exploit unevenly distributed resources. A strategy of managing multiple livestock species allows optimal use of these variable grazing resources. These approaches to land use are similar to those recommended by nonequilibrium models, which assume that plant dynamics in arid zones are influenced more by rainfall than by grazing. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, the equilibrium view of rangelands is defined in terms of the relationship between

- A. distribution of rainfall and patterns of grazing
- B. predictability of rainfall and fluctuations in food distribution
- C. mobility of livestock and extent of land degradation
- D. livestock numbers and availability of food
- E. number of livestock species and variability of grazing resources

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply

2. The passage suggests that proponents of “nonequilibrium models” would agree with which of the following statements about grazing induced land degradation in arid zones?

- A. Traditional pastoral systems of land use have caused land degradation.
- B. Land degradation will occur if livestock numbers exceed the availability of food.
- C. The employment of opportunistic methods of land use can help avoid land degradation.

Passage 26

Cuts that need to be held closed in order to heal properly have generally been held closed with stitches. However, pressure to reduce medical costs is mounting. Consequently, it is likely that a newly developed adhesive will become the routine method of holding most types of cuts closed. The new adhesive holds most types of cuts closed as well as stitches do, and the cost of applying it is comparable to that of closing cuts with stitches. But whereas stitches must generally be removed by medical personnel after the cut has healed, the adhesive simply wears off. Thus, **for any cut that the adhesive can hold closed as well as stitches can, it is more economical to use the adhesive.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

In the argument given, the two highlighted portions play which of the following roles?

- A. The first is a claim that the argument disputes; the second provides evidence against that disputed claim.
- B. The first is a claim that is used as supporting evidence for the main conclusion of the argument; the second is that main conclusion.
- C. The first is a claim that is used as supporting evidence for the main conclusion of the argument; the second is a conclusion that is drawn in order to support that main conclusion.
- D. The first introduces a practice about which the argument makes a prediction, the second is a conclusion based on that prediction.
- E. The first introduces a practice about which the argument makes a prediction; the second is an assessment that is used to support that prediction.

Passage 27

In *Why Photography Matters as Art as Never Before*, Michael Fried wants to set contemporary photography squarely within the traditions of high art, especially painting. While he is by no means the first writer to make a connection between photography and painting, his theoretical assumptions will strike many as rather incredible. His book, full of daring conceptual pyrotechnics, suggests an impatience with photography's wonderfully messy history—a desire to define the nature of photography once and for all. Perhaps this rage for order is inevitable, given **all the attention** that photography has been receiving in the marketplace, in museums, and in seminar rooms. Fried wants to contain the medium's unruly powers; but it is impossible to lock photography in a conceptual stainless steel box. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Based on the passage, it can be inferred that the author believes that Fried
 - A. rejects the very features that make photography distinctive and vital
 - B. misses the truly important connections between painting and photography
 - C. mistakenly presents himself as the first to study photography within a tradition of high art
 - D. misinterprets the significance of the attention that photography has been receiving in the culture at large
 - E. makes too much of the originality of his theoretical assumptions about art and photography
2. The author implies which of the following about “all the attention”?
 - A. It has led to an unhealthy commercialization of museums and academic departments.
 - B. It has led to the practice of treating fine art photographs as commodities rather than as aesthetic objects.
 - C. It has given rise to a somewhat misguided effort to establish the essential nature of photography.
 - D. It has led to a diminishment of photography's raw power and vitality.
 - E. It has boosted the reputation of theoretically oriented critics such as Fried.

Passage 28

Early life insurers in the United States found themselves facing the problem of obtaining reliable information, as they needed to rely on applicants themselves to provide truthful, complete answers to a standard set of questions. In an attempt to personalize the relationship between insurers and their individual applicants, firms selected highly respected local citizens to act as their agents. These agents were expected to evaluate the appearance of candidates, unearth evidence of unhealthy family histories or questionable habits, and attest to the respectability of the people writing testimonial letters on an applicant's behalf. In short, the initial purpose of the agency system was not to actively solicit customers, but, rather, to recreate the glass-bowl mentality associated with small towns or **city neighborhoods**. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. explain the original function of life insurance agents
 - B. evaluate the effectiveness of early life insurance agents
 - C. describe how life insurance was first introduced
 - D. illustrate how the life insurance agency system changed over time
 - E. compare the strategies used by life insurance in cities and in small towns
2. The author suggests which of the following about “city neighborhoods”?
 - A. They were places where family histories were difficult to establish.
 - B. They were places where unhealthy behaviors had been successfully addressed.
 - C. They were locations that were well suited for recruiting insurance agents.
 - D. They offered a high degree of transparency about a resident's personal history and character.
 - E. They offered potentially fruitful markets for the life insurance industry.

Passage 29

For years, the leading theory for what caused the Younger Dryas (a dramatic reversal, about 12,900 years ago, in a global warming trend) was a release of water from Glacial Lake Agassiz. The theory posited that this meltwater flooded into the North Atlantic, lowering the salinity and intensity of surface waters enough to prevent them from sinking. Ocean currents were changed in such a way that northward transport of heat in the ocean diminished, and the North Atlantic regions plunged back into near-glacial conditions. However, evidence has emerged that the Younger Dryas began long before freshwater flooded the North Atlantic. Additionally, the temperature changes induced by a shutdown in the North Atlantic heat conveyor system are too small to explain the Younger Dryas. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage implies which of the following about the release of water from glacial Lake Agassiz?

- A. The notion that the release occurred has been challenged by more recent findings.
- B. The release probably occurred much earlier than scientists have generally assumed.
- C. The release would not have been sufficient to cause any temperature change in the North Atlantic.
- D. The timing of the release is such that it probably did not trigger the onset of the Younger Dryas.
- E. The release was probably unrelated to the global warming trend that was taking place.

2. The passage is primarily concerned with

- A. presenting evidence that undermines an explanation
- B. explaining the nature of a climatological phenomenon
- C. questioning the timing of a particular event
- D. discussing a new explanation for a phenomenon
- E. suggesting revisions to a popular theory

Passage 30

One reason researchers have long believed that Mars never enjoyed an extensive period of warm and wet climate is that much of the surface not covered by wind-borne dust appear to be composed of unweathered material. **If water flowed for an extended period, researchers reasoned, it should have altered and weathered the volcanic minerals, creating clays or other oxidized, hydrated phases (minerals that incorporate water molecules in their crystal structure) .**

It turns out, though, that the scientists were not looking closely enough. New high-resolution mapping data and close-up surface studies have revealed clays and other hydrated minerals in many regions. The clay deposits are scattered all over, in ancient volcanic surfaces and heavily cratered highland regions, some of which have apparently been exposed by erosion only recently. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, scientists are able to discover weathered material on the Martian surface because they have benefited from which of the following?

- A. a new method to analyze volcanic craters created on the Martian surface
- B. an improved ability to detect hydrated materials on the Martian surface
- C. a more sophisticated understanding of the effect of wind-borne dust on the Martian surface
- D. a decision to look for water primarily in heavily cratered highland regions
- E. a better understanding of how erosion might affect clay deposits

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. It can be inferred from the passage that the author would agree with which of the following statements regarding the reasoning discussed in the highlighted sentence?

- A. It provides the basis for an explanation of why water on Mars has been difficult to find until recently.
- B. It correctly identifies a consequence of water flowing on the Martian surface.
- C. It depends on a false assumption about how water and volcanic materials interact on Mars.

Passage 31

Scientific consensus is that humans first began to have a warming effect on Earth's climate within the past century, after coal-burning factories, power plants, and motor vehicles began releasing carbon dioxide (CO₂) and other greenhouse gases in significant quantities into the air. **However, evidence suggests that human agricultural activities may have had such an effect much earlier:** concentrations of CO₂ started rising about 8000 years ago, even though natural trends indicate they should have been dropping; methane levels rose similarly about 3,000 years later. Without these rises, however, current temperatures in northern parts of North America and Europe would be cooler by three to four degrees Celsius-enough to inhibit agriculture-and an ice age would probably have begun several thousand years ago in northeastern Canada. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted sentence?
 - A. It undermines the assumption that human activity has had a significant impact on Earth's climate
 - B. It supports the assumption that Earth's temperatures have risen appreciably over the past 100 years
 - C. It questions the assumption that greenhouse gases have had a warming effect on Earth's climate
 - D. It challenges the assumption that human activity began to affect Earth's climate after the advent of industrialization
 - E. It supports the assumption that greenhouse gases are a direct by-product of industrial activities
2. The author mentions "natural trends" most likely in order to
 - A. propose a possible explanation for why current temperatures in North America and Europe are not as low as they might otherwise be
 - B. explain why levels of methane in Earth's atmosphere began to rise approximately 5,000 years ago
 - C. suggest that Earth's climate would have become even warmer without the advent of human agricultural activities
 - D. identify factors that may have contributed to the rise of greenhouse gases in Earth's atmosphere approximately 8,000 years ago and again some 3,000 years later
 - E. support the claim that human activity may have played a role in the rise in CO₂ and methane levels in the atmosphere thousands of years ago

Passage 32

Princessfish are a species of coral-reef fish that are captured alive by divers who first stun the individual fish by squirting a certain poison at them. Since the divers limit their catch to a few individuals and take care not to overfish, the divers' continuing activities will clearly not result in serious harm to populations of princessfish. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weaken the argument given?

- A. Princessfish cannot be captured alive by traditional methods of fishing.
- B. The poison used to stun the princessfish has no effect on humans who eat them.
- C. Demand for princessfish has remained steady during the last decade.
- D. Traces of the poison that remain in the seawater damage the Corals that create and maintain the reefs on which princessfish depend.
- E. Fish that have been stunned but have selected for capture by the divers soon recover from the temporary effect of the poison.

Passage 33

With few exceptions, the many commercial frozen foods introduced in the United States in the 1950s found little consumer acceptance, in part because few Americans had significant freezer space. Most freestanding freezers were owned by farm families, who tended to fill their freezers with their own produce. Meanwhile, the working couples and small families in cities and towns whom the food industry had identified as the likeliest consumers of commercial frozen food lacked freezer space. While new refrigerators coming on the market had large separate freezer compartments, many consumers still used **old refrigerators** with tiny interior freezer compartments, and such consumers seemed convinced that they did not have space for a freestanding freezer in a small house or apartment. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The passage suggests which of the following regarding United States farm families in the early 1950s?

- A. Despite the fact that many farm families had sufficient freezer space to hold commercial frozen foods, the food industry did not consider farm families to be the likeliest consumers of such foods.
- B. While farm families were more likely than other consumers to have sufficient freezer space to hold commercial frozen foods, they usually used that freezer space in other ways.
- C. Although farm families were more likely than other consumers to have adequate household space for freestanding freezers, more farm families had refrigerators with separate freezing compartments than had freestanding freezers.

2. The author mentions "old refrigerators" primarily in order to

- A. describe a drawback to a product innovation mentioned earlier in the sentence
- B. elaborate on a claim regarding a group of consumers that was made earlier in the passage
- C. help explain the basis for a marketing strategy alluded to earlier in the passage
- D. explain why a group of consumers chose not to replace an outdated product with a newer model
- E. discuss the impact of a particular consumer belief about a product discussed earlier in the passage

Passage 34

Archaeologists studying Bonito phase (ca. A.D. 900-1140) Native American ceramics from Chaco Canyon, New Mexico, observed that many pots had been altered after firing to revise their decorative designs--usually, intricate geometric patterns painted in black on white slipped surfaces. In some cases, a new design was imposed over an earlier one; less often, the original design was simply covered with white slip. Crown and Wills doubt that the alterations were made to correct design errors. Many Chaco pots with design errors were left unaltered. Furthermore, when errors were corrected, revisions were made prior to firing—either by painting directly over the error or by scraping off designs and applying new slip and paint, which is a less time-consuming method than repainting and refiring flawed pots. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage mentions Crown and Wills primarily in order to
 - A. distinguish among different factors that might have caused Chaco potters to alter their pots' decorative designs.
 - B. introduce new evidence related to the question of why Chaco potters altered their pots' decorative designs.
 - C. show how one potential explanation for the alteration of Chaco pots has been discounted.
 - D. present a hypothesis about why Chaco pots were altered to revise their decorative designs.
 - E. explain how archaeologists discerned the method by which Chaco pots were originally decorated.
2. According to the passage, which of the following is true of Bonito phase Chaco pots?
 - A. Relatively few of them have original designs concealed beneath white surfaces.
 - B. Relatively few of them were altered after firing.
 - C. Many of their alterations increased the intricacy of their painted designs.
 - D. Many of them have some flaw in their shape or structure.
 - E. Many of them were altered more than once.

Passage 35

Reasons for uncertainty about the timing of the Thule migration [the movement of a proto-Inuit culture from Alaska to northern Canada and Greenland] are many, but primary among them are the well-known problems with radiocarbon dating in the Arctic. In particular, radiocarbon dates obtained on two kinds of organic remains that typically are common in the remains of Thule dwellings—driftwood and sea mammal bone—are likely to be older than the archaeological context in which they are found. Driftwood found in archaeological sites in the form of fuel or as part of an artifact assemblage may have sat on beaches for centuries before being utilized, and sea mammal bone is subject to the marine reservoir effect in which living tissue (including bone) incorporates ancient carbon, which also results in dates that are too old. Beyond this, however, many dates obtained in decades past simply seem too old, and there is a widespread suspicion among archaeologists that **pretreatment methods** may not always have eliminated the presence of substances derived from sea mammals, especially fat, which can be absorbed into wood, bone, and other materials and thereby contaminate them. As a result of these and other factors, both McGhee and Park have shown that the full spectrum of existing Thule radiocarbon dates, numbering in the hundreds, covers much too wide a range to reflect Thule chronology accurately. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to

- A. question a recommendation
- B. outline a chronology
- C. describe a method
- D. criticize a hypothesis
- E. summarize a problem

2. The passage implies which of the following about the "pretreatment methods"?

- A. They may have caused the contamination of wood, bone, and other materials.
- B. They were intended to remove potential sources of error in radiocarbon dates.
- C. They were not intended to eliminate sea mammal fat from organic materials.
- D. They reflect a fundamental misunderstanding of the proper use of radiocarbon dating.
- E. They are likely to work properly on materials taken from regions outside the Arctic.

3. Which of the following best describes the organization of the passage?

- A. The cause of an impediment is identified and various contributing factors are described.
- B. A theory to explain a discrepancy is presented, evaluated, and then qualified.
- C. A controversial hypothesis is described, and then reasons to question it are presented.
- D. Some data supporting a viewpoint are questioned, and then an alternative interpretation is suggested.
- E. A common misconception about an occurrence is described and reason for the misconception is suggested.

Passage 36

Astronomers have had difficulty accounting for certain planets discovered outside our solar system. They are called hot Jupiters because each is similar in mass to Jupiter, the largest solar-system planet, but orbits its parent star at a fraction of the distance at which Earth, let alone Jupiter, orbits the Sun. In the standard, solar-system-based theory of planetary formation, such a massive planet could not form so close to a star. So most **attempts** to explain a hot Jupiter's existence envision it forming farther away, then migrating inward. According to one hypothesis, the planet's gravitational field tugs on the protoplanetary disk of dust and gas from which it formed. The disk exerts its own gravitational tug, and this interplay of forces robs the planet of momentum in its orbital path, forcing it to spiral in toward the star. According to another hypothesis, the planet's gravitational field is so strong that it creates a groove in the disk, partitioning it into inner and outer regions; the resulting gravitational interactions between the planet and these regions cause the planet to lose orbital momentum and spiral inward. Another question remains: what prevents the planet from continuing its spiral until it collides with the star? 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage mentions "Earth" primarily in order to
 - A. stress the massive size of a hot Jupiter
 - B. emphasize the proximity of a hot Jupiter to its parent star
 - C. imply that hot Jupiters are unlikely to harbor extraterrestrial life
 - D. point out differences between Earth and Jupiter with regard to their orbital distance from the Sun
 - E. illustrate how hot Jupiters might fit into the standard theory of planetary formation
2. Which of the following elements is part of one but not both of the hypotheses discussed in the passage?
 - A. an interplay of gravitational forces
 - B. a loss of orbital momentum
 - C. a protoplanetary disk composed of dust and gas
 - D. a protoplanetary disk divided into two regions.
 - E. a tendency of the inward spiral
3. It can be inferred from the passage that the "attempts" share which of the following goals?
 - A. to explain how a Jupiter-sized planet could form so close to its parent star.
 - B. to explain what prevents a hot Jupiter from colliding with its parent star.
 - C. to determine whether a hot Jupiter is formed from a protoplanetary disk of dust and gas.
 - D. to determine whether a hot Jupiter's gravitational field is strong enough to create a groove in its protoplanetary disk
 - E. to account for hot Jupiters in a way that is not inconsistent with the standard theory of planetary formation.

Passage 37

Because the subject matter was so personal, the work of several prominent mid-twentieth century poets has been termed “confessional” poetry. But confession is a bad metaphor for what those poets did. The motive for confession is penitential or therapeutic—by speaking openly about personal guilt and suffering, the poet hopes to make them easier to bear. But these poets always approached their writing as artists, and their motive was aesthetic. Writing from experiences like madness, despair, and lust, their aim was to make effective art, not to cure themselves. To treat their poems mainly as documents of personal experience is not just to diminish the poets’ achievement, but to ignore their unanimous disdain for the idea of confessional poetry. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The author of the passage suggests that applying the term “confessional” to the work of the poets discussed
- A. is mistaken in what it seems to imply about the poets’ motivation
 - B. might seem superficially appropriate given the subject matter of the poems
 - C. is an error arising from the absence of any other convenient term

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The passage implies that the poets discussed did NOT
- A. think that a poet’s motivation for writing was relevant in evaluating that poet’s work
 - B. experience any relief of their personal suffering as a result of writing
 - C. apply to their own work the label by which it has subsequently been known

Passage 38

Astronomers who study planet formation once believed that comets—because they remain mostly in the distant Oort cloud, where temperatures are close to absolute zero—must be pristine relics of the material that formed the outer planets. The conceptual shift away from seeing comets as pristine relics began in the 1970s, when laboratory simulations revealed there was sufficient ultraviolet radiation reaching comets to darken their surfaces and there were sufficient cosmic rays to alter chemical bonds or even molecular structure near the surface. Nevertheless, astronomers still believed that when a comet approached the Sun—where they could study it—the Sun's intense heat would remove the corrupted surface layer, exposing the interior. About the same time, though, scientists realized comets might contain decaying radioactive isotopes that could have warmed cometary interiors to temperatures that caused the interiors to evolve. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. According to the passage, astronomers recognize which of the following as being liable to cause changes to comets?

- A. cosmic rays
- B. radioactive decay
- C. ultraviolet radiation

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. According to the passage, astronomers' belief that comets are pristine relics was

- A. overturned by analysis of what happens when comets approach the Sun
- B. supported by what observations revealed about the composition of the outer planets
- C. based on consideration of the conditions that prevail where comets are located

3. The author suggests that the realization described in the final sentence of the passage had which of the following effects?

- A. It introduced a new topic for study by astronomers interested in planetary formation.
- B. It led astronomers to adopt a number of different strategies in trying to determine the composition of cometary interiors.
- C. It called into question an assumption that astronomers had made about comets.
- D. It cast doubt on astronomers' ability to study the interior parts of comets.
- E. It caused astronomers to revise their account of the composition of the outer planets.

4. It can be inferred that the author would agree with which of the following statements about the "laboratory simulations"?

- A. The simulations showed that despite the low temperatures in the Oort cloud, there was sufficient energy there to alter comets.
- B. Astronomers were initially reluctant to accept what simulations showed about the composition of comets.
- C. The simulations themselves did not eliminate the possibility that comets contain pristine relics of material from the early solar system.

Passage 39

Biologists studying wild monkeys sometimes need the genetic material DNA from a particular monkey to determine the animal's parentage. Until recently, DNA could be extracted only from blood. Collecting a blood sample required tranquilizing the donor animal. Now DNA can be extracted from hair. Monkeys shed large quantities of hair in places where they sleep. Therefore, researchers will now be able to determine the parentage of individual monkeys from DNA without tranquilizing the monkeys. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

- A. The places in which monkeys sleep are easily accessible to researchers.
- B. Information about a particular monkey's parentage is the only kind of information that can be determined from DNA that has been extracted from that monkey's hair.
- C. For at least some samples of hair collected from monkey habitat it will be possible to associate hairs with the individual monkeys from which they came.
- D. Examining DNA is the only way to determine the parentage of wild monkeys.
- E. It will be necessary to obtain any hair samples used in determining a monkey's parentage from a place where the monkey has slept.

Passage 40

Buell's study of village sketches (a type of fiction popular in the United States in the 1830s and 1840s) provides a valuable summary of sketches that portray the community as homogeneous and fixed, but it ignores those by women writers, which typically depicted the diversity that increasingly characterized actual village communities at that time. These women's geographical mobility was restricted (although women writers of the time were not uniformly circumscribed in this way), and their subject matter reflected this fact. Yet their texts were enriched by what Gilligan, writing in a different context, has called the ability to attend to voices other than one's own. To varying degrees, the women's sketches portray differences among community members: all stress differences among men and among women (particularly the latter) as well as differences between the sexes, and some also depict cultural diversity. These writers represent community as dynamic, as something that must be negotiated and renegotiated because of its members' divergent histories, positions, expectations, and beliefs. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. According to the passage, village sketches written by women in the United States in the 1830s and 1840s typically reflected

- A. the negotiations that characterized trade relationships between villages
- B. the fact that these women did not often travel very far beyond their own village
- C. the plurality of experiences and ideas that existed among the residents of a village

2. Select the sentence in the passage that contrasts how men and women depicted life in village communities.

3. The passage indicates that when Gilligan spoke of "the ability to attend to voices other than one's own," she

- A. did not consider that ability to be a desirable psychological characteristic
- B. did not believe that individuals differ greatly with respect to that ability
- C. was implying that that ability enhances a sense of belonging in communities
- D. was assuming that good writers are able to depict diverse characters
- E. was not discussing the women who wrote village sketches

Passage 41

While Venice, with its islands and canals, has always experienced periodic flooding, the frequency and severity of flooding have increased dramatically over the past century, primarily due to natural and human-caused subsidence (lowering of the ground level). Over a 40-year period, ground water was pumped from natural reservoirs beneath the city to supply surrounding factories. As water was pumped out, these aquifers—which are like rocky sponges—compressed, and the ground sank. This compression has combined with global sea-level changes to produce an effective rise in sea level at Venice of 23 centimeters over the past century. Groundwater is no longer being extracted, but natural subsidence, probably caused by shifting tectonic plates, continues to lower the city by 0.5 millimeter annually. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage mentions each of the following as a possible factor contributing to the increased frequency and severity of flooding in Venice over the past century EXCEPT
 - A. extraction of ground water
 - B. changes in sea level
 - C. shifting of tectonic plates
 - D. compression of aquifers beneath the city
 - E. seepage of groundwater into canals
2. Select the sentence that mentions a cause of increased flooding in Venice other than subsidence.

Passage 42

Carolina Hospital notes that Cuban-American writers who write primarily in English are dismissed from anthologies and analyses of Cuban exile literature on that account. She argues that since these writers were born in Cuba and consider themselves Cuban writers, they should not be ignored, and maintains that they represent a new phase of Cubanness, one that is expressed in the language **comfortable** to its writers—English. Moreover, another critic notes that the Spanish and English traditions of Cuban-American writing have different but equally viable functions. The English branch seeks to create a distinctive culture of Cuban roots in the United States, whereas the Spanish branch wishes to preserve a specifically Cuban culture while seeking affiliation with the canon of Latin American letters. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. Hospital, as presented in the passage, would probably agree with which of the following statements about Cuban-American writing?

- A. For Cuban-American writers, writing in English is not irreconcilable with Cuban identity.
- B. All Cuban-American writers are generally recognized as contributing to Cuban exile literature.
- C. It is appropriate for anthologies of Cuban exile literature to include works written both in Spanish and in English.

2. In the context in which it appears, “comfortable” most nearly means

- A. prosperous
- B. sufficient
- C. agreeable
- D. restful
- E. painless

Passage 43

Constant variations in the amount of sunlight available on Earth at any given location make energy storage a necessary design feature of terrestrial solar-energy systems. For systems transforming solar to thermal energy, the thermal energy may be stored in matter as either latent heat or sensible heat. Latent heat is absorbed or released whenever matter changes phase, as when matter changes from liquid to gas, for example, or from gas to liquid. Large heat capacities are associated with certain materials, like salts, but in any substance this storage is available only at the unique fixed temperature at which the particular phase transition occurs in that substance. Moreover, materials that have transitions at the temperatures that terrestrial solar-energy systems are likely to encounter are usually destructively corrosive at those temperatures. The storage of sensible heat, on the other hand, allows flexibility as to temperature, in addition, safe substances like water and most rocks have large sensible heat capacities. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to discuss which of the following?
- A. reasons for the necessity for developing solar-energy systems
 - B. different ways of storing solar energy as heat
 - C. new designs for devices that collect solar energy
 - D. procedures for transferring thermal energy between materials
 - E. differences between capacities of solids and liquids to store sensible heat

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. According to the passage, solar-energy systems located on Earth must store energy for which of the following reasons?
- A. At any given location on Earth, the amount of sunlight available frequently changes.
 - B. The operation of such systems depends on devices that require a power source other than solar energy.
 - C. Demand for the energy produced by such systems varies in unpredictable ways.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

3. The author suggests that which of the following constitutes a potential disadvantage of using latent heat for energy storage?
- A. The circumstances under which phase transitions occur would limit the versatility of latent heat as a storage method.
 - B. The supply of substances that possess the properties that are needed in a medium for latent heat storage is dwindling.
 - C. The properties that are needed in a medium for latent heat storage are found in substances that have other, undesirable properties.

Passage 44

Exotic insect pests can produce both short-and long-term effects on forest ecosystems. Short-term effects include the disturbances directly associated with the action of the pest, which may cause the defoliation, loss of vigor, or death of trees. Long-term effects are primarily mediated by changes in tree species composition and the consequent alterations of forest structure, productivity, and nutrient uptake. Exotic pests are more efficient than most abiotic disturbances (e.g., fire or wind) at producing long-term changes in species composition. Pests often target specific tree species and, if they become established, they usually remain as permanent components of the ecosystem. Shifts in forest species composition ramify through the ecosystem in many ways because tree species have different, often **unique properties**.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The passage mentions which of the following as effects of exotic pests on forest ecosystems?

- A. decreased vitality in trees
- B. defoliation of trees
- C. changes in forest structure

2. The author of the passage mentions the “unique properties” of tree species primarily in order to help explain

- A. why pests tend to target specific tree species
- B. why pests can have long-term effects on entire ecosystems
- C. how pests contribute to shifts in forest species composition
- D. how pests are able to become established in an ecosystem
- E. how some tree species are able to withstand the effects of pests

Passage 45

For centuries, oak was the wood of choice for European shipbuilders. However, toward the end of the eighteenth century, as British oak supplies grew scarce, shipbuilders there **turned to** teak and found in it an ideal substitute. Other woods expand and contract at different rates than oak, so repairs to oak ships done with those woods split or leak. Only teak matches oak's expansion coefficient and stays watertight. It is unmatched in its resistance to rot and pests, and its oils even protect nails against corrosion. Moreover, it was one of two important tropical hardwoods (with Central American mahogany) that dried light enough to float downriver--the only way to transport timber in quantity from the inland jungles where it grew. 【微信公众号：

张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. It can be inferred from the passage that an advantage of teak over mahogany is that teak is

- A. more compatible with the materials in existing ships.
- B. less susceptible to rot and pests.
- C. available in greater quantities in inland jungles.

2. In the context in which it appears, “turned to” most nearly means

- A. rotated
- B. resorted to
- C. deflected from
- D. reverted to
- E. revolved around

Passage 46

For the first time, funding for designing experiments to be conducted during space flights has been made available by the government space program to university biologists not already employed by the space program. From the fact that little interest has been expressed in this offer, however, it cannot be concluded that virtually the only biologists interested in research that such experiments could address are those biologists already employed by the space program, since _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following most logically completes the argument given?

- A. relatively few of the biologists already employed by the space program have ever held university positions.
- B. there are more research biologists in industry than at universities.
- C. biologists are not the only scientists interested in research that could be furthered by the opportunity to conduct experiments in space.
- D. the space program employs only a small percentage of the research biologists employed by the government.
- E. much of the biological research currently funded by the government's space program is concerned with the biological effects of a weightless environment.

Passage 47

From the 1880s to the 1930s, the textile industry in Japan employed over half of all workers, most of them in the three major branches of silk reeling, cotton spinning, and weaving. Because the branches were highly diverse—in scale, skill requirements, and technology—historians traditionally have analyzed them separately. However, the workforces of all three were drawn primarily from the same population: young, mostly rural women aged 10 to 25. Noting this commonality, Hunter argues that a consideration of the three branches of production together is long overdue: examining elements common to the different branches of textile production may, she asserts, permit the identification of gender-based factors that may have influenced the operation of the Japanese female labor market as a whole. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following does the passage cite as an explanation for historians' traditional analysis of the Japanese textile industry?

- A. a common workforce population across all branches of textile manufacturing
- B. similarities in the skills required for silk reeling, cotton spinning, and weaving
- C. the importance of the textile industry to the Japanese economy as a whole
- D. the high number of female factory workers employed within the textile industry
- E. differences in the technology used in the three major branches of textile production

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. It can be inferred that Hunter regards which of the following to be a shortcoming of historians' traditional analyses discussed in the passage?

- A. their failure to examine factors common to the three different branches of Japanese textile production
- B. their separation of the Japanese textile industry into three major branches based on differences in scale, skill requirements, and technology
- C. their failure to acknowledge the contribution made by rural women to the different branches of the textile industry

Passage 48

When studying shrimp feeding from hydro-thermal vents at the bottom of the ocean, biologists were surprised that the shrimps' reproductive cycles followed seasonal patterns. Far beyond the reach of sunlight, and with food abundant around the vents all year round, why should such animals reproduce seasonally? The answer might involve their offspring, which in their larval form drift in the currents to colonize new vents. The larvae must feed during their trip, and their springtime release coincides with a peak in algae raining down from surface waters. **So far, researchers have found no evidence of seasonal breeding among vent-dwelling species that provide their offspring with yolk to sustain them or among vent-dwelling species found in areas of the ocean with not seasonal algae blooms.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted sentence?

- A. It casts doubt on the accuracy of earlier observations of seasonal breeding among shrimp species living near hydro-thermal vents.
- B. It undermines the explanation proposed for seasonal breeding among some shrimp species living near hydro-thermal vents.
- C. It suggests that alternative theories are needed to explain seasonal breeding among shrimp species living near hydro-thermal vents.
- D. It describes the survival benefits to shrimp of mating in parts of the ocean where algae blooms rain down abundantly.
- E. It supports the explanation proffered for the seasonal breeding observed among some shrimp species living near hydro-thermal vents.

Passage 49

There is mounting evidence that the frequency and magnitude of landsliding is changing in many parts of the world in response to climate change. This is not surprising, given that precipitation is one of the two external triggering mechanisms—the other being seismic activity—involved in the formation of landslides. **Evidence from the past** clearly indicates that cycles of elevated landslide activity have been followed by cycles of low activity, and that these are correlated with climate fluctuations over a variety of timescales.

What sets current changes in landslide activity apart is the likely influence of anthropogenic [i.e., human-caused] factors, either acting alone or in concert with climate, which can further modify the process of landsliding and the nature of ecosystem responses. Among these factors, deforestation and land-use change have the potential to influence the frequency and magnitude of landsliding because of their direct effects on vegetation attributes that influence slope stability. The extent and conditions under which mountain ecosystems are resilient to these changes—that is, the amount of disturbance they can absorb before changing into states with different structure and function—are not known. Addressing this issue is crucial for the long-term conservation of mountain scapes. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage cites “evidence from the past” in order to
 - A. support a partial explanation
 - B. concede a potential objection
 - C. dismiss an apparent counterexample
 - D. highlight a scientific consensus
 - E. account for a historical anomaly
2. The passage makes which of the following claims?
 - A. A rise in precipitation resulting from human factors has increased the frequency and magnitude of landsliding.
 - B. Human factors have led to greater changes in landsliding activity than have cyclical climate fluctuations.
 - C. Decreases in landsliding activity have historically been accompanied by changes in climate.
 - D. Slope stability is more influenced by seismic activity than it is by human factors.
 - E. Changes in land-use patterns in mountain ecosystems are generally correlated with changes in climate.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

3. The author of the passage suggests which of the following about the role of human factors in landsliding activity?
 - A. Human factors can intensify or alter the effects of climate change on landsliding activity.
 - B. It is likely that human factors affect landsliding activity more than climate change does.
 - C. Until recently, human factors did not have much impact on landsliding activity.

Passage 50

There have been numerous well-documented extinctions of indigenous species caused by the introduction of non-indigenous predators and pathogens. However, surprisingly few extinctions of indigenous species can be attributed to competition from introduced species. For example, during the past 400 years, 4,000 plant species have been introduced into North America, and these non-indigenous plants currently account for nearly 20 percent of North America's plant species. Yet no evidence exists that any indigenous North American plant species became extinct as a result of competition from new species could mean that such extinctions take longer to occur than scientists initially believed or, alternatively, that extinctions are rarely caused by competition from non-indigenous species. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is concerned primarily with

- A. pointing out that a particular type of species extinction is rarely known to occur.
- B. proposing a possible explanation for conflicting data about a particular type of species extinction.
- C. resolving a debate about the frequency of a particular type of species extinction.
- D. comparing two theories regarding possible causes of a particular type of species extinction.
- E. refuting a proposed explanation for the increasingly rare occurrence of a particular type of species extinction.

2. The author introduces statistics about North America's non-indigenous plant species primarily in order to

- A. undermine a proposed explanation for the absence of any evidence for the occurrence of a particular phenomenon
- B. contrast the effect of introduced plant species in North America with the effect that introduced animal species have had
- C. suggest that North America's indigenous plants are a domain in which there has been ample scope for a particular effect to have occurred
- D. emphasize how much the ecology of North America has been affected over the past 400 years by the introduction of non-indigenous species
- E. substantiate a claim about the overall effect that the introduction of non-indigenous species tends to have on indigenous populations

Passage 51

The relevance of the literary personality—a writer’s distinctive attitudes, concerns, and artistic choices—to the analysis of a literary work is being scrutinized by various schools of contemporary criticism. Deconstructionists view the literary personality, like the writer’s biographical personality, as irrelevant. The proper focus of literary analysis, they argue, is a work’s intertextuality(interrelationship with other texts), subtexts (unspoken, concealed, or repressed discourses), and metatexts (self-referential aspects), not a perception of a writer’s verbal and aesthetic “fingerprints.” New historicists also devalue the literary personality, since, in their emphasis on a work’s historical contexts, they **credit a writer with** only those insights and ideas that were generally available when the writer lived. However, to readers interested in literary detective work—say scholars of classical(Greek and Roman) literature who wish to reconstruct damaged texts or deduce a work’s authorship—the literary personality sometimes provides vital clues. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is primarily concerned with

- A. discussing attitudes toward a particular focus for literary analysis
- B. describing the limitations of two contemporary approaches to literary analysis
- C. pointing out the similarities among seemingly contrasting approaches to literary analysis
- D. defending the resurgence of a particular focus for literary analysis
- E. defining a set of related terms employed in literary criticism

For the following question, consider each of the choice separately and select all that apply.

2. It can be inferred from the passage that on the issue of how to analyze a literary work, the new historicists would most likely agree with the deconstructionists that

- A. The writer’s insights and ideas should be understood in terms of the writer’s historical context.
- B. The writer’s literary personality has little or no relevance.
- C. The critic should primarily focus on intertextuality, subtexts and metatexts.

3. In the context in which it appears, “credit a writer with” most nearly means

- A. trust a writer with
- B. applaud a writer for
- C. believe a writer created
- D. presume a writer had
- E. accept a writer for

Passage 52

The physicist Wallace Sabine pioneered the scientific study of architectural acoustics when he was asked in 1895 to fix a **university lecture hall** in which the echo of a speaker's words rendered them unintelligible. He found that the length of time it takes a sound's echo to decay is determined by the absorption of the sound's original energy by surrounding material. By hanging panels of sound-absorbing felt on the walls, Sabine reduced the echo enough to make the hall usable. And the data he compiled yielded a mathematical formula for the relationship between a room's echo duration, its quantity and quality of sound-absorbing materials, and its spatial volume. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following can be inferred about the "university lecture hall" mentioned in the passage?

- A. It was not originally designed to be used for lecture.
- B. It was more suitable for listening to music than for listening to the spoken word.
- C. Its walls had surfaces made of material with very poor sound-absorbing properties.
- D. Its poor acoustics resulted from its being designed to accommodate a large audience.
- E. It was constructed at a time when sound-absorbing building materials were not readily available.

2. The passage suggests that Sabine's work made which of the following possible for the first time?

- A. to make a room soundproof
- B. to build an auditorium out of sound-absorbing materials
- C. to construct an enclosed space in which sound would not echo
- D. to design a building to meet predetermined specifications with regard to echo duration
- E. to render any large room usable for public lectures and performances

Passage 53

The manuscripts of the eight extant Latin tragedies identify the plays as the *Marci Lucii Annei Senecae Tragoediae*. Since nobody of that name is known, modern scholars believe the dramas to be the work of Lucius Annaeus Seneca the Younger, the well-known philosopher, orator and politician. Clearly the tragedies were written during Seneca's lifetime: internal references to earlier poets, most notably Ovid, indicate that the dramas cannot have been composed prior to the second decade C.E., and the plays must have been written by 96 C.E., when Quintilian quotes *Medea*, one of the tragedies.

It is remarkably, however, that Seneca himself never mentions the plays, since there are certain passages in them that could be used to illustrate points of his philosophy. There are at least two possible explanations. In the early Roman Empire, playwrights were sometimes exiled or executed for lines constructed as directed against the emperor; thus, Seneca's silence may be simple prudence. But if anyone could safely attach his name to dramas, surely it would be Seneca, the emperor's tutor. And although Herrmann offers Seneca's modesty as an explanation, Seneca is not averse to referring to his other writings. The evidence for equating Seneca with the author of the tragedies seems circumstantial. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author mentions *Medea* primarily in order to

- A. give an example of a play in which references to certain authors can be used to determine when the *Marci Lucii Annei Senecae Tragoediae* were composed
- B. acknowledge the possibility that the *Marci Lucii Annei Senecae Tragoediae* may have been written by Quintilian rather than Seneca
- C. suggest that certain of the *Marci Lucii Annei Senecae Tragoediae* may have been written near the end of Seneca's lifetime
- D. argue that *Marci* may have been one of the last of the eight plays in the *Marci Lucii Annei Senecae Tragoediae* to be written
- E. indicate how the latest possible date for the time period during which the *Marci Lucii Annei Senecae Tragoediae* were composed might be established

2. The author of the passage makes which of the following claims about the eight extant Latin tragedies?

- A. There is only circumstantial evidence that the plays were all written by the same author.
- B. Scholars have persistently attributed the plays to Seneca despite evidence that some of them may have been composed prior to his lifetime.
- C. Evidence in the manuscripts of the plays identifies them as having been written by Lucius Annaeus Seneca the Younger.
- D. The plays contain some lines that have been construed as being directed against the emperor.
- E. The plays contain material that could illustrate certain aspects of Seneca's philosophy.

3. The author of the passage would most likely agree that if Seneca had in fact written the tragedies, then Seneca probably would have

- A. used the plays as platforms for his philosophical ideas
- B. referred to the plays in some of his other writings
- C. been in danger of exile or execution for certain lines in the plays
- D. avoided attaching his name to the plays out of modesty
- E. written the plays during the latter portion of his lifetime

4. The author implies which of the following about Seneca's status as the emperor's tutor?
- A. It enabled Seneca to illustrate points of his philosophy to the leaders of the early Roman Empire.
 - B. It had more of an effect on Seneca's career as a dramatist than it did on his career as a philosopher, orator, and politician.
 - C. It might have offered Seneca some protection from certain dangers playwrights typically faced.
 - D. It required Seneca to avoid making references to his various writings.
 - E. It required that Seneca take particular care that his writings could not be construed as being directed against the emperor.
5. Each of the following assertions consistent with Seneca's authorship of the plays appears in the passage EXCEPT
- A. There is no known author by the name to which the plays are attributed.
 - B. Playwrights in the early Roman Empire were politically vulnerable.
 - C. There are references in the play to Ovid.
 - D. There are references in the plays to Seneca's philosophical works.
 - E. There are quotations from the plays in the works of Quintilian.

Passage 54

The discovery of subsurface life on Earth, surviving independently from surface life, refuted the belief that biological processes require not only liquid water but sunlight as well, thus greatly enhancing the possibility of life beyond Earth. **Take Jupiter's moon Europa.** Space probes show a body covered with a thick layer of ice. As Europa orbits its planet, however, it flexes due to the gravitational tug-of-war between it, its sister moons, and Jupiter. Through friction, this flexing produces heat in the moon's interior capable of melting ice. Indeed, observations suggest liquid water exists beneath Europa's icy crust. Photosynthetic life is impossible there because sunlight is completely absent, but life such as the microbes that flourish deep within earth may still be possible. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply

1. Life on Europa in the form suggested in the passage would be dependent on
- A. the protection Europa's icy crust gives against the harmful components of sunlight
 - B. the existence of water on Europa
 - C. the motion of Europa around Jupiter
2. The highlighted sentence "take Jupiter's moon Europa" serves to introduce
- A. an instance that allows a hypothesis to be tested
 - B. speculation grounded in empirical discovery
 - C. a deduction from a newly advanced hypothesis
 - D. a large-scale effect of an apparently insignificant contingency
 - E. the derivation of a contradiction to refute a claim

Passage 55

Some historians have recently challenged the “party period paradigm,” the view, advanced by McCormick and others, that political parties—especially the two major parties—in the United States between the years 1835 and 1900 **evoked** extraordinary loyalty from voters and dominated political life. Voss-Hubbard cites the frequency of third-party eruptions during the period as evidence of popular antipathy to the two-party regime. He correctly credits third parties with helping generate the nineteenth century’s historically high rates of voter turnout by forcing major parties to bolster supporters’ allegiance, lest minor parties siphon off their votes, and with pushing policy demands that the major parties ignored. Formisano stresses the pervasive record of nonpartisan and anti-party governance at the local level, and women’s frequent participation in nineteenth-century public life, prior to their enfranchisement, in nonpartisan and antiparty ways as evidence of the limitations of the party period paradigm. Yet McCormick would deny that the existence of antiparty sentiment during the period undermined the paradigm, since he has always acknowledged the residual strength of such sentiment during the nineteenth century. In any case, the strength of the paradigm is its comparative thrust: the contrast it draws between the period in question and earlier and later political eras.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. correct a common misconception about a historical period
 - B. identify a feature of a historical period that has often been overlooked
 - C. challenge the validity of evidence used to support a claim
 - D. discuss certain challenges to a particular view
 - E. account for a particular feature of historical period
2. Select the sentence in the passage that describes how a historian might reply to attempts to call his theory into question.
3. In the context in which it appears, “evoked” most nearly means
 - A. elicited
 - B. recalled
 - C. cited
 - D. suggested
 - E. elaborated

Passage 56

Soil communities are dependent on plants for organic matter. Plants provide organic matter for soil communities through the decomposition of leaf litter, by oozing nutrients from roots, or through other methods of deposition of organic compounds into the soil environments. As a result of these diverse methods by which plants supply resources, unique soil communities form under different plant species and under plant communities that differ in composition. If a nonnative plant species invades an above-ground community of flora and fauna, it can alter links between the native above-ground community and the below-ground soil community. For example, an invading nonnative plant could alter the quantity of leaf litter production, which would alter nutrient contributions to the soil. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. According to the passage, plants supply resources to soil communities by which of the following methods?

- A. Some plants supply resources to soil communities by promoting diversity of above-ground flora and fauna.
- B. Some plants supply resources to soil communities by oozing nutrients from their roots.
- C. Some plants supply resources to soil communities by depositing leaf litter.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. Which of the following statements about the connection between above-ground plants and below-ground soil communities can be inferred from the passage?

- A. Because of the nature of the link between above-and below-ground communities, many soil communities are deficient in nutrients.
- B. The extent to which soil communities are dependent on above-ground plants is extremely variable from one soil community to another.
- C. Because different plants supply resources to soil communities in different ways, distinctive soil communities form under different plant communities.

Passage 57

Recent studies of the Philippine fruit bat fauna have confirmed some previous hypotheses regarding bats on oceanic islands: for example, species richness [the number of different species in a particular area] and abundance are generally highest in the lowlands and decrease with increasing elevation. With few exceptions, each endemic species [species native to a particular place] is restricted to the modern islands that made up a single island during periods of low sea level, and **genetic differentiation has been influenced by the ecology of the species and the current and past geographic and geological conditions.** However, far more previous hypotheses have been overturned than supported. Some endemic Philippine species use disturbed habitat as extensively as nonendemic species that are widespread in Southeast Asia. Levels of genetic variation within all species are high, not low, and rather than showing evidence of an intrinsic vulnerability to extinction from natural causes, independent lineages of these bats have persisted in rather small areas for very long periods of time (often millions of years) in spite of frequent typhoons and volcanic eruptions. While colonization from outside areas has clearly contributed to the high species richness, speciation within the archipelago has contributed at least a quarter of the total species richness, including many of the most abundant species. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to

- A. draw on studies of the Philippine fruit bat in proposing a new theory regarding bats on oceanic islands
- B. show how recent research on the Philippine fruit bat reflects debates about bats on oceanic islands
- C. argue for the relevance of certain new evidence pertaining to the Philippine fruit bat or the study of bats on oceanic islands
- D. discuss recent investigations of Philippines fruit bat in light of conventional wisdom regarding bats on oceanic islands
- E. explain why the Philippine fruit bat is atypical among bats on oceanic islands in terms of genetic variation

2. The primary function of the highlighted text is to

- A. identify a finding from the Philippine fruit bat studies that will have a significant impact on how oceanic bats generally are viewed
- B. point out a hypothesis that has been the subject of considerable disagreement among researchers studying oceanic bats
- C. present evidence that is difficult to reconcile with other recent findings regarding the Philippine fruit bat
- D. illustrate a widely held view about oceanic bats generally that was confirmed by the Philippine fruit bat studies
- E. identify a feature of the Philippine fruit bat that does not appear to apply to oceanic bats generally

3. Which of the following can be inferred from the passage about the “recent studies”?

- A. They point to the need for a significantly revised perspective on oceanic island bats generally.
- B. They were undertaken with the assumption that Philippine fruit bats were somewhat atypical among oceanic bats.
- C. They remain somewhat controversial among researchers because of the number of standard hypotheses that they tested.
- D. They have largely confirmed what scientists thought about the Philippine fruit bat.
- E. They suggest that bats on oceanic islands are more vulnerable to extinction than previously thought.

Passage 58

Recent studies of the gender gap in the history of United States policies tend to focus on candidate choice rather than on registration and turnout. This shift in focus from gender inequality in political participation may be due to the finding in **several studies of voting behavior in the United States** that since 1980, differences in rates of registration and voting between men and women are not statistically significant after controlling for traditional predictors of participation. However, Fullerton and Stern argue that researchers have overlooked the substantial gender gap in registration and voting in the South. While the gender gap in participation virtually disappeared outside the South by the 1950s, substantial gender differences persisted in the South throughout the 1950s and 1960s, only beginning to decline in 1970s. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Select the sentence in the passage that offers a possible explanation for a trend.
2. According to the passage, which of the following is true about recent studies of the gender gap in the United States politics?
 - A. They accurately depict voter preference in the South prior to 1980.
 - B. They have been unduly influenced by changes in voter preferences.
 - C. They fail to recognize important factors affecting levels of voter participation.
 - D. They do not pay sufficient attention to the effect regional differences have on voter preference.
 - E. They are more concerned with the choices that male and female voters make than with the frequency with which they vote.
3. The author of the passage cites “several studies of voting behavior in the United States” to
 - A. suggest that rates of change in political participation have moderated
 - B. provide a possible explanation for a propensity among certain researchers
 - C. indicate an area of research that is particularly promising
 - D. speculate about the implications of a change
 - E. suggest that a particular area of study has not been very productive
4. The passage is primarily concerned with
 - A. establishing the chronology of a transition
 - B. discussing a perceived oversight
 - C. explaining the reasons for a change
 - D. evaluating an underlying assumption
 - E. confirming the merits of a claim

Passage 59

Recent studies of ancient Maya water management have found that the urban architecture of some cities was used to divert rainfall runoff into gravity-fed systems of interconnected reservoirs. In the central and southern Maya Lowlands, this kind of water control was necessary to support large populations throughout the year due to the scarcity of perennial surface water and the seasonal availability of rainfall. Some scholars argue that the concentration of water within the urban core of these sites provided a centralized source of political authority for Maya elites based largely on controlled water access. Such an argument is plausible, however, it is less useful for understanding the sociopolitical implications of water use and control in other, water-rich parts of the Maya region. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage implies which of the following about the political importance of the type of urban water management system described in the passage?
- A. Because the system was centralized, it allowed political control over a widely scattered population.
 - B. The knowledge required to design and maintain the system became the pretext for Maya elites' political authority.
 - C. By selectively limiting access to water, Maya elites used the system to curb challenges to their authority.
 - D. The system is not sufficient to explain the sources of centralized political power in all parts of the Maya region.
 - E. The system's continued maintenance required political authorities to exert control over an increasing proportion of economic resources.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. According to the passage, which of the following is true of the water management systems in the central and southern Maya Lowlands?
- A. They were implemented in part because of the prevailing pattern of rainfall.
 - B. They were an integral part of lowland cities' architecture.
 - C. They were needed because of insufficient resources such as ponds, rivers and lakes in the lowlands.

Passage 60

Ralph Ellison was passionately interested in visual arts. He immersed himself in Harlem's art scene in the 1930s, even apprenticing with sculptor Richmond Barthe for a time. Yet he was wary of projects aiming to provide a visual rendering of his novel *Invisible Man*. He reluctantly allowed Franklin Library to publish two illustrated versions of the novel but found the results disappointing and repeatedly rejected proposed film versions of the book. Despite his involvement in visual arts, Ellison insisted that only language could capture the complexity of American identity. This complexity consisted of the **tension** arising from the collision of the United States' written ideals, as outlined in the founding documents, and the historical and contemporary experience molding the national consciousness. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred that the author mentions Ellison's apprenticeship with Richmond Barthe primarily in order to
 - A. show that Ellison drew upon some aspects of the visual arts in developing his ideas for *Invisible Man*
 - B. show that Ellison's claim for the superiority of the language drive from his experience with other art forms
 - C. establish that Ellison had experience with an art form that interested many leading figures of the 1930s Harlem art scene
 - D. suggest that in the 1930s the Harlem art scene provided an environment in which artists were likely to work in several media
 - E. qualify Ellison's reservations about visual renderings of his work by showing that he was not indifferent to visual art
2. Which of the following can be inferred from the passage about the "tension"?
 - A. It partly resulted from social injustices that Ellison worked to alleviate.
 - B. It came to Ellison's attention partly as a result of his experience with proposed film versions of *Invisible Man*.
 - C. Ellison thought that it could not be adequately represented by sculpture.
 - D. Ellison believed that it arose from contradictions within the United States' founding ideals.
 - E. Ellison felt that it was an issue that could not adequately be addressed through the depiction of fictional characters.

Passage 61

Our terrestrial food supply comes from ecosystems transformed to produce a few comestible species through the removal of competitors, predators, and pests, but marine capture fisheries depend on the overall productivity of natural ecosystems. There is, however, increasing concern about the impact of fishing and other human activities on marine ecosystems, which are now far from pristine. One option for moving toward both biodiversity and terrestrial food supply goals is to produce greater yields from less land, thereby freeing land for conservation purposes. By contrast, the objective of maintaining or resorting the biodiversity of marine ecosystems may conflict with the objective of maintaining or increasing our food supply from the sea, since the level of fishing required to achieve the latter may compromise the former.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. examine the impact of certain research findings regarding changes to ecosystem biodiversity.
 - B. discuss a possible implication of a difference between terrestrial and marine food supply sources.
 - C. describe the consequences of a certain kind of interaction between terrestrial and marine ecosystems.
 - D. identify an area of ecosystem research in which there are significant uncertainties
 - E. present evidence that undermines one side of a debate about biodiversity and supports the other.
2. According to the passage, increasing the food yield per unit of land can have which of the following effects?
 - A. enabling more land to be used for development purposes
 - B. compromising progress toward conservation goals
 - C. helping protect comestible species from competition and predation
 - D. helping reduce pressure on marine ecosystems
 - E. helping restore the biodiversity of terrestrial ecosystems

Passage 62

Much recent work has examined the claim that women encounter increasing obstacles relative to men as they move up the organizational ladder in business. This **proposition**, which we term the increasing-disadvantage model, is a core element of the popular glass ceiling metaphor. Despite continued widespread public acceptance of the glass ceiling idea and some consistent findings, most research to date has failed to support the increasing-disadvantage model. Indeed, several studies based on private-sector firms find that women's mobility prospects improve, rather than decline, as they climb upward in corporate hierarchies. In the public sector, researchers have found either no sex differences in mobility or a larger female disadvantage in lower grades.

Comparing cross-sectional national samples of workers, Baxter and Wright found no evidence in the United States, and only **limited evidence** in Sweden and Australia, that women's probability of being located in a higher **versus** a lower hierarchical level declined relative to men's at higher levels. Taken together, these findings suggest that the glass ceiling may be a myth. Women's scarcity in top organizational ranks may simply represent the cumulative effect of a constant-or even decreasing-disadvantage at successive hierarchical levels. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. compare two explanations for a recurring problem
 - B. summarize evidence relevant to a hypothesis
 - C. point out inconsistencies in a set of findings
 - D. account for the persistence of a point of view
 - E. reconsider the origins an ongoing issue
2. Based on the passage, which of the following is true of the "limited evidence" from Sweden and Australia?
 - A. It lends supports to the increasing-disadvantage model.
 - B. It correlates with findings on women's mobility from most other counties.
 - C. It suggests important cultural similarities between these countries.
 - D. It points to a phenomenon not widely recognized in these countries.
 - E. It helps explain the persistence of the glass ceiling.
3. The author of the passage and those accepting the "proposition" would most likely agree with which of the following?
 - A. Lower down on the organizational ladder, women tend to experience fewer disadvantages than they do at higher levels.
 - B. Women experience no more disadvantages in moving up the organizational ladder than do men.
 - C. The degree of disadvantage experiences by women remains constant as women move up the organizational ladder.
 - D. The obstacles to women's advancement vary significantly from country to country.
 - E. Women face some disadvantage at each stage of the organizational ladder.

Passage 63

In various writings from the 1940s on popular culture, George Orwell examined commercial texts such as comics and crime novels, seeking out political meanings that ran counter to what he considered an inherent tendency toward socialism in the English common people. The public, he concluded, was often being duped by a covert patrician conservatism, conveyed through commercial culture, that restrained the people's radical instincts. These works constituted some of Orwell's greatest writing, yet those who see him as a lone precursor to today's cultural studies, a field in which scholars examine the ideological implications of popular culture, are mistaken. A number of left-wing writers in the 1930s, many of them associated with the Communist Party, saw the need to take popular culture seriously. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

The passage suggests which of the following about George Orwell?

- A. He regarded commercial texts as vehicles for the views of ordinary people.
- B. He regarded many commercial texts as having an insidious effect on readers.
- C. He considered commercial text such as comics to be unworthy of serious analysis.
- D. He initiated a new direction in scholarship by taking popular culture seriously.
- E. He regarded commercial texts as inappropriate vehicles for political ideas.

Passage 64

In the life of Charlotte Bronte(1857), the first and the most celebrated biography of novelist Charlotte Bronte, Elizabeth Gaskell promoted the long-persisting romantic view of Bronte as having no connection with the rest of English society at a time when industrialization was causing much turbulence, but as having sprung naturally, like so much purple heather, out of the English countryside. Gaskell also portrayed Bronte as irreproachably proper, incapable of “unladylike” feelings or dangerous views; this was at variance with the subversive spirit Matthew Arnold accurately discerned, albeit with distance, deep within Bronte’s fiction. While correcting many of Gaskell’s errors and omissions at last, even Winifred Gerin’s *Charlotte Bronte: The Evolution of Genius*(1967) failed to discard Gaskell’s viewpoint. Feminist have introduced new interpretations of Bronte’s life, but it is primarily Juliet Barker who takes into account the larger world that impinged on that life—the changing England in which old divisions of class and gender were under pressure. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. consider similarities in several studies of Charlotte Bronte’s life
 - B. defend a particular view of Charlotte Bronte’s life
 - C. discuss a change in perspective on Charlotte Bronte’s life
 - D. depict the social environment in which Charlotte Bronte lived
 - E. portray Charlotte Bronte as an early feminist writer
2. The passage suggest that Matthew Arnold disapproved of Charlotte Bronte’s fiction insofar as he believed that it
 - A. overly romanticized the English countryside
 - B. contained dangerous ideas buried within it
 - C. perpetuated outmoded social distinctions
 - D. failed to represent industrialized society realistically
 - E. reflected an excessive concern with propriety
3. The passage suggest that Gaskell’s biography of Charlotte Bronte advanced the idea that Bronte was
 - A. one of the most celebrated of the romantic novelist
 - B. an outspoken advocate of the social change
 - C. opposed to the industrialization of England
 - D. strongly influenced by the social upheaval of the times
 - E. chiefly the product of a rustic environment

Passage 65

In the country of Seligia where asbestos has been used extensively in construction, that use is about to be banned, because the exposure of construction workers to asbestos can cause a certain type of cancer. We can predict that **the ban will result in reducing the incidence of that type of cancer in Seligia by as much as 50 percent.**

It is true that **less than 30 percent of the death certificates of Seligians who have died of that cancer have “construction” listed as the deceased’s occupation.** The cancer takes about 20 years after exposure to develop, however, and Seligians who have worked in construction commonly turn to less strenuous occupations as they age. Seligian death certificates indicate only the deceased’s last occupation. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

In the argument given, the two highlighted portions play which of the following roles?

- A. The first is a prediction that argument seeks to defend, the second presents evidence that if not supplemented would cast doubt on that judgment.
- B. The first is a prediction that the argument seeks to defend, the second is a finding, the accuracy of which is disputed by the argument as a whole.
- C. The first is a prediction that the argument as a whole rejects the second presents evidence on which that rejection is based
- D. The first is a prediction that the argument as a whole seeks to defend, the second is evidence that the defense can be at best partially successful.
- E. The first is a prediction that is cited in order to justify a stated conclusion, the second is a consideration that has been raised against that conclusion.

Passage 66

In recent decades, scholars of American literature have skillfully revealed authors’ simultaneous accommodation and resistance to an increasingly commercialized, capitalized environment during the early nineteenth century. Historians of the period have not, however, fully exploited literary criticism, due to the disciplinary boundaries that mark contemporary academic research. Few historians have extensive training in critical theory and its specialized languages, and the sheer volume of work in early American history and literature challenges anyone who would master either field, much less both. Moreover, historians study people across the nation, but much literary scholarship called “American” actually examines works produced in northeastern states. And historians usually study the operations of capitalism in its details, while literary critics produce a generalized picture of literary commodification. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. As discussed in the passage, the literary scholars and the historians differ in which of the following ways?

- A. the amount of scholarship that they produce
- B. the nature of their geographic focus
- C. the extent to which they are critical of early capitalism
- D. the extent to which they are interested in interdisciplinary study
- E. The extent to which they restrict their focus to a particular time period

2. The passage cites which of the following as a reason for historians’ failure to fully exploit literary criticism?

- A. historians’ overly thematic approach to literature
- B. historians’ conservative notion of what constitutes literature
- C. historian’s lack of interest in critical theory
- D. the distinctive nature of much literary criticism

E. the ahistorical quality of much literary criticism

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

3. The passage cites which of the following as reasons for historians' failure to fully exploit literary criticism?

- A. The amount of scholarship involved
- B. The distinctive nature of literary criticism
- C. The ahistorical quality of much literary criticism

Passage 67

In 1755 British writer Samuel Johnson published an acerbic letter to Lord Chesterfield rebuking his patron for neglect and declining further support. Johnson's rejection of his patron's belated assistance has often been identified as a key moment in the history of publishing, marking the end of the culture of patronage. **However, patronage had been in decline for 50 years, yet would survive, in attenuated form, for another 50.** Indeed, Johnson was in 1762 awarded a pension by the Crown—a subtle form of sponsorship, tantamount to state patronage. The importance of Johnson's letter is not so much historical as emotional; it would become a touchstone for all who repudiated patrons and for all who embraced the laws of the marketplace. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage mentions Johnson's 1762 pension award in order to
 - A. reveal that Johnson remained consistent in his rebuke of Lord Chesterfield well after 1755
 - B. provide evidence for a general trend in the latter half of the eighteenth century of private patronage's being replaced by state sponsorship
 - C. situate the debate over the end of patronage within the wider realm of eighteenth-century economic history
 - D. suggest that Johnson's letter to Chesterfield was noticed by the Crown only years after it was published
 - E. emphasize that patronage still helped support Johnson's writing after his letter to Chesterfield
2. Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted phrase in the context of the passage as a whole? (patronage had been in decline for 50 years, yet would survive, in attenuated form, for another 50)
 - A. It points out the most obvious implications of Johnson's letter to his patron.
 - B. It suggests a motivation for Johnson's rejection of Chesterfield's patronage.
 - C. It provides information that qualifies the assertion that Johnson's letter sharply defined the end of a publishing era.
 - D. It provides a possible defense for Chesterfield's alleged neglect of Johnson.
 - E. It refutes the notion the patrons are found primarily among the nobility.
3. The author of the passage mentions Johnson's 1762 pension award in order to
 - A. provide a specific example of patronage's surviving into the second half of the eighteenth century
 - B. emphasize that patronage still helped support Johnson's writing after his letter to Chesterfield
 - C. provide evidence for a general trend in the later half of the eighteenth century of private patronage's being replaced by state sponsorship
4. Which of the following statements about literary patronage may be inferred from the passage?
 - A. It was strongly defended by most patrons.
 - B. It was regulated by the state in Britain after 1762.
 - C. It had largely fallen out of favor by 1800.

Passage 68

Historically, more cold-adapted antelope species originating in Eurasia have migrated into Africa, where the climate is generally warmer, than have warm-adapted African species into Eurasia. A likely explanation for this involves the fact that intercontinental migrations require both a land bridge connecting the two continents and the suitable habitat both on and across that land bridge. During periods of climatic cooling, such as the various ice ages, the land bridge is open for a long time (because sea level remains low) and is usable by cold-adapt species because cool habitats then extend across it. Thus during cooling most migrants would be expected to travel toward Africa, which is near the equator, since this is the direction dictated by habitat changes on a cooling Earth. In contrast, when the Earth is warm, the land bridge is reduced or gone because sea level is relatively high then. Only during the **short lag** between onset of global temperature change and sea level response can warm-adapted species migrate from the equator toward higher latitudes. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, which of the following is true of an Eurasia-Africa land bridge during ice ages?

- A. It offers suitable habitats for cold-adapted species of antelope.
- B. It encourages migration from Africa to Eurasia of cold-adapted species of antelope.
- C. It allows the survival of warm-adapted species of antelope that might otherwise become extinct.
- D. It is more likely to exist early in an ice age than later in an ice age.
- E. The habitats it offers change more quickly than do those offered by land bridges during other periods.

2. The author of the passage implies that during the “short lag”, a land bridge between Africa and Eurasia would

- A. be inhabited primarily by species of antelope originating in Eurasia.
- B. be characterized by areas of widely varying elevation above sea level.
- C. be inhabited by a wide diversity of antelope species.
- D. contain habitats that could sustain warm-adapted antelope species.
- E. contain habitats similar to habitats at much higher latitudes in Eurasia.

3. According to the passage, which of the following best accounts for the apparent bias in antelope-migration direction?

- A. Warm-adapted antelope species are rarely able to tolerate cool habitats, whereas cold-adapted antelope species usually can tolerate warm habitats.
- B. During global warming periods, land bridges, when present, lack habitats suitable for sustaining warm-adapted antelope species.
- C. Under most climatic conditions, Africa offers a larger number of suitable antelope habitats than does Eurasia.
- D. Many more species of antelope have originated in Eurasia than have originated in Africa.
- E. Land bridges are more likely to exist when climate change favors migration to warmer climates than when climate changes favors migration to cooler climates.

Passage 69

Historian Colin Calloway argues that in the late colonial period preceding the American Revolution (1775-1783), the British government sought to seal off territory west of the Appalachian Mountain from the encroachment of land-hungry White settlers, to negotiate with Native American peoples as independent foreign states, and to guarantee the integrity of traditional native American hunting grounds. By contrast, White Americans, released by the outbreak of the Revolution from the constraints of Britain's allegedly benevolent policies, are portrayed by Calloway as ruthless land-grabbers whose new national government endorsed their rapacity. Bernard Bailyn argues, however, that the "Americans" who encroached on Native American land during the Revolution had been British only a few years before. When, during and after the Revolution, White Americans seized Native American land by any available means, they were continuing a tradition dating back to **the earliest years of English settlement in North America**. And, according to Bailyn, the British government's prewar efforts to preserve the trans-Appalachian west for Native Americans resulted not from humanitarian virtue or ethnic tolerance but from British Merchants' desire to maintain their lucrative trade with native Americans and the government's desire to control immigration and avoid costly conflict between White and Native Americans over land. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. suggest that two different arguments about a particular historical period are both questionable.
 - B. present historical evidence that undermines a widely accepted viewpoints.
 - C. defend a revisionist historian's thesis against traditionalist criticism.
 - D. outline opposing interpretations of a particular historical phenomenon.
 - E. resolve a dispute among historians over a controversial historical episode.
2. The reference to "the earliest years of English settlement in North America" serves primarily to emphasize the point that
 - A. Calloway has exaggerated the ruthlessness and rapacity of White settlers in their relations with native Americans prior to the American Revolution.
 - B. Seizure of Native American lands by White settlers had increased dramatically throughout the time of British Colonial rule.
 - C. At one time White settlers had negotiated with Native American people as independent foreign states.
 - D. White settlers had no legitimate ground for claiming title to land they seized west of the Appalachian Mountains.
 - E. Aggression by White settlers against Native Americans during and after the American Revolution was not a new phenomenon.
3. It can be inferred that both Bailyn and Calloway would probably agree with which of the following assertions regarding the relations between White Americans and Native Americans concerning the trans-Appalachian west
 - A. The American Revolution unleashed an unprecedented wave of expropriation of Native American land by White settlers.
 - B. The British government's prewar policy towards the Native Americans was determined largely by the interests of British merchants who traded with the Native Americans.
 - C. The British government tried to keep White settlers out of the trans-Appalachian west primarily in order to prevent disputes over land between those settlers and Native Americans.
 - D. The new national colonial government to negotiate with Native American peoples as independent foreign states.
 - E. One objective of the British government's land policy prior to the American revolution was to prevent White settlers from moving to the western side of the Appalachian Mountains.

Passage 70

Because coal contains toxic materials such as arsenic and lead, and its use contributes to air pollution and acid rain, one might therefore conclude that no good case could be made for burning it for fuel. But that depends on where one is starting from. Switching to coal from firewood is beneficial for both the environment and the health of the individual. Firewood use results in deforestation, loss of ecosystems, and degradation of soil quality. Wood fires are also sooty, and their particulates contribute to global warming by decreasing the reflectivity of snow fields. Finally, firewood is generally burned in homes with poor ventilation and poses a greater health risk to the individuals than they would experience from a coal-fired utility that provides electricity to their homes. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The passage indicates which of the following about firewood?
 - A. Its use has a damaging effect on the quality of soil.
 - B. Its advantages over coal as a fuel have been exaggerated.
 - C. Its effect on human health is partly a result of the conditions under which it is burned.
2. The author mentions arsenic and lead primarily in order to
 - A. identify some of the factors that might support a particular conclusion.
 - B. challenge an assertion about the toxicity of various sources of fuel.
 - C. establish the grounds for a recommendation concerning future energy use.
 - D. acknowledge a weakness of the hypothesis proposed by the author.
 - E. question the advantages of switching from one source of fuel to another.

Passage 71

In a review of Lomborg's *The Skeptical Environmentalist*, Lovejoy challenges Lomborg's assertion that environmentalists' projections of species extinction due to habitat loss are overly pessimistic. For example, where Lomborg cites the lack of large numbers of recorded extinctions in the Brazilian Atlantic Forest despite the region's reduction to approximately ten percent of its original area, Lovejoy notes both lack of field biologists in the region to record species or their extinctions and an abundance of evidence suggesting that if the forest remains so reduced and fragmented, it will lose a sizable fraction of the species that can survive—for the moment—in their decimated habitats. Additionally, where Lomborg argues that few species became extinct when deforestation reduced the eastern forests of the United States to one or two percent of their original area, Lovejoy points out that only old-growth forests shrank to that extent: **total forest cover** never fell below about 50 percent, allowing much biodiversity to survive as new-growth forest returned. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is primarily concerned with

- A. identifying some of the possible causes for a particular environmental phenomenon.
- B. arguing that certain predictions regarding a particular environmental phenomenon are unduly pessimistic.
- C. presenting certain challenges to a particular author's arguments by means of specific examples.
- D. suggesting the need for conservation efforts to address a serious environmental problem.
- E. discussing the relative merits of two opposing arguments in a particular debate.

2. Based on his argument about "total forest cover," Lovejoy would probably agree with which of the following statements?

- A. Lomborg underestimates the number of species that became extinct as a result of deforestation of the eastern forests of the United States.
- B. The damage done to the eastern forests of the United States is even greater than that done to the Brazilian Atlantic Forest.
- C. The extent to which eastern forests of the United States were lost to deforestation is significantly greater than Lomborg suggests.
- D. The reason that large numbers of species extinctions have not been recorded in eastern forests of the United States is that there are too few field biologists working in those forests.
- E. The reason that few species of eastern forests of the United States became extinct as a result of deforestation is that no more than about half the total forest cover was lost at any given time.

3. The passage indicates that Lomborg would agree with which of the following claims regarding both the Brazilian Atlantic Forest and eastern forests of the United States?

- A. Deforestation has not reduced the size of the original area as much as environmentalists claim.
- B. Reduction and fragmentation of the original forest severely threatens the continued existence of species that are able to survive for the moment in a decimated habitat.
- C. A reduction of the amount of forested area has not resulted in large numbers of extinctions.
- D. Species extinction occurred because the forest was reduced to roughly one to two percent of its original area.
- E. The return of new-growth forest has allowed the continued survival of a wide variety of species.

Passage 72

Agricultural historians theorize that farming originated when the pressure of growing populations or shrinking resources imposed the need to find new species to adapt for food. This hypothesis is supported by impressive work by anthropologists who have observed transitions to agriculture that happened in recent times. But, as an explanation for why agriculture arose in the first place, it seems ill matched to the **facts of chronology**. Extinction—or even significant diminutions—in hunter's prey species cannot be shown to have happened in any of the right places at any of the right times. Populations certainly grew in the most dedicated farming culture—but, in most places, more probably as a consequence than as a cause. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The author would likely include which of the following evidence in the “facts of chronology”?

- A. the number of centuries separating the earliest transitions to agriculture from those observed by anthropologists
- B. the earliest dates for which evidence of farming practices has been established
- C. the known dates, if any, of extinctions of prey species that formed an important part of the diet of ancient human societies

2. The author of the passage would be most likely to disagree with the “agricultural historians” over whether

- A. Preagricultural societies frequently adapted new species for food.
- B. Preagricultural societies were vulnerable to fluctuations in the populations of species they hunted.
- C. The earliest transitions to agriculture resulted in population growth.
- D. Recent transitions to agriculture and the earliest such transitions were triggered by similar conditions.
- E. The first adoption of agriculture immediately created dramatic changes in social structure.

Passage 73

Published interviews with artists are compelling because they offer glimpses of an artist's personality and idiosyncrasies. However, as in the case of artist Andy Warhol, this perception of immediacy can be misleading, for interviews are highly contrived public performances, providing ample opportunity for self-promotion. Moreover, interviews are often heavily edited for publication, and their apparent spontaneity may be as false as that of a posed photograph. Nonetheless, such conversations remain an indispensable resource for scholars of art history, as they often differ qualitatively from other types of texts written by or about artists. **Because they retain forms peculiar to spoke language, such as non sequiturs, anecdotes, and digressions, interviews with artists make unique contributions to art history.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. In the context of the passage as a whole, the highlighted sentence serves to
 - A. defend the value of a problematical source of information.
 - B. amplify the assertion presented in the preceding sentence.
 - C. cast doubt on the point made by the earlier comparison between interviews and photographs.
2. In the context in which it appears, "peculiar" most nearly means
 - A. inexplicable
 - B. eccentric
 - C. pertinent
 - D. distinctive
 - E. uncommon

Passage 74

The damage that trucks do to highways escalates dramatically with the weight borne per axle. New regulations increase the maximum permitted vehicle weight; these regulations will therefore allow onto the highway trucks capable of doing even more damage than those currently permitted. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The argument is open up to criticism on the grounds that it
 - A. fails to establish that the level of damage done by trucks is a serious problem.
 - B. omits evidence about one of the two relevant factors.
 - C. ignores the possibility that careful driving can lessen damage to highways.
 - D. presumes that trucks are the only vehicles capable of causing substantial damage to highways.
 - E. presumes that something is bound to happen just because it is allowed to happen.

Passage 75

Normally, seeds of *Emmenathe penduliflora* stay dormant for years and germinate only when a fire burns through their habitat. Nitrogen dioxide in the smoke induces the seeds to germinate. Fires clear the brush, allowing germinating seeds to receive the sunlight they need to grow. The plants mature quickly, produce seeds, and then die. In areas with heavy automobile traffic, however, the seed germinates in the absence of fire, with automobile exhaust supplying the required nitrogen dioxide. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The information given, if accurate, most strongly supports which of the following hypotheses?

- A. Fires in the habitat of *E. Penduliflora* do not entirely destroy the plant's seeds even in the places where the fires burn most intensely.
- B. The nitrogen dioxide in automobile exhaust cannot harm plants of *E. Penduliflora* after germination.
- C. If human intervention decreases the number of fires in the habitat of *E. Penduliflora*, automobile exhaust can replicate the conditions the plant requires in order to thrive.
- D. Within the habitat of *E. Penduliflora*, natural fires are significantly more frequent in areas with heavy automobile traffic than they are in other areas.
- E. Unless *E. Penduliflora* seeds that have germinated can survive in the shade, automobile exhaust threatens the long-term survival of the plant in areas with heavy automobile traffic.

Passage 76

In most coastal regions, the level of the sea is rising in relation to the land by one to two millimeters a year, and this trend would be explained by the hypothesis that at the North and South Poles, the amount of ice that melts during the summer now exceeds the amount forms during the winter. The hypothesis is not undermined by observations that **sea levels are falling relative to the Scandinavian coast by four millimeters a year**. Much land in northern latitudes, including Scandinavia, is still rising in response to being freed of the enormous weight of the ice that used to cover it during the last ice age, and **in Scandinavia the land is now rising faster than the sea**. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

In the passage, the two highlighted portions play which of the following roles?

- A. The first states observation the accuracy of which is challenged in the passage; the second is part of the ground on which that challenge is based.
- B. The first states observations that, according to the passage, are incompatible with a certain hypothesis; the second is part of the grounds offered in support of a revision of that hypothesis.
- C. The first states observations that, according to the passage, can be reconciled with a certain hypothesis; the second describes a phenomenon that is factual basis of that reconciliation.
- D. The first presents a phenomenon, two competing explanations of which are considered in the passage; the second is the explanation of the phenomenon that the passage argues is correct.
- E. The first provides evidence against a position; the second is that position.

Passage 77

Editors of major United States news magazines have been criticized for reducing the amount of space these magazines devote to international news. According to these editors, however, readers are wholly to blame for the reductions. After all, the editors point out, **sales of magazine issues that prominently feature international news stories have declined significantly**, and declining sales reflect declining reader interest. Yet even if true, this evidence does not refute the contention that editors should bear some of the blame for the reductions, unless editors are merely passive instruments responding to reader interest. And that is clearly an untenable view, since **editors can often intensify reader interest in a news topic by giving it frequent coverage**. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

In the argument as a whole, the two highlighted portions play which of the following roles?

- A. The first is evidence that has been used to support a position that the argument opposes; the second is a point that the argument raises to cast doubt on the reasoning used to support that position.
- B. The first presents a claim, the truth of which is evaluated in the argument, the second is information introduced to cast doubt on that claim.
- C. The first presents a claim, the truth of which is evaluated in the argument, the second provides evidence in support of that claim.
- D. The first cites evidence in support of the main conclusion of the argument, the second states that conclusion.
- E. The first states an assumption that is explicitly made to support the main conclusion of the argument, the second is a position that the argument as whole opposes.

Passage 78

Benovians set their clocks back an hour for the winter. The result is that, during winter's short days, it is light when most commuters drive to work, but dark when they drive back home. Darkness contributes to accidents. Changing the clocks, however, does not actually increase the amount of driving done in the dark, so it is unlikely to have any effect on Benovia's automobile accident rate. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument relies?

- A. The average number of hours that Benovians drive when it is dark is greater for days during the winter than for days during other times of the year.
- B. In Benovia, hazards to safe driving that are made worse by darkness are as likely to occur in the morning as in the evening.
- C. The majority of cars on Benovia's roads during a given day are those of people commuting to or from work.
- D. The majority of automobile accidents in Benovia take place when it is dark.
- E. Driving conditions are no worse in Benovia in the winter than during the rest of the year.

Passage 79

Elizabeth Bishop's *Complete Poems* (1927-1979) has come to seem to most of its readers so achieved and sufficient as a life's work that it is hard not to lose sight of how slowly Bishop wrote poems and of how few poems, finally, she completed. But Bishop herself never ceased to find her productivity inadequate. The size and pace of her output were always in her eyes a failing (vaguely moral in **complexion**) for which she apologized throughout her career, although, as I will argue in this essay, Bishop's inability to write more poems than she did was also a refusal to do so. The small, manageable size of Bishop's body of work has facilitated its extraordinary critical reception since her death. (Robert Lowell, whose oeuvre is so much larger, has never had a complete edition of his poetry published.) Yet the size of her work is also a sign of Bishop's alienation, that is, her uneasy, resistant relation to the literary culture that today claims her as the major poet of her generation. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The passage indicates that the small size of Bishop's body of work contributed to bringing about which of the following?

- A. bishop's alienation from the literary culture of her generation
- B. the favorable scholarly attention that Bishop's work has received since her death
- C. an interest among readers regarding why Bishop wrote so slowly

2. In the context in which it appears, "complexion" most nearly means

- A. appearance
- B. constitution
- C. hue
- D. intricacy
- E. personality

Passage 80

Shoreland County recently purchased an area of wilderness land in the county to prevent it from being developed. In doing so, the county has forfeited all future property taxes on this land. Property taxes are assessed on market value, and if developed, the land would have contributed significantly to the county's overall annual tax revenue. Because of the purchase, therefore, overall annual tax revenue will be lower than it would have been if development had occurred. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

- A. The money the county would have had to expend for services to residences or industry developed on the wilderness land would have exceeded the tax revenue from the developed land.
- B. The market value of undeveloped properties in Shoreland County will not increase significantly in the foreseeable future.
- C. The property taxes received by Shoreland County from the previous owners of the wilderness area were insignificant relative to the county's overall annual tax revenue.
- D. Land near the area bought by the county will not increase significantly in market value as a result of being near wilderness that is protected from development.
- E. Shoreland County will not in the foreseeable future prevent the development of any other land in the county.

Passage 81

Following the United States Civil War (1861-1865), many former slaves in the rural South became sharecroppers (raising a landlord's crop for a share of the profits) or tenant farmers (selling what they raised and paying a share of the profits as rent). **Most historians tend to depict these African Americans as victims of racism and the farm tenancy system.** This approach, however, overlooks the role played by such African American rural reformers as Robert Lloyd Smith, founder of the Farmers' Improvement Society of Texas, and Joseph Elward Clayton, the first African American to organize farmers' institutes for the Texas Department of Agriculture. Both men advocated comfortable homes and better schools for African Americans; both attributed poverty and illiteracy to causes other than racism, such as insect damage to crops; and both worked to keep Black farmers on the land, although Smith opposed farm tenancy. Both were also accused by their contemporaries of downplaying the devastating impact of the farm tenancy system on Black farmers and of accommodating racism. While the extent of these reformers' influence requires more study, clearly their organizations provided a voice for African American farmers seeking to improve their positions in the agrarian South. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is primarily concerned with

- A. restoring the reputations of two reformers whose accomplishments have long been denigrated by historians.
- B. refuting criticism of two reformers made by their contemporaries by demonstrating that those criticisms are baseless.
- C. providing evidence to support a claim that historians' understanding of a particular phenomenon may be incomplete.
- D. discussing some of the reasons that two reformers who were well-known during their lifetimes are considered by historians today to have been ineffective.
- E. suggesting an alternative interpretation of the effect of the farm tenancy system on the economy of the rural South following the Civil War.

2. The author of the passage would most likely agree with which of the following statements concerning Smith and Clayton?

- A. More research is required to determine whether or not their organizations were typical of those established to aid African American farmers in the post-Civil War rural South.
- B. Their contributions to the improvement of the living conditions of African American farmers were overshadowed by subsequent political controversy.
- C. Their achievements as reformers have been exaggerated by many historians of the post-Civil War period.
- D. There is evidence demonstrating that they were committed to aiding African American farmers in the rural South.
- E. The extent of the criticism made about them by their contemporaries is difficult to determine.

Passage 82

TEB Attorney: TEB Corporation has been accused of not doing enough to discourage its executives from defrauding the government. This accusation is obviously false, since TEB, following its own written policy, rewards those who report the wrongdoing of others and promptly fires proven wrongdoers. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most seriously undermines the attorney's argument in defense of TEB?

- A. "Wrongdoing" is defined in TEB corporate policies as "any activity by a TEB employee that defrauds TEB."
- B. TEB has instituted what it calls "customer friendly" policies of responding to every complaint customers make.
- C. The government is not TEB's sole client, nor even its major client.
- D. Defrauding the government would have to involve more than one employee of any company that did so.
- E. Those who have accused TEB of not doing enough to discourage its executives from defrauding the government have themselves been government employees.

Passage 83

Throughout much of the Tertiary period (most of the past 65 million years), the Arctic supported continuous forests. Only toward the end of that period does the fossil evidence show that certain present-day Arctic plants were established and widely **distributed** throughout the Arctic. Many Arctic plants are thought to have originated in the high mountain ranges of central Asia and North America, to have spread northward to the Arctic as global temperatures fell in the late Tertiary, and to have achieved a circumpolar distribution by the end of the Tertiary (about 2 million years ago). However, fossil evidence to support these proposals is either lacking or fragmentary. Consequently, the routes by which these plants expanded their ranges during their colonization of the Arctic remain unknown. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. Which of the following statements about Arctic plants is supported by the passage?

- A. The decline in global temperature in the late Tertiary prevented many high-mountain plants from becoming established in the Arctic.
- B. There is not enough evidence to firmly establish the historical migration routes of present-day Arctic plants.
- C. Present-day Arctic plants are less likely to leave fossil remains than are plants outside the Arctic.

2. The context in which it appears, "distributed" most nearly means

- A. developed
- B. isolated
- C. dispersed
- D. divided
- E. disconnected

Passage 84

Like Germany, but unlike other European nations, Norway industrialized rather late in the nineteenth century. Compared to Germany, however, Norway has a comparatively recent history of industrially based social classes and a much longer history of rather egalitarian class relations. The origin of Norwegian egalitarian predates industrialism and the rise of the labor movement. The preindustrial economy was based largely on a small independent peasantry who combined agriculture with fishing (in the north) or with forestry (in the south). Because Norway was under foreign rule for five centuries until 1905, and because the topography is unfavorable for large estates, a strong aristocracy and landowner class did not emerge in most of Norway. There were some exceptions to this pattern, especially in the southern regions where a landowner class did exist. Norway's early social and economic history engendered egalitarianism, although, as has been pointed out by several observers, it was an equality of poverty. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is primarily concerned with discussing the
 - A. link between poverty and equality in the preindustrial state.
 - B. characteristics of industrial society shared by Norway and Germany.
 - C. effects of industrialization on social and economic relations in Norway.
 - D. roots of social equality in Norway.
 - E. emergence of social classes in Norway and Germany.
2. According to the passage, northern and southern Norway differed in which of the following ways in the nineteenth century?
 - A. a landowning class was more likely to be found in southern Norway than in northern Norway
 - B. Southern Norwegian peasants relied primarily on fishing for subsistence, while Northern Norwegians relied on forestry.
 - C. agriculture was a significant activity in southern Norway but not in northern Norway
 - D. Southern Norway industrialized earlier than did northern Norway
 - E. foreign rule effected southern Norway more profoundly than it did northern Norway
3. The passage suggests which of the following about egalitarianism in Norway?
 - A. It was a source of social stability that helped Norway survive five centuries of foreign rule.
 - B. It manifested itself in the same way after industrialization as it had prior to industrialization.
 - C. It did not necessarily provide a high standard of living for most Norwegians.
 - D. It produced a Norwegian industrialization that differed qualitatively from industrialization in other European countries in that the labor movement was less radical in Norway.
 - E. It was more pervasive in southern than in northern Norway.

Passage 85

The Rivera Art Museum recently began charging admission. The resulting decline in visitors has been far larger than at other local museums, which have also begun charging admission. The magnitude of the decline might be due to the Rivera's location near government offices. Because an admission charge is most discouraging to those who plan a short visit, it is likely that government workers who formerly made brief visits during lunchtime and after work now do not. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most seriously undermines the proposed explanation?

- A. The fee for admission to the Rivera is no larger than that charged by other museums.
- B. The Rivera does not keep track of how long individual visitors stay in the museum.
- C. The decline in visitors to the Rivera has been no greater in workdays than it has been on nonworking days.
- D. The museum with the smallest decline in visitors is the most popular with visitors from other countries.
- E. In the period between the announcement that there would be an admissions charge and its actual introduction, there was an increase in visitors at the Rivera.

Passage 86

The surface of Venus contains calcite, a mineral that absorbs the gas sulfur dioxide. Sulfur dioxide is often produced by volcanic activity and is plentiful in Venus' atmosphere, so there must be a source, perhaps volcanic, producing sulfur dioxide on Venus. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

- A. In the recent past, the level of sulfur dioxide in Venus' atmosphere was not much higher than it is now.
- B. If there is volcanic activity on the surface of Venus, it is not adequate to maintain the observed amount of sulfur dioxide in the atmosphere.
- C. The sulfur dioxide in Venus' atmosphere forms clouds that prevent direct observation of the surface.
- D. Sulfur dioxide produced by volcanic activity on the Earth's surface is also absorbed by minerals other than calcite.
- E. The calcite on the surface of Venus is in sufficient supply to continue to absorb sulfur for millions of years to come.

Passage 87

What accounts for the low-lying, flat surface of Mars's north? On Earth's surface, higher- and lower-lying areas have different types of crust: one, thin and dense, is pulled toward Earth's center more strongly by gravity, and the planet's water naturally comes to sit over it, creating oceans. The processes that generate this oceanic crust drive plate tectonics.

Is Mars's north similarly characterized by a sort of crust different from other areas of the planet? Some researchers do see signs of tectonic activity surrounding the northern basin that suggest that it was created through the formation of new crust, like ocean basins on Earth. However, McGill points to Northern bedrock structures that predate the features said to mark the start of the tectonic process. McGill instead believes that through some novel mechanism the ancient surface sank to its current depth as a single unit. This would explain why features around the basin's edge, which would have formed as the surface dropped, seem to be younger than structures at its floor.

The third possibility is that the northern lowlands result from impacts. Some researchers suggest they formed as a series of big overlapping impact craters. Others arguing that the odds against such a pattern of impacts are large, postulate a single event—the impact of an object bigger than any asteroid the solar system now contains. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. explore an analogy between aspects of the geology of Mars and the geology of Earth.
 - B. describe how a certain feature of Mars's surface formed.
 - C. point out the effect that new data has had on a scientific investigation.
 - D. summarize potential explanations of a large-scale geological feature.
 - E. present the rationale for a scientist's theory and expose some of its weakness.
2. Which of the following can be inferred from the passage about geological features on Earth
 - A. the relative elevation of the lowest-lying regions of the crust arises in part from forces generated within the planet
 - B. the difference in elevation between the ocean basins and their surroundings is greater than the difference between Mars's northern basin and its surroundings
 - C. the formation of low-lying areas proceeds by a different process than the one that created Mars's northern basin
 - D. the weight of the oceans does not affect the depth of the ocean basins
 - E. the proportions of the crust that is oceanic crust is increasing
3. As presented in the passage, McGill's account of the formation of Mars's northern basin differs from the other mentioned in that it alone
 - A. explains the formation of certain northern bedrock features.
 - B. does not specify the force that caused the northern basin to be lower than its surroundings.
 - C. takes the northern basin to be a landform that is not analogous to any found on Earth.
 - D. denies that features around the northern basin are the result of tectonic activity.
 - E. attributes the creation of the northern lowlands to processes occurring within the planet.

Passage 88

The waters east of Cape Hangklip were once the center of a lucrative wild-caught abalone fishery, but illegal fishing in the mid-1990s escalated to such levels that the recreational fishery was closed in 2003. When abalones did not rebound, commercial fishing was also banned. Continual declines in abalone were attributed to poaching, but an invasion by rock lobsters during the early 1990s probably intensified the trend. Rock lobsters prey on sea urchins, and increased rock lobster densities coincided with significant decreases in urchins. In that area, urchins feed largely by trapping drift kelp, and in doing so provide juvenile abalone with both protective shelter and nourishment. Without urchins' presence, juvenile abalones are less likely to survive to adulthood. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, since the early 1990s, sea urchins in the waters east of Cape Hangklip have

- A. significantly changed their feeding habits.
- B. suffered increased predation from a certain species.
- C. experienced increased competition for kelp, their main source of nourishment.
- D. seen a sharp decline in the availability of kelp, due to environmental changes.
- E. rebounded as commercial fishing in the region has declined.

2. According to the passage, which of the following is a true statement about the feeding behaviors of sea urchins

- A. They change according to the type of food available in an area.
- B. They are responsible for the decline of abalones in some regions.
- C. They have a significant impact on the young of another species.
- D. They make sea urchins more vulnerable to potential predators.
- E. They result in marked decline in certain regions.

3. Which of the following statements about the Closing of the "recreational fishery" is supported by the passage?

- A. It was a measure taken in response to the invasion of the area by rock lobsters.
- B. It had unintended effects on the region's population of sea urchins.
- C. It was enacted after the banning of commercial fishing in the region.
- D. It did not stem the decline of abalone in the region.
- E. It had a short-lived effect on the area's abalone population.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

4. It can be inferred from the passage that the decline of abalones in the waters east of Cape Hangklip was probably due in part to

- A. an increase in the area's population of rock lobsters.
- B. illegal harvesting of adult abalones in the area.
- C. a change in the feeding behavior of sea urchins.

Passage 89

Some conservationists, concerned about the rapid depletion through poaching of elephant herds in certain parts of Africa, are urging countries to which ivory is sold to ban ivory importation. This ban, they argue, would prevent ivory sellers from reaching their market, and elephant herds would have a chance to recover. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

The conservationists' recommendation as described is based on which of the following assumptions?

- A. The capacity of any illegal channels that may exist for the sale of ivory in export markets cannot expand to meet demand in those markets.
- B. There now exist synthetic substitutes for ivory that are essentially indistinguishable from the natural product.
- C. Bans on imports of ivory need to be combined with intensified efforts to stop poaching in order to be effective.
- D. To the economies of those countries that have significant elephant herds, elephants are more valuable alive than dead.
- E. In some parts of Africa where poaching has depleted elephant herds, those herds are already beyond recovery.

Passage 90

One of the reasons why many early British colonies in North America failed amid the New World's abundance was that the settlers' mindset prevented them from living like the native inhabitants. From Native Americans, the settlers learned such skills as building **brushwood weirs** to trap fish, but they did not adopt the real key to success: mobility. The whole intellectual foundation of European civilization was fixity—a worldview profoundly different from that of Native Americans, who moved in response to changing food resources. Settlers were drawn to North America by tales of its extraordinary abundance, not realizing that abundance is seasonal. Culture and ecological knowledge allowed Native Americans to exploit different food sources at different time of year. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The author suggests which of the following about the early British colonies in North America that failed?
 - A. Their inhabitants' worldview was deeply affected with native people and practices.
 - B. Their inhabitants experienced critical food shortages in part because their culture hindered their ability to exploit seasonally available resources.
 - C. Their longevity would have been greater had the inhabitants adopted more of the fishing technologies used by Native Americans.
2. The author mentions "brushwood weirs" primarily in order to
 - A. demonstrate that Native Americans provided certain forms of assistance to colonial settlers.
 - B. identify a skill that allowed Native Americans to thrive in regions where colonies failed to.
 - C. distinguish the kinds of technologies used by Native Americans from those used by colonial settlers.
 - D. acknowledge that colonial settlers adopted certain American ways even though they failed in the New World.
 - E. contrast the assumptions of British colonial settlers and Native Americans in the New World.

Passage 91

A mouse's immune system generally rejects proteins different from those produced by that mouse. The immune system of a pregnant mouse does not, however, reject the mouse's fetuses, although the fetal tissue a fetus produces as it develops typically contains many such proteins. Some scientists hypothesize that the placenta surrounding the fetus physically blocks the mother's immune system. But others, noting that the placenta produces IDO, an enzyme that suppresses the immune system, hypothesize that IDO plays a crucial role in protecting the fetus. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

In order to choose between the two hypotheses, it would be most useful to determine which of the following?

- A. whether mice sometimes produce IDO when they are not pregnant
- B. whether the immune systems of fetal mice are capable of attacking the tissue of the mother
- C. whether there are cases in which the immune system of a pregnant mouse rejects some fetuses but not others
- D. whether IDO is the only substance capable of suppressing the immune system produced by mice
- E. whether the immune systems of pregnant mice that are given a drug that inhibits IDO production subsequently reject the fetus

Passage 92

Most popularizations of science actually do more harm than good. Why? The single most important feature of scientific work is not this or that specific result. Instead, what science accomplishes—and what physics in particular accomplishes so beautifully—is the linking of diverse phenomena, the binding together of a myriad of predictions and explanations. What nearly all popularizations do is systematically undermine the progressive reasoning that links principles, conventions, experiments, and laws. Bad science writing splinters the most interesting feature of science, its long run of connected argumentation, into isolated metaphors that last just long enough to evoke a particular result: black holes are said to be huge funnels and quantum electron orbits are characterized as diffuse clouds. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

The author of the passage mentions black holes in order to provide

- A. an instance of a factual error to which popularizations of science are prone.
- B. a metaphor for the emptiness typical of most popular science writing.
- C. a case in which a metaphor for a scientific process leads to a misunderstanding of that process.
- D. an example of the metaphorical explanations the author believes are typical of bad science writing.
- E. an illustration of a complex phenomenon for which most readers require simplified explanations.

Passage 93

The use of nets at beach resorts to protect swimming areas from sharks has been criticized by environmentalists because the nets needlessly kill thousands of marine animals annually. However, environmentalists have recently discovered that an electrified cable buried beneath the periphery of swimming areas causes sharks to swim away while harming neither humans nor marine life. Hence, by installing such cables, resort communities will be able to maintain tourism while satisfying environmentalists' concerns. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument?

- A. Many seaside resort communities where sharks have never been sighted nonetheless paid to install buried electrified cables.
- B. Tourism at resorts where sharks have been sighted has suffered only slightly despite the fact that many people claim to fear sharks.
- C. Because they have a strong fear of sharks, many tourists prefer to swim at beaches that are known to be well protected from sharks.
- D. The buried electrified cable is not the only innovation approved by environmentalists that is known to be successful in repelling sharks without harming them.
- E. The marine mammals that are a major tourist attraction at many resorts do not enter areas around which there are buried electrified cables.

Passage 94

In general, naive individuals appear more likely to learn from interaction with familiar rather than unfamiliar members of their species. Kaveliers and colleagues (2005) reported that naive laboratory-bred deer mice showed greater social learning of defensive responses to biting flies after observing responses of familiar members than after observing responses of unfamiliar members. **Earlier, Valsecchi and colleagues (1996) reported striking differences in social learning of food preferences among Mongolian gerbils, depending on whether they were exposed to familiar or unfamiliar demonstrators.** At the time, this was unexpected because **Gaief and colleagues (1984)** had previously reported no familiarity effect in Norway rats on social learning of food preferences. However, Gaief et al (1998) subsequently uncovered a significant familiarity effect that was evident when demonstrators are some hours before interacting with observers but absent when demonstrators are immediately before interacting.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following can be inferred about the report by Gaief and colleagues (1984) as it is described in the passage?

- A. It introduced a concept that the report by Kaveliers and colleagues was intended to clarify.
- B. It highlighted an inaccuracy in the report by Valsecchi and colleagues.
- C. It led to an incorrect supposition on the part of some scientists.
- D. It played an important role in developing an understanding of social learning between members of different species.
- E. It suggested that the familiarity effect is stronger in some species than in others.

Passage 95

While historian Linda Nicholson sees women's participation in voluntary associations as activities consistent with the increasing relegation of women's lives to a separate, "private" sphere in nineteenth-century Europe, historian Katherine Lynch argues that these kinds of activities enabled women to join with one another and to develop a kind of shadow citizenship within civil society, if not the formal state. **These kinds of experiences** were no substitute for actual political entitlements, Lynch suggests, but they deserve more attention for their importance in helping individuals forge enduring bonds of community and identity beyond domestic life. Only by limiting one's notion of public life to formal political participation, she says, can one conclude that most women in Western society have ever been literally consigned to a separate or "private" sphere. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The phrase "These kinds of experiences" in the passage refers to experiences in Lynch's view are

- A. an early stage in women's political participation
- B. insufficiently appreciated for their role in women's public life
- C. properly assigned to the "private" sphere
- D. a means of altering the political structure
- E. historically atypical for women in Western society

2. The passage implies that Lynch would agree that formal political participation

- A. was increasingly important as the nineteenth century progressed.
- B. was an underreported phenomenon among women in nineteenth century Europe within civil society.
- C. is crucial to helping individuals form community ties.
- D. is a significant component of public life.
- E. is indicative of a kind of shadow citizenship.

Passage 96

In the 1600s there was intense competition in Europe to discover how to make porcelain. The two groups of Europeans working in China—Dutch merchants and French missionaries—each tried to discover the Chinese manufacturers' secrets. The first French missionary journal, was not published until 1717, several years after European porcelain manufacture began. Therefore, rather than copying the Chinese techniques, the European manufacturers must have learned by experiment. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, provides the strongest support for the argument?

- A. The techniques used by the first European makers of porcelain were essentially identical to techniques that Chinese porcelain maker used.
- B. The first European-manufactured porcelain items were comparable in quality to some of the lower-quality porcelain that was then being imported into Europe from China.
- C. The manuscript from which the 1717 journal article was published had been written down by French missionaries in China and sent to France some years before 1717.
- D. The particular raw materials that are needed to make porcelain were not used in European ceramic making until the manufacture of porcelain began.
- E. The first porcelain factory in Europe was founded in Germany by a manufacturer who had no channels of communication with China or Europeans working in China.

Passage 97

Editors of major United States newsmagazines have been criticized for reducing the amount of space these magazines devote to international news. According to these editors, however, readers are wholly to blame for the reductions. After all, the editors point out, **sales of magazine issues that prominently feature international news stories have declined significantly**, and declining sales reflect declining reader interest. Yet even if true, this evidence does not refute the contention that editors are merely passive instruments responding to reader interest. And that is clearly an untenable view, since **editors can often intensify reader interest in a news topic by giving it frequent coverage**. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

In the argument as a whole, the two highlighted portions play which of the following roles?

- A. The first is evidence that has been used to support a position that the argument opposes; the second is a point that the argument raises to cast doubt on the reasoning used to support that position.
- B. The first presents a claim, the truth of which is evaluated in the argument; the second is information introduced to cast doubt on that claim.
- C. The first presents a claim, the truth of which is evaluated in the argument; the second provides evidence in support of that claim.
- D. The first cites evidence in support of the main conclusion of the argument; the second states that conclusion.
- E. The first states an assumption that is explicitly made to support the main conclusion of the argument; the second is a position that the argument as a whole opposes.

Passage 98

The crustaceans known as harpacticoids are very widespread in marine sediments, where they feed on microorganisms by ingesting the sediment particles to which the microorganisms adhere. Heavy metals, such as those found in industrial pollution, readily adhere to sediment particles. Harpacticoids are poisoned by heavy metals but are unaffected by most other pollutants. Therefore the concentration of harpacticoids in an area is a good indication of whether that marine environment contains heavy metals. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument relies?

- A. Industrial pollution is the principal source of heavy metals in marine sediments.
- B. Harpacticoids are the only crustaceans that feed on microorganisms by ingesting sediment particles.
- C. Harpacticoids are more susceptible to poisoning by heavy metals than are other marine organisms.
- D. The microorganisms that harpacticoids feed on are not killed by pollutants that are harmless to harpacticoids.
- E. The microorganisms that harpacticoids feed on absorb heavy metals.

Passage 99

Orcas are small whales that generally travel in groups called pods. Orcas that feed on marine mammals travel in very small pods, while those that feed on fish travel in relatively large pods. Since a larger pod has an increased collective ability to locate prey, it is likely that orcas that feed on mammals travel in small pods only because the mammals that they hunt can more easily detect a large pod and escape it. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most strongly indicates that the conclusion is too sweeping?

- A. Orcas that feed on fish almost always remain in the pod into which they were born, while orcas that feed on mammals will form new pods if the one they are in becomes too big.
- B. No orcas have been observed to switch back and forth between feeding on fish and feeding on mammals.
- C. Pods of orcas generally include at least one mother and one or two of her offspring.
- D. Unlike marine mammals, fish generally travel in large schools, which can provide food for large pods of orcas.
- E. Individuals from different pods interact frequently, and pods are small, such interaction predominantly foraging activities.

Passage 100

The male lion's mane consists of hair of varying length and color, covering, to varying degrees, the head, neck, shoulders, and chest. Schaller suggested that the mane protects the area of the body "towards which most social contact is directed" by absorbing blows and bites. **Darker mane hairs are thicker than lighter hairs**, so darker manes may provide better protection. These ideas suggest that males with longer and darker manes will be wounded less frequently and/or with less severity on the area covered by the mane, but direct tests of this **prediction** are difficult. Individual males are seldom seen daily, and the mane itself obscures many wounds beneath it from view. Furthermore, even in the best studied population, serious fights between lions are rarely observed. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describe the function of the highlighted portion of the passage?

- A. to summarize the results of an experiment
- B. to provide evidence on which a particular prediction is offered
- C. to offer a counterexample that undermines a propelled explanation
- D. to identify a phenomenon that Schaller found difficult to explain
- E. to explain the variation among individual lion manes

2. The passage mentions which of the following as an obstacle to verify the "prediction" mentioned in the passage?

- A. Wounds to the mane area are often difficult to observe.
- B. Only a few lion populations have been well studied.
- C. The severity of fights between lions is difficult to determine.
- D. Individual males seldom have strong distinguishing characteristics.
- E. Researchers have relatively few opportunities to observe lion populations directly.

Passage 101

The Menkentown Business Herald dated June 4, 1965, carried an article about four dry cleaners in Menkentown and reported that in 1964 each of them took in a larger proportion of the total dollar amount spent by Menkentown residents at dry cleaners than it had in 1963. Assuming that the article is accurate and that during 1963 and 1964 no Menkentown resident patronized any dry cleaner outside of Menkentown, it follows that _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following most logically completes the argument?

- A. The average cost of having an article of clothing dry-cleaned was higher in 1964 than in 1963.
- B. Total revenues received by Menkentown's dry cleaners increased between 1963 and 1964.
- C. There were more than four dry cleaners in Menkentown in 1963.
- D. The total number of dry cleaners in Menkentown increased during 1963.
- E. Some dry cleaners in Menkentown that were in operation in 1963 were not in operation in 1964.

Passage 102

A divide between aesthetic and technical considerations has played a crucial role in mapmaking and cartographic scholarship. Since nineteenth century cartographers, for instance, understood themselves as technicians who did not care about visual effects, while others saw themselves as landscape painters. That dichotomy structured the discipline of the history of cartography. Until the 1980s, in what Blakemore and Harley called “the Old is Beautiful Paradigm,” scholars largely focused on maps made before 1800, marveling at their beauty and sometimes regretting the decline of the pre-technical age. Early mapmaking was considered art while modern cartography was located within the realm of engineering utility. Alpers, however, has argued that this boundary would have puzzled mapmakers in the seventeenth century, because they considered themselves to be visual engineers. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, Alpers would say that the assumptions underlying the “paradigm” were
 - A. inconsistent with the way some mapmakers prior to 1800 understand their own work
 - B. dependent on a seventeenth-century conception of mapmaking visual engineering
 - C. unconcerned with the difference between the aesthetic and technical questions of mapmaking
 - D. insensitive to divisions among cartographers working in the period after 1800
 - E. supported by the demonstrable technical superiority of mapmaking made after 1800
2. It can be inferred from the passage that, beginning in the 1980s, historians of cartography
 - A. placed greater emphasis on the beauty of maps made after 1800.
 - B. expanded their range of study to include more material created after 1800.
 - C. grew more sensitive to the way mapmakers prior to 1800 conceived of their work.
 - D. came to see the visual details of maps as aesthetic objects rather than practical cartographic aids.
 - E. reduced the attention they paid to the technical aspects of mapmaking.

Passage 103

Most mammals reach sexual maturity when their growth rates are in decline, whereas humans experience a growth spurt during adolescence. Whether apes experience an adolescent growth spurt is still undecided. In the 1950s, data on captive chimpanzees collected by James Gavan appeared devoid of evidence of an adolescent growth spurt in these apes. In a recent reanalysis of Gavan's data, however, zoologist Elizabeth Watts has found that as chimpanzees reach sexual maturity, the growth rate of their limbs accelerates. Most biologists, however, are skeptical that this is a humanlike adolescent growth spurt. While the human adolescent growth spurt is physically obvious and affects virtually the entire body, the chimpanzee's increased growth rate is detectable only through sophisticated mathematical analysis. Moreover, according to scientist Holly Smith, the growth rate increase in chimpanzees begins when 86% of full skeletal growth has been attained, whereas human adolescence generally commences when 77 percent of full skeletal growth has occurred. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describes the main idea of the passage?
 - A. Researchers have long disagreed about whether data collected in the 1950s indicate that chimpanzees and other apes experience an adolescent growth spurt.
 - B. Research data collected on chimpanzees living in captivity are inconclusive with respect to chimpanzees living in the wild.
 - C. The notion that apes do not experience an adolescent growth spurt has been confirmed by research conducted since.
 - D. Although the idea that apes experience an adolescent growth has received some support, most biologists remain unconvinced.
 - E. Although researchers agree that chimpanzees do not experience an adolescent growth spurt, they are divided in their opinions of whether this is true of other apes.
2. The passage mentions which of the following as one of the reasons why most biologists remain skeptical that chimpanzees experience a humanlike adolescent growth spurt?
 - A. Chimpanzees do not experience a demonstrable increase in growth rate until they are fully sexually mature.
 - B. The increase in growth rate that chimpanzees undergo at sexual maturity is less apparent than that of humans.
 - C. The increase in growth rate once regarded as a humanlike adolescent growth spurt in chimpanzees is too sporadic to be regarded as significant.
 - D. Not all chimpanzees undergo a calculable growth spurt.
 - E. Watt's approach to analyzing data is considered to be highly unorthodox.
3. The passage suggests which of the following about the adolescent growth spurt that takes place in humans?
 - A. Its primary effects are found in parts of the body other than the limbs.
 - B. It is generally completed by the time 77 percent of full skeletal growth is attained.
 - C. It is normally detectable without the assistance of sophisticated mathematical analysis.
 - D. The rate of growth is much faster at the beginning of puberty than at any other time.
 - E. The estimated growth rate varies depending on the methods of measurement that are used.

Passage 104

Many cultural anthropologists have come to reject the scientific framework of empiricism that dominated the field until the 1970s and now regard all scientific knowledge as socially constructed. They argue that information about cultures during the empiricist era typically came from anthropologists who brought with them a prepackaged set of conscious and unconscious biases. Cultural anthropology, according to the post-1970s critique, is unavoidably subjective, and the anthropologist should be explicit in acknowledging that fact. Anthropology should stop striving to build a better database about cultural behavior and should turn to developing a more humanistic interpretation of cultures. The new framework holds that it may be more enlightening to investigate the biases of earlier texts than to continue with empirical methodologies. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author implies which of the following about most cultural anthropologists working prior to the 1970s?

- A. They argued that scientific knowledge was socially constructed.
- B. They were explicit in acknowledging the biases inherent in scientific investigation.
- C. They regarded scientific knowledge as consisting of empirical truths.
- D. They shared the same conscious and unconscious biases.
- E. They acknowledged the need for a new scientific framework.

2. According to the passage, “many cultural anthropologists” today would agree that anthropologists should

- A. build a better, less subjective database about cultural behavior.
- B. strive to improve the empirical methodologies used until the 1970s.
- C. reject the notion that scientific knowledge is socially constructed.
- D. turn to examining older anthropological texts for unacknowledged biases.
- E. integrate humanistic interpretations with empirical methodologies.

Passage 105

Writing about nineteenth-century women's travel writing, Lila Harper notes that the four women she discussed used their own names, in contrast with the nineteenth-century female novelists who either published anonymously or used male pseudonyms. The novelists doubtlessly realized that they were breaking boundaries, whereas three of the four daring, solitary travelers espoused traditional values, eschewing radicalism and women's movements. Whereas the female novelists criticized their society, the female travelers seemed content to leave society as it was while accomplishing their own liberation. In other words, they lived a contradiction. For the subjects of Harper's study, solitude in both the private and public spheres prevailed—a solitude that conferred authority, hitherto a male prerogative, but that also precluded any collective action or female solidarity. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best characterizes the “contradiction” that the author refers to?

- A. The subjects of Harper's study enjoyed solitude, and yet as travelers they were often among people.
- B. Nineteenth-century travel writers used their own names, but nineteenth-century novelists used pseudonyms.
- C. Women's movements in the nineteenth-century were not very radical in comparison with those of the twentieth-century.
- D. Nineteenth-century female novelists thought they were breaking boundaries, but it was the nineteenth-century women who traveled alone who were really doing so.
- E. While traveling alone in the nineteenth-century was considered a radical act for a woman, the nineteenth-century solitary female travelers generally held conventional views.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. According to the passage, solitude had which of the following effects for the nineteenth century female travelers?

- A. It conferred an authority typically enjoyed only by men.
- B. It prevented formation of alliances with other women.
- C. It relieved peer pressure to conform to traditional values.

Passage 106

Although vastly popular during its time, much nineteenth-century women's fiction in the United States went unread by the twentieth-century educated elite, who were taught to ignore it as didactic. However, American literature has a tradition of didacticism going back to its Puritan roots, shifting over time from sermons and poetic transcripts into novels, which proved to be perfect vehicles for **conveying** social values. **In the nineteenth century, critics reviled Poe for neglecting to conclude his stories with pithy moral tags, while Longfellow was canonized for his didactic verse.** Although rhetorical changes favoring the anti-didactic can be detected as nineteenth-century American transformed itself into a secular society, it was twentieth-century criticism, which placed aesthetic value above everything else, that had no place in its doctrine for the didacticism of others. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted sentence?

- A. It explains why the fiction mentioned in the first sentence was not popular in the twentieth century.
- B. It assists in drawing a contrast between nineteenth-century and twentieth-century critics.
- C. It provides an example of how twentieth – century readers were taught to ignore certain literature.
- D. It questions the usefulness of a particular distinction between Poe and Longfellow made by critics.
- E. It explains why Poe's stories were more popular than Longfellow's verse during the nineteenth century.

2. In the context in which it appears, "conveying" most nearly means

- A. carrying
- B. transferring
- C. granting
- D. imparting
- E. projecting

Passage 107

During the Pleistocene epoch, several species of elephants isolated on islands underwent rapid dwarfing. This phenomenon was not necessarily confined to the Pleistocene, but may have occurred much earlier in the Southeastern Asian islands, although evidence is fragmentary. Several explanations are possible for this dwarfing. For example, islands often have not been colonized by large predators or are too small to hold viable predator populations. Once free from predation pressure, large body size is of little advantage to herbivores. Additionally, island habitats have limited food resources, a smaller body size and a need for fewer resources would thus be favored. Interestingly, the island rule is reversed for small mammals such as rodents, for which gigantism is favored under insular conditions. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. question the plausibility of one explanation sometimes offered for the dwarfing of certain species living on islands.
 - B. argue that dwarfing of certain species living on islands occurred prior to the Pleistocene.
 - C. cite evidence suggesting that dwarfing may have adverse consequences for some species living on islands.
 - D. present some possible explanations for the dwarfing of certain species living on islands.
 - E. contrast the effects of insular conditions on species with large body size and species with small body.
2. According to the passage, which of the following statements about body size in mammals is true?
 - A. A large body is unfavorable to mammalian species' survival under most conditions.
 - B. A large body tends to benefit small mammals living on islands.
 - C. For most herbivorous mammals, a large body size is easier to sustain in the absence of large predators.
 - D. Under most conditions, a small body is less beneficial to herbivorous mammals than to nonherbivorous mammals.
 - E. Among nonherbivorous mammals, a small body is more beneficial on an island than on a mainland.

Passage 108

In the early twentieth century, small magazines and the innovative graphics used on them created the face of the avant-guard. It was a look that signaled progressive ideas and unconventionality because it dispensed with the cardinal rule of graphic design: to take an idea and make it visually clear, concise, and instantly understood. Instead, graphics produced by avant-guard artists exclusively for the avant-guard (as opposed to their advertising work) were usually difficult to decipher, ambiguous, or nonsensical. This overturning of convention, this assailing of standard graphic and typographic formats, was part of a search for intellectual freedom. The impulse toward liberation enabled avant-guardists to see with fresh eyes untried possibilities for arranging and relating words and images on paper. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, the primary purpose of conventional graphic design is to
- A. render unpopular ideas palatable to a wider audience.
 - B. capture readers' attention with bold fonts.
 - C. communicate nonsensical notions to a wide public.
 - D. communicate ideas as efficiently and unambiguously as possible.
 - E. introduce previously unknown ideas to the general public.

For the following question, consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. According to the passage, avant-guard artists of the early twentieth-century created ambiguous or nonsensical graphics as part of an attempt to
- A. expand the potential for expression through visual art.
 - B. compete with advertisements for reader's attention.
 - C. encourage the expansion of small magazines.

Passage 109

According to Hill and Spicer, the term “nation-state” is a misnomer, since the ideal model of a monolingual, culturally homogeneous state has never existed, not even among Europeans, who invented the nation-state concept and introduced it to the rest of the world. Modern European states, they argue, emerged after the Renaissance through the rise of nations (i.e., specific ethnic groups) to positions of political and economic dominance over a number of other ethnic groups within the bounded political territories. The term “nation-state”, Hill and Spicer argue, obscures the internal cultural and linguistic diversity of states that could more accurately be called “conquest states.” The resurgence of multiple ethnic groups within a single state, Hill says, is not “potentially threatening to the sovereign jurisdiction of the state,” as Urban and Sherzer suggest; rather, the assertion of cultural differences threatens to reveal ethnocentric beliefs and practices upon which conquest states were historically founded and thus to open up the possibility for a “nations-state” in which conquered ethnic groups enjoy equal rights with the conquering ethnic group but do not face the threat of persecution or cultural assimilation into the dominant ethnic group. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to

- A. discuss issues relating to a form of political organization by raising doubts about the terminology used to refer to it.
- B. trace changes in a form of political organization by examining the evolution of the terminology used to refer to.
- C. justify the continued use of an established term for an evolving form of political organization.
- D. question the accuracy of a new term for a form of political organization.
- E. compare two terms for a form of political organization.

2. The author of the passage quotes Urban and Sherzer most probably in order to

- A. introduce a discussion of the legal ramifications of expanding the nation-state concept.
- B. summarize a claim about one possible effect of asserting cultural differences within a state.
- C. shift the focus of discussion from internal threats that states face to external threats that they face.
- D. point out similarities between the threats to states seen by Urban and Sherzer and those seen by Hill.
- E. describe one way an ethnocentric practice has affected attempts to assert cultural differences within a state.

3. According to the passage, Hill and Spicer define nations as which of the following?

- A. coalitions of distinct ethnic groups with similar concerns
- B. distinct ethnic groups
- C. culturally homogeneous states
- D. linguistically diverse states
- E. territorially bounded states

Passage 110

From 1910 to 1913, women suffragists in the United States organized annual parades—activity traditionally conducted by men to proclaim solidarity in some cause—not only as a public expression of suffragist solidarity but also a conscious transgression of the **rules of social order**: women’s very presence in the streets challenged traditional notions of femininity and restrictions on women’s conduct. While recognizing the parade’s rhetorical force as a vehicle for social change, scholars have recently begun to examine its drawbacks as a form of protest. Lumsden characterizes the American suffrage parade as a “double-edged sword”, arguing that women’s efforts to proclaim their solidarity left them open to patronizing commentary from press and public and to organized opposition from antisuffragists. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred from the passage that men’s and women’s parades were similar in that both
 - A. were employed as rhetorical vehicles for social change.
 - B. were regarded as violating contemporary standards of public decorum.
 - C. made participants vulnerable to organized opposition.
 - D. were largely ineffective as forms of protest.
 - E. were intended by their participants as public declarations of solidarity.
2. The passage suggests which of the following about proponents of the “rules of social order?”
 - A. They frowned upon public displays such as parades.
 - B. They had ulterior motives for objecting to women’s participation in suffrage parades.
 - C. They formed the core of the organized opposition to women suffrage.
 - D. They believed that it was unfeminine for women to march in suffrage parades.
 - E. They supported women’s rights to vote but disapprove some of the methods that suffragists employed to gain that right.

Passage 111

Unlike most Jane Austen scholarship before 1980, much recent scholarship analyzes the novels of Austen, who lived from 1775 to 1817, in the context of Austen's tumultuous times, which saw the French and American revolutions and the Napoleonic Wars. Yet Frantz notes another revolution, rarely mentioned in Austen scholarship: the Great Masculine Renunciation that altered conventions in men's dress and behavior. During the later eighteenth century, wealthy gentlemen exchanged the velvets and satins long in fashion for somber woolen suits. Frantz contends that this change reflected deeper cultural changes. The value once placed on men's expressiveness, reflected in Mackenzie's novel *The Man of Feeling* (1771), gave way to a preference for emotional restraint. In Austen's novels, the heroine often struggles to glimpse the true nature of hero beneath his reserved exterior. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage mentions *The Man of Feeling* (1771) in order to
 - A. contrast Mackenzie's reasons for writing novels with those of Austen
 - B. introduce evidence regarding the influence of particular writers on Austen
 - C. corroborate a claim that a convention of masculine behavior changed during Austen's lifetime
 - D. suggest that Austen's novels were more reflective of their historical context than Mackenzie's had been
 - E. challenge a particular misconception about the modes of behavior common among gentlemen in the later eighteenth century
2. The passage suggests which of the following about scholarship on Jane Austen?
 - A. Much recent scholarship has begun to place greater emphasis on gender conventions governing men's behavior during Austen's lifetime.
 - B. Some scholarship has debated whether Austen's novels depict emotional restraint as an admiral quality.
 - C. Certain scholars argue that Austen's novels do not accurately reflect cultural changes during Austen's lifetime that changed the way gentlemen dressed and behaved.
 - D. After 1980, scholarship on Austen shifted toward a greater emphasis on the historical context in which she wrote.
 - E. With few exceptions, recent scholarship depicts Austen as a writer who had little interest in the tumultuous events of her time.

Passage 112

Whereas Carlos Bulosan aimed through fiction and personal testimony to advance both Filipino civil rights in the United States and the social transformation of the Philippines, Yen Le Espiritu has set herself the task of recovering life histories of Filipino Americans. Her work brings Filipino Americans of the generation following the 1934-1965 immigration hiatus **graphically** to life. A special strength is the representation of Filipino American women, who were scarce among immigrants before the 1934 American curb on Filipino immigration but composed more than half of the immigrants to America since liberalization in 1965. Espiritu's subjects document their changing sense of Filipino identity in the United States, much as Bulosan did as a member of the first substantial wave of immigrants. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, both Bulosan and Espiritu do which of the following in their work?
 - A. consider generational differences in Filipino immigrants' responses to life in the United States
 - B. attempt to make allowance for the demographic variations among Filipino immigrants to the United States
 - C. employ fiction in addition to documenting actual life histories of Filipino immigrants to the United States
 - D. represent how life in the United States has affected immigrants' sense of Filipino identity
 - E. examine the effects on Filipinos in the United States of the 1934 American curb on Filipino immigration
2. In the context in which it appears, "graphically" most nearly means
 - A. in writing
 - B. by means of drawing
 - C. impressionistically
 - D. diagrammatically
 - E. vividly

Passage 113

1800 Thomas Dilworth's *New Guide to the English Dialogue* was being widely used to teach reading in the United States. Dilworth's primer, unlike earlier ones, stressed the importance of children's understanding what they read. While it is in fact unlikely that children would have recognized all the vocabulary Dilworth used, that was at least his stated goal. Dilworth recognized that primers should enable children to decode words from print with the form of language they already knew: speech. In contrast, many **earlier authors** assumed that, just as introductory Latin texts taught children an unknown language, introductory English texts should teach English as if it, too, were an unknown language. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, the "earlier authors" adopted a model for English instruction that
 - A. mirrored the practice used in Latin instruction.
 - B. was originally formulated by Dilworth.
 - C. was less esoteric than that adopted by Dilworth.
 - D. stressed familiarity with the peculiarities of English spelling.
 - E. emphasized the importance of fluent and articulate speech.
2. The author of the passage would probably agree with which of the following criticisms of English primers predating Dilworth's?
 - A. Their Latinate grammatical terms poorly described the structures of English.
 - B. They failed to make effective use of the knowledge of language a child already possessed.
 - C. Their texts typically focused on subject matter that held little intrinsic interest for their readers.
 - D. They neglected to teach the language in a sufficiently systematic way.
 - E. They required a pedagogical method that few American teachers of the era possessed.

Passage 114

Many scholars have argued that government investment in manufacturing in the southern United States during the Second World War spurred a regional economic boom that lasted into the postwar period. **But much of this investment went to specialized plants, many of them unsuitable for postwar production.** Large-scale, wartime government funding led to a massive increase in the number and scale of munitions facilities. By the war's end, 216 munitions establishment costing more than \$3.5 billion had been built, many of them located in the south. Indeed, according to one estimate, more than 70 percent of federally financed manufacturing construction capital in Alabama, Arkansas, Mississippi, and Tennessee went into munitions plants.

Even in the northern regions with strong prewar manufacturing economics, these plants were difficult to deal with once the imperative of war had been removed. In the south few industrialists had the capacity or desire to transform these factories to a peacetime function. Accordingly, at war's end almost all of the southern munitions facilities were shut down, placed on standby, operated at a very low capacity, or converted to nonmanufacturing functions, usually storage. Although some reopened a few years later for use during the Korean War, the impact of the special plants on the South's postwar economy was marginal at best. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. propose an alternative explanation
 - B. challenge a widely held position
 - C. contrast two views of a phenomenon
 - D. explain why a particular claim has been influential
 - E. evaluate evidence used to support a particular view

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. According to the passage, some southern munitions plants built in the South during the Second World War were
 - A. later reopened and used once more as munitions plants
 - B. used for nonmanufacturing purposes after the war
 - C. originally envisioned as continuing to manufacture munitions at high capacity even after the war had ended
3. In the passage, the mention of "Alabama, Arkansas, Mississippi, and Tennessee" serves primarily to
 - A. suggest that some states were better than others at anticipating postwar economic needs
 - B. identify evidence used to support a view held by scholars mentioned at the beginning of the passage
 - C. suggest that federal investment in some kinds of manufacturing was excessive
 - D. identify the states that received the largest allocations of federal funds
 - E. provide information to support a point about the nature of government investment made earlier in the paragraph
4. In the highlighted portion of the passage, the author notes that plants were "specialized" primarily in order to
 - A. support a claim about the way in which wartime imperatives determined the amount of government investment in southern manufacturing
 - B. suggest that the federal government's investments in southern manufacturing during the Second world war were largely ineffective
 - C. identify a factor that limited the impact of wartime government investment on the postwar southern economy

D. contrast the kinds of manufacturing facilities built in southern states during the Second world war with those built in northern states
E. challenge a claim about the reasons for government investment in southern manufacturing during the Second world war

5. The author implies which of the following about the manufacturing facilities built in southern states during the Second world war?

- A. They tended to be less well-suited to conversion to peacetime purposes than were manufacturing facilities built in northern states.
- B. They had a greater impact on the wartime economies of Alabama, Arkansas, Mississippi, and Tennessee than on those of other southern states.
- C. They temporarily allowed the southern states to surpass the northern states in creating manufacturing jobs.
- D. Few of them continued to serve their original functions during the postwar period.
- E. Some of them operated at a very low capacity during as well as after the war.

6. It can be inferred that the author of the passage would disagree with the “scholars” mentioned in the first sentence about which of the following?

- A. the extent to which the postwar southern economy benefited from the wartime investment of federal funds
- B. the effect of government investment on construction of manufacturing plants in southern states during the Second world war
- C. the extent to which government-funded manufacturing facilities in the South actually benefited the United States effort to win the Second world war
- D. whether southern munitions plants built during the Second world war were converted to nonmanufacturing functions after the war
- E. whether government investment in manufacturing in southern states during the Second world war exceeded private investment there

Passage 115

Although the passenger pigeons, now extinct, were abundant in eighteenth and nineteenth-century America, archaeological studies at twelfth-century Cahokian sites in the present day United States examined household food trash and found that traces of passenger pigeon were quite rare. Given that the sites were close to a huge passenger pigeon roost documented by John James Audubon in the nineteenth century and that Cahokians consumed almost every other animal protein source available, **the archaeologists conducting the studies** concluded the passenger pigeon population had once been very limited before increasing dramatically in post-Columbian America. Other archaeologists have criticized those conclusions on the grounds that passenger pigeon bones would not be likely to be preserved. But all the archaeological projects found plenty of bird bones and even **tiny bones from fish**. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage mentions “tiny bones from fish” primarily in order to
 - A. explain why traces of passenger pigeon are rare at Cahokian sites.
 - B. support a claim about the wide variety of animal proteins in the Cahokian diet.
 - C. provide evidence that confirms a theory about the extinction of the passenger pigeon.
 - D. cast doubt on the conclusion reached by the archaeologists who conducted the studies discussed in the passage.
 - E. counter an objection to an interpretation of the data obtained from Cahokian sites.
2. Which of the following, if true, would most call into question the reasoning of “the archaeologists conducting the studies”?
 - A. Audubon was unable to correctly identify twelfth-century Cahokian sites.
 - B. Audubon made his observations before passenger pigeon populations began to decline.
 - C. Passenger pigeons would have been attracted to household food trash.
 - D. Archaeologist have found passenger pigeon remains among food waste at eighteenth-century human settlements.
 - E. Passenger pigeons tended not to roost at the same sites for very many generations.

Passage 116

Feminist scholars have tended to regard women in the nineteenth-century United States who elected to remain single as champions of women's autonomy and as critics of marriage as an oppressive institution. Indeed, many nineteenth-century American women who participated in reform movements or who distinguished themselves as writers and professionals were single. Yet this view of single women tends to distort the meaning of their choices. The nineteenth century saw the elevation of marriage for love as a spiritual ideal. Consequently, it became socially acceptable for women not to marry if such an ideal marriage could not be realized with an available suitor. Thus, many women's choice to remain single reflected not a negative view of marriage but a highly idealistic one. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage implies that many nineteenth-century American women chose to remain single because they

- A. believed that marriage required them to give up much of their autonomy.
- B. had attitudes toward marriage that were influenced by contemporary reform movements.
- C. wanted to take advantage of increasing opportunities to distinguish themselves as professionals.
- D. doubted that their own marriage would live up to their notion of what a marriage ought to be.
- E. had a negative view of marriage fostered by a change in social attitudes during the nineteenth century.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The author of the passage suggests that the feminist scholars mentioned in the first sentence distort the meaning of certain nineteenth-century American women's choices by

- A. ascribing those choices to a particular attitude toward marriage.
- B. ignoring evidence about single women's motives for becoming writers or professionals.
- C. overestimating the number of nineteenth-century American women who were single by choice.

Passage 117

Many researchers attribute the large number of physiological and behavioral similarities between birds and mammals, which have separate evolutionary histories, to endothermy (a thermoregulatory strategy whereby warm body temperature is maintained through internal heat sources). However, Farmer argues that parental care rather than endothermy is the key to understanding the similarities between mammals and birds. According to Farmer, while endothermy provides an explanation for a few similarities, such as the presence of body insulation, endothermy is just one characteristic among many related to parental care. The two purported advantages of endothermy that have been most frequently cited by researchers are an expanded range of inhabitable environments and the ability to sustain vigorous exercise. But metabolism has to increase substantially (at great energy cost) therefore conferring any significant thermoregulatory advantage in terms of the former, and there is no causal biological linkage to explain why endothermy would be essential to sustain exercise. Farmer argues instead that endothermy evolved as a means to control incubation temperature and that the ability to sustain exercise evolved separately, as a means to improve a parent's ability to forage and provision its young. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to

- A. present a scientific theory that challenges a widely held theory.
- B. summarize the basis for a large body of scientific research.
- C. defend an established scientific theory in light of recent criticism.
- D. express skepticism about the results obtained by a particular researcher.
- E. compare the results of two particular scientific studies.

2. Which of the following best characterizes the organization of the passage as a whole?

- A. A position is noted, an alternative to that position is introduced, and then several points in support of the alternative are discussed.
- B. A theory is discussed, an inconsistency within that theory is illustrated, and then a recommendation is made for further inquiry.
- C. Certain research results are described, the significance of those results is explained, and then a novel interpretation of those results is summarized.
- D. A question is posed, a possible answer to that question is suggested, and then evidence is provided to corroborate that answer.
- E. A debate is outlined, contrasting viewpoints within the debate are discussed, and then one viewpoint is demonstrated to be correct.

3. According to the passage, Farmer concedes that endothermy provides an explanation for which of the following features shared by birds and mammals?

- A. the ability to forage
- B. the ability to sustain exercise
- C. the instinct to care for offspring
- D. flexibility in habitat usage
- E. body insulation

Passage 118

Prominent among theories of the function of sleep is Meddis' immobilization hypothesis, which holds that sleep, rather than serving a restorative function, plays a protective role during times that animals cannot be usefully engaged in other activities. **Meddis reasoned that animals not immediately threatened by predators would be safer if they passed the time sleeping.**

However, that hypothesis cannot easily explain why one often observes a rebound in sleep time or intensity following a period of sleep deprivation. Neither does the hypothesis explain the existence of various states of sleep, which themselves may be associated with different functions. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. According to the passage, the immobilization hypothesis fails to account for which of the following facts?

- A. that sleep does not appear to be a uniform and unchanging state
- B. that under certain conditions animals appear to need more sleep than usual
- C. that animals rarely sleep when a predator has been detected nearby

2. In the context of the passage as a whole, the highlighted portion serves primarily to

- A. present the thinking that led scientists to qualify a widely accepted view.
- B. describe the basis on which a hypothesis was advanced.
- C. illustrate the kind of reasoning that is applied in a branch of science.
- D. explain how a hypothesis can be tested empirically.
- E. relate the analysis that refined a tentative explanation.

Passage 119

In 1919 Britain experienced its largest ever reduction in industrial working hours, to 48 per week. In Dowie's view the 48-hour week played a central role in Britain's poor economic performance during the 1920s. Dowie argued that the reduction, together with rapid wage growth, drove up prices. However, Greasley and Oxley found that the First World War (1914-1918) constituted a more powerful negative macroeconomic shock to Britain's competitiveness. And Scott argues that Dowie's thesis ignores considerable evidence that hourly productivity improves when hours are reduced from a high base level. Crucially, Dowie's thesis does not acknowledge that hours were reduced to around 48 hours a week for industrial workers in most industrialized nations at this time so far—undermining any potential impact of reduced hours on industrial productivity relative to other nations. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following, if true, provides the strongest support for Scott's argument?
 - A. Companies have generally found that part-time employees are less productive than full-time ones.
 - B. When the total number of hours worked at a company increases owing to the addition of more employees, the usual result is improved productivity at the company.
 - C. When the total hours worked by all employees per week in two companies are equivalent, hourly productivity tends to be equivalent as well.
 - D. Companies whose employees usually work a high number of hours tend to have greater total costs than do similar companies whose employees work fewer hours.
 - E. Companies have found that total output per employee is not necessarily changed by reductions in the number of hours worked per employee.
2. It can be inferred from the passage that in the view of Greasley and Oxley
 - A. A reduced workweek was ultimately beneficial to employees.
 - B. The economic effects of the reduction in working hours in 1919 were brief.
 - C. Britain became less economically competitive in the 1920s.
 - D. Reduced working hours were the primary cause of the economic changes observed by Dowie.
 - E. The changes in economic performance in Britain in the 1920s were unforeseen.

Passage 120

The finding that there were rock-melting temperatures on asteroids for sustained periods is puzzling: asteroids' heat source is unknown, and unlike planet-sized bodies, such small bodies quickly dissipate heat. Rubin suggests that asteroids' heat could have derived from collisions between asteroids. Skeptics have argued that a single impact would raise an asteroid's overall temperature very little and that asteroids would cool too quickly between impacts to accumulate much heat. However, these objections assumed that asteroids are dense, solid bodies. A recent discovery that asteroids are highly porous makes Rubin's hypothesis more plausible. When solid bodies collide, much debris is ejected, dissipating energy. Impacts on porous bodies generate less debris, so more energy goes into producing heat. Heat could be retained as debris fall back into impact craters, creating an insulating blanket. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage suggests that one factor that has made it difficult to account for the temperatures once reached by asteroids is
- A. a miscalculation of the frequency of asteroid collisions.
 - B. a misconception about asteroids' density.
 - C. a mistaken assumption about what the heat source of the asteroids was.
 - D. an underestimation of the rate at which small bodies lose heat.
 - E. an erroneous view of how asteroids were formed.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. It can be inferred from the passage that Rubin disagrees with skeptics mentioned in the passage about which of the following?
- A. whether porous bodies generate less debris when struck than do solid bodies
 - B. the temperatures asteroids would have to reach for their rocks to have melted
 - C. the likely effect of impacts on asteroids' temperatures

Passage 121

Benjamin Franklin is portrayed in American history as the quintessential self-made man. In “Self-reliance”, Emerson asks, “Where is the master who could have instructed Franklin...?” In fact, Franklin took instruction widely, and his scientific work was highly collaborative. Friends in England sent equipment needed for his electrical experiments, others, in Philadelphia, helped him set up his workshop there. Philip Syng constructed a device for generating electrical charges, while Tomas Hopkinson demonstrated the potential of pointed conductors. Franklin, in addition to being the group’s theoretician, wrote and published its results. **His fame as an individual researcher is partly a consequence of the shorthand by which when one person writes about a group’s discoveries, history sometimes grants singular credit for collective effort.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted sentence?
 - A. It states a viewpoint about Franklin with which the author disagrees.
 - B. It introduces new evidence about Franklin’s role in the collaborative process.
 - C. It explains Franklin’s reputation in terms of a broad scholarly phenomenon.
 - D. It emphasizes the extent to which Franklin relied on others in his workshop.
 - E. It describes Franklin’s approach to writing scientific results.
2. Emerson is mentioned in the passage primarily to
 - A. identify the origin of a particular understanding of Franklin.
 - B. elaborate on a view of Franklin that the author takes issue with.
 - C. point to a controversial claim about Franklin’s historical legacy.
 - D. introduce the question of who Franklin’s main scientific influences were.
 - E. suggest that Franklin was resistant to collaboration with other scientists.

Passage 122

There have long been dead zones—water too low in oxygen to sustain most forms of life—in the Gulf of Mexico, which receives the waters of the Mississippi River. Scientists studied sediment cores from areas where the gulf's most recent dead zone occurred. The scientists dated the sediment and counted species of foraminifera (marine protozoans) in the sediment; these species thrive in low-oxygen waters. As far back as 1823, the foraminifera thrived especially during Mississippi River flood years (during which nutrients levels increase), suggesting that nutrients in floodwaters can trigger low-oxygen water. **The foraminifera in the core samples were most abundant after 1950, when farmers began using some fertilizer, which is rich in nutrients.** Researchers believe that increased use of fertilizer leads to more-extreme dead zones. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted sentence in the context of the passage as a whole?
- A. It reconciles two opposing theories that were discussed earlier in the passage.
 - B. It suggests what the initial impetus was for the studies mentioned earlier in the passage.
 - C. It undermines a hypothesis that was presented in the preceding sentence.
 - D. It describes a problem with the methodology of the studies discussed in the passage.
 - E. It provides evidence supporting the belief mentioned in the final sentence of the passage.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. It can be inferred from the passage that the “researchers” would agree with which of the following statements about the use of fertilizer?
- A. If farmers near the Mississippi River decreased the amount of fertilizer that they used, the severity of the dead zones could be diminished.
 - B. If farmers near the Mississippi River continue their dependence upon fertilizers, foraminifera population will eventually decline.
 - C. If farmers near the Mississippi River stopped using fertilizers altogether, there would no longer be dead zones.

Passage 123

Biologists know that some marine algae can create clouds by producing the gas dimethyl sulphide (DMS), which reacts with oxygen in air above the sea to form solid particles. These particles provide a surface on which water vapor can condense to form clouds. Lovelock contends that this process is part of global climatic-control system. According to Lovelock, Earth acts like a super organism, with all its biological and physical systems cooperating to keep it healthy. He hypothesized that warmer conditions increase algal activity and DMS output, seeding more clouds, which cool the planet by blocking out the Sun. Then, as the climate cools, algal activity and DMS level decrease and the cycle continues. In response to biologists who question how organisms presumably working for their own selfish ends could have evolved to behave in a way that benefits not only the planet but the organisms as well, Lovelock points out that cooling benefits the algae, which remain at the ocean surface, because it allows the cooled upper layers of the ocean to sink, and then the circulating water carries nutrients upward from the depths below. Algae may also benefit from nitrogen raining down from clouds they have helped to form. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, which of the following occurs as a result of cooling in the upper layers of the ocean?
 - A. The concentration of oxygen in the air above the ocean's surface decreases.
 - B. The concentration of DMS in the air above the ocean's surface increases.
 - C. The nutrient supply at the surface of the ocean is replenished.
 - D. Cloud formation increases over the ocean.
 - E. Marine algae make more efficient use of nutrients.
2. Which of the following is most similar to the role played by marine algae in the global climate control system proposed by Lovelock?
 - A. a fan that continually replaces stale air in a room with fresh air from outside
 - B. a thermostat that automatically controls an air-conditioning system
 - C. an insulating blanket that retains heat
 - D. a filter used to purify water
 - E. a dehumidifier that constantly removes moisture from the air in a room
3. The passage mentions the possible benefit to algae of nitrogen falling down in the rain most likely in order to
 - A. provide support for Lovelock's response to an objection mentioned in the passage.
 - B. suggest that the climatic effects of DMS production have been underestimated.
 - C. acknowledge that Lovelock's hypothesis is based in part on speculation.
 - D. demonstrate that DMS production alters the planet in more than one way.
 - E. assert that algae are the sole beneficiaries of DMS production.
4. Which of the following best describes the organization of the passage?
 - A. A question is posed, and several possible answers to the question are introduced and evaluated.
 - B. A prediction is made, and certain factors that influenced that prediction are considered.
 - C. A sequence of events is outlined, and a possible cause for the sequence is offered.
 - D. A phenomenon is described, a theory about the significance of the phenomenon is offered, and a reservation about that theory is addressed.
 - E. A debate is summarized, the strengths and weaknesses of each position are described, and an assessment of the defensibility of each is made.
5. It can be inferred from the passage that Lovelock thinks that biologists who question his hypothesis about cyclical DMS output and algal activity make which of the following errors?
 - A. They do not recognize the benefits that Earth receives from the activity.
 - B. They exaggerate the rate at which nitrogen falls from the clouds.

- C. They assume that the algae remain near the ocean surface throughout the cycle.
- D. They overlook the benefit that the algae receive from the formation of clouds.
- E. They fail to recognize changes in surface water temperature that are caused by algae clouds.

6. The primary purpose of the passage is to

- A. explain the role played by temperature in the stimulation of DMS production by marine algae.
- B. outline the sequence of events that occurs during the process of cloud formation caused by algal activity.
- C. describe a dispute about the role played by marine algae in certain instances of cloud formation.
- D. propose a way in which scientists might be able to understand the effects of clouds on marine algae.
- E. discuss a theory regarding the function of DMS production by marine algae.

Passage 124

When Earth formed 4.6 billion years ago, the Sun burned only 70 percent as brightly as it does today. Yet Geologic record contains no evidence for widespread glaciation until 2.3 billion years ago. Sagan and Mullen suggested in the 1970s that ammonia, a greenhouse gas, warmed early Earth's atmosphere, but subsequent research showed that the Sun's ultraviolet rays rapidly destroy ammonia in an oxygen-free environment, such as that of early Earth. Many scientists now attribute much of the warming of early Earth to oxygen-intolerant microbes—methanogens—that produce the greenhouse gas methane. **The methanogen hypothesis could help to explain the first global ice age: 2.3 billion years ago, Earth's atmosphere began to fill with oxygen produced by other microbes—cyanobacteria—causing methanogens to decline rapidly.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted sentence?
 - A. It refutes the possibility of a connection between two events previously thought to be related.
 - B. It describes how a hypothesis might account for the timing of a phenomenon described earlier in the passage.
 - C. It presents evidence that casts doubt on a statement made in the first sentence of the passage.
 - D. It clarifies a distinction between two related hypotheses.
 - E. It introduces findings that challenge a dominant explanation for a particular phenomenon.
2. Which of the following can be inferred from the passage about methanogens?
 - A. Methanogens must have appeared on Earth later than 2.3 billion years ago.
 - B. Methanogens must have been much more prevalent in some regions of the early Earth than in others.
 - C. Methanogens produce a greenhouse gas that is more susceptible to destruction by the Sun's ultraviolet rays than is ammonia.
 - D. Methanogens could not have thrived in early Earth's atmosphere without the presence of ammonia.
 - E. Methanogens would have had a less significant effect on early Earth's atmosphere if they had evolved after the appearance of cyanobacteria.

Passage 125

Some researchers claim that cetaceans—whales and dolphins—have culture, which the researchers define as the ability to learn from one another. Skeptics, however, demand clear evidence that cetaceans can acquire new behaviors through some form of social learning, preferably clear-cut instances of imitation or teaching. But such evidence is difficult to obtain. While few people doubt that captive cetaceans are adept at imitation or that they reproduce behaviors taught by researchers, biologists seeking insight into cetaceans' behavior in their natural habitats must rely on deduction rather than experiments. **If members of a particular group share behaviors that do not result from genetic inheritance or environmental variation, then they have almost certainly learned them by watching, following, or listening to other animals.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describe the function of the highlighted sentence?
 - A. It identifies a factor that complicates biologists' ability to draw conclusions about the behavior of cetaceans in their natural environments.
 - B. It illustrates the kind of deduction mentioned in the preceding sentence.
 - C. It explains why skeptics have remained unpersuaded by evidence that has been put forward in support of the claim that cetaceans have culture.
 - D. It introduces a claim that would be dismissed by both supporters and opponents of the view that cetaceans have culture.
 - E. It notes a previously overlooked factor that might shed light on the question of whether cetaceans have culture.
2. The passage suggests which of the following about captive cetaceans?
 - A. Whether they are engaged in social learning is a subject of disagreement among biologists.
 - B. Their ability to imitate new behaviors is more extensive than that of noncaptive cetaceans.
 - C. They exhibit few behaviors that have not also been observed in cetaceans in their natural habitats.
 - D. They appear to adopt new behaviors more quickly than noncaptive cetaceans.
 - E. They exhibit tendencies that suggest a capacity for the kind of behavior that qualifies as cultural.

Passage 126

Hotter and more massive than the Sun, stars called “stragglers” are puzzling to astronomers because such rapidly burning stars would not be expected to persist in ancient star clusters.

Some researchers believe that the typical blue stragglers formed when two ancient, lower-mass stars collide and merge form more massive, hotter star. Peter Leonard theorizes alternatively that in low density globular clusters, where mergers between single stars occur too infrequently to account for the observed quantity of blue stragglers, these stragglers are created instead by a group of stars. He suggests that a pair of stars already orbiting each other presents a **larger target** for a third star or another pair. Once this new grouping forms, close encounters between the stars could prompt any two to merge as a blue straggler. Leonard’s model predicts that each blue straggler has a distant orbiting companion —as appears true of many blue stragglers in the M67 cluster of the Milky Way galaxy. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The reference to a “larger target” serves primarily to suggest why a
 - A. blue straggler would be more likely to collide and merge with another star than would be a lower-mass star.
 - B. pair of stars would be more likely to encounter other stars than would the typical blue straggler.
 - C. pair of stars would be more likely to interact with other stars than would a single star.
 - D. blue straggler would be more likely to interact with a pair of stars than it would with a third star.
 - E. third star would be more likely to encounter a pair than it would to encounter a blue straggler.
2. Information presented in the passage suggests which of the following about blue stragglers?
 - A. They originate from stars that are hotter and more massive than the Sun.
 - B. They are burning more rapidly than other types of stars observed in ancient star clusters.
 - C. They are older than most other types of stars within the same star cluster.
 - D. They are less numerous in low-density globular clusters than are pairs of stars.
 - E. They generally originate from the oldest stars among those found in ancient star clusters.
3. The passage cites which of the following as evidence undermining the theory presented in the second sentence?
 - A. a discrepancy between the number of mergers between single stars in certain low-density globular clusters and that in other low-density globular clusters
 - B. a discrepancy between the heat and mass of blue stragglers formed by one type of process and the heat and mass of blue stragglers formed by another type of process
 - C. a discrepancy between the frequency of star mergers in low-density globular clusters and those in high-density globular clusters
 - D. a discrepancy between the amount of heat and mass of ancient single stars and that of blue stragglers
 - E. a discrepancy between the number of mergers between single stars in certain star clusters and the number of blue stragglers in those clusters

Passage 127

Most seismologists assume that following a major earthquake and its aftershocks, the fault (a break in Earth's crust where pressure can trigger an earthquake) will remain quiet until stresses have time to rebuild, typically over hundreds or thousands of years. Recent evidence of subtle interactions between earthquakes may overturn this assumption, however. According to the stress-triggering hypothesis, faults are unexpectedly responsive to subtle stresses they acquire as neighboring faults shift. Rather than simply dissipating, stress relieved during an earthquake travels along the fault, concentrating in sites nearby; even the smallest additional stresses may then trigger another quake along the fault or on a nearby fault. Although scientists have long viewed such subtle interactions as nonexistent, the hypothesis has explained the location and frequency of earthquakes following several destructive quakes in California, Japan, and Turkey. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, which of the following is an assumption that may be invalidated by recent seismological evidence?

- A. Earthquakes are caused by stresses building up in faults within Earth's crust.
- B. Most major earthquakes can be predicted with reasonable accuracy.
- C. Faults are highly responsive to even minor stresses in neighboring faults.
- D. Most major earthquakes are followed by predictable aftershocks.
- E. A fault that has resulted in a major earthquake becomes quiet for a long period.

For the following question, consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The passage suggests that most seismologists believe which of the following about fault stresses?

- A. They are dissipated when they result in an earthquake.
- B. They are transferred between neighboring faults.
- C. They will not cause a major earthquake along the same fault in the space of a few years.

Passage 128

MacArthur and Wilson suggested that the biodiversity of an island will vary in direct proportion to a function of the island's size (i.e., larger islands can support a greater number of species) and in inverse proportion to a function of its distance from the mainland (i.e., many remote islands will tend to support fewer species). Reduced biodiversity in an island context is likely to require significant adaptation on the part of colonizing human populations. Evans argues that this limitation makes islands ideal laboratories for the study of human adaptations to the natural environment, whilst Renfrew and Wagstaff, in the introduction to their study of Melos, focus on this limitation in biodiversity as a "significant characteristic of the island ecosystem." For human communities, however, this limitation may potentially be offset by other factors. The reduced biodiversity of an island ecosystem applies only to terrestrial resources: the resources of the sea will be as rich as on any other coastal area, and may be equally important to human communities. A small island such as Malta or Melos allows all communities direct access to the sea, providing an important nutritional "safety net," as well as an element of dietary diversity, which may actually give island communities an advantage over their landlocked counterparts. Islands may also have specific nonbiological resources (such as obsidian on Melos), which may be used in exchange with communities on other islands and adjacent mainlands. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to

- A. evaluate two contrasting approaches to island biodiversity.
- B. discuss the relevance of certain data pertaining to island biodiversity.
- C. call into question a particular understanding of island biodiversity.
- D. consider various reasons for reduced biodiversity on islands.
- E. contrast large and small islands in terms of overall biodiversity.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. According to the author, factors of potential importance to human communities on islands include

- A. the accessibility of the sea's resources.
- B. a diet superior in some respects to the diet of landlocked communities.
- C. nonbiological resources that can be exploited.

3. The author suggests that in considering the biodiversity of islands, Evans

- A. focuses too exclusively on terrestrial resources.
- B. misunderstands the relationship between an island's size and its terrestrial resources.
- C. misinterprets the work of MacArthur and Wilson.
- D. is wrong to assume that more remote islands support fewer species.
- E. downplays the ways that human communities adapt to island biodiversity.

Passage 129

A critical consensus has emerged that Mary McCarthy will be remembered primarily as an essayist rather than as a novelist. But despite her formidable gifts as a polemical and **discursive** writer, and for all her reputation as an intellectual who sacrificed feeling to intelligence, what powers McCarthy's best essays are her fictional rather than strictly intellectual gifts. She makes her points by telling stories or by way of vivid description, arresting images and subtle characterization. And for all her exacting sense of fact, McCarthy's greatest contribution was to blur the distinctions between different kinds of prose writing: to show how fiction could be opened up to the thinking mind and how essays could profit from the techniques of fiction. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

For the following question, consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The author of the passage suggests that Mary McCarthy's writing is characterized by
- A. the use in her essays of devices more typical in works of fiction.
 - B. a narrowing of the differences between narrative and expository prose.
 - C. careful attention to factual accuracy.

2. In the context in which it appears, "discursive" most nearly means

- A. prolific
- B. sophistic
- C. rambling
- D. analytical
- E. circuitous

Passage 130

Some archaeologists speculate that the Americas might have been initially colonized between 40,000 and 25,000 years ago. However, to support this theory it is necessary to explain the absence of generally accepted habitation sites for that time interval in what is now the United States. Australia, which has a smaller land area than the United States, has many such sites, supporting the generally accepted claim that the continent was colonized by humans at least 40,000 years ago. Australia is less densely populated (resulting in lower chances of discovering sites) and with its overall greater aridity would have presented conditions less favorable for hunter-gatherer occupation. Proportionally, at least as much land area has been lost from the coastal regions of Australia because of postglacial sea-level rise as in the United States, so any coastal archaeological record in Australia should have been depleted about as much as a coastal record in the United States. Since there are so many resource-rich rivers leading inland from the United States coastlines, it seems implausible that a growing population of humans would have confined itself to coasts for thousands of years. If inhabitants were present 25,000 years ago, the chances of their appearing in the archaeological record would seem to be greater than for Australia. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is primarily concerned with doing which of the following?
 - A. presenting an objection to a claim
 - B. accounting for an apparent anomaly
 - C. outlining an alternative interpretation
 - D. correcting a particular misconception
 - E. questioning the validity of a comparison
2. The author of the passage implies which of the following about 25,000 years ago?
 - A. The coastline of the region that is now the United States is longer than it was 40,000 years ago.
 - B. Rivers in what is now the United States were numerous than they are now.
 - C. Australia was less densely populated at that time than was the region that is now the United States.
 - D. Australia's climate was significantly drier than it is now.
 - E. Global sea level was lower than it is now.
3. The author of the passage implies that, in what is now the United States, archaeological evidence of inhabitation in the period from 40,000 to 25,000 years ago is lacking because that region
 - A. had its oldest habitation sites inundated following a postglacial rise in sea level.
 - B. has many resource-rich rivers that facilitated the dispersal of early inhabitants from an initial concentration in coastal areas.
 - C. was sparsely populated until about 25,000 years ago.
 - D. was colonized less than 25,000 years ago.
 - E. was inhabited only by hunter-gatherers until 25,000 years ago.

Passage 131

Animals live longer when their calorie intake is restricted to two-thirds of what is considered normal for their species. Animals so restricted are also generally healthier: most disease, including cancer, diabetes, and neurodegenerative illness, are forestalled. **This phenomenon was long attributed to a simple slowing of metabolism** (cells' production of energy from fuel molecules) and consequent reproduction of its toxic by-products in response to less food. In fact, however, calorie restriction does not slow mammalian metabolism, and **in yeast and worms, metabolism is both sped up and altered**. Some scientists now theorize that calorie restriction is a biological stressor that, like natural food scarcity, induces a more complex defensive response, which in mammals includes changes in cellular defenses and repair. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. In the passage, the function of the highlighted portion (in yeast... and altered) is to
- A. provide specific examples of organisms whose longevity does not increase in response to calorie restriction.
 - B. illustrate the probable means by which organisms placed on a calorie-restriction diet compensate for the reduction in available food-based level.
 - C. suggest the mechanism that is responsible for prolonging the life of organism whose calorie intake is significantly reduced.
 - D. give an example that explain why scientists' thinking about the physiological effects of calorie restriction changed.
 - E. distinguish the different ways that mammalian and non-mammalian metabolisms respond to significant reductions in calorie intake.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The passage implies which of the following about the explanation mentioned in the highlighted text (This phenomenon... of metabolism)?
- A. There are empirical findings that conflict with a presumption of the explanation.
 - B. The explanation predicts that the effect of calorie restriction on longevity will be the greatest for the species with the highest rate of metabolism.
 - C. The explanation predicts that the effects of calorie restriction will be uniformly positive.

Passage 132

The “deindustrialization” thesis of Bluestone and Harrison asserts that the replacement of domestic with foreign manufacturing begun by United States corporations in the late 1960s resulted in a “hollowing out” of American industry, whereby workers displaced from manufacturing jobs through massive plant closings found themselves moving more or less permanently into lower-paying, less secure jobs or into unemployment. Critics of the deindustrialization thesis have argued that new service and high-technology sectors of the United States economy have recently created a substantial number of jobs. While these critics do not deny the painful aspects of this transition from an industrial to a service- and information-based economy, they argue that it will be short-term, and a necessary evil if the United States is to have long-term increases in living standards. **Critics** of the emerging economy, however, point to disturbing evidence of an “**hourglass**” effect: a shrinking middle tier of managerial and blue-collar unionized workers and consequent polarization of incomes. The emergence of a technical and financial elite, they argue, has brought forth a host of low-wage jobs to service the new economy, and it is this service sector that many ex-industrial workers must seek. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The purpose of the passage is to

- A. analyze the events that contributed to an economic phenomenon.
- B. present different views on the nature and impact of an economic phenomenon.
- C. distinguish between the short-term and long-term effects of an economic phenomenon.
- D. challenge a dominant theory about how to solve the problems created by an economic phenomenon.
- E. present new evidence to suggest that an economic phenomenon is more complex than had previously been believed.

2. Which of the following, if true, would most tend to weaken the deindustrialization thesis of Bluestone and Harrison?

- A. A survey of the spouses of former industrial workers reveals a significant increase in the number of working spouses since the mid-1960s.
- B. Data from the most recent United States census show that fewer individuals list their occupation as industrial worker than in the census from ten years earlier.
- C. A random survey of United States consumers indicates that a majority of those surveyed would prefer to buy United States-manufacturing goods if given the opportunity.
- D. A recent study indicates that large numbers of former industrial workers have retrained and found employment as skilled, highly-paid computer workers.
- E. Interviews with representatives at major agencies for temporary employment in the United States suggest that they value the skills of former industrial workers.

3. It can be inferred from the passage that the highlighted “critics” believe which of the following about “hourglass” effect?

- A. It involves the relegation of industrial workers to less desirable jobs.
- B. It requires that workers make short-term sacrifices to achieve long-term gains.
- C. It affects non-unionized workers more strongly than it does unionized workers.
- D. It represents an increase in unemployment for those in the service sector.
- E. It threatens the status of the technological and financial elite.

Passage 133

Some historians question the widely held belief that continually improving education led to gradual African American empowerment in the southern United States from the late nineteenth century through the mid-twentieth century. They note that the development of Black educational institutions in the segregated South was never rapid or steady: disparities between Black and White schools sometimes grew in the early decades of the twentieth century. And African Americans' educational gains did not bring commensurate economic gains. Starting in the 1940s, even as Black and White schools in the South moved steadily toward equality, Black southerners remained politically marginalized and experienced systematic job discrimination. Although Black schools had achieved near parity with White schools in per capita spending and teachers' salaries by 1965, African Americans' income still lagged behind that of Whites. **Nonetheless, educational progress did contribute toward economic and political empowerment.** African Americans' campaigns to support Black schools fostered a sense of community, nurtured political determination, and often increased literacy. More significantly, politically outspoken Black newspapers achieved record circulation during the 1940s, just as the literacy rate among African Americans approached 90 percent. Finally, the leadership of the Civil Rights movement of the 1960s was composed largely of graduates of Black colleges. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage refers to the fact that “disparities between Black and White schools sometimes grew in the early decades of the twentieth century” most likely in order to
 - A. support the argument that the economic struggles of southern Blacks were largely due to educational inequalities.
 - B. give an example of the differences between Black schools in the early part of the twentieth century and Black schools starting in the 1940s.
 - C. illustrate the unevenness of the progress made by Black schools in the southern United States.
 - D. help explain why Black remained politically marginalized and experienced systematic job discrimination in the segregated South.
 - E. provide evidence that educational progress was a precondition for economic progress in the segregated South.
2. Which of the following best describes the purpose of the highlighted sentence?
 - A. It clarifies a point introduced in the preceding sentence.
 - B. It reiterates a point introduced in the first sentence of the passage.
 - C. It questions the accuracy of some of the evidence used to support the argument of the historians.
 - D. It introduces a perspective that runs contrary to the view of those who endorse the “belief.”
 - E. It qualifies the interpretation made by the historians.
3. The passage suggests which of the following about the Civil Rights movement?
 - A. It gave rise to a rapid increase in the number of Black newspapers published in the South.
 - B. Its political effectiveness was greatly enhanced by the increased circulation of Black newspapers.
 - C. Its leadership benefited from improvements in education for African Americans.
 - D. It was the force primarily responsible for increasing per capita spending in Black schools.
 - E. It was responsible for changing many historians' view of the relation between education and African American empowerment.

Passage 134

An influential early view held that ecosystems contain niches for a limited number of species and that competition for resources among species—whether native or nonnative invading ones—determines ecosystems' species composition. However, factors other than competition often help explain invading species' success. For example, the American grey squirrel, often cited as a classic example of competitively superior invading species, was introduced in England in 1876 and now thrives, while the native red squirrel population has declined. Although scientists have found gray squirrels to be more efficient foragers than red ones, they also note that even before the gray squirrel's arrival, Britain's red squirrel populations had a periodic tendency to die out, only to be subsequently reintroduced. Furthermore, many gray squirrels are silent carriers of a disease fatal to red squirrels. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred that the author of the passage mentions the efficiency with which gray squirrels forage primarily in order to
 - A. identify a factor that explains a certain phenomenon.
 - B. call attention to an inconsistency in a particular theory.
 - C. suggest that competition cannot be the factor responsible for a particular outcome.
 - D. acknowledge a fact that appears to support a view that the author intends to qualify.
 - E. cite evidence that is not consistent with an early influential view about species competition.
2. It can be inferred that the author of the passage would be most likely to agree with which of the following statements about the “early view?”
 - A. It reflects a mistaken assumption about the means by which nonnative species are introduced into ecosystems.
 - B. Its basic premise is shown to be valid by the effect of American gray squirrels on Britain's red squirrel population.
 - C. It presents a simplistic picture of the means by which species composition within ecosystems is determined.
 - D. It can effectively explain the formation of ecosystems that contain few species but cannot adequately account for the formation of complex ecosystems.
 - E. It understates the importance of competition as a factor determining species composition within ecosystems.

Passage 135

The revival of mural painting that has occurred in San Francisco since the 1970s, especially among the Chicano population of the city's Mission District, has marked differences from its social realist forerunner in Mexico and the United States some 40 years earlier. Rather than being government sponsored and limited to murals on government buildings, the contemporary mural movement sprang from the people themselves, with murals appearing on community buildings and throughout college campuses. Perhaps the biggest difference, however, is the process. In earlier twentieth-century Mexico, murals resulted from the vision of individual artists. But today's murals are characteristically the products of artists working with local residents on design and creation.

Such community engagement is characteristic of the Chicano art movement as a whole, which evolved from the same foundations as the Chicano civil rights movement of the mid-1960s. Both were a direct response to the needs of Chicanos in the United States, who were fighting for the right to adequate education, political empowerment, and decent working conditions. Artists joined other cultural workers in making political statements and played a key role in taking these statements to the public. They developed collectives and established cultural centers that functioned as the public-relations arm of the Chicano sociopolitical movement.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. argue for the superiority of a style of art.
 - B. consider the impact of an art movement.
 - C. describe the political content of a certain works of art.
 - D. detail the characteristic style of an art movement.
 - E. place an art movement in its historical context.
2. According to the passage, which of the following statements about the "cultural centers" is true?
 - A. They were the venue where many later leaders of the Chicano civil rights movement first became politically active.
 - B. Though later widespread, they originated in San Francisco area.
 - C. Springing up in a number of communities, they initially had largely apolitical goals centered on art instruction.
 - D. They constituted the nucleus from which the Chicano civil rights movement originated.
 - E. Founded by artists, they provided support for the Chicano civil rights movement.
3. Which of the following best describes the relationship between the first paragraph and the second paragraph of the passage?
 - A. The first focuses on the mural artists as individuals; the second, on their actions as a group.
 - B. The first compares the mural revival with an earlier artistic movement; the second describes the context contemporary to the revival.
 - C. The first defines the revival by distinguishing it from an earlier artistic movement; the second addresses the political goals of both the revival and its forerunner.
 - D. The first presents an apparently plausible account of the relationship between the revival and its forerunner, the second calls that account into question.
 - E. The first is concerned with the artistic aims and ambitions behind the San Francisco murals; the second considers their political significance.

Passage 136

Although Elizabeth Stuart Phelps' novel *Doctor Zay* (1882) dominates critical discussion of Phelps' interest in woman doctors, preceding it were many little-known writings by Phelps. These writings underscored the achievements of already established women doctors, the imperative of medically educating and training women in the face of pernicious resistance, and the medical woman's symbolic value as an agent of healing in post-Civil War America. An exploration of this largely overlooked early prose demonstrates that Phelps played an instrumental role in legitimizing the American medical woman during a crucial earlier period when the number of women doctors in the United States increased substantially, but the woman doctor remained perhaps the most controversial new presence on the nation's occupational landscape. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. It can be inferred that the author of the passage would be likely to agree with which of the following statements about Phelps' writing?

- A. While Phelps' earlier works did a great deal toward legitimizing the figure of the American woman doctor, her novel *Doctor Zay* did not.
- B. Critics have tended to underestimate the impact Phelps' earlier work had in helping to legitimize the figure of the American woman doctor during an important period.
- C. The substantial increase in the number of woman doctors in post-Civil War America was a more significant factor than was Phelps' writing in helping to legitimize woman doctors in post-Civil War America.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The passage provides information on which of the following?

- A. the public response to the emergence of women doctors during Phelps' lifetime
- B. how Phelps' earlier works advanced the cause of American women doctors
- C. the relative fame of *Doctor Zay* in comparison with Phelps' other writings

Passage 137

A bird's plumage, while contributing to structural integrity and participating in aerial locomotion, completely obscures a bird's internal activity from human view, greatly impeding our attempts to understand birds as functioning animals. Plumage has even made it difficult to describe bird movement. When describing the movement of mammals, writers turn to well-worn clichés like "grace in motion." A mammal's rippling muscles slide smoothly over one another in eye-catching ways. With a mammal, whether a mouse or hippopotamus, we recognize that the underlying body parts are similar to our own and we know these parts will act predictably. Not so with a bird. For centuries, we knew little more about a bird's movement than that it was a mystery that seemed to be based on the flapping of wings. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The passage mentions which of the following as an effect of bird plumage?

- A. It contributes to a bird's ability to fly.
- B. It hides the inner workings of birds.
- C. It contributes to the structural soundness of birds.

2. The author implies which of the following about the "underlying body parts" of nonhuman mammals?

- A. They are more similar to humans' underlying body parts than most people assume.
- B. They are more predictable in their workings than are the underlying body parts of humans.
- C. Their smooth and graceful actions belie how complicated they actually are.
- D. They work in much different ways than do the underlying body parts of most birds.
- E. They are easier to observe and understand than are underlying parts of birds.

Passage 138

In the 1920s, Gerstmann described a set of problems found in people who have suffered damage to the brain's left parietal lobe, problems that include being unable to understand arithmetic and having difficulty identifying one's fingers. There is still no agreement on whether the symptoms Gerstmann noticed constitute a syndrome, but **the parts of the brain used for storing facts about numbers and for representing the fingers are close to each other.** Mental representations of numbers and of fingers may therefore be functionally connected. A 2005 experiment had people perform some tasks requiring dexterity and others involving matching pairs of numbers, while an area of their parietal lobes—the left angular gyrus—was stimulated by a magnetic field. Facility at both sets of tasks was impaired. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage would most likely agree that the highlighted statement suggests
 - A. a flaw in the experiment conducted in 2005
 - B. a means by which dexterity might compensate for a loss of arithmetic ability
 - C. an explanation for some of Gerstmann's observations
 - D. an anomaly in some of Gerstmann's results
 - E. a reason to doubt damage to the left parietal lobe as a causal factor in certain symptoms
2. The author of the passage describes the "2005 experiment" and its results primarily in order to
 - A. establish the proximity between the part of the brain used for storing numerical information and the part used for representing the fingers.
 - B. illustrate the implications that Gerstmann's work may have for experimental research.
 - C. cast doubt on the idea that damage to the left parietal lobe causes the set of problems that Gerstmann described.
 - D. support a hypothesis about a significant association between parts of the brain related to fingers and to numbers.
 - E. suggest that the problems Gerstmann noted in relation to numbers and fingers have a different cause than the other problems associated with parietal lobe damage.

Passage 139

Analyzing levels of proportional representation of American Indians in state and local government jobs is important for several reasons. First, the basic idea underlying the theory of representative bureaucracy is that the demographic composition of bureaucracy should mirror the demographic composition of the general public. This is because in addition to its symbolic value, increased access to managerial position may lead to greater responsiveness on the part of policy makers to the policy interests of traditionally disadvantaged groups such as American Indians. Second, the focus on higher level jobs in bureaucracies (as opposed to non-managerial positions) is especially important because managerial positions represent a major source of economic progress for members of traditionally disadvantaged groups, as these jobs confer good salaries, benefits, status, security, and mobility. Third, it is important to know if there has been growth in the American Indian share of more desirable public sector positions over the last two decades. For instance, Peterson and Duncan argue that the population and power of American Indians have been growing in certain states. **Peterson and Duncan also suggest that this growth may reflect the possibility that American Indian population are becoming more active in nontraditional areas of politics, assimilating into mainstream culture, and securing with greater frequency leadership positions in non-tribal government.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. summarize a demographic trend over time.
 - B. present findings on a demographic group.
 - C. analyze the demographic composition of a type of job.
 - D. explain the need for particular social research.
 - E. argue for the implementation of a social policy.
2. Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted sentence in the context of the passage as whole?
 - A. It hypothesizes a phenomenon that might explain a point made in the preceding sentence.
 - B. It provides evidence that undermines that assertion made in the first sentence.
 - C. It offers a projection regarding the development of a trend mentioned earlier in the passage.
 - D. It presents an interpretation of a discrepancy noted earlier in the passage.
 - E. It proposed an implementation of a policy mentioned in the preceding sentence.
3. The passage suggests which of the following regarding “access to managerial positions” for disadvantaged groups?
 - A. This access is only significant when the percentage of disadvantaged group members in managerial positions mirrors the percent of that group in the general public.
 - B. This access is largely the result of policy decisions made response to interest of those groups.
 - C. This access has meaning apart from any policy benefits it confer on those groups.
 - D. This access often creates increased access to non-managerial position for those groups.
 - E. The extent of this access tends to be similar across different disadvantaged groups.

Passage 140

Some attine ants carry vegetation into their nests and add fungal material, thereby creating “gardens” in which fungal food for the ants grow. Because the ants play the behaviorally active role, it seems compelling to say that they cultivate and control the passive fungi. But even if that is true, the symbiotic association has existed for so long that cultivar traits may have evolved in the fungi that benefit the fungi but not necessarily the ants. Furthermore, many microorganisms have developed sophisticated mechanisms to **manipulate** the physiology and behavior of their symbiotic animals. It is not implausible, therefore, that the ants’ fungi have evolved chemical and physiological schemes that alter ant behavior to serve the fungus’ reproductive interests, possibly even compromising the reproductive interests for the ant hosts. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage points out which of the following in order to explain the appeal of the notion that some attine ants cultivate and control fungus?

- A. The ants play the behaviorally active roles in the symbiotic relationship.
- B. The ants purposefully carry vegetation into their nests for their own consumption.
- C. Fungus is physiologically a passive substance.
- D. Other organisms are able to manipulate their symbiotic partners.
- E. The chemical and physiological properties of the fungus are subject to ant influence.

2. In the context in which it appears, the word “manipulate” most nearly means

- A. influence
- B. oversee
- C. coerce
- D. deceive
- E. outmaneuver

Passage 141

As of late 1980s, neither theorists nor large-scale computer climate models could accurately predict whether cloud systems would help or hurt a warming globe. Some studies suggested that a four percent increase in stratocumulus clouds over the ocean could compensate for a doubling in atmospheric carbon dioxide, preventing a potentially disastrous planet-wide temperature increase. On the other hand, an increase in cirrus clouds could increase global warming.

That clouds represented the weakest element in climate models was illustrated by a study of fourteen such models. Comparing climate forecasts for a world with double the current amount of carbon dioxide, researchers found that the models agreed quite well if clouds were not included. But when clouds were incorporated, a wide range of forecasts was produced. With such discrepancies plaguing the models, scientists could not easily predict how quickly the world's climate would change, nor could they tell which regions would face dustier droughts or deadlier monsoons. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage is primarily concerned with
 - A. confirming a theory.
 - B. supporting a statement.
 - C. presenting new information.
 - D. predicting future discoveries.
 - E. comparing points of view.
2. It can be inferred that one reason the fourteen models described in the passage failed to agree was that
 - A. they failed to incorporate the most up-to-date information about the effect of clouds on climate.
 - B. they were based on faulty information about factors other than clouds that affect climate.
 - C. they were based on different assumptions about the overall effects of clouds on climate.
 - D. their originators disagreed about the kinds of forecasts the models should provide.
 - E. their originators disagreed about the factors other than clouds that should be included in the models.
3. The information in the passage suggests that scientists would have to answer which of the following questions in order to predict the effect of clouds on the warming of the globe?
 - A. What kinds of cloud systems will form over the Earth?
 - B. How can cloud systems be encouraged to form over the ocean?
 - C. What are the causes of the projected planetwide temperature increase?
 - D. What proportion of cloud systems are currently composed of cirrus clouds?
 - E. What proportion of the clouds in the atmosphere form over land masses?

Passage 142

Many theorists now doubt that heat loss from Earth's core and radioactive decay are sufficient by themselves to produce all the energy driving the tectonic plates whose movements have helped shaped Earth's surface. This leaves a loose end in current geological theory. Herbert Shaw argues that because scientists have underestimated the input of substantial amounts of energy from extraterrestrial impactors (asteroids and comets striking Earth), they have difficulty accounting for the difference between the quantity of energy produced from sources intrinsic to Earth and that involved in plate tectonics. Whereas most geologists have treated the addition of energy through the bombardment of Earth's surface by such impactors as a process separate and independent from the movement of Earth's tectonic plates, Shaw asserts that these processes are indivisible. Shaw's revolutionary "open-system" view recognizes a **continuum** between terrestrial and extraterrestrial dynamics, whereas modern plate tectonic theory, like the classical geology developed during the nineteenth century, is founded on the view that Earth's geological features have changed through gradual, regular processes intrinsic to Earth, without reference to unique catastrophic events. Classical geology borrowed a decisive, if unspoken, premise from Newton—the independence of Earth's processes from any astronomical context. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author's primary purpose is to

- A. identify the influences informing a particular geological theory about the processes that have shaped Earth's surface.
- B. identify differences between two views of the extraterrestrial impactors and argue that the phenomenon has influenced the development of plate tectonic theory.
- C. argue that an explanation is based on a dubious evidence and propose an alternative explanation.
- D. discuss an explanation and place that explanation under theoretical context.
- E. suggest that apparent discrepancy poses a serious problem for a particular theory that many have believed.

2. The author of the passage mentions the "continuum" in order to

- A. point out a relationship between plate tectonics and the nineteenth-century geology.
- B. explain how a theory of Newton's could influence geology and plate tectonic theory.
- C. distinguish between two sources of energy that contributed to the development of Earth's surface.
- D. point out a similarity between the surface of impactors and the surface of Earth.
- E. identify a feature of Shaw's view that deviates from current scientific theories.

3. The passage suggests which of the following about tectonic theory?

- A. It has led scientists to overlook an important contribution to classical geologists from Newton.
- B. It has been more successful than was classical geology in accounting for heat loss from Earth's core.
- C. It is based on premise about Earth's processes discerned in Newton's thought.
- D. It has correctly explained the effects of extraterrestrial impactors on Earth's surface.
- E. It corrects a fundamental flaw in classical geology.

Passage 143

Human impacts on the natural environment during the later part of the Holocene (beginning about 4,000 years ago) complicate investigations into environmental change during that period because the signals produced by human-and climate-induced change are sometimes difficult to separate. For example, in the later Holocene, one indicator of increased aridity due to climate change is an increase in pollen from grasses, as forest vegetation gives way to grassland. Such a change in vegetation could alternatively be attributed to human impact in the form of agricultural development. **Examples of such human impact from 4,000 years ago would be small-scale, however, since the broad ecosystem changes brought about by the widespread adoption of agricultural technologies occurred later.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted sentence in the context of the passage as a whole?
 - A. It provides an example of the kind of problems that often complicate investigations into environmental change.
 - B. It call into question the reliability of the established dates for later Holocene agricultural development.
 - C. It describes the nature of localized agricultural developments during the later Holocene.
 - D. It outlines a hypothesis that draws on evidence discussed earlier in the passage.
 - E. It limits the scope of a particular complication mentioned earlier in the passage.
2. According to the passage, which of the following is true regarding environmental changes 4,000 years ago?
 - A. No localized increases in grass pollen were caused by agricultural development.
 - B. Increases in grass pollen were at least sometimes a reflection of an increase in aridity.
 - C. Wholesale ecosystem changes probably resulted from agricultural development.
 - D. Any small-scale changes occurring then would not be detectable now.
 - E. Environmental change helped induce the adoption of agricultural technologies.

Passage 144

Meggers argued that agriculture depends on extracting nutrients from soils into edible crops, so premodern societies in Amazonia could never grow large because underlying soils are impoverished. **In Meggers' view the population size that a culture could reach depended upon the agricultural potential of its environment.** Meggers accepted that fish and turtle resources of the Amazon made possible the long riverside villages the explorer Orellana described in 1542, but she dismissed as exaggerated Carvajal's estimates of tens of thousands of people in those settlements, and she was sure those settlements did not have inland counterparts. Supporting this point, the Omagua, a riverbank people and one of the greatest chiefdoms observed by Carvajal as a member of Orellana's expedition, regarded hinterland forests as unpopulated wilderness. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. In the context of the passage the highlighted sentence serves to
 - A. explain the broader rationale for a conclusion described in the preceding sentence.
 - B. suggest some of the drawbacks of the riverbank location of the villages described in the following sentence.
 - C. acknowledge information that appears to undermine a description attributed to Orellana.
 - D. introduce a principle that appears to be contradicted by the agricultural development of premodern Amazonia.
 - E. give a reason for an upward revision in earlier estimates for premodern Amazonia.
2. From the passage it can be inferred that Omagua depended on
 - A. overland transport to communicate between villages.
 - B. foraging inland to obtain foodstuffs not available locally.
 - C. some form of fertilization to boost agricultural production.
 - D. fish and turtles for at least part of their diet.
 - E. trade with other peoples for some raw materials.

Passage 145

When selecting a nest, the female of the river blenny (a small fish) appears to be sensitive to both size and orientation. Blennies deposit their eggs preferably in nests under large stones and in nests facing southeast. Southeast-facing nests contain larger egg clutches, a fact that cannot be completely explained by differences in nest stone sizes. Moreover, in a recent study, **current speeds** upstream of the nest and at the nest entrance were similar for nests facing southeast and those facing in other directions. A southeast-facing entrance per se thus seems to be the specific nest feature preferred by females, rather than the effect of selective positioning on current at nest entrance. The reasons for this preference are unclear, however.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is concerned with which of the following?

- A. determining the different ways in which current speeds can influence the nesting preferences of female river blennies
- B. establishing nest orientation as a determining factor in egg laying among female river blennies
- C. questioning the importance of nest size as an influence on egg laying among female river blennies
- D. comparing the features of female river blennies that face southeast with those of nests facing in other directions
- E. examining how female river blennies determine the relative importance of nest size versus nest orientation

2. The author of the passage considers "current speeds" in order to

- A. identify a factor that undermines the significance of nest stone size for female river blennies.
- B. indicate one possible advantage of river blenny nests that do not face southeast.
- C. eliminate a possible explanation for a nest orientation tendency among female river blennies.
- D. indicate why female river blennies are sensitive to both size and orientation of possible nests.
- E. suggest a reason why many female blennies prefer southeast-facing nests.

Passage 146

The editors of the essay collection *Romantic biography* tell us repeatedly that biography is an invention of the Romantic period in British literature (late eighteenth and early nineteenth centuries), yet we are never shown that process of invention motion. Hazlitt, the most prominent example of the Romantic biographer, is almost invisible. The Romantic period was not just the period in which biography was invented—or, rather, the period in which some of its informing principles were invented, since biography could just as easily be said to have originated in the **scandalous memoirs** that formed part of the pre-Romantic culture of the novel. It was also the period in which biography, through its sheer ubiquity, became an object of major ideological significance within British culture. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage mentions the “scandalous memoirs” that were written prior to the Romantic period primarily in order to
 - A. indicate an alternative account of the origins of biography.
 - B. compare these memoirs to Romantic biography.
 - C. explain how biography became ubiquitous in British culture.
 - D. question the ideological significance accorded to biography.
 - E. suggest that biographies were not as popular as memoirs.
2. According to the passage, biography attained great significance within British culture during the Romantic period because biographies
 - A. were associated with scandal.
 - B. were easy to read and comprehend.
 - C. were so widespread in Britain at the time.
 - D. challenged conventional British ideologies.
 - E. contributed to the development of the novel.

Passage 147

Our study revealed that nest-guarding long-tailed skinks (a species of lizard) homed (returned to their nests) more successfully when displaced shorter distances. There are two reasons why homing success rates decreased with increasing displacement distance. One possibility is that females were simply displaced too far to find their way home. **However, this is unlikely given that some individuals managed to find their way home from each distance we used.** The second possibility deals with trade-offs between the risks associated with making a long return trip and the benefits of returning. Animals should expend energy only when the associated costs are low. As reptiles increase the time spent moving, their daily energy expenditure increases dramatically. The energetic costs of returning home and the chances that the eggs will have been preyed upon during the return trip both increase substantially as displacement distance increases. For example, the 130 hours (5.5 days) that female skinks spent returning from a distance of 300 meters is sufficient for an egg-eating snake to locate and prey upon the entire clutch. However, females with larger clutches were more likely to home at distances over 50 meters. For these females, the relative fitness benefits associated with having more eggs successfully hatch may outweigh the energetic costs of returning to a nest site, even if the nest may have already been preyed upon. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. question the validity of research on nest-guarding behavior in long-tailed skinks.
 - B. consider explanations for a finding regarding long-tailed skinks.
 - C. discuss the importance of homing for long-tailed skinks.
 - D. describe the relationship between clutch size and homing success in long-tailed skinks.
 - E. identify the benefits of a behavior common among long-tailed skinks.
2. The claim in the highlighted sentence assumes which of the following about the individuals that managed to find their way home from each distance?
 - A. They were less able to detect egg-eating predators than were the other long-tailed skinks studied.
 - B. They were more averse to risk than were the other long-tailed skinks studied.
 - C. They expended less energy when homing than did the other long-tailed skinks studied.
 - D. They did not possess better homing skills than did the other long-tailed skinks studied.
 - E. They had significantly smaller clutches than did the other long-tailed skinks studied.
3. The “second possibility” implies which of the following as a possible explanation for the female long-tailed skinks that failed to home from distances over 50 meters ?
 - A. They had relatively small clutches.
 - B. They were unable to find their way home.
 - C. They lacked sufficient energy to home successfully.
 - D. They had male long-tailed skinks guarding their clutches.
 - E. They detected evidence of egg-eating snakes in the vicinity of their nests.

Passage 148

In her book *Fisher Row*, Mary Prior examined a long swath of time covering the wax and wane of the occupational community of bargemen who lived canalside in Oxford, England. In Prior's view, longtime spans are important because otherwise historians generalize too readily. Pamela Sharpe consciously followed Prior's lead in her study of over 400 years of early modern English lace making. Early modern lace making has often been considered separately from the mechanized lace trade of the nineteenth century, but as Sharpe shows, a longer vision points to more continuity than change. The sort of time frame advocated by Prior makes the circumstances of the survival of handworked lace into the second half of the nineteenth century easier to comprehend. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is primarily concerned with

- A. highlighting similarities in the conclusions reached by two historians.
- B. calling attention to the unique issues associated with studying occupational communities.
- C. criticizing the overly simplified findings of historians regarding a series of events.
- D. pointing to the advantages of a particular historical approach.
- E. revealing new evidence regarding a misunderstood era.

2. Select the sentence that mentions an instance of an approach that is at odds with the one taken by Prior and Sharpe.

Passage 149

Researchers suspect that meteorites (particles of matter that fall to Earth's surface from space) are pieces of asteroids, the many minor planets primarily inhabiting the region between Mars and Jupiter called the asteroid belt. The most common meteorites are ordinary chondrites—rocks containing tiny flecks of metal. By analyzing the spectrums of sunlight reflected by asteroids to determine the asteroids' chemical composition, researchers have found that most of the brighter asteroids contain the same silicates and other compounds that dominate chondrites. These siliceous, or S-type, asteroids are the most abundant type in the inner asteroid belt, the part of the asteroid belt from which objects are most likely to escape and travel to Earth. However, S-type asteroids reflect red and infrared light much better than they reflect green, blue, and violet light, suggesting that they have a higher metal content than do ordinary chondrites. This has led at least one researcher to posit that meteorites come from other types of asteroids that are too small and too dim to be detected. However, S-type asteroids could be ordinary chondrites that have been weathered by the effects of the space environment, making them seem redder and more metallic than they really are. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. discuss the defining characteristics of chondrites.
 - B. compare the spectrums of light reflected by chondrites and S-type asteroids.
 - C. chronicle changes in the accepted interpretation of data concerning the chemical composition of asteroids.
 - D. weigh evidence for and against a particular hypothesis on the origin of meteorites.
 - E. question a current theory on the chemical composition of the most common type of meteorite.
2. The author of the passage most likely mentions that the inner asteroid belt is “the part of the asteroid belt from which objects are most likely to escape and travel to Earth” in order to
 - A. distinguish between two important sources of meteorites that travel to Earth.
 - B. suggest that S-type asteroids are likely to be a source of meteorites.
 - C. call into question an assumption about the compounds that dominate chondrites.
 - D. explain why S-type asteroids do not reflect green, blue, and violet light as well as they reflect red and infrared light.
 - E. provide evidence to support an assertion about the abundance of S-type asteroids.
3. It can be inferred from the passage that one reason for considering S-type asteroids to be likely sources of meteorites is that S-type asteroids
 - A. are brighter than other types of asteroids.
 - B. are the most common type of asteroid throughout the asteroid belt.
 - C. reflect red and infrared light better than they reflect green, blue, and violet light.
 - D. contain the same silicates and other compounds that dominate chondrites.
 - E. are the only type of asteroid found in the inner asteroid belt.

Passage 150

French-born avant-garde composer Edger Varese (1883-1965) coined the phrase “organized sound” to distinguish his bold sonic experiment, which called for howling sirens and electronically taped ambient noises from conventional music. Many of his contemporaries would not have accepted his works as music at all. But Varese didn't regard himself as an iconoclast. He traced his heritage to music's ancient practices, and professed admiration for the music of the Gothic Middle Ages. This seems appropriate, for the medieval composers shared his view of music as a technical unfitting of sound. Unlike the nineteenth-century Romantics, they would have had no problem with a discussion of music in terms of acoustic frequencies and intensities, rather than in terms of particular emotions associated with them.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author would be most likely to agree with which of the following statements about Varese's approach to composition?

- A. It ultimately influenced many works produced by Varese's contemporaries.
- B. It made him an iconoclast.
- C. In some significant ways, it resonated with older models of music theory.
- D. When compared to that used by composers of earlier eras, it was less systematic.
- E. It used standard orchestral instruments in unusual ways.

2. The author alludes to the howling sirens featured in some of Varese's works to

- A. identify a critical influence on Varese's approach composition.
- B. challenge accepted notions concerning the use of nontraditional instrumentation.
- C. illustrate a similarity between Varese's work and that of medieval composers.
- D. emphasize the extent to which Varese's work was innovative and unusual.
- E. suggest that conventional music tends to employ a limited sound palette.

Passage 151

In 1825, emancipated slave Pierre Toussaint, who had become a successful New York hairdresser, commissioned miniature portraits of himself, his wife, Juliette, and his adopted niece. It was an unconventional choice. Judging by the extant evidence, those few antebellum African Americans who commissioned portraits chose bust-sized oil paintings, paintings that announced their status—their respectability, their prosperity, and their personhood—to the public at large. And, given the implicit publicity of these paintings, it is not surprising that so many represent men: African-descended ministers, activists, barbers, and men of affairs, men who were assuming positions of leadership within the North's free black communities. It is not clear why Toussaint, a public-minded man who was deeply involved in a variety of philanthropic efforts, diverged from this pattern by choosing to represent himself, much less his entire family, in a genre so closely associated with domestic intimacy. Perhaps he associated miniatures with the gentility and refinement of his wealthy clientele. Perhaps he was attracted to the genre's familiar associations. Toussaint was, after all, a man who prized family, who expended great effort to preserve family ties against overwhelming odds: after moving to New York, he had tried repeatedly and unsuccessfully to recover family members who had been lost during the Haitian Revolution. Or perhaps miniatures recalled a pivotal moment in his own life, for when Toussaint's former mistress was on her deathbed, she bequeathed him her miniature portrait along with his freedom papers. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. explain the importance of a historical figure.
 - B. evaluate the evidence used to support a claim.
 - C. consider the implications of a particular choice.
 - D. contrast the social meanings of two kinds of paintings.
 - E. establish the historical context for an artistic trend.
2. Which of the following is an assumption apparently underlying the author's discussion of Toussaint?
 - A. Toussaint's commissioning of miniature family portraits instead of bust-sized portraits was not significantly influenced by differences in the costs associated with the two genres.
 - B. Miniature portraits of family members were not often commissioned by the same patrons who commissioned larger, more ostentatious portraits in antebellum New York.
 - C. Successful antebellum African Americans in New York did not generally regard different genres of painting as reflective of different kinds of values.
 - D. The frequency with which African Americans commissioned family portraits increased significantly during Toussaint's lifetime.
 - E. Toussaint harbored highly conflicted feelings about the former mistress who bequeathed him her miniature portrait when she was on her deathbed.
3. It can be inferred that the "extant evidence"
 - A. gives the impression that a larger number of African Americans commissioned portraits during this period than was actually the case.
 - B. indicates African Americans' preference for family portraits over individual portraits during this period.
 - C. reflects the popularity of large oil paintings of African American families during this period.
 - D. includes few miniature portraits of influential African American men.
 - E. suggests that African Americans' portraits were generally painted by African American artists.

Passage 152

This passage is excerpted from an article discussing how craft production was incorporated into the work regimes of ancient Mesoamerican households.

Recent ethnographic research has demonstrated that households are highly dynamic and plastic social units that can change their composition and work regimes quickly. Robert Netting has shown that households are flexible, motivated, and innovative social units that can intensify production on their own initiative when economic conditions permit or require them to do so. While archaeologists recognize that households were important social institutions, they usually are not seen as a source of innovation or long-term social change (but see Lohse and Valdez 2004). Archaeologists often turn to **models of political economy** to explain economic innovation and change. Archaeology as a discipline has been slow to recognize the dynamic nature of household production for two reasons. The first is the long-recognized inability to study households in short-term temporal segments that can be correlated with meaningful episodes within the domestic life cycle. Without the ability to see the household in "short time" (Smith 1992), it is hard to evaluate how households respond to new conditions as flexible, adaptive units. The second is the absence of a dynamic theoretical model of domestic economy and household behavior that archaeologists can use to interpret material remains.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. account for a failure to recognize a characteristic.
 - B. correct a misconception about an era.
 - C. describe conflicting views of a discipline.
 - D. outline a pattern of behavior.
 - E. consider the implications of a model.
2. The passage implies which of the following about the "models of political economy"?
 - A. They are not as well-known to ethnographic researchers as they are to archaeologists.
 - B. They typically do not represent households as a source of economic innovation or long-term social change.
 - C. They are little used outside the discipline of archeology.
 - D. They have prevented most ethnographers from recognizing the dynamic nature of household production.
 - E. They are used by archeologists to evaluate how households respond to new conditions as flexible, adaptive units.
3. It can be inferred from the passage that Lohse and Valdez are archaeologists who
 - A. downplay the importance of households as social institution.
 - B. originated a dynamic theoretical model of domestic economy.
 - C. use models of political economy to explain economic innovation.
 - D. prefer to study households in long-term temporal segments.
 - E. recognize households as agents of lasting change.

Passage 153

There is little dispute that the early poem of William Wordsworth (1770-1850) called *An Evening Walk* (1793) draws heavily on eighteenth-century descriptive traditions. Wordsworth made explicit connections to Thomson Gray and other eighteenth-century poets in textual allusions. Wordsworth's relationship to his eighteenth-century precursors has dominated critical reaction to the poem, but in a specific, indeed, limited manner, focusing on Wordsworth's ability to break free of his influences. Because the mainstream of twentieth-century criticism represented Romanticism (the late-eighteenth to early-nineteenth-century movement of which Wordsworth became a defining figure) as a salutary revolt against the sedate norms of eighteenth-century culture, the fortunes of the poem have waxed or waned according to how solid a case could be made for placing it on the far side of the Romantic divide. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following is NOT supported by the passage?

- A. Critics agree that *An Evening Walk* shares many conventions of earlier eighteenth-century poems.
- B. Wordsworth's prominence as a poet is associated with the Romantic period.
- C. Criticism of *An Evening Walk* is intimately tied to its relationship to its eighteenth-century precursors.
- D. Traditional twentieth-century criticism views Romanticism as revolutionary in nature.
- E. *An Evening Walk* reflects Wordsworth's rejection of the descriptive tradition of eighteenth-century poetry.

2. The author of the passage implies that criticism of *An Evening Walk*

- A. is beginning to change as more critics question the degree to which the poem reflects Wordsworth's indebtedness to eighteenth-century descriptive traditions.
- B. has shifted over time in its focus but not in its evaluation of the quality of the poem.
- C. has suggested that the poem's allusions to eighteenth-century poets are somehow unprecedented.
- D. has given too little attention to the aspects of the poem that most interested Wordsworth himself.
- E. has given too much attention to the question of the poem's indebtedness or lack of indebtedness to Wordsworth's precursors.

Passage 154

Late-eighteenth-century English cultural authorities seemingly concurred that women readers should favor history, seen as edifying, than fiction, which was regarded as frivolous and reductive. **Readers of Marry Ann Hanway's novel *Andrew Stewart, or the Northern Wanderer*, learning that its heroine delights in David Hume's and Edward Gibbon's histories, could conclude that she was more virtuous and intelligent than her sister, who disdains such reading.** Likewise, while the naïve, novel-addicted protagonist of Jane Austen's *Northanger Abbey*, Catherine Morland, finds history a chore, the sophisticated, sensible character Eleanor Tilney enjoys it more than she does the Gothic fiction Catherine prefers. Yet in both cases, the praise of history is more double-edged than it might actually appear. Many readers have detected a protofeminist critique of history in Catherine's protest that she dislikes reading books filled with men "and hardly any women at all." Hanway, meanwhile, brings a controversial political edge to her heroine's reading, listing the era's two most famous religious skeptics among her preferred authors. While Hume's history was generally seen as being less objectionable than his philosophy, there were widespread doubts about his moral soundness even as a historian by the time that Hanway was writing, and Gibbon's perceived tendency to celebrate classical paganism sparked controversy from the first appearance of his history of Rome.

1. The author's primary purpose is that
 - A. the evidence used in support of a particular argument is questionable.
 - B. a distinction between two genres of writing has been overlooked.
 - C. a particular issue is more complex than it might appear.
 - D. two apparently different works share common features.
 - E. two eighteenth-century authors held significantly different attitudes toward a particular.
2. According to the passage, which of the following is true of Hume's reputation in the late eighteenth century?
 - A. He was more regarded as a historian than Gibbon.
 - B. His historical writing, like his philosophical writing, came to be regarded as problematic.
 - C. He was more well-known for his historical writing than for his philosophical writing.
 - D. His historic writing came to be regarded as morally questionable because of his association with Gibbon.
 - E. His views about classical paganism brought him disapproval among the general reading public.
3. The highlighted sentence exemplifies which of the following?
 - A. cultural authorities' attempt to use novels to support their view about the value of reading fiction
 - B. eighteenth-century women authors' attempts to embody in their work certain cultural authorities' views about reading
 - C. a point about the educational value of reading books about history
 - D. an instance in which a particular judgment about the value of reading history is apparently presupposed
 - E. a challenge to an assumption about eighteenth-century women's reading habits
4. The author mentions the "widespread doubts" in order to
 - A. support a point about the scholarly merit of Hume's writings.
 - B. contrast Hume's philosophical writing with his writing on historical subjects.
 - C. suggest that Hanway did not understand the implicit controversy depicting her heroine as reading Hume.
 - D. identify an ambiguity in Hanway's depiction of the philosopher in *the Northern Wanderer*
 - E. illustrate a point about a way eighteenth-century fiction sometimes represented historians.

Passage 155

Columnist: Until very recently, Presorbin and Veltrex, two medications used to block excess stomach acid, were both available only with a prescription written by a doctor. In an advertisement for Presorbin, its makers argue that **Presorbin is superior** on the grounds that doctors have written 200 million prescriptions for Presorbin, as compared to 100 million for Veltrex. It can be argued that the number of prescriptions written is never a worthwhile criterion for comparing the merits of medicines, but that **the advertisement's argument is absurd** is quite adequately revealed by observing that Presorbin was available as a prescription medicine years before Veltrex was. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

In the columnist's argument, the two highlighted portions play which of the following roles?

- A. The first is a claim that the columnist's argument seeks to clarify; the second states a conclusion drawn about one possible interpretation of that claim.
- B. The first identifies the conclusion of an argument that the columnist's argument is directed against; the second states the main conclusion of the columnist's argument.
- C. The first states the main conclusion of the columnist's argument; the second states a conclusion that the columnist draws in defending that conclusion against an objection.
- D. The first identifies an assumption made in an argument that the columnist's argument is directed against; the second states the main conclusion of the columnist's argument.
- E. The first is a claim that has been offered as evidence to support a position that the columnist opposes; the second states the main conclusion of the columnist's argument.

Passage 156

Stylistic evidence and laboratory evidence strongly support the claim that the magnificent painting Garden of Eden is a work of the Flemish master van Eyck. Nevertheless, **the painting must have been the work of someone else**, as anyone with a little historical and zoological knowledge can tell merely by looking at the painting. **The animals in the painting are all vivid representations of actual animals, including armadillos**. Yet armadillos are native only to Americas, and van Eyck died decades before Europeans reached the Americas. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

In the argument given, the two highlighted portions play which of the following roles?

- A. The first is a position that the argument seeks to reject, the second is evidence that the argument uses against that position.
- B. The first and the second are each pieces of evidence that have been used to support the position that the argument opposes.
- C. The first presents the main conclusion of the argument; the second provides evidence in support of that conclusion.
- D. The first is a judgment that serves as the basis for the main conclusion of the argument; the second states that main conclusion.
- E. The first is an intermediate conclusion drawn in order to support a further conclusion stated in the argument; the second provides evidence in support of that intermediate conclusion.

Passage 157

New methods developed in genetic research have led taxonomists to revise their views on the evolutionary relationships between many species. Traditionally the relatedness of species has been ascertained by a close comparison of their anatomy. The new methods infer the closeness of any two species' relationship to each other directly from similarities between the species' genetic codes. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following conclusions is best supported by the information?

- A. The apparent degree of relatedness of some species, as determined by anatomical criteria, is not borne out by their degree of genetic similarity.
- B. When they know the differences between two species' genetic codes, taxonomists can infer what the observable anatomical differences between those species must be.
- C. The degree to which individuals of the same species are anatomically similar is determined more by their genetic codes than by such environmental factors as food supply.
- D. The traditional anatomical methods by which taxonomists investigated the relatedness of species are incapable of any further refinement.
- E. Without the use of genetic methods, taxonomists would never be able to obtain any accurate information about species' degrees of relatedness to one another.

Passage 158

Sportfishers introduced the Zander, a type of perch, to Britain's rivers and canals in the 1970s. Because zander eat large numbers of smaller fish, they have had a devastating effect on native fish populations. To protect the native fish, a government program removed a significant proportion of the zander from Britain's waterways last year. Surprisingly, this year the loss of native fish to zander has been greater than before. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, would most help to explain the greater effect of zander on the native fish population?

- A. The climate in Britain is very similar to the climate in regions to which zander are native.
- B. Most of the zander removed were fully grown, and fully grown zander eat large numbers of smaller zander.
- C. Every year a large number of zander are caught by sportfisher in Britain's waterway.
- D. Previous government programs designed to remove nonnative species from Britain's waterways have failed.
- E. Zander are just one of several nonnative fish that prey on the other fish found in Britain's waterway.

Passage 159

There are many structural and thematic similarities between *Piers Plowman* by Langland (1330-1400) and *House of Fame* by Chaucer (1342-1400), two Middle English poems relating dream visions. Some critics have argued that because a number of the shared elements are uncommon in Middle English poetry, and because Langland's poem probably predates Chaucer's by a few years, Chaucer was most likely influenced by *Piers Plowman* when writing *House of Fame*. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the critics' argument?

- A. *Piers Plowman* is one of Langland's major works, whereas *House of Fame* is a minor work of Chaucer's.
- B. *House of Fame* survives in only three manuscript copies, substantially fewer than the number of manuscript copies that exist of *Piers Plowman*.
- C. Because *Piers Plowman* became a well-known work in its day, it is likely that the similarities between it and *House of Fame* were detected by many of the people who read *House of Fame* soon after Chaucer wrote it.
- D. Many of the themes and structures of *Piers Plowman* are also found in Latin, Italian, French works with which Chaucer could well have been familiar.
- E. There is no evidence that Chaucer and Langland ever met or that they corresponded with each other about literary topics.

Passage 160

The Great Sphinx is a huge statue in Egypt that has a lion's body with a man's head. The face of the Sphinx has long been claimed to be that of pharaoh Khafre, who lived around 2600 B.C., but it cannot be: erosion patterns recently discovered on the lion's legs can only have been caused by heavy rains, and the Sahara has not had heavy rains in over 10,000 years.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument?

- A. The face of the Sphinx bears a resemblance to the faces on certain stylized statues dating from both before and after the reign of Khafre.
- B. Other erosion patterns that appear on the body of the Sphinx are of a sort that could be caused by wind and sand alone.
- C. Other than the Sphinx, there are no surviving sculptures that have been claimed to portray the face of Khafre.
- D. In the last 10,000 years the climate of Egypt has been so dry that even rains that are not heavy have been extremely infrequent.
- E. The face of the Sphinx is small relative to the rest of the head, indicating that the face may have been recarved long after the Sphinx was built.

Passage 161

Although initially symptomless, glaucoma can eventually cause blindness when not properly treated. Tests under laboratory conditions of the traditional treatment, daily administration of eyedrops, show it to be as effective in relieving the internal ocular pressure that causes glaucoma as is a new laser-surgical procedure. Yet glaucoma-related blindness occurs in a significantly smaller percentage of patients who have had the surgery than of patients for whom only the eyedrop treatment was prescribed. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most helps to explain the low rate glaucoma-related blindness among patients who had the surgery?

- A. Glaucoma-related blindness is no more common among patients who have had only the surgery than it is among patients who had the surgery after using the eyedrops.
- B. Doctors rarely recommend the surgery for glaucoma patients who have already started the traditional course of treatment.
- C. There is no known physiological cause of glaucoma other than increase in pressure inside the eye.
- D. A significant percentage of the people for whom the eyedrop treatment has been prescribed fail to follow the prescribed daily regimen, because the eyedrops have unpleasant side effects.
- E. The eyedrops traditionally prescribed to treat glaucoma are normally prescribed to treat other disease of the eye.

Passage 162

In mountainous regions, the timberline is the highest altitude at which trees grow. In the Rocky Mountains, the current timberline is at the altitude above which growing season temperatures remain cooler than 10 degrees centigrade. Fossilized remains of trees that grew 10,000 years ago have been found 100 meters above the current Rocky Mountain timberline. Clearly, therefore, the climate of the Rocky Mountains is cooler now than it was 10,000 years ago. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument relies?

- A. In the past 10,000 years, the only trees to have grown above today's timberline are the trees whose fossilized remains been found.
- B. No trees grew 10,000 years ago at altitudes higher than the ones at which fossilized tree remains have been found.
- C. The fossils are not of species of trees that were able to tolerate cooler growing temperatures than are the species that currently grow near the timberline.
- D. The Rocky Mountains have not eroded significantly over the past 10,000 years.
- E. The climate of the Rocky Mountains has never been significantly warmer than during the lifetime of the trees whose fossilized remains have been found.

Passage 163

Cotton grass, which grows only in arctic regions, has been the only summertime source of protein available to caribou. Caribou that do not get adequate amounts of protein in the summer are unable to reproduce the following year. Rising average temperatures in arctic regions, however, are causing cotton grass to disappear. Therefore, if the warming trend continues, caribou are likely to become extinct. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

- A. Cotton grass is the only one of the caribou's food sources that is becoming scarce as temperatures rise in arctic regions.
- B. Caribou that do not eat enough protein to reproduce do not live as long as caribou that do.
- C. The warming trend in arctic regions will not enable other plants capable of providing protein to caribou to grow there.
- D. The caribou is the only animal that depends on cotton grass as a major source of food.
- E. If the warming trend continues and cotton grass disappears from arctic regions, then cotton grass will be extinct.

Passage 164

Although the percentage of first graders in Almaria who were excellent readers varied little between 1995 and 2010, the percentage of first graders who had considerable difficulty reading their schoolbooks increased markedly during that period. This evidence strongly indicates that the average reading ability of first graders decreased between 1995 and 2010. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, provides the strongest additional support for the argument?

- A. The number of hours devoted to reading activities in first-grade classrooms in Almaria did not vary significantly, on average, between 1995 and 2010.
- B. The percentage of first graders in Almaria who had difficulty solving arithmetic problems did not increase as much between 1995 and 2010 as did the percentage of first graders who had reading difficulties.
- C. The number of children in Almaria who were enrolled as first graders decreased steadily between 1995 and 2010.
- D. The average difficulty of the schoolbooks used in first-grade classrooms in Almaria decreased between 1995 and 2010.
- E. The average number of schoolbooks used in first-grade classrooms in Almaria increased between 1995 and 2010.

Passage 165

The Minoan civilization flourished on the island of Crete around 2000 B.C. The discovery on Crete of large numbers of bronze implements and the furnaces used in their manufacture shows that the Minoans had a thriving bronze industry. Moreover, many bronze artifacts from this period that are similar in style to those produced on Crete have been found in southern Greece. Hence it is probable that, besides making bronzeware for domestic use, the Minoans exported bronzeware to southern Greece. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the argument given?

- A. Copper and tin, the main ingredients of bronze, were present in Southern Greece.
- B. No furnaces dating from the Minoan era and suitable for the manufacture of bronze implements have been found in southern Greece.
- C. The Minoans exported a great deal of pottery, which was highly valued by other ancient civilizations.
- D. The fuel needed for Minoan bronzeware furnaces was provided by a variety of local species of hardwood.
- E. Some of the pieces of bronzeware found on Crete were non-Minoan in origin.

Passage 166

Although several ancient cultures practiced mummification, mummies from ancient Egypt are generally more well-preserved than mummies of similar antiquity from other cultures. One possible explanation for this difference is that the mummification techniques or material used by ancient Egyptians were better than those of other cultures. A second, more likely, explanation is that the extremely dry climate of ancient Egypt was largely responsible, given that dryness promotes the preservation of organic remains generally. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following provide the most support for the argument?

- A. The materials used by ancient Egyptians for mummification were not used by any other ancient culture that practiced mummification.
- B. Some ancient Egyptian mummies are better preserved than other ancient Egyptian mummies from around the same time.
- C. No ancient people living in very damp areas practiced mummification.
- D. Bodies from ancient Egyptian tombs dating from before the practice of mummification began are almost as well preserved as ancient Egyptian mummies.
- E. Ancient mummies discovered in places other than Egypt have typically not been as well protected from the elements as ancient Egyptian mummies were.

Passage 167

The economy of Colonia has been in recession for the past eight years. Most companies that have not been forced into bankruptcy have survived thanks to the high efficiency of the employees they retained, which helped the companies control costs. In recent months, however, the Colombian economy has begun to recover, and companies are beginning to expand their workforces. Colonia, therefore, will soon experience a drop in average worker efficiency, since _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most logically complete the argument?

- A. People who have been employed throughout the recession will, no doubt, continue to be employed.
- B. Colonia is expected to begin importing more goods from other countries.
- C. Most companies will find that few of the workers available for hiring are as efficient as those they retained during the recession.
- D. During the recession, workers did not receive any raise in their pay.
- E. Many companies that were forced into bankruptcy in the past eight years had a fair number of efficient workers.

Passage 168

A hoard of coins recently unearthed at an ancient Carthagian site bear an image of a face in profile with what appears to be a large mole on the cheek. Pointing out that an artist would be unlikely to include such a specific detail in a generalized portrayal of a face, some archaeologists have concluded that these coins portray an actual individual rather than an idealized type. However, this conclusion is unwarranted, since _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following most logically completes the argument?

- A. Archaeologists cannot determine the actual identity of the individual portrayed just from the likeness that appears on the coins.
- B. It cannot be established with certainty that Carthagian artists were on the whole less skillful at portraying human face than artists of other cultures.
- C. None of the other designs of Carthagian coins that have been discovered features a face with a mole on it.
- D. In ancient times it was quite common for the money circulated in a city or country to include coins that originated in other jurisdictions.
- E. The relatively soft metal used for Carthagian coin molds sometimes resulted in the production of series of coins with unintended bumps.

Passage 169

People widely believed that the controlled use of fire originated 200,000 years ago with the human species *Homo sapiens*. However, a site containing a deposit, estimated to be nearly 500,000 years old, consisting of charcoal, burned animal bones, and charred rocks, has recently been found. Although *Homo sapiens* did not exist at that time, this discovery provides no basis to the claim that the controlled use of fire preceded the *Homo sapiens*, since _____.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following most logically completes the passage?

- A. The use of fire might have originated independently in several different parts of the world.
- B. It is possible that fire was used much earlier than 500,000 years ago.
- C. The charred rocks found in the deposit included several different kinds of stone, all of which are common in the immediate vicinity of the site.
- D. Animal bones could have been discarded in a fire used for purposes such as protection or heat rather than for cooking.
- E. It is impossible to determine whether a charred deposit dating from so long ago resulted from a fire caused by lightening or from the purposeful use of fire.

Passage 170

Because of strong overall stylistic similarities, prehistoric cave paintings in El Castillo, Spain and others in Altamira, Spain, were thought to date from the same period. Recent pigment analyses, however, established the Altamira paintings as by far the older and as about the same age as a third group of paintings done in a different overall style. Nevertheless, this case does not prove that stylistic similarities cannot be a reliable indicator of closeness in age, since _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following most logically completes the passage?

- A. Experts who knew the results of the pigment analyses reexamined these paintings and found no previously unnoticed stylistic similarities between the Altamira paintings and the paintings in the third group.
- B. There are certain stylistic features that the Altamira paintings share with all known paintings of their period and do not share with the El Castillo paintings.
- C. Before dating by pigment analysis was widely practiced, stylistic similarities were the only means of determining whether two prehistoric cave paintings dated from the same period.
- D. Determining the age of a prehistoric cave painting simply by reference to the age of the pigments used in that painting substitutes technology for artistic judgment.
- E. There are experts who maintain that the results of the recent pigment analyses leave the striking stylistic similarities between the El Castillo paintings and the Altamira paintings unexplained.

Passage 171

Members of the San, a hunter-gatherer society, have a diet far richer in fruits and vegetables and lower in salt than is typical in industrialized societies. They also differ from industrialized societies in that they have extremely low rates of high blood pressure and obesity. However, contrary to what some have claimed, if people in industrialized societies adopted the San's diet, the incidence of high blood pressure and obesity in these societies might not be dramatically reduced, because _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following most logically completes the passage?

- A. Psychological stress, which can also cause high blood pressure, occurs in both industrialized and nonindustrialized societies.
- B. The San's low-salt diet is due, not to preference, but to the limited availability of salt in their region.
- C. A few members of the San have been found to suffer from circulatory system ailments other than high blood pressure.
- D. Members of the San are far more physically active than are most members of industrialized societies.
- E. Not all individuals with high blood pressure are obese.

Passage 172

This passage discusses Minoan buildings constructed during the Bronze Age on the Greek Island of Crete.

Although the term “Palace” is widely used and deeply ingrained in Minoan archaeology, Driesen has marked that term has been used to describe a number of quite different things and that there is no consensus on what the term signifies. The debate usually centers on the presumed functions of the building. Evans assumes that the building known as Places has several roles, including royal residences, administrative centers, economic centers, manufacturing centers, and cult centers. Over the years, each of those functions has been called into questions. For example, Schoep notes, **“The use of the term Place carries with it a whole host of perhaps unhelpful baggage, which consciously or unconsciously encourages interpretation of the “Palace” as the residence of a royal elite, occupying supreme position within a hierarchical social and political structure”**, she suggests using the **more neutral term** “court-centered building” instead. The problem, however, come not from the architectural label one applies, but from making unwarranted assumptions about how the Palaces were used. I use the word “Palaces” (capitalized to signal its arbitrariness) not to imply a range of functions but to refer to a group of buildings that share a set of formal elements. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Select a sentence in the passage that summarizes the author’s primary opposition to a particular approach taken by Minoan archaeologists.
2. The author would most likely agree with which of the following as response to Schoep’s argument for using a “more neutral term”?
 - A. The term that Schoep favors would exclude some sites that ought to be included in the category.
 - B. Given the profusion of terms that archaeologists have applied to the building that have been called Palaces, it is redundant to introduce another one.
 - C. If a new term is introduced, it should be based on the known functions of the buildings that have been called Palaces, rather than on theory formal architectural features.
 - D. It is possible to use the term “Palace” without being committed to the term’s functional implications.
 - E. It is not true that the buildings that have been called Palaces are the only evidence for a hierarchical social structure in Minoan society.
3. The author would most likely agree with which of the following statements about the use of the term “Palace” in Minoan archaeology?
 - A. It is useful largely as a matter of convention.
 - B. It should be replaced by a more neutral term.
 - C. It is the correct term for most of the Minoan buildings to which it has been applied.
 - D. It has only recently become popular among archaeologists.
 - E. It has been used to describe buildings that are formally dissimilar to one another.
4. The author would most likely agree with which of the following statements about the buildings discussed in the passage?
 - A. They possess a discernible architectural cohesiveness as a group.
 - B. They probably all had the same or a similar function.
 - C. They almost certainly were not used as royal residences.
 - D. They were more likely to be used as administrative centers than as manufacturing centers.
 - E. They are architecturally similar to a number of other buildings on Crete.

5. The author of the passage suggests which of the following about the term “Palace” in Minoan archaeology?

- A. It is used by many Minoan archaeologists.
- B. It is a term that I. Schoep recommends replacing.
- C. There is little agreement as to the function of the buildings designated by the term.

6. The highlighted quotation from I. Schoep serves in part to

- A. suggest that the debate surrounding the Palaces’ function has been misguided.
- B. caution against a particular understanding of the Palaces’ function.
- C. articulate a hypothesis about the Palaces’ function that the author goes on to critique.
- D. explain why the Palaces were probably not used as residences by a royal elite.
- E. support a claim by the author that the term “Palace” should no longer be used.

Passage 173

The capture hypothesis holds that the Moon formed separately from Earth and was later captured into orbit around Earth. If the Moon formed far from Earth before capture, that would explain why Earth and Moon have different compositions. Capture is not unprecedented in the solar system, as **satellites of giant planets** orbiting in the opposite direction to their planet's rotation demonstrate; but capturing a satellite is not easy. If the Moon once had enough kinetic energy to wander close to Earth, it would also have had enough to escape again. Tidal interactions, collisions with material orbiting Earth, or passage through Earth's atmosphere could remove some energy, but not nearly fast enough to allow the Moon to be captured in a single passage by Earth. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author mentions "satellites of giant planets" in order to
 - A. show how unusual a particular event would have been.
 - B. explain how a particular event likely occurred.
 - C. acknowledge that an idea has some plausibility.
 - D. demonstrate a feature common to orbiting satellites.
 - E. point to similarities between Earth and the giant planets.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The author implies that the fact that the Moon and Earth "have different compositions"
 - A. is consistent with the capture hypothesis but not sufficient to prove that hypothesis.
 - B. helps explain how the Moon might have lost a significant amount of kinetic energy.
 - C. supports the idea that capture is somewhat common in the solar system.

Passage 174

Before 1970, children in the United States were commonly vaccinated against smallpox. In the early 1970s, large-scale vaccinations of children against smallpox were discontinued because smallpox had virtually disappeared from the world. Recently, some scientists have cautioned that the United States could be exposed to smallpox again. Contrary to what many people believe, this exposure would probably find all age-groups within the United States population at comparable levels of risk of contracting smallpox, since _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following most logically completes the passage?

- A. Smallpox is a highly communicable disease among people who are not immune to it.
- B. Smallpox vaccine is not now widely available in the United States.
- C. The population of the United States has been growing more slowly since 1970 than it was before then.
- D. Smallpox vaccinations lose their efficacy after about 20 years.
- E. People in the United States travel more than they did in 1970, thereby increasing the chances that an epidemic could spread.

Passage 175

Madagascar's Mahafale cattle raisers have incorporated the prickly pear cactus into their pastoral economy, which depends on assisting their cattle through the dry season, when grass and water are scarce. Rather than relying on nomadism in the pursuit of water and pasture for their livestock, they have turned to cactus to keep stock alive. This has influenced the cattle raisers' way of life, particularly in terms of diet and mobility. Women harvest cactus for their families to eat. Male herders work cactus as a vegetable crop for cattle. For these benefits, pastoralists sow, prune, and shape prickly pear into living fences around their corrals. In doing so, these herders have become cactus cultivators, which has reduced their mobility. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Select the sentence in the passage that tells how the prickly pear has affected the Mahafale diet.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. Which of the following is mentioned in the passage as an affect of cactus cultivation on the Mahafale's pastoralist way of life?

- A. The Mahafale no longer need to help their cattle survive during the dry season.
- B. The Mahafale have abandoned their pastoralist way of life.
- C. The mobility of the Mahafale has been diminished.

Passage 176

Catherine Stimpson calls for a reassessment of literary merit based on affective standards—on how literary works make readers feel—rather than on the aesthetic standards traditionally used to define the canon, the body of literary works generally accepted as “great”. Stimpson advocates an alternative para canon for literary works, such as Louisa May Alcott’s *Little Women*, because she believes such works have been unjustifiably neglected by unsympathetic scholars. According to Stimpson, a para canonical work may or may not have literary value by traditional standards; rather, its worth consists in its “capacity to inspire love”. Elizabeth Barnes criticizes Stimpson’s approach as subjective and therefore uncritical. “Although Stimpson never actually defines ‘love’, she implies that a lovable work is one that so engages the reader that its worldview becomes inseparable from the reader’s own” (Stimpson acknowledges that the values reflected in *Little Women* may have subconsciously influenced her invention of the para canon). For Barnes, the conflation of ethics and aesthetics implicit in Stimpson’s approach (in which “good” can refer to something morally sound and/or above average in quality) demonstrates the ambiguity inherent in such concepts as goodness and love. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, Stimpson advocated the creation of a para canon because she
 - A. found many of the works that were included in the canon to be uninspiring.
 - B. rejected the ethical standards reflected in many canonical works.
 - C. failed to convince other scholars that some of her favorite works should be added to the canon.
 - D. felt that the values of some works has gone unrecognized by critics who are concerned only with traditional aesthetic standards.
 - E. insisted on strict adherence to traditional standards for the evaluation of literature.
2. The author of the passage mentions Louisa May Alcott’s *Little Women* primarily in order to provide an example of a work that
 - A. the author of the passage feels has been inappropriately excluded from the canon.
 - B. the author of the passage and Stimpson agree is emotionally satisfying.
 - C. Stimpson feels has not been sufficiently appreciated by scholars.
 - D. conforms to Barnes’s ethical and aesthetic standards.
 - E. presents an ambiguous view of the concept of love.
3. It can be inferred from the passage that Barnes would be most likely to agree with which of the following characterizations of Stimpson’s approach to assessing literary works?
 - A. It requires the application of more exacting standards than are traditionally employed.
 - B. Its application would result in the exclusion from the para canon of most of the works included in the canon.
 - C. It accords recognition to too large and diverse a body of literature.
 - D. It involves the use of a criterion that is not rigorously defined.
 - E. It results in evaluations that are more objective than those based on traditional aesthetic standards.

Passage 177

Oscillatory swimming—the alternating of deep dives with **forays** toward the surface—is among the most common behaviors of large marine animals in the open ocean. The reason most often proposed for this behavior is to warm the body after heat loss during descent into cooler water. Tuna, mako sharks, and white sharks maintain an internal body temperature above that of the surrounding waters thereby improving their muscular efficiency and enabling them to swim with bursts of speed. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. According to the passage, maintaining an internal body temperature above that of surrounding waters enables certain marine animals to

- A. use their muscles with greater efficiency
- B. swim faster than usual for short periods
- C. alternate between deep diving and surface swimming

2. In the context in which it appears, “forays” most nearly means

- A. trips
- B. attacks
- C. attempts
- D. adventures
- E. encroachment

Passage 178

W.C. Handy wrote and published the celebrated 1914 composition “St.Louis Blues”. Despite achieving fame and fortune with that and other songs, some of which incorporated and developed common blues material, Handy has been dismissed by some critics as inauthentic: “real” blues musicians, it is said, neither read nor write music; instead, they live the blues. Yet Handy’s cardinal sin seems to have been that he profited from a genre whose practitioners are defined, in these critics’ mythology, by their subjection to economic exploitation. Far from signifying inauthenticity, however, Handy’s stubborn pursuit of profit through the blues places him squarely within a well-established tradition: blues music as a means to escape the blues of poverty. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following can be inferred about blues music from the passage?
 - A. Genuine blues music is transmitted orally.
 - B. Creating blues music by using extant blues material was rare before W.C. Handy
 - C. “St.Louis Blues” was the first piece of blues music to achieve widespread success.
 - D. Blues music is often intimately related to economic deprivation.
 - E. W.C. Handy was the first person to transcribe and publish blues music.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. According to the passage, which of the following is true regarding Handy’s musical career and blues music?
 - A. Handy profited from blues music.
 - B. The critics who dismiss Handy as inauthentic include several blues musicians.
 - C. In some of his most successful songs, Handy used music that he had not himself composed.

Passage 179

The pepper *Capsicum chinense* grows as a native wild plant only in South America. Birds swallow the pepper’s fruit whole, thereby providing the plant with its means of distributing seeds. Domesticated varieties of *C.chinense* grow in the Caribbean islands as well as in South America. Although it is unknown just when *C.chinense* was introduced into the islands, the introduction of the species was probably the result of human activity, because _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following most logically completes the argument?

- A. The fruits of the domesticated varieties are too large for birds to swallow.
- B. *C.chinense* grows in the Caribbean islands under climatic conditions very similar to those under which the wild variety grows.
- C. The peppers are an important part of the Caribbean islands’ characteristic cooking.
- D. Most of the plant species in the Caribbean islands originated in South America.
- E. Many of the species of birds that are found in the Caribbean islands spend only the winter there.

Passage 180

Data on modern and historic peasant communities suggest that individuals and communities specialize in ceramic production for trade primarily to offset subsistence shortfalls arising from inadequate or insufficient agricultural land. Harry investigated whether this **correlation** of ceramic specialization with agricultural **marginality** occurred among prehistoric inhabitants of the American Southwest. At Arizona's West Branch site, occupied A.D. 900-1100, abundant pottery manufacturing materials suggest village wide ceramic production in excess of that needed for household purposes. Harry points out, however, that if West Branch residents exchanged pots for food, one would expect the villages with which they traded to have produced more consistent food surpluses than West Branch did. **In fact, the West Branch village appears to have been located in an area with better agricultural conditions than those of the pottery-consuming settlements.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The final sentence of the passage primarily serves to do which of the following?
 - A. cite a particular factor that may have influence the decision to settle the West Branch site
 - B. identify a possible reason why the inhabitants of the West Branch site may have specialized in the manufacture of ceramics
 - C. suggest that inhabitants of the West Branch site may have had agricultural surpluses to use for trade with other settlements in the region
 - D. present evidence to support a claim that the West Branch site was not a pottery consuming settlement
 - E. cite one reason to doubt that the ceramic specialization at the West Branch site served to offset subsistence shortfalls
2. Replacement of the word "marginality" with which of the following words results in the least change meaning for the passage?
 - A. peculiarity
 - B. insignificant
 - C. nonconformity
 - D. deficiency
 - E. futility
3. Which of the following, if discovered to be true, would most tend to suggest that the "correlation" mentioned in the passage held true for the people of the West Branch site?
 - A. The ceramic technology used at the West Branch site was superior to that used at other villages in the region.
 - B. West Branch residents traded with communities located in a region that was agriculturally less productive than West Branch.
 - C. Soil at the West Branch site was deficient in nutrients essential to agriculture during the time the site was inhabited.
 - D. Rainfall at the West Branch site was generally favorable for agriculture between A.D. 900 and 1100.
 - E. Inhabitants of the West Branch site regularly traveled to neighboring villages for trading purposes.

Passage 181

Although Klezmer—a style of traditional Jewish folk music from Eastern Europe—grew from very diverse musical traditions, Roma (Gypsy), Greek, and Romanian elements eventually became so predominant that **some scholars** refused to recognize klezmer as a separate genre. If one listens closely, however, one can learn to distinguish the sound of a Klezmer interpretation from other related performance styles. Yiddish-speaking Jews routinely use several uniquely descriptive words to identify the sounds found in the Jewish approach to music. Krekht (Yiddish for “groan”) refers to a wailing sound reminiscent of weeping, tshok refers to a laugh-like instrumental sound; and a kneytsh is a sob-like “catch”. These and other elements typical of klezmer are also found in other forms of Jewish musical expression, including cantorial music. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following can be inferred from the passage about Roma, Greek, and Romanian music?

- A. They are frequently difficult to distinguish from one another.
- B. They have had a significant influence on klezmer music.
- C. They were not recognized as separate genres by certain scholars.
- D. They contain elements analogous to the tshok.
- E. They were ignored by Yiddish-speaking Jewish musicians.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. It can be inferred that the author would be likely to agree with the highlighted “some scholars” about whether

- A. any traditions other than Roma, Greek and Romanian contributed to the development of klezmer
- B. the degree of resemblance between klezmer and the Roma, Greek, and Romanian traditions is enough to preclude klezmer’s being a separate musical genre
- C. such musical devices as the krechts are found throughout Jewish musical expression

Passage 182

Samples taken from the ice of glaciers show that during the last ice age there was far more dust in the atmosphere than there is now. Since greater amounts of dust in the atmosphere would result in less sunlight’s reaching the Earth’s surface, it is likely that the large amount of dust then present helped maintain low global temperatures and thus prolonged the ice age.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument?

- A. Large amount of dust in the atmosphere would tend to keep heat from the Sun that reached the Earth’s surface from escaping into outer space.
- B. The glacial samples show that during the period between the two most recent ice ages the level of atmospheric dust was far lower than it was during either of ice ages.
- C. Volcanic eruptions in the recent past have released sufficient dust to cause detectable changes in global temperature patterns.
- D. The amount of dust in the atmosphere was significantly greater in the middle of the last ice age than at the end.
- E. Sunlight is the main heat source of the Earth’s surface.

Passage 183

Climatologists observed in 1964 that a slow warming of the surface of the North Atlantic in the 1910s and 1920s could well have been driven by a surge of warm water up the Gulf Stream. This Atlantic warming accompanied a global warming that by the 1940s had produced the highest global temperatures to that point in the records. It was so warm that statistical techniques used in the 1990s to detect the “fingerprint” of greenhouse warming in climate records also show the 1940s having greenhouse warming. However, no one believes enough greenhouse gases had reached the atmosphere by then to cause much of a human-induced warming. That inconsistency has led greenhouse **contrarians** to claim that any recent warming could be natural rather than anthropogenic. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. It can be inferred that the “contrarians” mentioned in the passage would agree with which of the

- A. The extent of the global warming that occurred between the 1940s and the 1990s has been exaggerated by some climatologists.
- B. Changes in global temperatures in the 1990s are a part of a trend that is distinct from any trend that may have existed in the 1910s and 1920s.
- C. Recent changes in global temperature may not be the direct result of human activity.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. Which of the following statements about the global warming observed in the 1940s is implied by the passage?

- A. It was part of a climatic change that can be traced to the 1910s and 1920s.
- B. Its cause was not apparent to climatologists until the 1990s.
- C. It is doubtful that it was caused primarily by greenhouse gases produced by humans.

Passage 184

The area of literary rights is confusing for scholars whose work focuses on collaborative materials particularly materials of earlier Native American writers. Questions arise over authorship and the determination of literary heirs. For example, recognition of heirs turns on the European-based assumption of the private ownership of a written statement. The first person to write down an oral tale can become legally recognized as the owner of that version of the story, just as the first chemist to patent a tribal healing practice becomes the owner of the resulting chemical formula. This instance on private rather than collective ownership, derived from the nineteenth-century notion of the autonomous, creative, authorial voice, flies in the face of those who come from an oral tradition. Thus a scholar concerned with finding literary heirs in order to afford them the benefits of copyright laws must in so doing accede to legal concept of ownership that has been used to appropriate knowledge from community-based cultures. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The example of a chemical patent is used to illustrate a
 - A. legal mechanism by which community knowledge can be turned into private property
 - B. technological development that goes beyond the scope of nineteenth-century science
 - C. government action that creates a temporary form of intellectual property
 - D. kind of expression that exists only in written, rather than oral, form
 - E. way in which medical innovation can be rewarded
2. The author of the passage focuses on a contrast between
 - A. patents and copyrights as ways of protecting ownership
 - B. oral and written as means of artistic expression
 - C. literary heirs and authors of literary works as creative thinkers
 - D. individual and collective ownership of cultural products
 - E. contemporary and nineteenth-century views of authorship
3. According to the passage, the notion of a literary heir depends on a presupposition that can be traced to
 - A. a confusion over the purposes of collaboration
 - B. a misunderstanding between people from different cultures
 - C. a nineteenth-century view of authors as creative individuals
 - D. oral traditions that hand down knowledge through generations
 - E. scholars who first recorded oral tales in written form

Passage 185

In Stanton the average number of people injured per automobile accident is consistently higher for accidents involving a taxicab than for those not involving a taxicab. Although all Stanton taxicabs are equipped with passenger seat belts, taxicab drivers report that passengers tend not to use them. It is likely, therefore, that if taxicab passengers were required to use seat belts, the number of people injured per accident would soon be no higher for taxicabs than for other automobiles. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true about Stanton, most seriously weakens the argument?

- A. The number of automobile accidents has been declining in recent years.
- B. Since taxicabs are driven more miles annually than most other vehicles, they are more likely to be in an accident during any given year than is the average vehicle.
- C. There are more taxicabs in operation, relative to the overall number of motor vehicles, than there are in most cities of Stanton's size.
- D. The number of people, including the driver, who occupy a vehicle is generally greater for taxicabs than for other vehicles.
- E. Not all passengers in automobiles other than taxicabs use seat belts.

Passage 186

Growing grapes in greenhouses containing air enriched with carbon dioxide increases crop yields, an effect that is enhanced when the growing temperature is also raised several degrees. Although enclosed cultivation is impractical in vineyards, increases in yields from grape cultivation in the open can be expected because emissions from the burning of fossil fuels will almost certainly lead to an increase in the carbon dioxide content of atmospheric air over the next century. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following, if true, most weakens the argument?

- A. When grapes are grown in greenhouses, it is relatively easy to control the grape pests that thrive in air enriched with carbon dioxide.
- B. Recent improvements in pest control have increased grape yields in many vineyards.
- C. Increasing carbon dioxide levels in greenhouses has not been shown to improve the quality of grapes grown in greenhouses.
- D. Increasing carbon dioxide levels in greenhouses increases the sweetness of raisins made from grapes grown in the greenhouses.
- E. As the carbon dioxide level in the open air increases, temperatures at the Earth's surface will also increase.

2. Which of the following would be most useful to determine the possibility that the grapes yields increase with the raise of the temperature?

- A. Whether increasing carbon dioxide levels in greenhouses improves the eating quality of the grapes grown in the greenhouses
- B. Whether in the future the market for grapes will be greater than it is now
- C. Whether temperatures today often get so high in regions where grapes are grown that the grapes suffer serious damage
- D. Whether the use of greenhouses for growing grapes serves research purposes only
- E. Whether the economic benefits that might be derived from a major increase in world grape production would outweigh any economic harm resulting from negative health effects associated with increased worldwide carbon dioxide levels

Passage 187

One way to assess *This is the American Earth*, a collection of photographs selected and arranged by Nancy Newhall, is to apply Newhall's own criteria for judging photographic art. Does this photographic essay achieve results impossible in other media? By contrasting the small with the vast—for example, placing a photo of a rock pool next to one of a spiral galaxy—Newhall exploits the camera's ability to manipulate the size of an object, thereby challenging viewers to question their conventional concepts of size. However, a similar result could be achieved in the medium of painting.

Does the work bear its creator's imprint, and does it draw viewers' interest even after repeated viewings, Newhall's second and third criteria? Indeed, Newhall's work bears her unmistakable imprint in the juxtaposition of the photos and in the rhythmic prose accompanying them, but the individual viewer must decide whether Newhall's work evokes, as it did for this reviewer, new experiences upon subsequent viewings. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, which of the following is a way in which *This is the American Earth* satisfies Newhall's criteria for judging photographic art?

- A. It takes advantage of one of the camera's unique abilities.
- B. It leaves viewers with a particularly strong visual impression.
- C. It contains elements identifying it as a particular person's work.
- D. It consistently evokes an emotional response from viewers.
- E. It successfully destroys an overemphasis on humans' concept of size.

2. According to the passage, one of the criteria Newhall uses in making judgments about photographic art is the degree to which the art

- A. provides viewers with an experience what will encourage subsequent viewings.
- B. challenges viewers to question their preconceptions.
- C. evokes similar experiences for different viewers in different circumstances.
- D. achieves results that have not been realized by earlier works of photographic art.
- E. produces results that can only be achieved in the medium of photography.

Passage 188

Spiders of many species change color to resemble the color of the flowers they sit on. Many animals that prey on such spiders possess color discrimination so acute that they, unlike human beings, can readily see the spiders despite the seeming camouflage. It is unlikely, therefore, that the spiders' color changes confer significant survival benefit on these spiders.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following would it be most useful to determine in order to evaluate the argument?

- A. whether the spiders' own ability to discriminate color-camouflaged species is as acute as that of their predators
- B. whether the spiders have a color that could properly be regarded as their natural color
- C. whether the spiders' color-changes allow them to remain undetected by prey
- D. whether different species of color-changing spiders tend to favor different species of flower
- E. whether the color-changing spiders prey on any insects that themselves change color

Passage 189

Most feminist labor historians believe that the emergence and rapid general adoption of industrial unionism in the late 1930s was essential for the success of efforts to organize large numbers of women workers into unions. They argue that industrial unionism's commitment to recruiting unskilled workers and its abandonment of racial and gender exclusiveness was more attractive to women workers (who, according to these scholars, were largely unskilled) than was the earlier exclusionary craft-union model. The successful organization of women garment workers in the 1910s does not undermine this dominant view, since the garment unions welcomed women workers of every skill level, prefiguring the industrial form of unionism. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

According to the author, the successful organization of women garment workers is consistent with the dominant view of women labor history because

- A. garment unions concentrated their recruitment efforts exclusively on attracting unskilled workers as members.
- B. those women garment workers who joined the garment unions were not as skilled as those who refused to join.
- C. garment unions accepted both skilled and unskilled workers as members.
- D. garment unions lacked exclusionary racial rules as well as rules barring unskilled workers.
- E. most garment workers were relatively skilled craft workers rather than unskilled workers.

Passage 190

The United States Civil Rights movement, which began in the 1950s and gained momentum in the 1960s and 1970s, owed a heavy debt to African American newspapers. This is not to suggest that the African American press caused the Civil Rights era. But its continual push from 1910 to 1950 or more African American rights, using a compelling form of advocacy journalism rather than the standard objective newspaper style, allowed those who in the 1950s began pushing nationally for equality to start at a far higher level than if the African American press had not existed. This point has largely been missed by many Americans, who seem to believe the Civil Rights era erupted from a standstill like a dormant geyser. But that is not how history occurs. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. challenge a particular scholarly argument.
 - B. identify the cause of a historical development.
 - C. present a summary of a long-standing debate.
 - D. explain the origins of a flawed theory.
 - E. correct a commonly held misconception.
2. According to the passage, African American newspapers contributed to the Civil Rights movement primarily by
 - A. exposing bias in supposedly objective newspaper accounts.
 - B. connecting the movement's leaders with local communities.
 - C. providing a platform for leaders to be heard by a wide audience.
 - D. laying the groundwork for a later national effort.
 - E. building momentum for efforts that were already in progress.

Passage 191

Except in special situations, human beings' battle with mosquitoes will not be won by a simple campaign to eliminate the insects. Social tradition and habits, it seems, do much to ensure continual contact between mosquitoes and people. On the slopes of Mount Kilimanjaro, for example, mosquitoes breed in the leaf axils of a plant called dracaena. Although dracaena is not a food plant for humans, its use as a hedge or boundary marker is deeply rooted in tradition. Here, as in other parts of the world, human behavior ensures contact and conflict between people and mosquitoes.

I am not advocating a policy of live and let live; we already know that living with mosquitoes is very unpleasant. But until we accomplish the difficult task of understanding how our habits often perpetuate—even create—our problems, efforts to resolve our battle with mosquitoes will probably fail. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is primarily concerned with

- A. discussing shortsighted proposals to eliminate problems with mosquitoes.
- B. outlining ways in which people can alleviate the problems caused by mosquitoes.
- C. arguing that social traditions can perpetuate people's problems with mosquitoes.
- D. discussing various ways in which people come into contact with mosquitoes.
- E. suggesting how the breeding habits of mosquitoes create problems for people.

2. Which of the following best describes the organization of the passage?

- A. A hypothesis is presented, weighed, and qualified, and then the modified hypothesis is reaffirmed.
- B. An argument is advanced, then it is refuted, and an alternative is suggested.
- C. A claim is made, a supporting example is provided, and then a conclusion is offered.
- D. Opposing views are presented, evaluated and then reconciled.
- E. A problem is identified, a solution is proposed, and potential difficulties with the solution are raised

3. Select a sentence in which a potential misinterpretation of the author's position is addressed.

Passage 192

In an experiment, a group of pregnant mice were each given food containing minute doses of the hormone BPA. A control group of pregnant mice were given no BPA. Offspring of mothers that had been given BPA were 10 percent bigger when weaned from their mothers than were offspring of mothers in the control group. Clearly, this result supports the hypothesis that the physical development of mice is significantly affected by prenatal exposure to BPA. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

- A. Prenatal exposure of mice to doses of BPA even smaller than those used in the experiment would not have significantly affected the physical development of the mice.
- B. At birth, there was no difference in size between offspring of mothers that had been given BPA and offspring of mothers in the control group.
- C. Postnatal exposure of mice to BPA before the mice are weaned has significant effects on the physical development of the mice.
- D. Exposure of a pregnant mouse to the doses of BPA used in the experiment does not significantly enhance its ability nurse its offspring.
- E. Significant differences in size between offspring of mothers that had been given BPA and offspring of mothers in the control group persisted long after the offspring were weaned.

Passage 193

In 1995, after an absence of nearly 70 years, wolves were reintroduced into Yellowstone National Park. During the wolf-free era, heavy browsing of aspen trees by elk populations spelled doom not only for trees themselves but for a host of other creatures dependent on them, such as beavers, whose population in Yellowstone crashed after wolves were removed. Without beavers to create ponds, wetland ecosystems—aquatic plants, amphibians, birds—were devastated. When wolves returned, grazers and browsers resumed normal patterns of behaviors, preferring safer, open areas over the dense cover and streamsides where carnivores can lurk. Keeping elk wary and on the move, wolves gave aspen and other young trees the opportunity to grow and become reestablished. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage asserts which of the following about beaver populations in Yellowstone?

- A. They have rebounded since the reintroduction of wolves.
- B. They were adversely affected by the feeding habits of elk population.
- C. They increased during the period when wolves disappeared from the park.
- D. They have historically had an adverse effect on the park's wetland ecosystems.
- E. They are essential to the health of the park's aspen trees.

2. The author would most likely agree with which of the following claims about the reintroduction of wolves to Yellowstone?

- A. It indirectly harmed some of the park's amphibian habitats.
- B. It reduced the number of elk feeding along streamsides.
- C. It led to greater species diversity among the park's grazers and browsers.
- D. It significantly increased competition for food among the park's carnivores.
- E. It fostered the resurgence of tree species that once flourished in the park's open areas.

Passage 194

Unlike herbivores and omnivores, predators have traditionally been thought not to balance nutrient intake because of the assumption that animal tissue as a food source varies little and is nutritionally balanced. But chemical analysis of invertebrate prey reveals remarkable variation in nutrient composition among species; even within species, nutrient composition may vary considerably. Greenstone suggested that predators may select food items according to their nutrient contents. Jensen et al (2011) have shown experimentally that even sit-and-wait invertebrate predators with limited mobility can work to address nutrient deficiencies. The wolf spider, for instance, has been shown to regulate nutrient intake by extracting more dry mass from a prey item if it contains a higher proportion of a nutrient that was deficient in the previous prey. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage supplies information for answering which of the following questions?
 - A. Do invertebrate predators with full mobility address nutrient needs in the same fashion as sit-and-wait invertebrate predators with limited mobility?
 - B. Why would there be a considerable variation in nutrient composition within prey of a given species?
 - C. Is all of the nutrient content of invertebrate prey contained in the dry mass?
 - D. What would a wolf spider do if a fly it was eating contained a higher proportion of a certain nutrient than was present in the spider's recent prey?
 - E. How is a wolf spider able to determine that some prey it is eating contains a higher proportion of a nutrient that was deficient in the previous prey?
2. Which of the following best describes the organization of the passage as a whole?
 - A. A phenomenon is described, and an interpretation is offered.
 - B. A claim is made, and the corroborating evidence is evaluated.
 - C. A hypothesis is presented and undermined by recent findings.
 - D. A contrast is noted and shown to be specious based on recent findings.
 - E. A series of assumptions is presented and shown to be based on sound reasoning.

Passage 195

Extensive housing construction is underway in Pataska Forest, the habitat of a large population of deer. Because deer feed at the edges of forests, these deer will be attracted to the spaces alongside the new roads being cut through Pataska Forest to serve the new residential areas. Consequently, once the housing is occupied, the annual number of the forests deer hit by cars will be much higher than before construction started. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

- A. The number of deer hit by commercial vehicles will not increase significantly when the housing is occupied.
- B. Deer will be as attracted to the forest edge around new houses as to the forest edge alongside roads.
- C. In years past, the annual number of deer that have been hit by cars on existing roads through Pataska Forest has been very low.
- D. The development will leave sufficient forest to sustain a significant population of deer.
- E. No deer hunting will be allowed in Pataska Forest when the housing is occupied.

Passage 196

Matisse's art, with its spectacular immediacy and its mysterious depths, poses confounding problems for analysis. When Hilary Spurling writes of *The Piano Lesson* that "the picture can not be confined to any single source or meaning," she might be writing of any of Matisse's works. Picasso's themes, with their collage of traditional signs and symbols, are far more susceptible to conventional iconographic analysis than anything in Matisse. Similarly, the cubism of Picasso and Braque, while rejecting traditional perspective, can nevertheless be studied as an inversion of traditional norms, using the same tools that one uses to study those norms. But the solutions that Matisse arrives at are always idiosyncratic and tend to be unrelated to any system of ideas. Intuition is his only system. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage suggests which of the following about Braque's cubism?

- A. It lends itself more readily to systematic analysis than does Matisse's work.
- B. It is more radical in terms of form than most paintings by Matisse.
- C. It was influenced by Matisse's idiosyncratic and intuitive approach.
- D. It can not be confined to any single source or meaning.
- E. It is overly dependent on traditional signs and symbols.

For the following question, consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The passage identifies which of the following as a reason that Matisse's art can confound analysis?

- A. Traditional analytical tools are not well suited to Matisse's art.
- B. Matisse's art is marked by a freedom from systematic influence.
- C. The norms that Picasso and Braque rejected were not ones that Matisse rejected.

Passage 197

Attempts to identify New Guinea's hunter-gatherers face the well-known difficulty of defining what constitutes a hunter-gatherer group. According to the **common** definition, hunter-gatherers are those who subsist by hunting wild animals and gathering wild plants. Yet those who subsist by hunting wild animals and gathering wild issue of what constitutes "wild". The very presence on a landscape of humans who are consumers affects food resources, blurring the lines between wild and domesticated and, hence, between hunting and pastoralism and between gathering and cultivation. Moreover, it is unclear how groups should be classified that are hunter-gatherers in their procurement strategies but that make use of pastoralism and cultivation in their consumption patterns—subsisting, for example, by trading wild foods to neighbors in return for domesticated crops. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to

- A. suggest that there are not as many hunter-gatherers in New Guinea as is commonly thought.
- B. explain why identifying New Guinea's hunter-gatherers is not a straightforward process.
- C. point to certain difficulties in establishing what constitutes a wild plant and a wild animal.
- D. establish new, more relevant criteria for what constitutes a hunter-gatherer group.
- E. discuss the implications of an inappropriate definition of pastoralism.

2. Replacement of the word "common" with which of the following results in the least change in meaning to the passage?

- A. trite
- B. mutual
- C. unexceptional
- D. collective
- E. conventional

Passage 198

Only since the late 1960s have literary scholars attempted to establish an accurate and systematic literary history of women novelists. Many previous histories suffered from “**Great Traditionalism**,” an approach that, by limiting itself to a group of women writers termed “great”, ignored the diversity among women novelists. These histories excluded the minor novelists, who are the links in the chain that binds literary generations together, and who allow us to see the continuities in women’s writing. Given the distortions produced by this concentration on “great” writers, as well as the obviously problematic tendency of many literary scholars to apply stereotypes of femininity, it was not surprising that **some literary scholars in the early 1960s** evaded the important issue of women’s sexual identity entirely, focusing instead on the form and style of women’s writing. Such an approach, while insightful and very valuable, did not consider the crucial connections between women’s writing and changes in their legal and economic status. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, some literary scholars in the early 1960s tended to do which of the following in their considerations of women novelists’ works?

- A. attack the traditional distinction between “great” women novelists and those women novelists considered less important
- B. consider sexual identity when evaluating the works of “great” women novelists but not the works of minor women novelists
- C. ignore the issue of the sexual identity of women novelists altogether
- D. address issues of form and style more frequently when discussing “great” women novelists than when discussing minor women novelists
- E. apply more stringent stylistic standards when evaluating minor women writers than when evaluating the group of women writers traditionally termed “great”

2. Information in the passage suggests that literary histories that adhere to “Great Traditionalism” have which of the following flaws?

- A. They overemphasize the issue of sexual identity in women’s writing.
- B. They overemphasize the degree of continuity between literary generations.
- C. They do not help to explain the connections between different generations of women novelists.
- D. They denigrate the achievements of “great” female novelists in comparison with those of male novelists.
- E. They do not incorporate the insights of literary histories produced before the late 1960s.

3. The attitude of the author of the passage toward the approach taken toward women novelists by “some literary scholars in the early 1960s” can best be described as

- A. disinterested and aloof
- B. condescending and dismissive
- C. respectful but critical
- D. favorable but brusque
- E. interested but puzzled

Passage 199

The accepted model of planetary formation holds that Jupiter-sized planets could only form in orbits much farther from their parent star than Earth is from the Sun. Recently, astronomers have detected planets, though as large as Jupiter, have orbits around stars older than the Sun that are much closer to those stars than Earth's orbit is to the Sun. Nonetheless, most astronomers continue to regard the accepted model as correct. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, provides astronomers with the strongest support for continuing to regard the accepted model of planetary formation as correct, despite the new discoveries?

- A. The instruments used to detect planets orbiting other stars are incapable of detecting planets that are smaller than Jupiter.
- B. Only a small fraction of the stars likely to have planets have been examined so far.
- C. After being formed, planets as small as Earth might be attracted to large planets, eventually becoming their satellites.
- D. There is no known reason why older stars would tend to be more likely than younger stars to have planets.
- E. Planets tend to be drawn into closer orbits of their parent star as time passes.

Passage 200

What causes size variation in bumblebee workers? In pollen storing species larvae develop in individual nest cells and are fed directly by adults. Thus, adults probably **determine** the size attained by each larva. Bumblebee larval cells are not as neatly organized as are those of honeybees, and larvae at the periphery of the brood may receive less care than a ten-fold variation in worker mass results from the accidental neglect of some larvae. Given that larvae are reared in a controlled environment by specialized nest workers, it seems more likely that this size variation has an adaptive function and that the colonies benefit from rearing workers of a range of sizes. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred that the author of the passage considers the variation in size of bumblebee workers to be
 - A. serendipitous
 - B. unpredictable
 - C. inconsequential
 - D. advantageous
 - E. unfortunate
2. In the context in which it appears, "determine" most nearly means
 - A. order
 - B. discover
 - C. control
 - D. decipher
 - E. terminate

Passage 201

Pueblo Bonito, the most impressive of the “great houses” at the prehistoric Chaco Canyon site in New Mexico, comprised over 600 rooms and 4 to 5 stories. Traditional interpretations have viewed the great houses as almost entirely residential, with some archaeologists estimating the population of Pueblo Bonito at 1,200. But Windes recently challenged this view by pointing out the paucity of hearths recorded during the excavation of Pueblo Bonito, which revealed only 3 upper-story hearths, in contrast to 59 ground-floor hearths: habitation rooms would have required hearths for cooking and heat. It is possible, however, that the collapse of upper-story floors disturbed evidence of upper-story hearths to such an extent that they were not revealed by early excavations such as those conducted by Pepper’s field crews in the 1890s and Judd’s in the 1920s. Additionally, reliance on room features for early population estimates is complicated by the Chacoan’s later remodeling, especially given Judd’s disinclination to destroy later structures and features to expose earlier ones. The failure of early excavations to strip off intact floors may have concealed evidence of hearths in upper-story rooms. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage would be most likely to agree with which of the following statements about Windes’ argument?
 - A. It relies on evidence that is irrelevant to the examination of structures as large as Pueblo Bonito.
 - B. It fails to acknowledge crucial evidence from great houses other than Pueblo Bonito.
 - C. It fails to incorporate crucial evidence from excavations before the 1920s.
 - D. It is based on a false notion about the significance of hearths.
 - E. It is based on evidence that may be incomplete.
2. It can be inferred from the passage that Windes would be most likely to agree with which of the following statements about room usage in Pueblo Bonito?
 - A. Upper-story rooms were rarely used as storage areas.
 - B. Rooms that were remodeled were most likely to have been residential rooms.
 - C. The majority of residential rooms were located on the ground floor.
 - D. Early excavations of Pueblo Bonito disturbed much of the evidence indication room usage.
 - E. Upper-story rooms with hearths were probably used for different purposes than were lower story rooms with hearths.
3. Which of the following can be inferred about the excavation work performed by Judd’s field crew?
 - A. It did not unearth many room features that existed prior to Chacoan remodeling.
 - B. It did not unearth any evidence of upper-story hearths.
 - C. It revealed only habitation rooms.
 - D. It resulted in the collapse of some room features and upper-story floors.
 - E. It confirmed traditional population estimates for Pueblo Bonito.

Passage 202

Since the 1970s, archaeological sites in China's Yangtze River region have yielded evidence of sophisticated rice-farming societies that predate signs of rice cultivation elsewhere in East Asia by a thousand years. Before this evidence was discovered, it had generally been assumed that rice farming began farther to the south. This scenario was based both on the geographic range of wild or free-living rice, which was not thought to extend as far north as the Yangtze, and on archaeological records of very early domestic rice from Southeast Asia and India (now known to be not so old as first reported). Proponents of the southern-origin theory point out that early rice-farming societies along the Yangtze were already highly developed and that evidence for the first stage of rice cultivation is missing. They argue that the first hunter-gatherers to develop rice agriculture must have done so in this southern zone, within the apparent present-day geographic range of wild rice.

Yet while most strands of wild rice reported in a 1984 survey were concentrated to the south of the Yangtze drainage, two northern outlier populations were also discovered in provinces along the middle and lower Yangtze, evidence that the Yangtze wetlands may fall within both the present-day and the historical geographic ranges of rice's wild ancestor. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following, if true, would most clearly undermine the conclusion that the author makes based on the 1984 survey?

- A. Areas south of the Yangtze basin currently have less wild-rice habitat than they once did.
- B. Surveys since 1984 have shown wild rice populations along the upper Yangtze as well as along the middle and lower Yangtze.
- C. The populations of wild rice along the Yangtze represent strains of wild rice that migrated to the north relatively recently.
- D. Early rice-farming societies along the Yangtze were not as highly developed as archaeologists once thought.
- E. In East Asia, the historical geographic range of wild rice was more extensive than the present-day geographic range is.

2. Based on the passage, skeptics of the idea that rice cultivation began in the Yangtze River region pointed to which of the following for support?

- A. lack of evidence supporting the existence of rice-farming societies along the Yangtze at an early date
- B. lack of evidence regarding the initial stages of rice cultivation in the Yangtze region
- C. recent discoveries pertaining to the historical geographic range of rice's wild ancestor
- D. new information regarding the dates of very early domestic rice from Southeast Asia
- E. new theories pertaining to how hunter-gatherers first developed rice agriculture in East Asia

3. Which of the following can be inferred from the passage about the "southern-origin theory?"

- A. The theory is based on an unconventional understanding of how hunter-gatherers first developed rice agriculture.
- B. The theory fails to take into account the apparent fact that evidence for the first stage of rice cultivation in the north is missing.
- C. The theory was developed primarily in response to a 1984 survey of wild rice's geographic range.
- D. Reassessment of the dates of some archaeological evidence has undermined support for the theory.
- E. Evidence of sophisticated rice-farming societies in the Yangtze region provides support for the theory.

Passage 203

The disappearance of Steller's sea cow from the Bering and Copper islands by 1768 has long been blamed on intensive hunting. But its disappearance took only 28 years from the time Steller first described the species, a remarkably short time for hunting alone to depopulate the islands, especially given the large populations initially reported. However, by 1750, hunters had also targeted nearby sea otter populations. Fewer otters would have allowed sea urchin populations on which the otters preyed to expand and the urchins' grazing pressure on kelp forests to increase. Sea cows were totally dependent on kelp for food, and within a decade of the onset of otter hunting. Steller noted that the islands' sea cows appeared malnourished. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following can be inferred from the passage about kelp forests in the Bering and Copper is lands between 1750 and 1768?

- A. They were reduced significantly.
- B. They disappeared entirely from the region.
- C. They were the primary food source for sea otters.
- D. They were harvested in record numbers by humans.
- E. They increased pressure on sea urchin populations.

2. According to the passage, it is likely that during the mid-1700s, sea urchin populations near the Bering and Copper islands

- A. were diminished by sea cow predation.
- B. experienced substantial increases.
- C. migrated to waters with more plentiful food supplies.
- D. were reduced by the pressures of hunting.
- E. appeared to be malnourished.

Passage 204

The conventional story of the American colonists' revolt against Britain holds that the founders of the United States established a form of government that, although flawed by its leaders' failure to recognize the rights of women and African Americans, was nevertheless unsurpassed in its promise of human equality. There is, however, a cynical counterstory, which details the founders' lust for property and their crass manipulation of the colonial population, and characterizes leaders like Thomas Jefferson as having wielded promises of equality merely as deceptive tools, discarded once the Revolution was won, and as having deliberately allowed the United States to be governed by a small, powerful elite. Both of these stories assume that a homogeneous revolutionary leadership employed an equally homogeneous egalitarian discourse to justify its actions. Even a cursory examination of the public discourse from the period, however, makes it clear that the leadership was anything but homogeneous in its discourse, and that **overall the relative emphasis placed on the words "liberty" and "property" was far greater than that placed on "equality"**. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage implies that an examination of public discourse from the Revolutionary period shows that the
 - A. revolutionary leadership was homogeneous in its attempts to justify its actions.
 - B. revolutionary leaders were more concerned with liberty and property than with equality.
 - C. revolutionary leaders initially desired to provide freedom and wealth for all colonial citizens.
 - D. colonial population was cynically manipulated into supporting the revolutionary leadership.
 - E. conventional story that the revolutionary leadership ignored the rights of women and African Americans is wrong.
2. According to the passage, which of the following best summarizes the primary difference between two accounts of the American Revolution?
 - A. The first account acknowledges the failure of the revolutionary leaders to recognize the rights of women and African Americans, while the second does not address the issue of equal rights.
 - B. The first account claims that the government succeeded in its goal of providing equal rights for all of the colonists, while the second reports that the new nation was governed by a small, powerful elite.
 - C. The first account employs traditional historical scholarship and sources, while the second reports that new nation was governed by a small, powerful elite.
 - D. The first account suggests that the revolutionary leaders sincerely promised equality, while the second reports that the leaders' false promises of equality were a deceptive means of gaining colonists' support.
 - E. The first account does not address the issue of public discourse, while the second describes how public discourse shaped the outcome of the Revolutionary War.
3. A subsequent research uncovered the following materials, which of them would most clearly call into question the position taken by the author in the highlighted portion
 - A. A speech given by Thomas Jefferson during the Revolutionary War in which he speaks about the Revolution's goal of providing all citizens with equal access to property.
 - B. Written statements by British leaders of the Revolutionary period revealing that the British monarchy continually warned its colonial subjects that the revolutionary leaders were making false promises of liberty and equality in order to gain support.
 - C. Unpublished essays by major revolutionary leaders contradicting one another with regard to the Revolution's position on human equality.
 - D. The diaries of revolutionary leaders revealing that the goals of the revolution were defined differently by different people and the leaders of the new government embraced many different ideals and principles.
 - E. A series of leaflets written by various revolutionary leaders and distributed widely among the colonial population detailing the Revolution's consistent dedication to the principles of human equality.

Passage 205

Zora Neale Hurston's 1942 autobiography, *Dust Tracks on a Road*, has received some of the most negative criticism of any of Hurston's books. Among critics' complaints—some from Hurston's warmest admirers—is the work's fragmentary nature, a nature which, while presented in other Hurston's texts, including the universally acclaimed novel *Their Eyes Were Watching God*, is particularly conspicuous in *Dust Tracks*. The complaints about *Dust Tracks* are valid if one insists on the cardinal conventions of autobiography: traditional autobiographical structure and formal organization, and a focused projection of the autobiographical persona. But *Dust Tracks* portrays a persona that resists reduction to a coherent unity—a person of many moods who is in tension with the world in which she moves. In order to correspond better to this persona, *Dust Tracks* focuses on the fragmented life of Hurston's imagination: the psychological dynamics of her family, community stories, and characters of friends. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. explain why *Dust Tracks* has been less well received than other similarly structured works by Hurston.
 - B. argue that a supposed deficiency in *Dust Tracks* actually contributes to the work's presentation of its subject.
 - C. compare the critical reaction to *Dust Tracks* with the critical reaction to *Their Eyes Were Watching God*.
 - D. point out specific similarities between the structure of *Dust Tracks* and the structure of Hurston's other works.
 - E. suggest that some critics' evaluations of *Dust Tracks* is influenced by their rejection of certain conventions of autobiography.
2. The author of the passage suggests that critics' complaints about the structure of *Dust Tracks* are
 - A. not valid, because *Dust Tracks* should not be judged by the standards of conventional autobiography.
 - B. unjustified, because they have not been directed at other Hurston texts that are similarly structured.
 - C. justified, given the extent to which *Dust Tracks* is autobiographical.
 - D. inexplicable, given the critical response to *Their Eyes Were Watching God*.
 - E. compelling, because Hurston's warmest admirers have complained the most strenuously.
3. Which of the following best describes the organization of the passage?
 - A. A situation is presented and an explanation of how that situation developed is offered.
 - B. Two opposing points of view are contrasted and their relative merits are evaluated.
 - C. An orthodox view is discussed, a challenge to it is analyzed, and the original view is affirmed.
 - D. A point of view is described and an analysis challenging that point of view follows.
 - E. A dispute is analyzed and several points of agreement between the two sides are identified.

Passage 206

African American painter Malvin Gray Johnson (1896-1934) grew up in urban environments, including New York City, but in 1934 visited and painted scenes from the small town of Brightwood, Virginia. Some critics have celebrated the Brightwood paintings, which depict a vibrant natural landscape and close-knit Black community, as Johnson's discovery of an "authentic" African American life in the rural South. This view, which reflects a common tendency to regard African American artists' imagery as unmediated documentation of direct experience, overlooks Johnson's interpretive thinking. In truth, Johnson's conceptualization of the South was largely formed before he left New York, where he had studied the French expressionist Paul Cézanne. **Johnson's Brightwood paintings reflect Cézanne's stylistic influence and tendency to present rural life as an idyllic alternative to modern industrialism.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. contest a particular interpretation of Johnson's Brightwood paintings.
 - B. compare Johnson's Brightwood paintings to French Expressionist art.
 - C. use information about Johnson's historical context to illuminate the social significance of his Brightwood paintings.
 - D. explain why the work of African American painters is sometimes misunderstood.
 - E. call attention to an aspect of Johnson's technique that has been largely overlooked.

For the following question, consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The highlighted sentence has which of the following functions in the passage?
 - A. It expands upon a point made in the previous sentence.
 - B. It helps explain a common tendency described earlier in the passage.
 - C. It identifies a way in which Johnson sought to differentiate his work from that of other artists.

Passage 207

The ability to recognize specific individuals has profound implications for the evolution of complex social behaviors such as reciprocal altruism. Many researchers assumed that recognition of individuals, a phenomenon predominantly observed in laboratory studies of fish, might also operate extensively in free-ranging fish populations, where it could underpin these complex interactions. In fact, evidence of individual recognition in free-ranging fish populations is equivocal. The possibility exists that for many species, individual recognition observed in the laboratory might be an artifact of experimental designs, which enforce prolonged interaction between individuals and which prevent the diluting effects on social structure of immigration into and emigration from the shoal, factors that in nature would erode group stability and prevent the learning of individual identities.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Click on the sentence in the passage that speculates about the effect of human intervention on an observation.

For the following question, consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The author would likely agree with which of the following statements about the prevalence of specific individual recognition that occurred in fish in the laboratory studies discussed?
 - A. It suggests that the laboratory studies were well designed to simulate the natural habitats of the fish studied.
 - B. It might have been inflated due to continued exposure to the same individuals.
 - C. It does not provide reliable evidence about the behavior of free ranging fish.

Passage 208

Hard Times, Charles Dickens' shortest novel, was written and published in 1854. Despite the sensational success of its two immediate predecessors, *David Copperfield* and *Bleak House*, and its immediate successors, *Little Dorritt* and *A Tale of Two Cities*, *Hard Times* seems to have been Dickens' least popular novel during his own lifetime and subsequently. One critic speculated that editorial cuts imposed on the novel for serialization were responsible. However, as Jane Jacobs points out, *Hard Times* was serialized in *Household Words*, a periodical that Dickens not only founded but edited. Part of the reason for the book's relative unpopularity may have been its despairing message, its depiction of pervasive emptiness in almost everything life has to offer, from marriage and family to success and community. Jacobs also suggests that the book's structure may have played a role: action is slow and scant throughout, and descriptions and conversations during the first two thirds of the book are repetitious. While the book's tone changes abruptly in the last section, when Dickens, the master storyteller, jogs his characters into life by enmeshing them in convoluted coils of plot, the reader must first endure the tedious way in which Dickens establishes the novel's settings and characters. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage suggests which of the following about the last section of *Hard Times*?
 - A. The last section compares unfavorably with the first part of the book in terms of literary quality.
 - B. In the last section the settings are presented in a more tedious fashion than is the case in other Dickens' works mentioned in the passage.
 - C. In the last section the characters tend to be more optimistic than they are in the first part of the book.
 - D. The last section is atypical of Dickens' general storytelling style.
 - E. The last section would be more likely to appeal to readers than would the first part of the book.
2. The author of the passage mentions *David Copperfield*, *Bleak House*, *Little Dorritt*, and *A Tale of Two Cities* most likely in order to
 - A. provide a context that helps to explain the public and critical reaction to *Hard Times*.
 - B. present examples of other works by Dickens that were not initially commercially successful.
 - C. suggest that *Hard Times*' lack of popularity was an anomaly during this period in Dickens' career.
 - D. imply that the quality of Dickens' writing improved over time.
 - E. question the idea that the novels immediately preceding and following *Hard Times* were extraordinarily successful.
3. Each of the following is mentioned in the passage as a possible reason for the relative unpopularity of *Hard Times* EXCEPT for the
 - A. repetitive conversations throughout most of the book
 - B. novel's depiction of marriage and family
 - C. novel's despairing message
 - D. convoluted plot development in the last part of the book
 - E. way that the novel establishes its characters

Passage 209

Was resource intensification—an increase in labor and time devoted to subsistence activities in order to increase food yields—by Dorset Paleo-Eskimos and Recent Indians on the island of Newfoundland simply a response to population pressure? Not exactly. On Newfoundland, population pressure did not result from a steadily growing resident population but, rather, from the arrival and lingering presence of new and significantly different populations. Newfoundland's hunter-gatherer populations—both resident and newcomer—adjusted to the presence of other populations through niche differentiation. Building on a tradition that emphasized marine resources, Dorset Paleo-Eskimos intensified their harvest of seals in response to the arrival of Recent Indians in the first few centuries A.D. **Recent Indians who were more familiar with broad-based, interior-maritime adaptation, intensified this strategy to cope with the Dorset.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, which of the following resulted from the arrival of the Recent Indians?
 - A. The Dorset Paleo-Eskimos were forced to compete with the Recent Indians for a limited supply of seals.
 - B. The Dorset Paleo-Eskimos spent more time harvesting seals than they had in the past.
 - C. The Dorset Paleo-Eskimos increased the amount of labor and time devoted to defending their territory.
 - D. The Dorset Paleo-Eskimos began to adopt new subsistence strategies they learned from the Recent Indians.
 - E. The previously steady growth of the Dorset Paleo-Eskimo population came to a halt.
2. Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted sentence in the context of the passage as a whole?
 - A. It points out a flaw in a theory discussed earlier in the passage.
 - B. It demonstrates the need for additional research on a phenomenon mentioned earlier in the passage.
 - C. It underscores the importance of a trait mentioned earlier in the passage.
 - D. It supports an assertion made earlier in the passage.
 - E. It questions the evidence for a tradition mentioned earlier in the passage.

Passage 210

Having a larger assortment to choose from increases consumers' expectations about matching their preferences. The heightened expectations seem logical, since assortments containing more or more varied items should increase the degree to which preferences can be matched. In practice, however, as assortment size increases, the degree to which consumers realize better preference matches often rises relatively little. Larger assortments may not actually offer more variety, the market may simply not supply an envisioned offering, or in the absence of sophisticated search tools, consumers may miss a better preference match even if it is available. Therefore, larger assortments can increase the likelihood that expectations will not be met, **leaving consumers less satisfied with options chosen from larger rather than smaller assortments.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. In the highlighted portion of the passage, the author assumes that
 - A. consumers' attitude toward the assortment of choices they are presented with depends almost exclusively on the size of the range.
 - B. consumers who have clear preferences make their choices more quickly than those whose preferences are relatively vague.
 - C. consumers' anticipation of meeting specific expectations directly affects their satisfaction with a selected option.
 - D. consumers presented with an assortment of choices often adjust the preferences they had beforehand.
 - E. consumers presented with a larger assortment of choices often make their decisions too quickly.
2. Which of the following best describes the function of the first sentence in the author's argument as a whole?
 - A. It states a premise on which the author's conclusion is based.
 - B. It provides information to support the inference made in the following sentence.
 - C. It introduces a concept that the author proves is illogical.
 - D. It summarizes a position that the author proceeds to dispute.
 - E. It presents the phenomenon the argument is intended to explain.

Passage 211

Founder mutations are a class of disease-causing genetic mutations, each derived from its own ancestral “founder” in whom the mutation originated. While most disease-causing mutated are found in humans at a rate of one in a few thousand to one in a few million people, founder mutation can occur at much higher rates. This apparent anomaly is partially explained by the fact that most founder mutations are recessive: only a person with copies of the affected gene from both parents becomes ill. Most people with only one copy of the gene—“carriers”—survive and pass the gene to offspring. Furthermore, the single copy of a founder mutation often confers a survival advantage on carriers. For example, the **hereditary hemochromatosis mutation** protects carriers from iron-deficiency anemia because the mutated gene allows increased efficiency of iron absorption. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

For the following question, consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The passage indicates which of the following about founder mutations?
 - A. Carriers of founder mutation may receive certain benefits from the mutated gene.
 - B. People who inherit founder mutations from both parents can become ill as a result.
 - C. Founder mutations are less likely than other mutations to be passed to offspring.
2. The author of the passage mentions the “hereditary hemochromatosis mutation” primarily in order to illustrate
 - A. the circumstances under which a founder mutation fails to cause a disease.
 - B. how difficult it is to predict the effects of founder mutations on carriers.
 - C. the difference between harmful founder mutation and those that are beneficial.
 - D. how a single copy of a founder mutation can benefit a carrier.
 - E. a challenge to a particular theory about the transmission of founder mutations.

Passage 212

The recently announced discovery of the first known planet orbiting a pulsar (the ultradense, pulsating remnant off the supernova explosion of a star) turned out to be based on faulty data. Had this discovery been confirmed, theorists would have had difficulty accounting for the existence of such a planet. The supernova would certainly have destroyed any preexisting planets. This particular pulsar is relatively young, allowing little time for a new planet to have coalesced, and it rotates relatively slowly, implying that it has not interacted with any nearby star since the supernova.

But newer evidence of a different pulsar with planets is more promising. This is a rapidly spurring “millisecond pulsar” thought to be a much older object that has pulled gaseous material from a stellar neighbor, causing its rotational speed to increase. Leftover, unconsumed gas around such a pulsar could, in theory, coalesce into planets. Or the pulsar’s radiation might have vaporized a companion star, providing new material for planetary formation. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to

- A. provide an example of the dangers of a recent discovery based on faulty data.
- B. illustrate the difficulty of explanation concerning a recent discovery.
- C. assess the credibility of recent findings concerning the as yet unverified existence of a class of objects.
- D. argue that a certain hypothesis fails to account for a seemingly contradictory phenomenon.
- E. demonstrate how difficult it might be to find out the reality of a phenomenon.

2. Which of the following best describe the organization of the passage?

- A. Two sets of research findings relating to similar phenomenon are mentioned, and the theoretical implication of each are discussed.
- B. A theoretical explanation of a phenomenon is presented and rejected, and a more attractive alternative is offered.
- C. Two independent and divergent interpretations of a set of observational data are compared and one is favored over the other.
- D. An example of careless scientific research is introduced and contrasted with a more rigorous analysis of the same material.
- E. The state of knowledge of an unexplainable phenomenon is outlined and an approach to further investigation is recommended.

3. Which of the following can be inferred regarding the pulsar discussed in the first paragraph?

- A. Theorists initially doubted its existence.
- B. If its existence had been confirmed, astronomers would and have turned their attention to the pulsar discussed in the second paragraph.
- C. If the supernovas explosions that created it had been more powerful, the resulting radiation would have preceded the subsequent formation of a planet.
- D. If it had interacted with a nearby star since the supernova explosion, it would rotate faster than it does.
- E. Astronomers’ interest in it ultimately led to a new theory of planetary formation.

Passage 213

There have been numerous well-documented extinctions of indigenous species caused by the introduction of nonindigenous predators and pathogens. However, surprisingly few extinctions of indigenous species can be attributed to competition from introduced species. For example, during the past 400 years, 4,000 plant species have been introduced into North America, and these nonindigenous plants currently account for nearly 20 percent of North America's plant species. Yet no evidence exists that any indigenous North American plant species became extinct as a result of competition from introduced plant species. The scarcity of documented extinctions caused by competition from new species could mean that such extinctions take longer to occur than scientists initially believed or, alternatively, that extinctions are rarely caused by competition from nonindigenous species. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is concerned primarily with

- A. pointing out that a particular type of species extinction is rarely known to occur.
- B. proposing a possible explanation for conflicting data about a particular type of species extinction.
- C. resolving a debate about the frequency of a particular type of species extinction.
- D. comparing two theories regarding possible causes of a particular type of species extinction.
- E. refuting a proposed explanation for the increasingly rare occurrence of a particular type of species extinction.

2. The author introduces statistics about North America's nonindigenous plant species primarily in order to

- A. undermine a proposed explanation for the absence of any evidence for the occurrence of a particular phenomenon.
- B. contrast the effect of introduced plant species in North America with the effect that introduced animal species have had.
- C. suggest that North America's indigenous plants are a domain in which there has been ample scope for a particular effect to have occurred.
- D. emphasize how much the ecology of North America has been affected over the past 400 years by the introduction of nonindigenous species.
- E. substantiate a claim about the overall effect that the introduction of nonindigenous species tends to have on indigenous populations.

Passage 214

Marine ecosystems certainly have less permanence than terrestrial ecosystems. Ashore, ecologists are not confronted with shifting ecological discontinuities, or with changes in the characteristic conditions of individual ecosystems, because, unless man intervenes, the tree line on a mountain or the passage between grassland and savannah remains approximately static over a human lifetime. It is only on the millennial scale that such boundaries migrate significantly, or that characteristic regional ecosystems disappear. Urban sprawl, deforestation, overgrazing, and intensive agriculture are accomplishing in a few decades what nature cannily do in centuries, but that sad fact does not alter the argument. Although the human population explosion can produce pressures that rapidly shift ecological boundaries and modify ecosystems ashore, it is paradoxically more difficult directly to modify the average locations of the ephemeral and shifting **ecological boundaries of the sea**. We can accomplish this only indirectly by atmospheric modification, resulting in a changed global climate and a shifted ocean circulation.

Indeed, if we are agreed that the regional characteristics of marine ecosystems are consequent on the characteristics of the physical environment, then we must assume that ecological conditions are as impermanent as the physical conditions themselves. And these, it is now well understood, are in continual flux and state of change at all scales of variability. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. examine differences in the threats faced by marine and terrestrial ecosystems.
 - B. explain how human intervention has affected marine and terrestrial ecosystems.
 - C. discuss a distinguishing feature of marine ecosystems.
 - D. present a debate regarding the causes of marine ecosystem impermanence.
 - E. discuss certain consequences of marine ecosystem impermanence.
2. The passage indicates which of the following about the “ecological boundaries of the sea?”
 - A. They have become increasingly sensitive to changes in global climate.
 - B. They are not significantly impacted by changes in Earth’s atmosphere.
 - C. Their stability is essential to the health of marine ecosystems.
 - D. They are more closely tied to surrounding physical conditions than are analogous boundaries on land.
 - E. They are less susceptible to direct human intervention than are analogous boundaries on land.

Passage 215

W.E.B. Du Bois' exhibit of African American history and culture at the 1900 Paris Exposition Universelle attracted the attention of a world of sociological scholarship whose value his work challenged. Du Bois believed that Spencerian sociologists failed in their attempts to gain greater understanding of human deeds because their work examined not deeds but theories and because they gathered data not to affect social progress but merely to theorize. In his exhibit, Du Bois sought to present cultural artifacts that would shift the focus of sociology from the construction of vast generalizations to the observation of particular, living individual elements of society and the working contributions of individual people to a vast functioning social structure. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage implies that Du Bois attributed which of the following beliefs to Spencerian sociologists?

- A. Theorizing is important to the understanding of human actions.
- B. Vast generalizations have limited value.
- C. Data gathering is a relatively unimportant part of sociological research.
- D. Sociology should focus on the living elements of society rather than cultural artifacts.
- E. Particulars are more important than universals.

For the following question, consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The passage implies that Du Bois believed which of the following statements about sociology?

- A. It should contribute to the betterment of society.
- B. It should study what people actually do.
- C. It should focus on how existing social structures determine individual behavior.

For the following question, consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

3. It can be inferred from the passage that Du Bois believed which of the following statements about the artifacts he included in his exhibit?

- A. They tended to support an established view of African American history and culture.
- B. They documented the contributions of particular African Americans to American social structure.
- C. They were chosen to encourage Spencerian sociologists to form useful generalizations.

Passage 216

Favorable environments do not necessarily lead to the occurrence of plant cultivation. South China is warmer and moister than North China and the Yangtze Basin, with wild rice and highly abundant natural resources. Yet archaeological data indicate that cereal cultivation did not occur in this region until approximately 7,000 to 6,500 years ago. This cultivation was likely a result of cultural contact with and expansion from the Yangtze Basin. Clearly, environmental factors were important for the occurrence of cultivation in China, but were not the absolute determining factors. While incipient cultivation might occur in areas of relatively abundant resources, it may not occur in areas of very abundant resources, such as South China, where foraging might be a more efficient way of life. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author implies which of the following about natural resources in South China prior to 6,500 years ago?

- A. Their abundance may have actually served to discourage the development of plant cultivation.
- B. They were not as abundant as most archaeologists have maintained.
- C. They led indirectly to cultural contact with peoples from the Yangtze Basin.
- D. Their importance has been downplayed by scholars studying the beginnings of plant cultivation in South China.
- E. They had little influence on the types of plants that were eventually cultivated in South China.

2. Which of the following can be inferred from the passage about plant cultivation in the Yangtze Basin?

- A. It occurred in spite of an unfavorable climate.
- B. It occurred prior to 6,500 years ago.
- C. It occurred somewhat later than it occurred in North China.
- D. It occurred largely because of the abundance of wild rice in the region.
- E. It occurred as a result of cultural contact with South China.

Passage 217

Wildcats are improbable candidates for domestication. Like all felids [cats], wildcats are obligate carnivores, meaning they have a limited metabolic ability to digest anything except proteins. Wildcats live a solitary existence and defend exclusive territories, making them more attached to places than to people. Furthermore, cats do not perform directed tasks and their actual utility is debatable; even as mousers, in this latter role, terrier dogs and ferrets are preferable.

Accordingly, there is little reason to believe an early agricultural community would have sought out and selected the wildcat as a house pet. Rather, the best inference is that wildcats exploiting human environments were simply tolerated by people and, over time and space, they gradually diverged from their “wild” relatives. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author would most likely agree that in early agricultural communities cats would have been
 - A. more tolerant than ferrets of contact with humans
 - B. as incapable of performing directed tasks as ferrets
 - C. less likely to be solitary than ferrets
 - D. less useful than terrier dogs at controlling rodents
 - E. more easily domesticated than terrier dogs
2. Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted sentence in the context of the passage as a whole
 - A. It challenges a widely accepted theory presented in the passage.
 - B. It explains a fact that has long puzzled researchers.
 - C. It draws a conclusion from evidence presented in the passage.
 - D. It presents new facts in support of a hypothesis.
 - E. It formulates a new hypothesis from evidence presented in the passage.

Passage 218

George Milner cites three primary problems with the labeling of Cahokia, the large archaeological site by the Mississippi River, as a state rather than a chiefdom. First, finds at Cahokia are essentially similar to finds at other Mississippian chiefdoms, except that the amount of earth moved in building the mounds at Cahokia was greater than elsewhere. Second, fewer people lived at Cahokia than is commonly estimated (Milner estimates that there were only a few thousand inhabitants, more common estimates are 10,000 or 20,000 inhabitants); therefore, extensive taxes, trade, and tribute were not necessary to support them. Finally, while there is evidence of extensive earth movement, craftwork, trade, and elite at Cahokia, this does not indicate that Cahokia was politically centralized, economically specialized, or aggressively expansionistic. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. underscore a characterization
 - B. outline a challenge
 - C. point out an ambiguity
 - D. discuss an oversimplification
 - E. define a category
2. The passage implies that political centralization is a feature that
 - A. has not historically tended to emerge in centers with fewer than 20,000 inhabitants
 - B. distinguished other Mississippian chiefdoms from Cahokia
 - C. is considered characteristic of state but not of chiefdoms
 - D. often results from aggressive expansionism and economic specialization
 - E. has historically been necessary for extensive trade to occur

Passage 219

Ecologists had assumed that trees in the consistently warm tropics grew at a slow but steady rate, unvarying from year to year. However, a study at La Selva, Costa Rica, showed that trees grew less in hotter years and more in cooler ones: between 1984 and 2000, dramatic differences occurred in the six species of trees studies, with trees adding twice as much wood in some cooler years as they did in the scorching El Nino year of 1997-1998. Because tree growth is an index of the balance between photosynthesis, in which trees absorb carbon dioxide (CO_2) from the atmosphere and release oxygen, and respiration, in which the opposite occurs, the La Selva data were the first hint that rapidly rising global temperatures, driven by human-generated emissions of CO_2 , may be pushing tropical forests to release more CO_2 , thereby intensifying global warming. This raised serious questions about a popular theory that tropical forests act as a sponge, soaking up much of the excess CO_2 that humans pump into the atmosphere. The La Selva data are consistent with a model of global CO_2 flux developed by Keeling, who concluded that the amount of CO_2 taken up in tropical landmasses rose in cooler years and fell in hotter ones, accounting for year-to-year changes in the amount of CO_2 that stays in the atmosphere. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. present additional evidence to support a popular theory
 - B. show the underlying similarities of two seemingly contradictory theories
 - C. point out the implications of a particular study for two related theories
 - D. provide an alternative explanation for a well-documented phenomenon
 - E. reconcile two competing theories that explain a phenomenon
2. The passage supports which of the following statements about the trees in the La Selva study?
 - A. During the El Nino year, they added considerably less wood than they did in cooler years during the period of 1984-2000.
 - B. During the El Nino year, they typically had higher rates of photosynthesis than they did in other years during the period of 1984-2000.
 - C. During the El Nino year, they released considerably more oxygen than they did in cooler years during the period of 1984-2000.
 - D. During the El Nino year, they took up considerably more CO_2 than they did in cooler years during the period of 1984-2000.
 - E. The amount of CO_2 that they absorbed remained constant throughout the entire period of 1984-2000.
3. The passage suggests that as temperatures rise, trees in the tropical regions
 - A. continue to grow at a slow but steady rate
 - B. grow less and intensify photosynthesis
 - C. emit more CO_2 and oxygen
 - D. increase overall respiration and decrease overall photosynthesis
 - E. grow more and absorb more CO_2

Passage 220

In the 2,000-year period immediately before European contact, many native groups of the Northern Plains of North America specialized in big-game hunting, subsisting primarily on bison. Bison routinely became fat-depleted in the spring, reducing their nutritional value, yet these groups did not supplement their diets with the nutritious, fat-rich fish that were abundantly available. Malainey et al. find a possible explanation in late-eighteenth and early-nineteenth century accounts from three frontiersmen who had adapted to lean-meat diets during extended periods in the plains. Each had an opportunity to consume fish after extended meat dependence and upon eating it, became weak and ill. Malainey notes that prolonged lean meat dependence renders the body incapable of digesting lipids (fats), perhaps explaining native hunters' fish avoidance. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage mentions accounts from three white frontiersmen primarily in order to
 - A. show how the frontiersmen's dietary choices were influenced by the native groups with whom they came into contact.
 - B. suggest that these frontiersmen had not adapted well to a diet composed primarily of lean meat.
 - C. indicate what kind of diet was habitually followed by native big-game hunters of the Northern Plains.
 - D. identify evidence for a hypothesis regarding native hunters' fish avoidance.
 - E. call into question an assumption about the effects of fish consumption on people who have adapted to a lean-meat diet.
2. Select the sentence that describes the phenomenon that the passage is concerned with finding an explanation for.

Passage 221

Migratory songbirds breeding in Eurasia's temperate forests depend on a summer flush of insects, particularly caterpillars, to feed themselves and their offspring. In some places, these caterpillars are emerging earlier in responses to rising global temperatures. **In theory, the songbirds could simply push up their departure from their winter quarters to catch the earlier flush of insect prey.** If, however, the birds rely on a fixed cue such as increasing day length to begin flying north, they may be unable to adjust the timing of their migration. Precisely this disruption in the emergence of insects relative to the timing of songbird migration has been identified as the cause of a significant decline in populations of pied flycatchers in the Netherlands. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary function of the highlighted sentence is to
 - A. refute the legitimacy of an earlier claim.
 - B. hypothesize about a response to a particular situation.
 - C. point out a distinction between two theories.
 - D. present an explanation for a shifting environment.
 - E. illustrate a problem by providing an example.
2. According to the passage, populations of insects preyed upon by pied flycatchers.
 - A. are finding less food as temperatures rise in the Eurasian forests that they inhabit
 - B. are endangered because of global warming
 - C. have recently experienced changes in the timing of their life cycles relative to the calendar
 - D. have recently begun inhabiting cooler climates largely unfrequented by pied flycatchers.
 - E. have increased significantly because of lack of predation.

Passage 222

Widespread climate change challenges traditional notions that preserving specific chunks of land is an adequate way to protect endangered species. Commitment to particular places has taken conservation a long way, but it works only when the climate is relatively stable. When climate change rather than degraded habitat threatens a species' survival in a particular location, moving the species to new locales might become one way of preserving it. Some ecologists argue that such assisted migration is simply a way to mimic the natural process of dispersal: its adherents intend to transport species from places that have become uninhabitable through places that humans have made impassable. Although it has its risks, assisted migration may be a necessary step in the evolution of conservation. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage implies that some endangered species are unlikely to migrate naturally to habitats better suited to their survival because
 - A. climate change is making such habitats disappear
 - B. few if any viable routes to such habitats exist
 - C. the pace of natural migration is typically slower than the current pace of climate change
 - D. their numbers are already below the thresholds necessary for the typically random processes of natural dispersal
 - E. their dependency on their current habitats is too strong
2. The passage suggests that, in order to adapt to changing conditions, conservationists should
 - A. reformulate their goals regarding the preservation of species
 - B. turn their attention to reversing climate change
 - C. end the practice of labeling certain species as endangered
 - D. reconsider the measures they use to protect endangered species
 - E. rely on natural processes of dispersal and change

Passage 223

The North American red squirrel has expanded its range into Indiana in conjunction with an increase in the fragmentation of forests due to agriculture and with a decrease in the number of gray squirrels, whose population is sensitive to forest fragmentation. Red squirrels tend to hoard food in a central location, while gray squirrels are scatter hoarders. Burial of nuts by scatter hoarders is highly beneficial for the regeneration of nut-producing trees. Red squirrels would have to collect 1,000 walnuts to achieve the same germination success that results from the handling of 150 walnuts by gray squirrels. If red squirrels successfully colonize the fragmented landscapes of Indiana in response to decreasing numbers of gray squirrels, they may not compensate completely for the loss of gray squirrels as seed dispersers. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage implies that compared with gray squirrels red squirrels
 - A. are less effective seed dispersers
 - B. are less successful colonizers
 - C. are more efficient at scatter-hoarding
 - D. do not bury as many nuts
 - E. do not collect as many nuts
2. Select the sentence in the passage that provides an illustration of a claim stated elsewhere in the passage.

Passage 224

Norman Rockwell was the most popular illustrator in the United States during the mid-twentieth century, yet no important artist of his time showed interest in his work. This prompts the question: how good an artist was Rockwell? His technique is an adaptation of standard nineteenth-century verismo (an artistic movement marked by use of common everyday themes), competent but undistinguished. While he had an acute sense of gesture and facial expression, his anatomical competence was limited. In *No Swimming* (1921), for example, there is a bit of leg visible between the legs of the central figure that belongs to the boy lagging behind, but it is so shapeless that one cannot be considered a sophisticated perversion of expressive purposes as, for example, would the elastic spine in Ingres's *Grande Odalisque*. However, Rockwell's work does exhibit a genius in its fastidiousness about the absolute justness of every expression and its precise positioning of each prop. It is this attention to detail that renders unforgettable his best images, such as the open mouth in the form of an O of the little who has just discovered that there is no Santa Claus. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is primarily concerned with
 - A. describing a change in the reputation of a particular artist.
 - B. suggesting that the work of particular artist has been overrated
 - C. evaluating the skill of particular artist.
 - D. placing the work of a particular artist in its historical context.
 - E. contrasting two view of particular artist.
2. It can be inferred that the author of the passage would probably agree with which of the following statements about Rockwell's work?
 - A. Rockwell's work was evaluated fairly by the important artists of the mid-twentieth century.
 - B. Rockwell's work was dismissed by many of his mid-twentieth-century contemporaries because they considered it primarily a product of popular culture rather than high art.
 - C. Although Rockwell's work lacked artistic merit, it is important for what it reveals about mid-twentieth-century culture.
 - D. Although Rockwell's work was rejected by his contemporaries, he is now considered one of the most important artists of the mid-twentieth century.
 - E. Although Rockwell's work demonstrated a lack of certain skills, it does have qualities that make it worthy of appreciation.
3. Select the sentence in the passage that indicates Rockwell's artistic reputation among his contemporaries.

Passage 225

Ecologists study how millions of species share the world, rather than take on the whole planet at once; they generally focus on a single ecosystem, be it a prairie, a tidal flat, or a sand dune. Even within those limits, they are frustrated by **porous frontiers**. As a result, ecologists have done some of their most important work on islands, nature's own **isolated** laboratories, which may be colonized only a few times over the course of millions of years. On them, ecologists have figured out how the size of a given habitat determine how many species it can support. They have then applied that knowledge to the mainland, showing how fragmented ecosystems become like archipelagoes, where extinctions can strike. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred that the term "porous frontiers" is used to refer to
 - A. a tendency for the area of an ecosystem to shrink
 - B. human-caused processes that alter the character of an ecosystem
 - C. movement of species into an ecosystem from outside
 - D. variation in what the term "ecosystem" signifies
 - E. lack of protection for endangered habitats
2. In the context in which it appears, "isolated" most nearly means
 - A. completely uncontaminated
 - B. somewhat unusual
 - C. extremely rare
 - D. relatively inaccessible
 - E. strictly confined

Passage 226

The border decoration in medieval manuscripts referred to as pen flourishing reached great artistic heights in the northern Netherlands in the 1400s. The regional variants in form that evolved make flourishing a useful tool for localizing and roughly dating manuscripts. When the first printed books appeared in that region, many copies were still traditionally decorated by hand with such flourishing. Since books' publication can usually be dated with far more accuracy than manuscripts, studying these decorations in early printed books might lead to a more precise dating of the penwork in manuscripts. It is of less help in localizing the flourishing. **Upon completion, copies of printed books were often sold unadorned, to be decorated elsewhere as commissioned by their buyers.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted sentence?
 - A. It points out a difficulty involved in studying pen flourishing.
 - B. It restates an assertion about the first printed books.
 - C. It corrects a misconception regarding the decoration of manuscripts.
 - D. It provides support for a claim about the dating of printed books.
 - E. It summarized an argument about how to interpret certain type of penwork.
2. According to the passage, pen flourishing in manuscripts can provide historians with valuable information about
 - A. who commissioned the manuscript
 - B. the source from which the manuscript was copied
 - C. the value placed on the contents of the manuscript
 - D. where the manuscript was produced
 - E. the collaborative process used to produce the manuscript

Passage 227

Early in the twentieth century, San Francisco was the main venue for African American jazz musicians on the West Coast of the United States. Musical activity was centered in a district known as the Barbary Coast, where an abundance of nightclubs provided ample work opportunities for local players and drew musicians and other entertainers, many of them African American, from throughout the country. In 1921, as part of its Prohibition-era efforts, the government closed the Barbary Coast. This closure was the decisive event that established Los Angeles as the premier center for jazz on the West Coast. Once the Barbary Coast was shut down, it became far harder for jazz musicians to make a living in San Francisco; thus, many headed south to Los Angeles. Yet even before that closing, the center of jazz activity had begun to swing southward. With the largest and fastest growing African American urban community in the West, as well as the growing movie industry and an emerging recording industry, Los Angeles was already a magnet for jazz musicians from other parts of the country, especially New Orleans, where jazz players suffered a devastating blow with closing of the Storyville district in 1917. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to

- A. point out the parallel effects on jazz music of governmental actions in San Francisco and New Orleans
- B. offer an alternative to the standard explanation for the decline of San Francisco as a jazz center
- C. argue for the importance of Californian cities in the development of jazz
- D. present and refute an argument about the reasons for a demographic shift in jazz activity
- E. outline the factors that contributed to a change in the Geographical locus of jazz activity

2. The passage cites which of the following as a factor helping to explain San Francisco's preeminence as a center for jazz music on the West Coast early in the twentieth century?

- A. the number of job opportunities for musicians in San Francisco's nightclub district
- B. the efforts by the government to enforce Prohibition in San Francisco
- C. the existence of venues for many different types of jazz in the San Francisco area
- D. the relative accessibility of San Francisco, as compared to Los Angeles, for musicians from elsewhere in the country
- E. the fact that San Francisco at that time had a larger African American population than Los Angeles

3. It can be inferred from the passage that, for African American musicians, which of the following became an advantage of Los Angeles over San Francisco only after 1921?

- A. It became easier to travel to Los Angeles than to San Francisco.
- B. Prohibition had less impact on the availability of work opportunities in Los Angeles.
- C. Nightclubs in Los Angeles offered better pay to jazz musicians than did nightclubs in San Francisco.
- D. The movie industry in Los Angeles became an important source of employment for jazz musicians.
- E. The African American community in Los Angeles began to expand rapidly.

Passage 228

A recent exhibition of works by late-nineteenth-century painters Mary Cassatt, Berthe Morisot, and Eva Gonzales offered a rich visual **counterpart to** studies focusing new attention on the social and ideological forces that influenced their work. The paintings by Gonzales were particularly illuminating. Long marginalized by scholars as little more than an apprentice of Edouard Manet, Gonzales is revealed by the exhibition as possessing remarkable, if uneven, talents. Given the exhibition's focus, and especially the provocative new emphasis on Gonzales, the accompanying catalog proved disappointing. There often-quoted essays by critics contemporary to the artists—essays in themselves noteworthy but historical artifacts nonetheless—provided the exhibition with its only critical readings. Thus, a significant opportunity for scholarly debate was not only lost but even seemed pointedly avoided. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Select the sentence in which the author describes and counters an assessment of a particular artist.
2. In the context in which it appears, “counterpart to” most nearly means
 - A. duplicate of
 - B. alternate to
 - C. complement to
 - D. opposite of
 - E. emblem of

Passage 229

Between 1970 and 1980, energy consumption by United States industry peaked and then declined, so that by 1980 total industrial use of energy was below the 1970 level even though total industrial output had grown substantially in the same period. Industry must have instituted highly effective energy conservation measures in those years to have achieved such impressive results. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the conclusion of the argument?
- A. Many industries switched to the greatest extent possible from high-priced oil to lower-priced alternatives throughout the 1970s.
 - B. Total residential energy consumption was higher in the United States in 1980 than it had been in 1970.
 - C. Many industrial users of energy had paid little attention to energy conservation prior to 1970.
 - D. Industrial output grew less rapidly from 1970 to 1980 than it had from 1960 to 1970.
 - E. The industries whose production dropped sharply during the 1970s included a disproportionately large number of energy-intensive industries.

Passage 230

In the shallow end of Lake Tomwa, there are remains of numerous Jeffery pine trees that grew there during a lengthy drought. Researchers had believed that this drought lasted at least 150 years, but carbon dating reveals that pines were growing in the lake bed for only 120 years, from 1200 until 1320. Since the Jeffery pines, which cannot survive in water, must have died at the end of the drought, the dating shows that the drought lasted less than 150 years. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

The argument given relies on which of the following as an assumption?

- A. No other species of tree started growing in the bed of Lake Tomwa after 1200.
- B. No tree remains of any kind are present at the bottom of deeper parts of Lake Tomwa.
- C. There was at least one tree in the lake bed that was alive for the entire period from 1200 to 1320.
- D. There has not been a more recent drought that caused a drying up of the shallow end of the lake.
- E. The shallow end of the lake had been dry for less than 30 years by the time Jeffery pines started growing in the lake bed.

Passage 231

When on an airplane, Consuelo never enjoys movies that have been widely recommended because the poor quality of the picture spoils her enjoyment. Since in no circumstances does she ever enjoy movies that have been widely derided, it follows that she never enjoys movies on airplanes. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, would enable the conclusion of the argument to be properly drawn?

- A. The only place where Consuelo enjoys widely recommended movies is a movie theater.
- B. Widely recommended movies are never shown on airplane.
- C. If a movie shown on an airplane is not widely derided, then it is invariably widely recommended.
- D. If the picture quality of the movies shown on airplanes was better, Consuelo would enjoy the widely recommended movies.
- E. Some movies are neither widely recommended nor widely derided.

Passage 232

Recently an unusually high number of dolphins have been found dead of infectious diseases, and most of these had abnormally high tissue concentrations of certain compounds that, even in low concentrations, reduce dolphins' resistance to infection. The only source of these compounds in the dolphins' environment is boat paint. Therefore, since dolphins rid their bodies of the compounds rapidly once exposure ceases, their mortality rate should decline rapidly if such boat paints are banned. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the argument?

- A. The levels of the compounds typically used in boat paints today are lower than they were in boat paints manufactured a decade ago.
- B. In high concentrations, the compounds are toxic to many types of marine animals.
- C. The compounds break down into harmless substances after a few months of exposure to water or air.
- D. High tissue levels of the compounds have recently been found in some marine animals, but there is no record of any of those animals dying in unusually large numbers recently.

E. The compounds do not leach out of the boat paint if the paint is applied exactly in accordance with the manufacturer's directions.

Passage 233

Iridium, a hard, whitish metal similar to platinum, is extremely rare on Earth. Extremely high concentrations of iridium on Earth result from only two scenarios: massive volcanic eruptions that release iridium from deep within the Earth and meteorites that shower down on Earth from space. When scientists found concentrations of iridium 30 times higher than normal in rock stratum from 65 million years ago, they concluded that a massive meteor or comet hit the Earth and caused the massive extinction of the dinosaurs. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most strongly supports the scientists' conclusion?

- A. Volcanoes massive enough to generate high concentrations of iridium are very rare.
- B. Massive volcanic eruptions occurred frequently 80 million years ago.
- C. Most scientists support the hypothesis that a cosmic impact wiped out the dinosaurs.
- D. The massive extinction that occurred 70 million years ago killed not only the dinosaurs but also 70 percent of all life on Earth.
- E. A comet struck the earth some 120 million years ago, but no widespread extinction occurred.

Passage 234

Upon maturity, monarch butterflies travel hundreds of miles from their places of origin and lay their eggs on milkweed. The caterpillars that emerge feed on milkweed and absorb the glycosides in milkweed sap. The specific glycosides present in milkweed differ from region to region within the monarch butterfly's range. Since mature butterflies retain the glycosides, the glycosides in a mature monarch butterfly could be used to determine its place of origin. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the argument?

- A. Mature monarch butterflies do not feed on parts of milkweed that contain glycosides.
- B. The glycosides in milkweed sap are slightly toxic to caterpillars of other species.
- C. The vast majority of the monarch butterflies that are laying eggs in a given region will have traveled there from a single region.
- D. There are substances other than glycosides in milkweed sap that accumulate in a monarch caterpillar and are retained in the body of the mature butterfly.
- E. There are certain glycosides that are found in the sap of all milkweeds, no matter where they grow within the monarch butterfly's range.

Passage 235

When rats are placed under conditions of stress, their adrenal glands immediately increase production of the hormone corticosterone, and soon thereafter the rats' white blood cell count drops substantially. Yet rats without functioning adrenal glands experience little decrease in white blood cell count when placed under conditions of stress. It is likely, therefore, that an increase in corticosterone produced by a rat's adrenal glands causes the rat's white blood cell count to decrease. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following would it be most useful to know in evaluating the reasoning of the argument?

- A. Whether the drop in white blood cell count that occurs in rats under conditions of stress is sufficient to make the rats more susceptible to diseases that white blood cells normally combat
- B. Whether normal white blood cell counts vary widely among healthy rats that are not under conditions of stress
- C. Whether the adrenal glands of rats that are under conditions of stress increase production of any hormone other than corticosterone
- D. Whether the adrenal glands of rats produce elevated levels of corticosterone on occasions when the rats are not under conditions of stress
- E. Whether rats' adrenal glands are affected by hormones produced by any of the rats' other organs.

Passage 236

Some psychologists have proposed the hypothesis that children in different cultures have different psychologies, demonstrated, for example, by culture-specific tendencies for the children's behavior to be relatively self-assertive or obedient. However, that hypothesis is incorrect, since the psychological mechanisms by which children acquire behavioral traits are identical for all cultures.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

In the argument, the author's position and the position challenged by the author differ in the criteria they use to distinguish different

- A. behaviors
- B. cultures
- C. mechanisms
- D. psychologies
- E. traits

Passage 237

Scholars have tended to treat the ideas of American social reformer Jane Addams as unique, failing to compare them sufficiently with those of other social activists and public intellectuals. Recent work, however, has situated her more thoroughly in the thinking and events of her time. For example, labor historians have usefully contextualized Addams' close work with labor unions in the 1890s. When Addams' interest in the workers' reform agenda is understood in relation to the **history of trade unionism in Chicago** and its impressive record of political action, her contribution emerges as far more cooperative than groundbreaking. Workers influenced her in ways not preciously appreciated. Such contextualizing efforts make it possible to see what Addams learned from other reformers and what she contributed herself. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. criticize Addams for not realizing the extent of her debt to other social activists and public intellectuals
 - B. describe how scholars have misunderstood Addams' ideas regarding social reform
 - C. outline a debate within the historical community regarding Addams' approach to social reform
 - D. emphasize the importance of placing Addams' work in a larger framework of reform and activism
 - E. discuss the impact of Addams' close work with labor union on working conditions in the 1890s
2. The author refers to the "history of trade unionism in Chicago" primarily as
 - A. an issue that has been largely ignored by historians
 - B. an issue that has inspired contention among historians
 - C. a model for how trade unionists might engage in political action
 - D. an area in which Addams' contributions have been underestimated
 - E. a valuable context for understanding the nature of Addams' contributions

Passage 238

Because different mammalian species favor different environments, identifying and counting bones from prehistoric deposits in caves can reveal much about climatic change. However, using large mammals' bones can be problematic. Some species, such as red deer, are very adaptable—both on open grassland and in thick woodland. Moreover, some large-animal bones may have traveled considerable distances before being discarded: both carnivores and humans can have large hunting territories and bring home large animals quite unlike those near their den or campsite. Consequently, the bones of the small mammals found with cave sediments provide a better index of climate change. They are generally more numerous, the species are more sensitive to environmental conditions, and few travel far within their short lives. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The passage mentions which of the following as an obstacle to using animal bones to reconstruct past climate changes?
 - A. The size of some carnivorous species' hunting territories
 - B. The range over which some small mammals travel
 - C. The ability of some species to thrive in multiple types of environment
2. The passage mentions "red deer" as an instance of an animal that
 - A. is likely to be transported long distances by carnivores or human
 - B. is frequently represented in prehistoric bone deposits
 - C. can be used to reconstruct past climate changes
 - D. can travel considerable distances over the course of its life
 - E. yields limited information about past environmental conditions

Passage 239

Seeding a forest with nonnative species after a fire can impede native plant regeneration and spread invasive species in vulnerable fire-affected soils. Moreover, native seed sources are almost always sufficient for early nature reestablishment of native species, so planting should be considered only when natural regeneration is unlikely. Replanting dense stands of fast-growing conifers—a common postfire management practice—truncates the biologically rich early stage of ecological succession and can increase the severity of future fires. Other treatments should be carefully scrutinized for their potential to spread noxious weeds. For instance, straw much applied extensively to reduce erosion after the 2002 Hayman Fire in Colorado was contaminated with cheatgrass, an invasive grass difficult to control or eradicate once established. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. According to the passage, which of the following is a consequence of replanting an area with dense stands of fast-growing conifers after a fire?

- A. The normal progression of ecological development will be affected.
- B. The conifers will be slower growing than if they had been less densely planted.
- C. Subsequent fires may be more severe than they would have been if such a replanting had not been done.

2. The passage implies which of the following about native plant regeneration in forests after a fire?

- A. It is hampered by the changed nature of the fire-affected soils.
- B. It will generally occur without the human interventions of reseeding or replanting.
- C. The likelihood of its success increases when forest managers have on hand a good supply of native seed sources.
- D. Native plants will inevitably have to compete with nonnative plants.
- E. The earlier nature reestablishment occurs, the more complete it will be.

Passage 240

In the late 1990s, the Mars Global Surveyor spacecraft detected magnetized patches of terrain near the north pole of Mars and also in the Terra Sirenum region, which is in the planet's southern hemisphere. These magnetic features may be relics of a global magnetic field in the vicinity of several huge, ancient craters in the Terra Sirenum region. Astronomers believe these craters were formed some 3.8 billion years ago from the impact of **chunks of debris** pelting the **inner solar system**, where Mars orbits the Sun. If a global magnetic field once existed on Mars, it must have vanished before these craters formed. Such large impacts beat rock to temperatures well above 600 degrees Celsius—high enough to erase any magnetic field that metallic particle within the rock strong at the time the craters formed, it would have realigned and remagnetized the articles as they cooled. **The Surveyor findings thus suggest the magnetic field vanished early in the planet's 4.5 billion year existence.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, astronomers believe which of the following about the “chunks of debris”?
 - A. They may have destroyed a global magnetic field that once existed on Mars.
 - B. They affected Mars more substantially than other planet in the inner solar system.
 - C. Some of them contained a higher concentration of metallic particles than did rocks on Mars.
 - D. Some of them caused craters that exist in the Terra Sirenum region of Mars.
 - E. Few of them were large enough to cause impacts that would beat rocks to 600 degrees Celsius.
2. The author's conclusion in the final sentence of the passage is based in part on which of the following points?
 - A. Elsewhere on Mars there are likely to be patches of magnetized terrain similar to those that the Mars Global Surveyor detected.
 - B. Planets other than Mars could have been affected by the chunks of debris that pelted the inner solar system 3.0 billion years ago.
 - C. A global magnetic field on Mars could have remagnetized metallic particles that had lost their magnetic field.
 - D. Not all collisions between debris chunks and planets result in the formation of craters.
 - E. Impacts much smaller than the ones that probably created the craters in the Terra Sirenum region do not heat rocks to temperatures above 600 degrees Celsius.
3. The author of the passage mentions the “inner solar system” in the course of
 - A. explaining how Mars may have acquired a global magnetic field
 - B. explaining how scientists estimate the probable age of Mars
 - C. accounting for the size and location of magnetized patches of terrain detected on Mars
 - D. casting doubt on one possible explanation for the disappearance of a global magnetic field on Mars
 - E. relating how features of the surfaces

Passage 241

Astronomers occasionally detect gamma-ray bursts in the sky. Matter crashing onto neutron stars in our galaxy would emit gamma-ray bursts with durations and intensities like those of the bursts observed by astronomers. Therefore, such interactions between matter and neutron stars are, plausibly, the explanation for these bursts. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most strongly undermines the proposed explanation for gamma-ray bursts?

- A. Astronomers first detected gamma-ray bursts in 1973, whereas neutron stars were known to exist several decades before that.
- B. Astronomers believe that neutron stars are the remnants of stars that once violently exploded and ejected most of their constituent matter.
- C. Gamma-ray bursts vary in duration from as little as a thousandth of a second to more than 100 seconds.
- D. Gamma-ray bursts occur just as often in regions of the sky where neutron stars are thought not to exist as they do where neutron stars are known to exist.
- E. Some neutron stars emits short pulses of radio waves, which are known to be of lower frequency than gamma rays.

Passage 242

Paintings of property—anything that was possessed—such as those created by eighteenth-century British painter George Stubbs were condemned by several of Stubbs's contemporaries: objects thus “individualized” would appeal to our appetite to own and enjoy them, whereas “generalized” objects in other paintings were no longer merely things but abstract ideas. To collect or commission **paintings displaying lofty unconcern with materiality** was considered by these commentators a mark of taste and civic virtue, the ability to subordinate private material interests to the abstract, public interest. Yet this notion of disinterested taste and virtue was founded on private interest: it was because the “public” man or woman already owned enough that he or she was presumed to be free from the urge to own more. Political power and status were thus based on the ownership of property, while at the same time they were legitimated by the claim that the avaricious behavior associated with the acquisition of property was somehow transcended by those who had already acquired it. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describes the relationship of the first sentence to the passage as a whole?
 - A. It introduces a topic that is then placed in historical context.
 - B. It introduces two contradictory approaches that are ultimately reconciled.
 - C. It presents an argument that is then strengthened by evidence.
 - D. It argues in favor of a position that is subsequently modified.
 - E. It describes a viewpoint whose inconsistencies are later probed.
2. With which of the following statements about “paintings displaying lofty unconcern with materiality” would the author be most likely to agree?
 - A. Only the property-rich collector could appreciate paintings of this type.
 - B. Such paintings demonstrated the collector's degree of taste and civic virtue.
 - C. Such paintings were often collected by people who were quite property-rich.
 - D. Collectors of such paintings often displayed them for the public's benefit.
 - E. Collectors of such paintings were, as a class, the most avaricious members of their society.
3. According to the passage, which of the following is true about the painting of property as it is described in the passage?
 - A. It was typified in the work of George Stubbs.
 - B. It was usually commissioned by persons who had great political power.
 - C. It was regarded in the eighteenth century as a mark of good taste.
 - D. It was at its most popular in eighteenth-century Britain.
 - E. It was advocated primarily by those who owned a great deal of property.
4. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. examine the origins of a particular style of painting
 - B. analyze the paintings of a particular school
 - C. point out the weakness that underlies a criticism
 - D. compare two different approaches to the painting of objects
 - E. rebut a criticism of a particular painter's integrity

Passage 243

Typical of Argentine melodrama of the 1930s were the films starring Libertad Lamarque, the genre's biggest box-office attraction. Her most frequent role was that of the tango singer whose romance with a wealthy suitor is blocked by his elitist family. Despite its widespread social acceptance by the 1930s, tango continued to be associated in film melodramas with criminality and vice. As Diana Paladino remarks, in these films, "the tango songstress was doomed from the start." Nevertheless, if melodramatic logic dictated that Lamarque be punished for the transgressive act of singing tango, surely that judgment was not shared by the members of the audience, many of whom were drawn to her early movies precisely because of her fame as a tango singer. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following claims about Lamarque can be inferred from the passage?
 - A. She considered herself to be primarily a tango singer rather than a movie actor.
 - B. By the end of her movie career, she was exercising considerable control over the writing and direction of her films.
 - C. Her personality differed greatly from those of the characters she portrayed in films.
 - D. Her popularity as a tango singer preceded her popularity as an actor.
 - E. She continued to act in movies after she had ceased performing as a tango singer.
2. According to the author of the passage, which of the following is true about the tango?
 - A. By the time Lamarque starred in films as a tango singer, the tango was socially acceptable.
 - B. Outside Argentina the tango's reputation was quite different from what prevailed in Argentina.
 - C. The tango began to gain popularity in Argentina once it became an element in melodramatic films.
 - D. By the 1930s, no one in Argentina associated the tango with criminality and vice.
 - E. Until the 1930s, the tango was primarily thought of as a dance form rather than as a genre of song.

Passage 244

Progressivism, the wave of reform movements in the early twentieth century whose stated intention was to make United States society more democratic, has undergone significant scholarly reevaluation by historians over the years. In the 1960s, leftist scholars dismissed progressive reform as a mask for the empowerment of individuals forming a corporate, capitalist elite. In the two subsequent decades, many scholars began to question whether there was any such thing as progressivism; the phenomenon seemed so diverse and amorphous that the word itself, some claimed, had no meaning. In the early 1990s, however, the tone, if not always the substance, of historical accounts of progressivism changed again. Although some scholars admitted that progressivism was diverse, they insisted that there is an identifiable “**progressive minimum**,” a core of belief and action that lends coherence to the concept. Further, some scholars, while acknowledging that progressivism had some conservative and even reactionary results, argue that the motives behind many of the reform movements of the era were genuinely democratic. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following most accurately describes the organization of the passage?
 - A. A theory is proposed, refuted, and then amended.
 - B. The thesis of the passage is stated and several views for and against that thesis are compared and contrasted.
 - C. Opposing views are presented, classified, and then reconciled.
 - D. An assertion is made and an elaboration of that assertion is provided.
 - E. An argument is advanced and evidence is presented to refute it.
2. According to the passage, the term “progressive minimum” is used by scholars who have
 - A. determined the quintessential elements of reform movements in general
 - B. claimed that progressivism was a movement grounded in a set of common beliefs
 - C. underrated the impact and historical significance of progressivism
 - D. defined progressivism as a unified effort led by a core of proponents
 - E. questioned the basic motivation underlying the inception of progressivism
3. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. analyze the early-twentieth-century sociopolitical environment of the United States
 - B. affirm the profound differences among reformist groups contending for power in the early-twentieth-century United States
 - C. explain a radical approach to promoting democracy in the early twentieth-century United States
 - D. argue that the results achieved by several decades of reform activity begun in the early-twentieth-century United States were paradoxical
 - E. trace the course of inquiry over time regarding an aspect of early twentieth-century United States history

Passage 245

Native American music is unique in the world in having almost no string instruments. The fretless, single-string violin of Mexico's Seri Indians is therefore often remarked on in studies of Native American music. Most scholars assume that the Seri violin descended from the European violin. **The Spanish introduced a variety of string instruments to Mexico following the conquest (1519), and these subsequently spread widely in many forms.** However, Helen Roberts questions other scholars' arguments that Mexican string instruments could not have preconquest origins **simply** because they are not mentioned by early Spanish sources and do not appear in indigenous Mexican illustrations. Roberts argues that because of their low volume, string instruments would not have been used in loud group contexts such as those depicted in Mexican manuscripts. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. In the context in which it appears, "simply" most nearly means
 - A. artlessly
 - B. frankly
 - C. ordinarily
 - D. slightly
 - E. just
2. It can be inferred from the passage that the view held by most scholars regarding the origins of the Seri violin is based in part on
 - A. differences between the Seri violin and European violins
 - B. the rarity of string instruments among Native American peoples
 - C. the fact that the Seri violin lacks frets and has only a single string
 - D. a resemblance between the Seri violin and Spanish string instruments of the sixteenth century
 - E. the means by which string instruments spread in Mexico following the conquest
3. The passage suggests that in Roberts' view, the Seri violin
 - A. may be represented in Mexican manuscripts that have yet to be found
 - B. was probably modeled on string instruments introduced to Mexico by the Spanish
 - C. was not likely to have been in use prior to the Spanish conquest of Mexico
 - D. was best suited for playing in relatively quiet settings
 - E. was probably capable of greater volume than most scholars have assumed
4. Which of the following best describes the purpose of the highlighted sentence in the passage as a whole?
 - A. It introduces an alternative to a widely held view.
 - B. It casts doubt on a point made in the first sentence of the passage.
 - C. It explains why scholars disagree about a particular issue.
 - D. It cites evidence overlooked by scholars previously mentioned in the passage.
 - E. It suggests a reason for the assumption mentioned in the preceding sentence.

Passage 246

Geographers and historians have traditionally held the view that Antarctica was first sighted around 1820, but some sixteenth-century European maps show a body that resembles the polar landmass, even though explorers of the period never saw it. Some scholars, therefore, argue that the continent must have been discovered and mapped by the ancients, whose maps are known to have served as models for the European cartographers. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, is most damaging to the inference drawn by the scholars?

- A. The question of who first sighted Antarctica in modern times is still much debated and no one has been able to present conclusive evidence.
- B. Between 3,000 and 9,000 years ago, the world was warmer than it is now, and the polar landmass was presumably smaller.
- C. There are only a few sixteenth-century global maps that show a continental landmass as the South Pole.
- D. Most attributions of surprising accomplishments to ancient civilizations or even extra terrestrials are eventually discredited or rejected as preposterous.
- E. Ancient philosophers believed that there had to be a large landmass at the South Pole to balance the northern continents and make the world symmetrical.

Passage 247

One of the legends that has been attached to the nineteenth century writer Edgar Allan Poe is that he was addicted to morphine. Poe discussed virtually every known aspect of his life in his letters. However, nowhere in his voluminous correspondence does he mention his reputed morphine addiction. On the basis of this evidence, it is safe to conclude that reports of his supposed addiction are untrue. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

- A. The symptoms that legend attributes to Poe and that have been taken as evidence of morphine addiction could instead have been caused by a different condition.
- B. Poe had enemies whose own careers could have been advanced if rumors that Poe was addicted to morphine were widely believed.
- C. Poe would not have refrained, out of any considerations of privacy or reputation, from mentioning in his correspondence any addiction that he might have had.
- D. Reports claiming that Poe was addicted to morphine did not begin to circulate until after his death.
- E. None of the reports of Poe's supposed addiction to morphine can be traced to individuals who knew Poe personally.

Passage 248

After the identification of three of the main macronutrients that plants need to grow—nitrogen, phosphorus, and potassium (N-P-K)—and the development of manufactured nitrogen fertilizer in the 1910s, agricultural soils began receiving large doses of N-P-K but little else. Early agronomists overlooked the importance of biological activity provided by the underground ecosystem of soil microbes, earthworms, and Mycorrhizal fungi. Chemical fertilizers such as N-P-K depress this activity, increasing plants' vulnerability to pests and diseases. They might also diminish crops' nutritional quality, which has declined substantially since the widespread adoption of chemical fertilizers. Some researchers attribute this decline to the condition of the soil; others cite the tendency of modern plant breeding to select for characteristics such as yield rather than nutritional quality. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, which of the following typically distinguishes soil nourished exclusively by N-P-K fertilizers from unfertilized soils?
 - A. lower average yields
 - B. higher earthworm populations
 - C. slower crop growth
 - D. less microbial activity
 - E. increased resistance to pests
2. The author of the passage would most likely agree that the widespread use of N-P-K fertilizers
 - A. has encouraged plant breeders to select for yield rather than other characteristics
 - B. caused early agronomists to ignore the importance of biological activity in soils
 - C. has diverted attention away from the nutritional value of crops
 - D. spurred attempts to reproduce the effect of microbial activity in the soil
 - E. has resulted in plants that are less hardy

Passage 249

Meltzoff and Moore reported experiments showing that human newborns possess the ability to imitate certain facial expressions, such as a protruding tongue or an open mouth. Yet numerous researchers challenge Meltzoff's interpretation that such neonatal imitation is the origin of later imitation, which appears at approximately eight to twelve months of age. These researchers point out that the neonatal imitative response disappears or is lessened at approximately two months. Moreover, since in follow-up studies only one type of imitative response toward a facial expression (that is, tongue protrusion) was observed, some researchers assert that neonatal imitation is not imitation at all but may simply be a form of exploratory behavior in response to interesting stimuli.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage implies which of the following about the experimental results reported by Meltzoff and Moore?
 - A. They were, at best, only partially borne out by subsequent studies.
 - B. They cast doubt on the validity of a particular claim about newborns.
 - C. They formed the basis for revised interpretations of other behaviors of newborns.
 - D. They derived from a methodology that turned out to be flawed.
 - E. They challenged the distinction between imitative and nonimitative behavior in newborns.
2. According to the passage, those who challenge "Meltzoff's interpretation" do so on the basis that it
 - A. implies inaccurate predictions
 - B. lacks testable consequences
 - C. assumes a discredited theory
 - D. leaves an unexplained gap
 - E. involves circular reasoning

Passage 250

In “The Franklin’s Tale”, from Chaucer’s fourteenth-century *Canterbury Tales*, a Clerk uses medieval astronomical tables, calculating lunar and solar positions, to predict an extraordinarily high flood tide. Literary scholar **Phyllis Hodgson** has concluded that Chaucer’s purpose here is artistic, not scientific, and that even though Chaucer was a master of astronomy and author of an astrolabe treatise, this “highly technical account of the Clerk’s astrological calculations need not be taken too seriously.” Recently, however, astronomer Don Olson concluded that Chaucer’s account actually describes a very rare astronomical configuration of the Sun, Moon, and Earth that produced an exceptionally high tide in December 1340. But why would Chaucer be aware of a high tide that occurred in 1340, some five decades before “The Franklin’s Tale” was written? Some scholars place Chaucer’s birth in late 1340s or early 1340s. When Chaucer was studying astronomy during the 1380s and 1390s, it is plausible that he investigated his own horoscope. Chaucer may have discovered the remarkable tide-raising configuration in 1340 while calculating celestial positions at the time of his own birth and then used this knowledge as inspiration for the plot device in “The Franklin’s Tale.” 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following statements regarding medieval astronomers can be inferred from the passage?
 - A. They were skeptical of the idea that certain astronomical configurations could produce high flood tides.
 - B. They had an understanding of the effect of the Sun and Moon on ocean tides.
 - C. They could calculate lunar positions with some accuracy, but not the positions of the Sun and Earth.
 - D. Although they were highly skilled in celestial calculations, they were unlikely to apply this knowledge to predictions of events on Earth.
 - E. They possessed the mathematical skills for performing only the simplest of astronomical calculations.
2. It can be inferred that Hodgson would agree with which of the following statements about the Clerk’s astronomical calculations?
 - A. The Clerk’s calculations do not add artistic merit to “The Franklin’s Tale.”
 - B. Chaucer’s purpose in describing the Clerk’s calculations is to instruct readers in the rudiments of astronomy.
 - C. Chaucer’s intent in using technical material was not to provide a scientifically valid discussion.
 - D. The Clerk’s ability to predict a high flood tide is implausible, given the level of scientific knowledge in the late fourteenth century.
 - E. The technical language that Chaucer uses in describing the calculations does not reflect the scientific terminology of the time.
3. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. explain how fourteenth-century astronomers used complicated astronomical calculations to predict unusually high tides
 - B. show how medieval and modern methods predict similar effects of astronomical configurations on tides
 - C. argue that modern literary scholars should take Chaucer’s scientific references throughout *The Canterbury Tales* more seriously
 - D. describe Chaucer’s fascination with astronomy in general and with horoscopes in particular
 - E. present an explanation that supports the scientific veracity of a particular passage in *The Canterbury Tales*

Passage 251

In 1876 Edmond Duranty dubbed the style of emerging French Impressionist artists “The New Painting.” More than a style, the Impressionists’ luminous landscapes were regarded as a new way of seeing. Of course, it was not wholly new. **The English painters Constable and Turner, whose work French artists knew, had already painted out of doors earlier in the century and brilliantly sought to capture the impact of natural scenes on their sensibility.** Courbet’s tough-minded realism and Jongkind’s harbor scenes also had much to teach the emergent movement. The Impressionists never denied this ancestry; but they were aware, too, that they had taken these painters’ unconventional experiments to unfamiliar levels and, consolidating themselves as a movement, had indeed made painting new. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted sentence?
 - A. It provides support for an assertion made previously in the passage.
 - B. It undermines a claim made earlier in the passage.
 - C. It questions the usefulness of categorizing artists into particular movements.
 - D. It identifies painters whose works were praised by some Impressionists.
 - E. It suggests that painting out of doors was unusual during the early 1800s.
2. The passage suggests that the impact of Impressionism can be attributed in part to
 - A. Duranty’s enthusiastic promotion of the movement
 - B. the moribund state of painting when Impressionists first presented their works
 - C. the widespread popularity in France of works by Courbet and Jongkind
 - D. a lack of earlier examples of outdoor painting
 - E. the solidarity of its practitioners

Passage 252

Shapin's book demonstrates that contrary to a widely held belief, industrial research has not invariably been more regimented than academic science. He argues that the intellectual freedom historically available to industrial scientists during the twentieth century has been underestimated. Many companies, recognizing that the results of scientific investigation were necessarily uncertain and that profits, if any, might take years to materialize, granted scientists considerable latitude to develop their ideas and follow them in unexpected directions. Some companies even provided senior scientists with free time to pursue their own research interests, whatever they might be. Consequently, some scientists were drawn to industrial research not primarily because of the generally good financial compensation but because they saw industry as the best place to do cutting-edge research. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage's discussion of "free time" suggests that
 - A. senior scientists in industry have been less likely than junior scientists to remain in positions where opportunities to conduct their own research are restricted
 - B. scientists who work in industry can gain financially from their own independent research as well as from research they conduct for their companies
 - C. scientists who work in industry have tended to become frustrated by their employers' expectations that their research will be restricted to areas deemed to be in the employers' interests
 - D. industry has sometimes been willing to support scientific research that has no prospect of yielding a direct profit
 - E. industrial scientists have not differed from academic scientists in the amount of time they are able to dedicate to pure research
2. It can be inferred that those who hold the "belief" mentioned in the passage would be most likely to agree with which of the following statements about scientists?
 - A. Scientists who conduct research in university settings have generally been less motivated than researchers employed in industry to pursue scientific inquiries solely for the sake of advancing knowledge.
 - B. Scientists have not been primarily motivated by financial considerations in choosing among different professional settings in which to conduct their research.
 - C. Scientists employed by for-profit companies have always tended to have their research restricted by their companies' interests.
 - D. Scientists have tended to be less concerned about the regimentation of industrial research than nonscientists generally assume.
 - E. Scientists should be more skeptical than they generally have been about the reliability of research conducted by for-profit companies.
3. The author of the passage mentions companies' recognition that "the results of scientific investigation were necessarily uncertain" primarily in order to
 - A. suggest that industrial scientists often faced a different set of challenges than did academic scientists
 - B. present a premise that motivated some companies' policies regarding their scientists' research
 - C. explain how companies calculated possible future profits from research undertaken by their scientists
 - D. refute a common assumption about the costs associated with industrial research relative to the costs of academic research
 - E. explain how the expectations of scientists conducting industrial research differed from those of scientists conducting academic research

Passage 253

Certain practices common in the early United States make it easy for historians to underestimate the extent of American women's paid labor. Under the legal principle called coverture, married women had no legally recognized economic existence apart from their husbands and could not receive wages for their work. Records of payments for outwork (work performed in the home on a piece-rate basis) show male names as wage recipients. One has to look in the columns recording the amount of work completed to see that female names are listed as producers. Furthermore, most wage laborers were paid partly in goods and received cash wages only quarterly or once or twice a year. The infrequency of such payments has sometimes made it difficult for historians to recognize them as wages. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage suggests which of the following about records of payments for outwork?

- A. They have only recently received attention from historians.
- B. They could easily be misinterpreted by historians.
- C. They have frequently been overlooked by historians.
- D. They show a discrepancy between the amount of men's and women's wages.
- E. They fail to reflect the infrequency of payments for completed work.

2. According to the passage, payments to wage laborers in the early United States were

- A. usually lower for outwork than for other kinds of wage labor
- B. consistently higher for male workers than for female workers
- C. paid to male workers at more frequent intervals than to female workers
- D. often paid partly in forms other than cash
- E. often not recorded by employers

Passage 254

Bat studies in Indiana between 1961 and 1993 recorded bat roost locations. All of the roosts of evening bats were in buildings. Consequently, the fact that all evening bats radio-tracked since 1993 have roosted in trees was notable. The building roosts may have been the result of spillover from large populations of evening bats in the woods along rivers, where, prior to 1993, scientific data were not collected. The building roosts may also indicate that this species had adapted well to human structures. However, the disappearance after 1993 of previously known roosts in buildings suggests that this adaptation became less successful. Big brown bat populations have been increasing in Indiana, and perhaps evening bats do not compete successfully with them for roosts in buildings. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author mentions the fact that evening bats radio-tracked since 1993 have roosted in trees primarily in order to

- A. account for a puzzling aspect of evening bat behavior mentioned earlier in the passage
- B. introduce evidence that indicates a change in evening bat behavior discussed later in the passage
- C. undermine a theory about evening bat behavior presented earlier in the passage
- D. provide a contrast between evening bat behavior and big brown bat behavior
- E. provide an example of evening bat behavior that fits well-established scientific views of the species

2. According to the passage, the disappearance after 1993 of known evening bat roosts in buildings suggests which of the following?

- A. After 1993 evening bats in Indiana were less likely to live near rivers.
- B. Humans and their structures became increasingly threatening after 1993.
- C. The spillover of large bat populations from woods near rivers increased after 1993.
- D. Evening bats in Indiana inhabited the roosts previously used by big brown bats.
- E. In Indiana, evening bats' adaptation to buildings was ultimately undermined by other factors.

Passage 255

Witnesses to a meteor in Australia in 1978 claimed to have heard strange noises as it streaked overhead. Yet, given that the meteor was 30 kilometers up, if these sounds had come directly from the meteor, people on the ground could not have heard them until almost a minute after the meteor had disappeared. Physicist Colin Keay hypothesized that the light given off by a meteor's trail must be accompanied by invisible electromagnetic radiation in the form of very low frequency (VLF) radio waves. **Such waves, which travel at the speed of light, would reach the observer when the meteor itself came into view.**

Subsequent experiments in a soundproof chamber showed that many things can act as transducers to convert VLF waves into audible vibrations. Aluminum foil, thin wires, pine needles, or dry hair all responded to a VLF field. VLF waves induce small charges in such objects, thereby causing them to vibrate in time with the waves' oscillation. This transducer effect would explain why some people heard the noises while others close by heard nothing. Those who heard sounds were simply nearer to transducers. It could also explain why attempts to record meteor sounds have failed: scientists carefully place their microphones away from possible sources of interference. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted sentence?
 - A. It explains why observers who were looking at the meteor would be the only ones who could hear the sounds made as it went overhead.
 - B. It explains why the witnesses' claims could not be verified by scientific experts.
 - C. It shows that Keay's hypothesis provides the correct explanation of the sounds heard by observers of the meteor.
 - D. It suggests that Keay's hypothesis is capable of explaining an important aspect of the witnesses' observations.
 - E. It suggests that Keay's hypothesis is able to explain how observers can see a fast-moving meteor.
2. The passage suggests that Keay formulated his hypothesis in response to
 - A. scientists' failure to record meteor sounds
 - B. an inference based on the speed of sound in the atmosphere
 - C. measurements of the strength and wavelength of electromagnetic radiation from a meteor's trail
 - D. the fact that observers who heard meteor sounds were close to objects that could act as transducers of VLF waves
 - E. experiments in a soundproof chamber to determine what objects would transduce VLF waves into audible vibrations
3. It can be inferred from the passage that if Keay's proposed explanation of meteor sounds is correct, it is true that
 - A. meteors themselves produce no audible vibrations, even though the meteor does cause the sounds that observers hear
 - B. when an observer hears the sounds, it is his or her own hair that is causing the audible vibrations
 - C. if two observers in widely separated locations hear sounds caused by the same meteor, the audible vibrations that reach the observers are produced by different objects
 - D. visible light and VLF radio waves are the only forms of electromagnetic radiation that are given off by a meteor's trail
 - E. atmospheric conditions, such as clouds, that made a meteor invisible to observers on the ground would also prevent those observers from hearing any sounds caused by that meteor

Passage 256

Larvae of many marine invertebrate species delay their metamorphosis into juveniles when cues signaling an appropriate juvenile environment are absent, thereby increasing their likelihood of thriving as juveniles and of ultimately reaching adulthood. Nevertheless, delayed metamorphosis has potential costs for juveniles, including reduced growth and increased mortality. Nearly all evidence of such costs involves species whose larvae do not feed but rather subsist on stored nutrients, indicating that insufficient energy reserves may be an underlying cause of these costs. Supporting this **hypothesis** are laboratory studies showing that in a certain bryozoan, the prolonged larval swimming that results from delayed metamorphosis is associated with size reductions in the juvenile feeding organ (the lophophore) and that one factor influencing the size of juveniles of certain barnacle species is how long larvae delay metamorphosis. However, other studies show that while significantly fewer juvenile *Capitella* worms survived to adulthood when metamorphosis had been delayed, prolonged larval swimming had no significant effect on juvenile size, suggesting, perhaps, that in some species, factors other than insufficient energy reserves account for the negative effects of the larval stresses that result from delayed metamorphosis. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage suggests that the “bryozoan,” the “barnacle species,” and “*Capitella* worms” all share which of the following characteristics?
 - A. The larvae of these species do not feed but rather subsist on stored nutrients.
 - B. The larvae of these species are unable to undergo metamorphosis if larval swimming is significantly prolonged.
 - C. The larvae of these species do not have enough energy to meet their needs when metamorphosis is delayed.
 - D. The juveniles of these species manifest the negative effects of delayed metamorphosis as a decrease in size.
 - E. The juveniles of these species are not significantly larger than their respective larvae.
2. The “hypothesis” implies that compared to marine invertebrate larvae that subsist on stored nutrients, marine invertebrate larvae that feed are less likely to
 - A. exhibit prolonged larval swimming as a result of delayed metamorphosis
 - B. experience negative effects as a result of delayed metamorphosis
 - C. thrive as juveniles in environments inappropriate for juveniles
 - D. delay metamorphosis in the absence of appropriate environmental cues
 - E. delay metamorphosis for an extended period of time
3. The passage is primarily concerned with
 - A. weighing the relative benefits and costs of delayed metamorphosis
 - B. illustrating the range of costs that can result from delayed metamorphosis
 - C. speculating on why the costs of delayed metamorphosis have gone unrecognized
 - D. discussing a possible explanation of the costs of delayed metamorphosis
 - E. debunking the notion that the costs of delayed metamorphosis are negligible

Passage 257

The presence of work themes in the painting of the Impressionist movement of the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries has until recently been largely discounted, despite the body of Impressionist works that continued the **tradition**, initiated by Courbet and Millet and developed through the 1880s by Breton, Bastien-Lepage, Pissaro, and Berthe Morisot, of representing rural labor, and notwithstanding the significant body of Impressionist work—including that of Degas, Caillebotte, and Morisot—representing urban or suburban labor. The notion of Impressionism as concerned primarily with the representation of leisure has less to do, however, with the subject matter of the paintings than with the acceptance of the view, widely held in nineteenth-century France, that considered peasants performing physically demanding rural labor as the epitome of work. The numerous Impressionist representations of activities (often those of women) that we might classify as work—a woman serving beer in a cafe, many paintings by Degas of the ballet (a physically demanding activity by any standard)—were instead classified as representations of leisure by those who held this view. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to

- A. propose a new theory about the techniques used to represent work themes in Impressionist painting
- B. expand the meaning of the term “work” as it applies to painting
- C. note that work themes were often overlooked in Impressionist painting and suggest a reason why
- D. provide insight into why certain activities were not considered work in the late nineteenth century
- E. provide specific examples of rural work themes in Impressionist painting and explain the significance of such themes

2. The “tradition” refers to the

- A. view that work themes are of little importance in Impressionist painting
- B. representation of leisure
- C. representation of urban and suburban labor
- D. representation of rural labor
- E. works of Degas, Caillebotte, and Morisot

3. With which of the following statements about Impressionist painting would the author of the passage be most likely to agree?

- A. The view that Impressionist painting is concerned primarily with themes of leisure is based in part on a limited definition of what constitutes work.
- B. Many Impressionist paintings once regarded as representing work themes are now viewed as being concerned primarily with the representation of leisure.
- C. Most of the Impressionist paintings that treat work themes depict activities representing urban and suburban labor.
- D. Although themes of work appear frequently in Impressionist paintings, these themes are limited to the traditional representations of work as rural physical labor.
- E. Notwithstanding the large body of Impressionist painting in which work themes are present, the notion that Impressionist paintings are primarily about leisure activities is essentially correct.

Passage 258

The ship Mary Rose, first launched in 1511, underwent extensive repairs in 1528 and 1536 and sank in 1543. Researchers raised the ship in 1982 and analyzed the wreck's preserved timbers; some timbers came from trees felled after 1511, so they must have been added during repair. There were some beams, however, that came from trees felled before 1511. It is likely, therefore, that these beams were part of the original ship. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the argument?

- A. The repair caused the Mary Rose to be significantly more difficult to handle and ultimately may have led to the ship's sinking.
- B. The beams were fastened with wooden nails that came from trees felled after 1511.
- C. The beams came from a part of the ship that quite commonly needs to be repaired every few years.
- D. One structurally important timber came from a tree felled after 1528.
- E. Shipbuilders of the 1500s preferred to work with recently felled wood that was still green with sap.

Passage 259

Tea is rich in compounds called polyphenols, which are similar to certain compounds known to help prevent cancer. Among people in Japan, those who drink over ten cups of tea per day have lower rates of stomach cancer than others. On average, people in Japan drink much more tea than people in the United States and have lower rates of lung cancer. It is therefore likely that polyphenols also help prevent cancer. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, provides the most support for the argument?

- A. Smoking, a known cause of lung cancer, is more common in Japan than it is in the United States.
- B. Few people in the United States drink more than ten cups of tea per day.
- C. Stomach cancer is much more common in Japan than it is in the United States.
- D. Soy products, which are known to help prevent cancer, are more widely used in Japan than in the United States.
- E. Coffee, which like tea is a source of caffeine, is more popular in the United States than in Japan.

Passage 260

Few central Asian textiles from the Timurid period (1370-1526 C. E.) have survived to be dated. However, scholars have long assumed that Timurid rugs with geometric patterns were replaced in royal courts by floral-patterned rugs only at the end of the 1400s, under the influence of the painter Behzād (circa 1455-circa 1536). Nevertheless, the presence of floral-patterned rugs in court scenes from two paintings in a 1440s Timurid manuscript suggests that floral-patterned rugs were already being used at that time. **Whether the occasional presence of geometric rugs in similar paintings after the 1440s means the tradition of weaving rugs with geometric patterns also continued, or whether here the painters simply followed a well-established formula, is still an open question.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, after the 1440s, Timurid paintings of court scenes
- A. generally followed well-established formulas
 - B. are more likely to have survived than Timurid textiles
 - C. were greatly influenced by the painter Behzād
 - D. are frequently found in Timurid manuscripts
 - E. sometimes showed rugs with geometric patterns

For the following question, consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The passage implies which of the following about the introduction of floral-patterned rugs in Timurid royal courts?
- A. It explains the absence of any surviving geometric-patterned rugs.
 - B. It predates any influence wielded by the painter Behzād.
 - C. It occurred earlier than scholars have long thought.

3. Which of the following statements best describes the function of the highlighted sentence in the context of the passage as a whole?

- A. It notes a fact about Timurid rugs, that explains why they have been the subject of scholarly controversy.
- B. It emphasizes the fragility of central Asian textiles from the period in question,
- C. It situates Timurid rugs within the wider context of textile arts from the same period.
- D. It suggests why the author is relying upon indirect evidence for the dating of trends in Timurid rugs.
- E. It describes a constraint on the study of Timurid rugs that the author thinks has been overemphasized.

4. In the context in which it appears, “formula” most nearly means

- A. fact
- B. symbol
- C. ritual
- D. maxim
- E. recipe

Passage 261

The sixteenth-century art historian Vasari wrote about a building only when he himself had seen it or a detailed model of it. The thorough description of the new chapel at Larcona contained in the second edition of *Vasari's Lives of the Artists* must have been contributed by someone else, since the edition was published the year before Vasari's travels took him to Larcona, and no model of the chapel was ever shown in Florence, Vasari's home. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument?

- A. Vasari discussed with his collaborators the new chapel at Larcona described in the second edition of the book.
- B. A model of the proposed chapel at Larcona was displayed in Rome, a city Vasari visited often.
- C. There were many printings of the second edition of the book, all of them textually identical.
- D. Vasari did not intend to provide in his book detailed descriptions of buildings outside of his native Florence.
- E. Most sections of the book are devoted to works of art and buildings of Vasari's native Florence.

Passage 262

Setting conservation objectives often mixes scientific knowledge with political feasibility in such a way that one cannot tell where the science stops and the political pragmatism takes over. For example, Tear found that for endangered species with recovery plans, over a quarter of the plans set quantitative recovery objectives at or below the species' existing population size or number of populations. Most likely these objectives were so low because they were politically palatable. Another possible explanation for such **modest** recovery objectives is what is known as the **shifting-baseline syndrome**. In this scenario, successive generations of wildlife managers use as their baseline the conditions they experienced at the start of their careers, resulting in lower expectations with each new generation. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. In the context in which it appears, "modest" most nearly means

- A. conventional
- B. appropriate
- C. unpretentious
- D. diffident
- E. unambitious

2. According to the passage, the "shifting-baseline syndrome" is a result of which of the following?

- A. modest recovery objectives determined by political pragmatism
- B. the difficulty of determining existing population size and number of populations for endangered species
- C. changes in the criteria that are used in determining whether a given quantitative objective has been met
- D. each new generation of wildlife managers using recent conditions to set numerical baselines for wildlife populations
- E. the way that hopes for recovery of endangered species populations color the expectations of successive generations of wildlife managers

Passage 263

People who have low bone density have a markedly higher-than-average incidence of stroke, as do people with high blood pressure. There are well-known mechanisms by which high blood pressure can cause a stroke, but since it is highly unlikely that there are any mechanisms by which low bone density can cause a stroke, or vice versa, a possible hypothesis to account for the association between low bone density and stroke is that _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following most logically completes the argument?

- A. a higher proportion of people with high blood pressure than of people with low bone density have strokes
- B. whatever causes low bone density in people protects them from high blood pressure
- C. there is a condition that can cause both low bone density and strokes
- D. those people with high blood pressure who take steps to lower it in order to prevent a stroke generally take no steps to increase their bone density
- E. there are few initial symptoms of high blood pressure or of low bone density

Passage 264

About 20 percent of professors at Torellia National University were not educated in Torellia. The average pay of professors at the university who were educated in Torellia is about 10 percent lower than that of professors with comparable levels of training and experience who were educated outside Torellia. These figures clearly indicate the existence of a university policy, though probably an unwritten one, of favoring foreign-educated professors over those educated in Torellia when determining salaries. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most seriously undermines the editorials conclusion?

- A. The salaries of professors at the university are increasing more slowly than the salaries of people with comparable levels of training and experience employed by corporations.
- B. The business school of the university, where most of the professors who were educated outside Torellia teach, must pay high salaries to its faculty to compete with salaries available to them from corporations.
- C. The benefits other than salary offered to the university's professors are about the same for professors educated in Torellia as for those not educated in Torellia.
- D. The university has an explicit policy setting broad salary ranges for professors at all levels of experience.
- E. Most of the professors at the university who were educated outside Torellia are native-born citizens of Torellia.

Passage 265

Harriet Martineau's *Illustrations of Political Economy*, a series of didactic novellas about industrialists and workers that were immensely popular upon their publication (1832-1834), are considered the first industrial novels. But instead of foregrounding suffering individuals, as other industrial novels do, they champion the impersonal economic laws that determine individuals' behavior. Martineau's explicit aim is to convince her readers of the truth of the principles laid out by such economic philosophers as **Thomas Malthus**. Yet the novellas' embrace of predetermined truths blunts their narrative force. Their claim to be "illustrations," in which stories of human choice serve only to make vivid an abstract law, contravenes the relation in most realist fiction between abstract law and lived experience, in which the former is found inadequate to explain the latter.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following can be inferred from the passage about industrial novels written after Martineau's *Illustrations of Political Economy*?
 - A. They drew on the same subject matter as *Illustrations of Political Economy* but approached that subject matter with a different emphasis.
 - B. They were written by authors who aimed to capitalize on the popularity of *Illustrations of Political Economy*.
 - C. They differed from *Illustrations of Political Economy* in that they were more directly concerned with abstract economic laws than with the experiences of individuals.
 - D. They were more popular with readers than were *Illustrations of Political Economy*.
 - E. They differed from *Illustrations of Political Economy* in that they tended to present industrialists more sympathetically than workers.
2. The author of the passage mentions Thomas Malthus primarily to
 - A. cite a feature of Martineau's writing that makes it particularly vivid
 - B. clarify a poorly understood aspect of Martineau's fiction
 - C. explain Martineau's intentions in writing *Illustrations of Political Economy*
 - D. contrast Martineau's fiction with the writings of economic philosophers
 - E. help account for the popularity of Martineau's *Illustrations of Political Economy*

Passage 266

Nielsen is aware that for many readers, including the anthologists who create textbooks, African American literature is thought to be primarily realistic in style and sociological or political in content. Avant-garde expressions—beyond the obvious examples offered by Langston Hughes, Amiri Baraka, and Ishmael Reed—are frequently overlooked. While such a narrow view is more readily apparent in critical attention given to fiction than in that given to poetry, it certainly skews anthologies. Nielsen is acutely aware of the serious political motives that often underlie such compilations and is also concerned that the currently popular critical paradigm of an oral tradition might deflect proper attention due African American literary traditions. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage suggests that compared with critical writing on African American fiction, critical writing on African American poetry

- A. is more often driven by serious political motives
- B. is more influenced by currently popular critical paradigms
- C. draws clearer distinctions between oral and literary traditions
- D. acknowledges a broader range of style and content
- E. focuses more on the sociological implications of the works discussed

For the following question, consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The passage suggests that Nielsen has which of the following concerns regarding anthologies of African American literature?

- A. that the anthologies overlook the work of the important avant-garde writers Langston Hughes, Amiri Baraka, and Ishmael Reed
- B. that the anthologies focus on a particular type of literature at the expense of other types
- C. that the anthologies give insufficient attention to the oral tradition in African American literature

Passage 267

We take for granted that island populations must have a continental origin, and not the other way around. The number of islands that acquire their biota [i.e., plant and animal life] from a larger source supports this notion. There is, however, no fundamental mechanism in the **equilibrium theory** of island biogeography to preclude island species from colonizing the mainland. The belief in one-way biogeographic traffic has only begun to erode as phylogenetic analyses have revealed island origins for continental rodents and lizards. Among plants, the genus *Exostema* has successfully diversified in the continental Neotropics, while two populations in the angiosperm genus *Erithalis* have colonized Florida. At least two Neotropical bat lineages can be added to the growing list of island-to-continent colonizers. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, which of the following is true of the “equilibrium theory”?

- A. It implies that very few island populations are able to colonize continental areas.
- B. It can accommodate two-way biogeographic traffic between islands and mainlands.
- C. It necessarily assumes that island species originate on continents.
- D. It has been undermined recently by phylogenetic analyses.
- E. It questions the distinction between island and continental populations.

2. Select the sentence that presents a presupposition.

Passage 268

The temperance movement, aimed at combating alcohol use, comprised the largest women's movement and the largest group of women orators in nineteenth-century America. While the sheer quantity of material these women produced justifies **critical** attention, their importance is by no means solely quantitative. Although they lacked formal rhetorical training, these women exhibited an exceptional understanding of language use within their cultural context and demonstrated remarkably effective rhetorical strategies in relation to their own purposes and the audiences they addressed. Despite the success that temperance activists had in creating change, twentieth-century feminists tended to focus on the suffrage movement as women's only significant political act, an oversight that has resulted in a distortion of women's participation in the political process.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. In the context in which it appears, "critical" most nearly means
 - A. urgent
 - B. censorious
 - C. judgmental
 - D. scholarly
 - E. crucial
2. The passage suggests which of the following about the temperance movement's audiences?
 - A. They were usually composed exclusively of women.
 - B. They were often persuaded by the speeches they heard by women temperance orators.
 - C. They were typically hostile to the idea of outlawing the use of alcohol.
 - D. They were more numerous in the beginning of the nineteenth century than they were at its end.
 - E. They were drawn largely from the same population as the audiences for women's suffrage groups.

Passage 269

It was recently discovered that the editors of a scholarly journal rejected a paper submitted for publication, even though expert reviewers had strongly recommended it. The editors said they had concerns about possible political reactions to this paper. This sorry episode shows that what many people have long suspected is true: that the journal routinely rejects papers on the basis of political rather than scholarly considerations. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- The reasoning in the argument is open to criticism on the grounds that the argument
- A. presumes that just because something happens frequently, it invariably happens
 - B. presumes that something is true simply on the grounds that many people think it
 - C. relies on evidence that contradicts the conclusion that is drawn
 - D. relies on a single example to establish a general claim
 - E. relies on claims made by people who are not experts in the field

Passage 270

A year ago, the government of Portran predicted that Torre City would experience strong net job growth for the following year but that Glanville, Portran's other major city, would not. Events have clearly proved otherwise, however; in Torre City, but not in Glanville, the number of people who are unemployed is greater now than it was a year ago. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the editorial's argument depends?

- A. The unemployment rate is higher in Torre City than in Glanville.
- B. The unemployment rate in Torre City is higher now than it has ever been.
- C. Since making the prediction a year ago, the government of Portran has taken no steps to improve job growth in the country.
- D. Few, if any, unemployed people moved to Torre City from Glanville during the year.
- E. Government predictions about the economy in Portran are generally not reliable.

Passage 271

In a five-year study of people with coronary heart disease, 85 percent of those given Artilase, a new drug developed as a treatment for coronary heart disease, were still alive at the end of the study. Since without Artilase only 75 percent of this group would have been expected to have lived the entire five years, Artilase is clearly effective in extending the lives of people with coronary heart disease. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most seriously undermines the argument given?

- A. Eighty-five percent of those in the study who were given a placebo (a medically ineffective but harmless pill) rather than Artilase were still alive at the end of the study.
- B. The study was funded by the manufacturers of Artilase.
- C. The study did not include people whose coronary heart disease was so far advanced at the time the study began that they were not expected to live more than one year.
- D. At least 75 percent of the people in the study would have been expected to live an additional five years or more had they undergone surgical treatment for their heart disease.
- E. The study had originally been intended to last only four years.

Passage 272

Writings by Renaissance artists are often prized for the light they can shed on artists' lives and personalities. **Despite their nearly equal life spans and impressive artistic output, Michelangelo, whose surviving writings are copious, is accessible in a way that Donatello is not.** Other artists now less appreciated for their oeuvres, such as Cennino Cennini, are of greater value to modern historians for their written than for their painted output. The great paradox, however, is Leonardo da Vinci, who left thousands of pages of writing. These texts have been categorized for study, segmenting his body of writings into smaller groupings on subjects such as painting, science, anatomy, optics, and engineering. Yet despite the exhaustive application of this method, Leonardo, as an individual, remains thoroughly obscure. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

The author introduces the subject of Leonardo da Vinci primarily in order to

- A. note an exception to the usefulness of a particular approach to studying Renaissance artists
- B. emphasize the difficulty of interpreting the writings of Renaissance artists
- C. vindicate a particular approach to interpreting the work of Renaissance artists
- D. cite an artist whose writings have attracted particularly keen scholarly interest
- E. cast doubt on a particular assumption about the relationship of biography and painting

2. Which of the following best characterizes the function of the highlighted sentence?

- A. It acknowledges an important exception to a particular generalization.
- B. It helps to account for a scholarly tendency mentioned earlier in the passage.
- C. It contrasts two kinds of evidence used in the study of Renaissance artists.
- D. It provides an illustration of a point articulated in the preceding sentence.
- E. It notes an important distinction between the reputations of two Renaissance artists.

Passage 273

Arctic sea ice belongs to two categories. Seasonal ice freezes in winter and then dissolves in summer, while perennial ice perseveres year-round. To the untrained eye, all sea ice looks the same, but by licking it, one can evaluate how long a specific piece has been floating round. When ice starts to form in seawater, it drives out salt, which has no position in the crystal structure. As the ice gets thicker, the rejected salt collects in small pockets of brine too greatly concentrated to freeze. A piece of first-year ice will taste salty. Finally, if the ice survives, these pockets of brine drain out through **fine**, veinlike channels, and the ice becomes fresher; multiyear ice can even be dissolved and drunk. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

For the following question, consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The passage mentions which of the following as being a feature of seasonal ice?

- A. It is similar in appearance to perennial ice.
- B. It is typically filled with fine, veinlike channels.
- C. It tastes saltier than perennial ice.

2. In the context in which it appears, "fine" most nearly means

- A. acceptable
- B. elegant
- C. precise
- D. pure
- E. small

Passage 274

The novel *Georges*, published under Alexander Dumas' name, may actually have been written by Felicien Mallefille. A comparison of *Georges* with well-known Dumas novels such as *The Count of Monte Cristo* suggests that Dumas had little to do with *Georges*. For example, *Georges*' characters are tiresomely earnest, while those from Dumas' well-known novels crack jokes and utter colorful oaths. Meanwhile, in a technical sense, *Georges* is well-written, while *The Count of Monte Cristo*, with all its verve and sparkle, is full of redundancies, repetitions, and non sequiturs. As Umberto Eco discovered while attempting to translate *The Count of Monte Cristo*, the charm of Dumas' novel and its "narrative wisdom" are inseparable from its "linguistically sludgy and gasping" prose.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage would be most likely to agree with which of the following statements about Dumas as a novelist?
 - A. His use of non sequiturs detracts from the stylistic verve of his writing.
 - B. His use of repetition has been overrated as effective novelistic technique.
 - C. His reliance on humor results in one-dimensional characters.
 - D. His novels, while technically well written, have predictable plots.
 - E. His writing displays narrative skill despite certain technical flaws.
2. According to the passage, which of the following is true regarding the novel *Georges*?
 - A. Its authorship was widely questioned soon after its publication.
 - B. Its characters are less interesting than those in most Dumas' novels.
 - C. It is marred by redundancies, repetitions, and non sequiturs.
 - D. It presents unusual problems for translators.
 - E. It has often been compared favorably to *The Count of Monte Cristo*
3. The quotation from Umberto Eco most directly serves to
 - A. underscore an apparent inconsistency
 - B. introduce a new explanation
 - C. reevaluate the critical status of a work
 - D. point out a contradiction in a critical stance
 - E. enumerate certain challenges of translation

Passage 275

Pharmaceuticals imported into Bornland are inspected for quality to the extent that staff limitations permit. For the last few years, the proportion of shipments examined that have been found to be deficient has been consistently around 25 percent. This year, the number of inspectors and inspections was doubled, and only 21 percent of shipments inspected were found deficient. Clearly, therefore, the quality of pharmaceuticals being imported into Bornland has greatly improved. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The answer to which of the following would be most helpful in evaluating this argument?
 - A. What is the maximum fine that the inspectors can impose when they find that an importer's pharmaceutical shipments are of deficient quality?
 - B. Can the newly hired inspectors detect deficiencies in shipments at least as well as their more experienced colleagues?
 - C. Is Bornland currently a major exporter of pharmaceutical products?
 - D. How many pharmaceutical companies import pharmaceuticals into Bornland?
 - E. When did Bornland first consider the hiring of additional inspectors for pharmaceutical imports?

Passage 276

While studying different-sized ant colonies, Cole discovered that when there were only a few ants in the space provided, each individual exhibited a chaotic pattern of activity and rest. As the density of the colony increased by the addition of more ants, Cole observed a sudden transition to dynamic order: patterns of activity and rest over the colony as a whole suddenly changed from chaotic to rhythmic. Why should the density of ants play an apparently crucial role in the transition from chaotic to **ordered** behavior? Ants interact with one another, and an active ant encountering an inactive one will stimulate the latter into movement. At low densities there are few encounters, but at higher densities activity can spread like a contagion through the colony. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. According to the passage, which of the following statements about ant interactions is true?
 - A. The interaction between active and inactive ants leads to a change in the inactive ant's behavior.
 - B. When the density of an ant colony is low, there are relatively few interactions between ants.
 - C. When there are many ants in an ant colony, the perceived lack of space often leads ants to inactivity.
2. In the context in which it appears, "ordered" most nearly means
 - A. prepared
 - B. prearranged
 - C. regular
 - D. peaceful
 - E. restricted

Passage 277

Spiders of the species *Argiope* build distinctive zig-zag patterns, called stabilimenta, into their webs. Recent research has established that *Argiope* spiders use stabilimenta to collect drinking water. This discovery, far from discrediting the long-standing hypothesis that stabilimenta serve to reinforce the webs, actually supports that hypothesis since _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most logically completes the argument?

- A. The source of the spiders' drinking water is not rainwater but morning dew.
- B. Spiders would not make structures as energy-consuming as the stabilimenta are unless those structures conferred some benefit on the spiders.
- C. The role of stabilimenta in collecting drinking water was discovered independently of attempts to verify the reinforcement hypothesis.
- D. A spider web designed to trap rather than shed water needs to be structurally stronger than one that sheds water.
- E. The threads that make up the stabilimenta are as strong as the threads that make up the rest of the web.

Passage 278

A team of researchers has claimed that by drilling below the Earth's surface, they have been able to recover microorganisms that inhabit depths where it was previously thought that no life existed. Although other microorganisms that were at first thought to have been recovered from these depths were later determined merely to have come from surface soil, that cannot be so in this case, because _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following most logically completes the argument?

- A. Some of the microorganisms found by the researchers are incapable of living near the Earth's surface.
- B. Some of the microorganisms found by the researchers are known to inhabit the surface soil near the researchers' drilling site.
- C. When drilling below the Earth's surface, it is impossible to prevent contamination of the drill by surface-soil microorganisms.
- D. It is difficult to keep microorganisms alive once they have been recovered from underneath the Earth's surface.
- E. The drilling equipment used by the team of researchers was similar to drilling equipment used by most previous teams of researchers investigating life below the surface of the Earth.

Passage 279

In November 1753, the British author Sarah Fielding received half the payment for her novel *The Cry* and asked that the other half, when due, go to her "or to whomsoever I shall appoint," probably implying that the remaining share was purposed for someone else. In fact, many believe that the novel was a collaborative venture between Fielding and Jane Collier. This specific collaboration was likely enough, as the two were close friends with similar interests. They wrote jointly authored letters, were both published authors with a lively interest in each other's work, and were passionate supporters of didacticism and innovation in fiction—core concerns of *The Cry*. However, contemporaries accredit the work solely to Fielding, and there is nothing in the novel that is incompatible with Fielding's other writings. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

For the following question, consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The passage presents which of the following as evidence in favor of Fielding and Collier's having collaborated in writing *The Cry*?

- A. Their friendship
- B. Their joint authorship of correspondence
- C. Their approach to fiction

2. It can be inferred that the author of the passage would agree with which of the following claims about *The Cry*?

- A. It develops themes commonly found in published works.
- B. It reflects an interest in the purposes to which fiction may be put.
- C. It contains elements that are incompatible with any of Collier's solo writings.
- D. It shows that the extent of Collier and Fielding's shared interests was not as wide as is generally thought.
- E. Parts of it were written jointly by Fielding and Collier.

Passage 280

The Moon once had a magnetic field, and Mars shows evidence of having had one early in its history, but neither object currently possess a magnetic field. But Mercury, which is halfway in size between the Moon and Mars, has an active and relatively strong magnetic field. Planetary scientists think that planets require a liquid core to sustain such a field, but the smaller the planet, the faster it cools. Mercury, **by all right**, should have a core as cold and **dead** as the Moon's, yet the magnetic field persists. This may result from the presence of elements like sulfur that, when mixed with iron, lower the melting point and keep the core molten. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary basis for the author's use of the expression "by all right" is Mercury's

- A. size
- B. early history
- C. temperature
- D. magnetic field
- E. chemical composition

2. In the context in which it appears, "dead" most nearly means

- A. latent
- B. inert
- C. dormant
- D. deceased
- E. obsolete

Passage 281

Experts have disagreed about where the genus *Varanus* (monitor lizards) derived. Since most existing species live in Australia, early researchers believed that *Varanus* originated in Australia and subsequently island hopped westward along the Indo-Australian archipelago. Herpetologist Robert Mertens later argued that *Varanus* possibly originated in the archipelago. Chromosomal analysis has since supported Mertens' contention, and additionally, **geologic evidence** refers to a crash between the archipelago and the Australian landmass after *Varanus* originated—a fact that could account for the genus' present distribution.

A relevant puzzle for scientists is the current distribution of *Varanus*' largest surviving species, the Komodo dragon. These carnivores inhabited only on four small islands in the archipelago where, scientists note, the prey base is too small to support mammalian carnivores. But the Komodo dragon has recently been revealed to control body temperature much more efficiently than do mammalian carnivores, enabling it to survive on about a tenth of the food energy demanded by a mammalian carnivore of comparable size. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred from the passage that the geographical distribution of the Komodo dragon is
 - A. currently less restricted than it was at the time researchers first began investigating the origins of the genus *Varanus*
 - B. currently more restricted than it was at the time researchers first began investigating the origins of the genus *Varanus*
 - C. less restricted than is the distribution of the genus *Varanus* as a whole
 - D. more restricted than is the distribution of the genus *Varanus* as a whole
 - E. viewed as evidence in favor of the hypothesis that the genus *Varanus* originated in the Indo-Australian archipelago
2. Which of the following elements in the debate over the origin of *Varanus* is NOT provided in the passage?
 - A. The evidence that led Mertens to argue that *Varanus* originated in the Indo-Australian archipelago
 - B. The evidence that led early researchers to argue that *Varanus* originated in Australia
 - C. A possible explanation of how *Varanus* might have spread to the Indo-Australian archipelago if it had originated in Australia
 - D. A possible explanation of how *Varanus* might have spread to Australia if it had originated in the Indo-Australian archipelago
 - E. An indication of the general present-day distribution of *Varanus* species between Australia and the Indo-Australian archipelago
3. It can be inferred that which of the following is true of the "geologic evidence" ?
 - A. It was first noted by Mertens as evidence in favor of his theory about the origins of *Varanus*.
 - B. It cannot rule out either one of the theories about the origins of *Varanus* discussed in the passage.
 - C. It accounts for the present distribution of the Komodo dragon.
 - D. It has led to renewed interest in the debate over the origins of *Varanus*.
 - E. It confirms the conclusions reached by early researchers concerning the origins of *Varanus*.

Passage 282

For *Temnothorax* ants in search of suitable rock crevices for new nest sites, size is an important consideration, and certain behaviors suggest how scouts might compare the size of several sites. After entering a crevice, scouts invariably exit and reenter. During their first inspection, they mark their route with their personal pheromones. (Experiments have shown that workers can distinguish their own pheromones from those of nest mates.) Some **researchers** believe that these ants are counting the frequency of intersections between their two exploratory trails. The smaller the area, the more likely they are to cross a spot twice. **The observation that *Temnothorax* scouts always pave out a path of the same length on their first visit to sites strongly supports this hypothesis.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. In light of the claim made by the “researchers”, it can be inferred that ants’ ability to distinguish their own pheromones from those of nest mates is important primarily because
 - A. ants would otherwise be unable to tell whether potential mating sites were occupied by related colonies.
 - B. the ability aids in the assignment of specific tracks such as scouting for new nests, among the various members of a nest.
 - C. ants who could not distinguish their own personal pheromones would be unable to tell if they had previously embraced a site
 - D. pheromone differentiation is essential to account evaluation of potential nesting sites
 - E. pheromone differentiation is essential to ants’ ability to evaluate the size of crevices before entering them
2. Which of the following best describe the function of the highlighted portion of the passage?
 - A. It clarifies the relationship between the scout ants’ behavior and the quality of a potential nesting site.
 - B. It offers a hypothesis to explain why ants make only two trips through each potential nesting site
 - C. It attempts to reconcile the behavior of scout ants with the nesting locations eventually chosen by their colonies
 - D. It challenges the conclusion of researchers about scout ants’ specific behavior
 - E. It undermines observations of former experiments about *Temnothorax* ants’ ability to distinguish pheromones

Passage 283

If a supernova (the explosion of a massive star) triggered star formation from dense clouds of gas and dust, and if the most massive star to be formed from the cloud evolved into a supernova and triggered a new round of star formation, and so on, then a chain of star-forming regions would result. If many such chains were created in a differentially rotating galaxy, the distribution of stars would resemble the observed distribution in a spiral galaxy.

This line of reasoning underlies an exciting new theory of spiral-galaxy structure. A computer simulation based on this theory has reproduced the appearance of many spiral galaxies without assuming an underlying density wave, the hallmark of the most widely accepted theory of the large-scale structure of spiral galaxies. That theory maintains that a density wave of spiral form sweeps through the central plane of a galaxy, compressing clouds of gas and dust, which collapse into stars that form a spiral pattern. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. describe what results when a supernova triggers the creation of chains of star-forming regions
 - B. propose a modification in the most widely accepted theory of spiral-galaxy structure
 - C. compare and contrast the roles of clouds of gas and dust in two theories of spiral-galaxy structure
 - D. describe a new theory of spiral-galaxy structure and contrast it with the most widely accepted theory
 - E. describe a new theory of spiral-galaxy structure and discuss a reason why it is inferior to the most widely accepted theory
2. The passage implies that, according to the new theory of spiral-galaxy structure, a spiral galaxy can be created by supernovas when the supernovas are
 - A. producing an underlying density wave
 - B. affected by a density wave of spiral form
 - C. distributed in a spiral pattern
 - D. located in the central plane of a galaxy
 - E. located in a differentially rotating galaxy
3. Which of the following, if true, would most discredit the new theory as described in the passage?
 - A. The exact mechanism by which a star becomes a supernova is not yet completely known and may even differ for different stars.
 - B. Chains of star-forming regions like those postulated in the new theory have been observed in the vicinity of dense clouds of gas and dust.
 - C. The most massive stars formed from supernova explosions are unlikely to evolve into supernovas.
 - D. Computer simulations of supernovas provide a poor picture of what occurs just before a supernova explosion.
 - E. A density wave cannot compress clouds of gas and dust to a density high enough to create a star.

Passage 284

In the mid-seventeenth century, some Native Americans in colonial New England started to keep and manage livestock for the first time, doing so according to their own cultural priorities and interests. Several factors influenced their decision to keep animals, including threats to their land base and to the productivity of their hunting. It might appear that animal husbandry as practiced by Europeans would have posed an insurmountable sociocultural challenge for Indians. **Scholars studying the issue have argued that livestock would have compromised the mobility needed for winter hunting, destroyed crops, competed with wild game for resources, and violated prevailing conceptions of property and of human-animal interconnectedness.** Such obstacles were indeed difficult, but creative ways to overcome them were found. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describes the primary function of the highlighted sentence?
- A. It identifies an atypical scholarly viewpoint regarding Native Americans and animal husbandry.
 - B. It helps to explain why animal husbandry was not adopted by more Native Americans in colonial New England.
 - C. It points out some of the typical misconceptions that scholars have regarding Native Americans in colonial New England.
 - D. It identifies factors that ultimately transformed the Native American way of life.
 - E. It identifies certain challenges that practicing animal husbandry posed for Native Americans in colonial New England.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. It can be inferred that the author would agree with which of the following statements about animal husbandry by Native Americans in colonial New England?
- A. Its adoption required some cultural adjustment by Native American societies.
 - B. Its influence eventually led to changes in the husbandry practices used by Europeans in the regions.
 - C. It may have allowed those who adopted it to compensate, in whole or in part, for reduced hunting yields.

Passage 285

Analyzing the physics of dance can add fundamentally to a dancer's skill. Although dancers seldom see themselves totally in physical terms—as body mass moving through space under the influence of well-known forces and obeying physical laws—neither can they afford to ignore the physics of movement. For example, no matter how much a dancer wishes to leap off the floor and then start turning, the law of conservation of angular momentum absolutely prevents such a movement.

Some movements involving primarily vertical or horizontal motions of the body as a whole, in which rotations can be ignored, can be studied using simple equations of linear motion in three dimensions. However, rotational motions require more complex approaches that involve analyses of the way the body's mass is distributed, the axes of rotation involved in different types of movement, and the sources of the forces that produce the rotational movement. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author mentions all of the following as contributing to an understanding of the physics of dance EXCEPT

- A. the law of conservation of angular momentum
- B. analyses of the way in which the body's mass is distributed
- C. equations of linear motion in three dimensions
- D. analyses of the sources that produce rotational motions
- E. the technical terms for movements such as leaps and turns

2. Analysis of which of the following would require the kind of complex approach described in the last sentence?

- A. a long leap across space
- B. a short jump upward with a return to the same place
- C. a sustained and controlled turn in place
- D. short, rapid steps forward and then backward without turning
- E. quick side steps in a diagonal line

Passage 286

The most believable justification for higher taxes on automobile fuel is that fuel consumption diminishes the environment and thus increases the costs of traffic congestion. But the fact that burning fuel generates these “negative externalities” does not indicate that no tax on fuel could ever be too high. Economics is accurate about the tax that should, in principle, be levied to cope with negative externalities: **the tax on a liter of fuel should equal the harm resulted from using a liter of fuel**. If the tax is more than that, its costs (including the inconvenience to those who would rather have used their cars) will **exceed** its benefits (including any reduction in congestion and pollution). 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. In the last sentence, “exceed” most closely means
 - A. outstrip
 - B. magnify
 - C. delimit
 - D. offset
 - E. supplant
2. Which of the following best features the function of the indicated portion of the passage?
 - A. It restates a point made earlier in the passage.
 - B. It provides the evidence on which a theory is based.
 - C. It presents a specific application of a general principle.
 - D. It summarizes a justification with which the author disagrees.
 - E. It suggests that the benefits of a particular strategy have been overestimated.

Passage 287

The national crime rate has been declining, but television news coverage of crime has been increasing. Many media analysts hold that the increasing emphasis on crime is making viewers more mistrustful of others and more afraid of crime. To support this position, they cite survey results that show that the people most likely to be mistrustful of others and to overestimate the crime rate are those who watch the most television. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the support provided by the survey results for the media analysts’ position?

- A. There are many people who are deeply mistrustful of others and watch little or no television.
- B. Most people who have themselves been victims of a crime overestimate the crime rate and are mistrustful of others.
- C. Among people who say that they are not mistrustful of others, the great majority say that they believe that when an individual event is portrayed on television, it is portrayed accurately.
- D. Most people who watch television news on a regular basis say that they find crime stories more interesting than most other kinds of stories.
- E. People who are unusually suspicious and particularly afraid of crime tend to stay home watching television more than do people who are not.

Passage 288

Only since the Second World War has graphic design been categorized as a field worth knowing about and preserving, and most design collections have been narrowly defined. There are few extant archives of advertisements, some design collections include only political posters by established artists, other collections focus on such specific historical documents as election posters. **Rigidly defined collections like these can foster pigeonholed concepts of design history.** In contrast, Merrill Berman's ambitious reach as a collector—one that includes avant—graphics, anonymous political posters, and commercial advertisements—preserves graphics in a wide range to show how graphic designs pervade a culture, not in isolation from one another but all mixed together part of the daily inundation of meanings and visual stimulation. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following best describes the function of the highlight sentence

- A. It offers a critique of the design collections referenced in the preceding sentence
- B. It questions the motivation behind Berman's graphic design collection
- C. It illustrates why graphic design was not viewed as an important field of study before the Second World War
- D. It identifies an understanding of design history that informed Berman's early career
- E. It supports an argument against Berman's eclectic approach to collecting

Passage 289

During the early nineteenth century, the demand for ever-louder sound led to ever-increasing tension on piano strings, making evident the need for stronger framing. Sooner or later, long after factories had taken over the manufacture of other commodities, the Industrial Revolution nevertheless shaped the attitudes of those who decided whether to accept this innovation. To build pianos with steam-powered tools was one thing, to put a cast-iron frame at the center of the instrument, making the product itself a modern factory of sound rather than a fully handcrafted artwork, in wood, was quite another. The resulting debate was vigorous, with many feeling certain that iron in the piano would ruin the **tone**. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. Which of the following statements about the development of the piano can be inferred from the passage?

- A. Pianos continued to be made by artisans well into the nineteenth century.
- B. The use of steam-powered tools in piano making led to a decline in tone quality.
- C. Prior to the Industrial Revolution, the framing in piano was made entirely of wood.

2. In the context in which it appears, "tone" most exactly means

- A. interval
- B. mood
- C. timbre
- D. pitch
- E. shade

Passage 290

Virtually everyone who speaks Torvic lives in Torvia, a small country that takes pride in its unique culture. Since Torvia trades with many other countries, however, most people who live in Torvia speak several languages, and many languages are taught in Torvia's public schools. Nevertheless, from these facts it should not be inferred that most speakers of Torvic speak several languages, because _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following most logically completes the argument?

- A. very few languages are as difficult to learn as a second language as Torvic is
- B. of all the people in the world who speak several languages, only a small minority speak Torvic
- C. few people who live in Torvia actually speak Torvic
- D. few people who live in Torvia have ever lived outside Torvia
- E. some of the languages taught in Torvia's public schools are not spoken in any of the countries with which Torvia trades

Passage 291

During the 1920s, most proponents of scientific management, Frederick Taylor's approach for maximizing workers' productivity by intensively routinizing their jobs, antagonized the five-day workweek. Despite scientific managers conceded that decreasing hours might supply an incentive to workers, in practice they more often utilized pay differentials to encourage higher productivity. Those **reformers** who wanted to accept both scientific management and reduced hours had to make a greatly negative case, depicting the latter as an antidote to the rigors of the former. In conflict to the scientific managers, Henry Ford stated that shorter hours caused larger productivity and profits. However, few employers matched either Ford's vision or his particular interest in mass marketing a product—**automobiles**—that requested leisure for its use, and few unions succeeded in saving shorter hours through bargaining. **At its 1928 convention, the American Federation of Labor (AFL) boasted of approachingly 165,000 members working five-day, 40-hour weeks.** But even though this represented an raise of about 75,000 since 1926, about 70 percent of the entire came from five enormously well-organized building trades' unions. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is primarily concerned with discussing which of the following?
 - A. The relative merits of two points of view regarding a controversy
 - B. The potential benefits to workers in the 1920s of a change in employers' policies
 - C. The reasons for a labor-management disagreement during the 1920s
 - D. The status of a contested labor issue during the 1920s
 - E. The role of labor unions in bringing about a reform
2. It can be inferred that the author of the passage mentions "automobiles" primarily to suggest that
 - A. Ford's business produced greater profits than did businesses requiring a workweek longer than five days
 - B. Ford, unlike most other employers, encouraged his employees to use the products they produced
 - C. Ford may have advocated shorter hours because of the particular nature of his business
 - D. unions were more likely to negotiate for shorter hours in some businesses than in others
 - E. automobile workers' unions were more effective than other unions in securing a five-day workweek
3. It can be inferred that the author of the passage would probably agree with which of the following claims about the boast highlighted?
 - A. It is based on a mistaken estimation of the number of AFL workers who were allowed to work a five-day, 40-hour week in 1928.
 - B. It could create a mistaken impression regarding the number of unions obtaining a five-day, 40-hour week during the 1920s.
 - C. It exaggerates the extent of the increase between 1926 and 1928 in AFL members working a five-day, 40-hour week.
 - D. It overestimates the bargaining prowess of the AFL building trades' unions during the 1920s.
 - E. It is based on an overestimation of the number of union members in the AFL in 1928.
4. According to the passage, the "reformers" claimed that
 - A. neither scientific management nor reduced hours would result in an improvement in the working conditions of most workers
 - B. the impact that the routinization of work had on workers could be mitigated by a reduction in the length of their workweek
 - C. there was an inherent tension between the principles of scientific management and a commitment to reduced workweeks
 - D. scientific managers were more likely than other managers to use pay differentials to encourage higher productivity
 - E. reducing the length of the workweek would increase productivity more effectively than would increases in pay

Passage 292

Unlike the static, classically composed portraits produced by her mentor Walker Evans, twentieth-century New York photographer Helen Levitt's photographs seem candid and spontaneous. Whereas Evans' subjects look directly into the camera, so that photographer and subject conspire in the making of a portrait, Levitt's subjects seem caught unawares. As a "street" photographer, before the term's invention, Levitt has claimed to have attempted to capture life as she found it. But there is a paradox to her technique. Her off-the-cuff aesthetic seemingly guarantees objectivity, since she was recording street scenes she happened upon, yet her photographs could be said to be highly subjective, to be reflections of Levitt's own distinctive preoccupations and ways of seeing. Unlike Evans' images, Levitt's are solely the products of the photographer without the conscious participation of their subjects. The repetitions evident in Levitt's choices of subjects, for example, her many photographs of children in masks and disguises, reveal more about Levitt herself than about those subjects.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, which of the following appears to ensure the objectivity of Levitt's photographs?

- A. She took photographs in public places rather than in a studio.
- B. She was not personally acquainted with the subjects of her photographs.
- C. She did not arrange the scenes or pose the subjects she photographed.
- D. She avoided using classical principles of composition.
- E. She was guided by her subjects' preoccupations rather than by her own.

2. The passage asserts which of the following about Evans' portrait photographs?

- A. Evans' photographs indicate a conscious rejection of the approaches associated with street photography.
- B. The subjects in an Evans' photograph become collaborators in the portrait's creation.
- C. Evans' photographic portraits usually reveal more about Evans than they do about his subjects.
- D. Evans' static, classically composed portraits reveal Evans' preoccupation with maintaining an appearance of objectivity.
- E. Evans' static, classically composed portraits reveal little about his distinctive way of seeing.

3. The passage suggests which of the following about street photography?

- A. It characteristically depicts groups of people rather than individual subjects.
- B. It tends to depict a narrow and repetitious range of subject matter.
- C. It creates the impression of spontaneity but often actually involves scenes contrived by the photographer.
- D. Its early practitioners were not accorded much recognition for their aesthetic achievements.
- E. It had not been named as such when Levitt began practicing this kind of photography.

Passage 293

United State women won the vote in 1920 after decades of campaigning. Yet, the impact on women's status was more limited than women's rights activists had anticipated. Women were granted suffrage at a historical point when voting was no longer a significant political activity for many Americans. In the mid-nineteenth century, when women first sought suffrage rights, voter turnout rates were unprecedentedly high, elections in much of the country very competitive, and political parties important. But when women finally received the vote in 1920, electoral politics was largely noncompetitive, with virtual one-party rule in many areas, and voter turnout had slipped to its all-time low. **Nonetheless, the vote still mattered enough for women to seek it and for conservatives to try to restrict its availability.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage discusses voter turnout rates primarily in order to
 - A. confirm an assumption about the impact of women suffrage on united states electoral politics
 - B. explain a significant change in American political life that occurred over the course of the campaign for woman suffrage
 - C. account for changes in the importance of political parties between the mid-nineteenth and early twentieth centuries.
 - D. identify a reason elections were less competitive after 1920 than they had been in earlier decades.
 - E. illustrate a point about the importance of political parties in the mid-nineteenth century
2. The author of the passage mentions conservatives in the highlighted sentence primarily in order to
 - A. account for long lag between the beginning of the woman suffrage movement and the achievement of voting rights for women
 - B. suggest that political parties had a larger role in opposing woman suffrage than has sometimes been acknowledged
 - C. confirm that the attaining of woman suffrage was politically important in spite of a national devaluation of voting
 - D. identify a reason that the granting of voting rights to women had less political impact than women's rights activists hoped
 - E. argue that women's votes had a greater impact on United States electoral politics than was previously believed

Passage 294

Some studies have shown that red-backed salamanders (RBS) are scarce in areas with acidic soils and that those present in such conditions have smaller-than-average bodies.

Explanations have included the possibility that young RBS are adversely affected by acidic soil, that adult RBS can sense and may avoid acidic soil conditions, or that loss of RBS prey populations due to acidic soil could result in reduced RBS populations. Yet researchers found fairly high densities of large-bodied RBS at Lake Claire Watershed, where soil conditions are acidic. One hypothesis is that intraspecific geographical variation in acidity tolerance (i.e., local adaptation to an acidic environment) could exist for RBS. Previous studies showed potential local adaptation of some salamander species to acidity. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following can be inferred about the studies mentioned in the highlighted portion of the passage?

- A. They may have undercounted RBS in their study areas due to faulty methodology.
- B. They focused less on adult RBS than on RBS in the early stages of their development.
- C. They found evidence that acidic conditions adversely affect the prey on which RBS depend.
- D. They drew unsubstantiated conclusions about the possible adverse effects of acidic conditions on RBS.
- E. They were conducted in areas where the soil conditions were similar to those at Lake Claire Watershed.

2. The primary purpose of the passage is to

- A. cite evidence that appears to contradict a widely held assumption
- B. present contrasting interpretations of a particular research finding
- C. explain how a particular environmental change can produce diverse outcomes
- D. note an unexpected finding and summarize new possible explanation for it
- E. identify a correlation and explain why one hypothesis about it is more persuasive than others

Passage 295

Tropical forests typically have many more species of plants and animals than do temperate forests of comparable size. During the Ice Age, forests in temperate regions were destroyed, while those in the tropics were not. Accordingly, one proposed explanation of this difference in the number of species is that tropical forests typically had a much longer period than temperate forests in which different species could take hold. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most strongly supports the proposed explanation?

- A. The greater warmth of tropical forests enables them to sustain a greater density of plants and animals than temperate forests can.
- B. There is virtually no overlap between the species that are found in tropical forests and those found in temperate forests.
- C. Some areas that were temperate forests before the Ice Age are no longer forested.
- D. The number of plants and animal species is no greater in tropical forests that have arisen since the Ice Age than in temperate forests of comparable size.
- E. A change in climate tends to increase the rate at which new species become established in a region.

Passage 296

Federal courts in the United States, especially before the famous 1962 case of *Baker v. Carr*, were often thought to be powerless in the area of election law, voting rights, and other legal questions clearly bearing on politics. This perception was not entirely correct, of course, as pre-1962 Supreme Court decisions such as that in the case of *Smith v. Allwright* demonstrated in the wake of that decision, voting participation among African Americans in the South increased substantially. However, political rights had not always been so clearly championed by the Supreme Court as they were in *Smith v. Allwright*. Indeed, the transformations between the Civil War and 1962 were such that, in reviewing voters' rights cases over the intervening decades, one feels like an archaeologist cutting through distinct layers in which the judicial decisions uncovered reveal a pattern of ideological and societal change. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage uses the analogy of the archaeology most probably in order to

A. contrast judicial decisions made after 1962 concerning voters rights with decision made immediately after the Civil War

B. suggest that the author is perplexed by many judicial decisions regarding voters' rights

C. characterize the nature of change in judicial thinking regarding voters' rights

D. indicate that much of the history of voters' rights has been lost since the Civil War

E. illustrate the lack of concern for voters' rights exhibited by federal courts before the Civil War

2. Which of the following can be inferred regarding the case of *Baker v. Carr*?

A. Its outcome required clarification in subsequent decisions rendered by the Supreme Court.

B. Its resolution attested to the power of federal courts to address legal issues related to politics.

C. It marked a radical change in judicial thinking in the United States.

D. It was decided before the Supreme Courts heard the case of *Smith v. Allwright*.

E. It has little historical significance aside from its focus on laws affecting politics.

Passage 297

In *A Fine Brush on Ivory*, his **appreciation of** novelist Jane Austen, Richard Jenkins remarks that in Austen scholarship, there are pressures that cause ordinary critical circumspection to break down. Principal among those pressures is the peculiar affection in which the person of Jane Austen is held by many readers. This affection is not altogether explained by admiration for her genius, nor is it entirely a symptom of nostalgia for her orderly, decorous, even mysterious life. Writers have led critics to approach her work in mostly biographical or historical ways, often in defiance of other critical fashions, especially the various formal approaches that have dominated modern literary criticism. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. According to the passage, critics approach Jane Austen's work in biographical or historical ways for which of the following reasons?
 - A. They find her work particularly well suited to biographical and historical readings.
 - B. They are unsatisfied with the formal approaches that have dominated modern literary criticism.
 - C. They feel the need to know the baffling writer personally.
2. In the context in which it appears, "appreciation of" most nearly means
 - A. gratitude toward
 - B. awareness of
 - C. appraisal of
 - D. esteem for
 - E. grasp of

Passage 298

The traditional color of fire trucks is red, but in cities that have introduced yellow trucks into their fleets, the rate of traffic accidents per mile driven among these trucks has been far lower than the rate among red trucks. Some critics of the innovation have questioned whether **this difference should be attributed to color**, given that the yellow trucks were generally newer than the red trucks with which they were compared. But this criticism can be dismissed. Certainly, **the mere difference in accident rates is not decisive evidence**. The decisive fact is that the rates differed significantly only in the hours around dawn and dusk. At these hours, the visibility of yellow is known to be better than that of red. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

In the argument given, the two highlighted portions play which of the following roles?

- A. The first is a statement of the position the argument as a whole opposes; the second is a statement of the position it defends.
- B. The first is a claim that the argument as a whole calls into question; the second denies the rationale presented by some critics of that claim.
- C. The first is a claim that the argument as a whole calls into question; the second points out an error of reasoning made by defenders of that claim.
- D. The first is the position defended in the argument; the second is an intermediate conclusion drawn to support that position.
- E. The first is the position defended in the argument; the second concedes a point to critics of that position.

Passage 299

Findings in biological anthropology suggest that Native Americans' ancestors probably came to the Americas from northeastern Asia. Turner, for example, has studied the dentition of prehistoric and living Native Americans and northeastern Asians. Based on approximately twenty dental traits, including tooth-crown shape and number of roots, he has defined an overall dental pattern called Sinodonty, which includes three-rooted lower first molars and shovel-shaped incisors. This distinctive pattern is shared among most Native Americans and people from northeastern Asia, but is not found in people who originated in southern Asia, Africa, or Europe. Another less complex pattern—Sundadonty—is shared among the people of southeastern Asia and is also found in prehistoric American populations, but Turner believes that widespread Sinodonty demonstrates most Native Americans' northeastern Asian origins. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The passage implies that Turner's conclusion regarding the origins of most Native American populations is based in part on which of the following findings?
 - A. The presence of Sundadonty among prehistoric American populations
 - B. The prevalence of shovel-shaped incisors among Native Americans
 - C. The absence of Sinodonty among people from southern Asia, Africa, and Europe.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. According to the passage, Sinodonty and Sundadonty differ from one another in that Sinodonty
 - A. has been found among prehistoric Native American populations, while Sundadonty has not.
 - B. is a more complex dental pattern than Sundadonty is
 - C. occurs frequently in modern Native American populations, while Sundadonty does not.

Passage 300

Belnovia's government provides health care to all its citizens. Five years ago, with costs incurred from smoking-related health problems accounting for 5 percent of annual government expenditures, Belnovia's health agency initiated a nationwide antismoking campaign. Although the campaign succeeded in reducing the number of smokers in Belnovia substantially, it clearly failed to reduce the annual costs incurred from smoking-related health problems, since these costs currently account for 6 percent of annual government expenditures. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

- A. Costs incurred from smoking-related health problems account for a greater portion of the Belnovian government's overall health expenditures now than they did five years ago.
- B. The average cost of treatment for smoking related health problems in Belnovia has not increased significantly over the past five years.
- C. Overall health expenditure account for a greater portion of the Belnovian government's annual expenditures now than they did five years' ago.
- D. Belnovia's annual government expenditures are not significantly lower now than they were five years ago.
- E. Smoking-related health problems usually persist long after a person has quit smoking.

Passage 301

Edith Wharton's reputation may be secure, but it is the wrong kind of reputation: she is celebrated as a novelist concerned with elegant surfaces and manners. Critics have misunderstood the nature of her contribution to modern fiction largely because they misperceive her subject matter as genteel and effete. **Even sympathetic critics fail to acknowledge the extent to which Wharton challenged contemporary mores.** Between her early novel *The House of Mirth* (1905) and her last, *The Buccaneers* (1938), Wharton addressed subjects that many might think of as decidedly un-Whartonesque, including marital strife and rural and urban poverty. Yet she remains firmly enshrined as a scion of rarefied upper-class America, an image reinforced by Martin Scorsese's sumptuous 1993 film adaptation of *The Age of Innocence*. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author would most likely agree with which of the following statements about Scorsese's film adaptation of *The Age of Innocence*?
 - A. It is not as true to the novel as are other film adaptations of Wharton's works.
 - B. It has encouraged a misguided impression of Wharton and her work.
 - C. It was based on a highly unusual interpretation of *The Age of Innocence*.
 - D. It did some damage to Wharton's reputation as a major figure in modern fiction.
 - E. It spent too much time dwelling on subject matter that many would consider un-Whartonesque.
2. The author implies which of the following about the challenge referred to in the highlighted sentence?
 - A. It goes against the main current of modern fiction.
 - B. It has recently become a matter of scholarly controversy.
 - C. It became bolder and more pronounced at the end of Wharton's career.
 - D. It does not manifest itself in Wharton's novel *The Age of Innocence*.
 - E. It spanned all or nearly all of Wharton's writing career.

Passage 302

While captive orangutans learn to use tools, wild orangutans have not been observed doing so until recently when researchers witnessed orangutans near Suaq Balimbing in Sumatra using tools to extract insects from tree holes and seeds from the Neesia fruit. What explains this population's tool use? It is doubtful that the Suaq orangutans are intrinsically smarter: captive orangutans have demonstrated that the species has the brain capacity to use tools. Another explanation is environmental. While previously studied orangutans mostly inhabited dry forests, the Suaq orangutans inhabit a lush swamp where insects flourish in tree holes and Neesia fruit is abundant. However, **orangutans in other habitats where Neesia grows** do harvest the seeds, but without tools they obtain fewer than do the Suaq orangutans. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage mentions "orangutans in other habitats where Neesia grows" primarily in order to
- A. explain why orangutans living in dry forests apparently do not use tools to obtain foods
 - B. propose an alternative to the environmental explanation for Suaq orangutans' tool use
 - C. demonstrate how environment may influence orangutan populations' brain capacity
 - D. contrast the food preferences of the Suaq orangutans with those of orangutans living in other habitats
 - E. suggest that the Suaq orangutans' tool use cannot be explained merely by the availability of certain foods in their habitat

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The passage suggests which of the following about orangutans that live mostly in dry forests?
- A. They probably use some tools, though this tool use has not been observed by researchers
 - B. They dislike the foods that the orangutans living near Suaq Balimbing prefer.
 - C. They probably have the same capacity for tool use as have orangutans living near Suaq Balimbing.

Passage 303

In 431 B.C. several hundred cavalry soldiers received a state burial outside the gates of Athens. Archaeologists excavating at the location of these gates found the bones of hundreds of men that dated to the period of the funeral. There are other gravesites in the area; however, examination of the bones in question indicates that the men frequently rode horses, as would be true of cavalry soldiers. Therefore, the bones are probably those of the soldiers, since _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following most logically completes the argument?

- A. There are no historical records of any state burial of foot soldiers in that location around that period.
- B. None of the other gravesites in the area contain the bones of women, who were not permitted to be soldiers in ancient Athens.
- C. Few Athenian men who lived during that period rode horses frequently.
- D. None of the bones at the gravesite are those of horses.
- E. Ancient historians do not provide specific enough descriptions to enable archaeologists to pinpoint the burial's exact location.

Passage 304

In 1886 approximately 20 percent of United States workers belonged to the Knights of Labor, a labor-activist fraternal order. Nonetheless, soon after reaching this peak, the Knights membership began a rapid decline, and the organization never regained its national prominence. This collapse had wide-ranging repercussions: subsequent worker organizations took a less active and less broad-based organizational approach. The Knights' defeat demoralized those who championed radical reform and the organization of workers as a class, while empowering those who promoted a less inclusive strategy.

Current scholarship has tended to attribute the Knights calamitous decline to two factors: persistent tension between skilled and unskilled workers, and fierce opposition from employer associations, which used extralegal means to undermine unions. Voss examined both factors and found that employer associations' opposition, not conflict among the Knights, led to the Knights' rapid decline. But Voss's account fails to explain why the Knights succumbed so easily when other union movements thrived. It seems that the Knights' particular organizational structure prompted factional disputes among members and, more important, that competition from rival trade and fraternal **organizations** lured members away. While dissension within the order might not itself have sufficed to cause its demise, the profusion of organizational alternatives during this period induced mass defection, and, subsequently, the transformation of the American labor movement. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author would be most likely to agree with which of the following statements about "Current scholarship"?
 - A. It underestimates the extent to which the American labor movement was affected by the decline in influence of the Knights of Labor.
 - B. It tends to downplay the intensity of the tension between skilled and unskilled workers who belonged to the Knights of Labor
 - C. It offers a more accurate view of the factors that led to the decline of the Knights of Labor than was offered in earlier scholarship.
 - D. It tends to characterize the organizational structure of the Knights of Labor in ways that obscure its effect on the organization's decline
 - E. It fails to identify a key factor that accounts for the decline in membership of the Knights of Labor.
2. According to the passage, the rapid decline in the Knights of Labor membership resulted in which of the following?
 - A. Greater prominence of labor activists who advocated a relatively moderate approach to organizing workers
 - B. Increasing tensions between labor activists who advocated a broad-based approach to organizing workers and those who advocated a less inclusive approach
 - C. A decline in the number of workers who regarded labor organizing as an effective means of advancing their interests
 - D. An increase in the aggressiveness with which employer associations sought to undermine workers' efforts to organize
 - E. An increase in public concern over the use of extralegal means to undermine workers' efforts to organize
3. The author implies that the "organizations" highlighted in the passage were
 - A. strengthened by their adoption of the Knights' organizational structure
 - B. weakened by their separation of skilled from unskilled workers
 - C. more intent than the Knights had been on achieving radical political reforms
 - D. more aggressive than the Knights had been in countering the extralegal strategies used by employer associations
 - E. less committed than the Knights had been to including all workers

Passage 305

While direct bite-inflicted injury is the most commonly observed mechanism for Komodo dragons to dispatch prey, the role of bacteria in aiding prey death is poorly known. One study identified in the lizards' saliva and oral cavities 58 species of bacteria, 93 percent of which are classified as potentially pathogenic. Auffenberg proposed that the bacteria are **beneficial** to the lizards in essence a slow-acting venom that facilitate prey capture by attacking lizards. He offered no mechanism by which the bacteria are acquired by lizards, however. Fry et al. questioned this interpretation, and proposed that sepsis-inducing bacteria are more plausibly acquired passively from prey and other environmental sources, with no role in prey acquisition. That model fits the observation that captive lizards (and presumably newborns) lack sepsis-inducing bacteria. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred from the passage that Auffenberg regarded the bacteria in Komodo dragon saliva as "beneficial" because he believed that these bacteria

- A. play an important role in helping the lizards digest their food
- B. play an important role in maintaining the lizards' immune systems
- C. are a weapon used by the lizards to incapacitate their prey
- D. are transmitted directly from parent lizards to their offspring
- E. deter larger predators from attacking the lizards

2. Select a sentence in the passage that highlights a gap in an explanation.

Passage 306

The hypothesis that paranormal phenomena are real but lie outside the limits of science is supported by considerable evidence. The *Society for Psychical Research* has collected stories of ordinary people apparently demonstrating paranormal abilities. Entirely anecdotal, this evidence has nothing to do with science, since it cannot be reproduced under controlled conditions. But the society took great trouble to interview first-hand witnesses and to document the stories carefully. One fact that emerges clearly from the stories is that paranormal events occur, if they occur at all, only when people are experiencing strong emotion. This would immediately explain why paranormal phenomena are not observable under the conditions of a well-controlled scientific experiment. **Strong emotion is inherently incompatible with controlled scientific procedures.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describes the role played in the passage by the highlighted sentence?
- A. It states the main conclusion of the author's argument.
 - B. It provides a basis for a recommended course of action.
 - C. It articulates a principle that supports the claim made in the preceding sentence.
 - D. It is intended to undermine the credibility of apparent evidence that the author has mentioned earlier in the passage.
 - E. It serves to emphasize a limitation of the evidence collected by the *Society for Psychical Research*.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. It can be inferred that the author of the passage would agree with which of the following descriptions of the evidence collected by the *Society for Psychical Research*?
- A. carefully recorded
 - B. unscientific
 - C. credible

Passage 307

More than two decades after the death of George Balanchine, the choreographer's legacy is strangely unclear. In part this is because ballet has shallow roots in American culture. When Balanchine arrived in the United States in 1933, American ballet was little more than a vaudeville act. During the next 50 years, he raised American ballet to an internationally recognized art, producing an impressive body of great ballets and laying a foundation for generations to come—or so it was thought at the time of his death. But dance has no written tradition and disappears easily from collective memory: unless Balanchine's dances are alive and interesting now, we are likely to forget why they ever seemed so important. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. It can be inferred that the author of the passage would probably agree with which of the following statements about ballet's lack of a written tradition?

- A. This lack is one reason that ballet has shallow roots in American culture.
- B. This lack makes it imperative that a ballet be performed regularly for it to remain alive.
- C. This lack makes it more difficult to preserve a particular ballet in the public's consciousness.

2. The passage suggests that at the time of Balanchine's death, many people thought which of the following about Balanchine's work?

- A. There was little danger that Balanchine's work would be forgotten.
- B. It was unlikely that Balanchine's body of work would ever be equaled.
- C. Balanchine's work had only shallow roots in American culture.
- D. Balanchine's work was difficult to understand due to the lack of a written balletic tradition.
- E. Balanchine's work made work by other American choreographers look like a vaudeville act.

Passage 308

This passage is adapted from material published in 2019.

In 2018, the U.S. Congress passed the “45Q legislation,” which significantly increases corporate tax credits for various uses of CO₂ (carbon dioxide). The most controversial use is “enhanced oil recovery.” An oil company purchases CO₂, transports it by pipeline and injects it into depleted oil wells, pushing out extra oil it could not extract by conventional means. A climate change solution that entails producing more fossil fuels may sound Orwellian, and **some environmental critics** have attacked 45Q as just another fossil-fuel subsidy program in disguise. But enhanced oil recovery appears to reduce current emissions because the captured CO₂, typically from natural gas or ethanol refineries, gets sequestered underground. Some environmentalists, such as **Kurt Waltzer** of the Clean Air Task Force, argue that turning carbon capture into an energy technology, rather than an emissions technology, is the first step toward broad commercial adoption of CO₂ removal. It turns recaptured CO₂ into a product to be bought or sold rather than simply a cost to be endured. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is primarily concerned with
 - A. discussing a controversial aspect of specific legislation relating to CO₂
 - B. explaining the science of a new process for capturing CO₂
 - C. highlighting the shortcomings of a specific method of combating climate change
 - D. arguing that emissions technologies are the most effective method of combating climate change
 - E. summarizing the advantages of relying on legislation to combat climate change
2. According to the passage, “some environmental critics” object to the 45Q legislation on which of the following grounds?
 - A. It will drive up the price of captured CO₂.
 - B. The process of extracting extra oil could have unforeseen environmental consequences.
 - C. Fossil fuels extracted via enhanced oil recovery typically produce more carbon emissions than ethanol or natural gas.
 - D. It will replace current subsidy programs that have been proved effective.
 - E. Its proponents' claims that it is part of a climate change solution are misleading.
3. The passage suggests that Kurt Waltzer would likely agree with which of the following statements about the 45Q legislation
 - A. It will likely replace some of the fossil-fuel subsidy programs that are currently in effect
 - B. It is likely to impede the development of economically efficient ways of recapturing CO₂ for sequestration.
 - C. The positive effects of other portions of the legislation will likely outweigh the environmental harm caused by its controversial aspects
 - D. The incentives it provides for the production of more fossil fuel are an ineffective means of reducing the production of CO₂ byproducts.
 - E. Its provision of corporate tax credits for using CO₂ for enhanced oil recovery may offer a net gain in environmental terms

Passage 309

Despite today's more efficient electrical generators, modern electric-only power plants waste more of their fuel sources potential energy than did Thomas Edison's power plants of the late 1800s. Edison used cast-off steam from his generators to warm nearby homes and factories. But few modern power plants use this residual heat, instead venting it into the air. When newer, larger plants required more real estate, they were built farther from customers. Moreover, because electricity travels easily, plants were located wherever they could tap the energy of a river or where local coal was especially cheap. The heat generated during the production of electricity does not travel far, however, so when power plants moved out to the horizon, the steam went to waste. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred from the passage that, in general, locating modern power plants closer to population centers would have
 - A. compromised efforts to conserve energy in populated areas
 - B. decreased the demand for heating within those population centers
 - C. resulted in higher costs for the fuel used by those plants
 - D. required much larger plants than those currently operating
 - E. obliged power companies to find an alternative to coal as a fuel source
2. The author suggests that steam generated by modern power plants is not used for heating because
 - A. steam generally proves incompatible with most modern industrial needs
 - B. other means of heating have become more cost-effective
 - C. steam is no longer produced in sufficient quantities to be useful
 - D. insufficient demand for heating exists nearby
 - E. transporting steam long distances would prove to be prohibitively expensive

Passage 310

Manatees are large marine mammals that inhabit the coastal waters of southern Florida and feed on the vegetation that grows in shallow waters. They frequently gather in the vicinity of power stations that release heated water into the sea. Since the warmer water supports abundant vegetation, some biologists have hypothesized that manatees gather in these areas because they are attracted to this convenient source of food. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following, if true, most seriously undermines the hypothesis?
- A. When a power station near which manatees usually gather is shutdown for even a few hours, manatees move elsewhere.
 - B. Other marine animals that feed on vegetation also congregate in large numbers in the vicinity of power stations.
 - C. All of the species of vegetation that grow near the power stations also grow elsewhere in the coastal waters of southern Florida, though not nearly as abundantly.
 - D. Even more manatees than usual gather near power stations during the winter months, when vegetation growth away from power stations slows.
 - E. Manatees also tend to gather in waters where high levels of nutrients support especially abundant vegetation.

Passage 311

Victorian literature is much preoccupied with the social and moral effects of nineteenth-century capitalism, and literary critics long tended to address this **preoccupation** from an explicitly anticapitalist point of view, focusing particularly on Victorian novels' depictions of poverty, economic disparity, exploitation, and greed. However, in 1990s, scholars' inclination to take an explicitly critical stance toward capitalism in their studies of literature diminished, and a **new body of scholarship** emerged that is devoted to exploring, less polemically, the many ways in which literature reflects Victorian capitalism and its impact on individual lives.

This new work has caused some astonishment. In one essay, Rose remarked, "We are witnessing the emergence of something quite unprecedented—a capitalist criticism" and then suggested that literary criticism concerned with aspects of capitalism but not explicitly anticapitalist must be implicitly procapitalist. Yet Rose's response derives more from the assumption that an illuminating analysis of literature will, of necessity, entail a critique of capitalism than from evidence in the works Rose discusses, which treat capitalism simply as a fact of life. Insofar as we can define a new movement within literary studies it would be misleading to call it capitalist criticism. Rather, much of this new work is looking to uncover neglected aspects of Victorian culture. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author would be most likely to agree with which of the following statements about the "preoccupation"?

- A. It is an important aspect of Victorian literature that was largely neglected by scholars until the 1990s
- B. It is a less dominant aspect of Victorian literature than has been claimed by critics who take an explicitly anticapitalist position in their work
- C. It has been treated somewhat dismissively by critics who do not regard an examination of capitalism as an important aspect of literary criticism
- D. It is evident in a more diverse range of representations of capitalism in Victorian fiction than many critics have acknowledged.
- E. It has mistakenly been ascribed to some Victorian authors whose views of capitalism diverge from those of anticapitalist literary critics

2. Which of the following can be inferred from the passage about the "new body of scholarship"?

- A. It takes no interest in the social and moral effects of nineteenth-century capitalism.
- B. It is less methodologically sophisticated than the body of scholarship that it has superseded.
- C. It involved a reinterpretation of representations of economic disparity and poverty in Victorian literature.
- D. It emerged in response to the availability of new evidence about nineteenth-century economic conditions.
- E. It has resulted in a broader consensus among scholars of Victorian literature than had existed prior to the 1990s.

3. It can be inferred that Rose would disagree with the author of the passage about whether

- A. The movement that emerged in literary studies in the 1990s was motivated by anticapitalist sentiment
- B. Victorian authors displayed ambivalence about capitalism in their works
- C. recent literary criticism implicitly makes value judgments about Victorian capitalism
- D. literary representations of economic conditions offer reliable evidence about past social conditions
- E. literary critics should be concerned with the social conditions under which literary works are produced

4. The primary purpose of the passage is to

- A. suggest that a particular debate among literary critics has distorted their perceptions of Victorian literature
- B. describe and clarify the nature of a change in the direction of scholarship on Victorian literature
- C. contrast two approaches to Victorian literature and suggest that one is preferable to the other
- D. characterize a particular approach to Victorian literature and explain why the influence of that approach has diminished
- E. note an apparent contradiction between a particular aspect of Victorian literature and the way it has been treated by literary critics

Passage 312

Editorial

Opponents of a proposal to extend the city's subway line to two new stations claim that **the project will benefit only a small portion of the city's population**. These opponents are misguided. After all, the last time the line was extended, the greater availability of quick transport to the city reduced the number of private cars on city streets, thus benefiting everyone by easing rush-hour traffic. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. In the argument in the editorial, the part that is highlighted plays which of the following roles?
- A. stating the conclusion toward which the argument is directed
 - B. describing a circumstance that the argument seeks to explain
 - C. introducing the position to be refuted by the argument
 - D. serving as an intermediate conclusion that supports a further conclusion stated in the argument
 - E. introducing an explanation that is called into question by the argument

Passage 313

While export prices remained robust, British India's Tea Cess Committee (TCC) made only sporadic, small-scale attempts to create demand for tea in India by giving away pre-brewed cups in selected locations and selling **small packets of leaf fragments**. Still, by 1930 only a fraction of the Indian population had tasted tea, and more than 90 percent of the crop was exported. The Great Depression decisively changed the picture, however. International tea prices plunged, and by 1935 growers faced an unsold surplus of more than a hundred million pounds. The prospect of a huge "uninitiated" market suddenly seemed appealing, and the TCC, reorganized as the Indian Tea Market Expansion Board (ITMEB) and provided with an expanded budget, began the largest marketing campaign in Indian history. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage suggests that "small packets of leaf fragments" were
 - A. preferred by Indian consumers over other forms of tea
 - B. too valuable to be sold in large packets to consumers
 - C. marketed in response to a local surplus of unsold tea leaves
 - D. likely to sell for high prices if exported
 - E. an ineffective way to expand the local tea market
2. It can be inferred from the passage that the Tea Cess Committee reorganized as the Indian Tea Market Expansion Board in order to
 - A. appeal to Indian consumers' sense of national identity
 - B. escape the TCC's reputation for selling low-quality tea
 - C. increase the prestige of tea by emphasizing its exotic origins
 - D. receive a larger budget for marketing tea in India
 - E. respond to economic conditions created by the Great Depression

Passage 314

Since the 1970s, there has been a movement in African literary studies toward the recognition of national literatures in newly independent African states, such as Cameroon, Senegal, and Benin. But while in some of these national literatures there has undoubtedly emerged a sense of corporate identity, often marked by clear thematic and formal progressions, it remains an incontrovertible fact that the European languages in which these literatures are expressed have only an official acceptance: **they are neither indigenous to the cultures on which they have been imposed, nor are they national in any real sense of the word.** This must limit the claims of any of these literatures to national significance, however abundant the corpus or coherent the internal configurations. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, certain African literatures have
 - A. undergone significant changes since the 1970s
 - B. flourished as a result of governmental support
 - C. been directed primarily at non-African audiences
 - D. avoided openly discussing sensitive cultural issues
 - E. achieved a degree of internal cohesiveness
2. The highlighted portion of the passage serves primarily to
 - A. support a conclusion stated later in the passage
 - B. qualify an assertion presented earlier in the passage
 - C. suggest an explanation for an anomaly mentioned in the passage
 - D. offer a tentative answer to a question raised in the passage
 - E. justify the use of a term introduced earlier in the passage

Passage 315

Unlike most plants, cactuses absorb carbon dioxide from the air mainly at night. Night air contains greater quantities of certain types of carbon than does daytime air. Consequently, these types of carbon are more common in cactuses than in most other plants. Quintral plants, however, which grow as parasites on cactuses, contain nearly the same proportions of these types of carbon as cactuses. Therefore, quintral plants probably take significant quantities of carbon from their cactus hosts, since _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following most logically completes the argument?

A. in the desert climates where cactuses grow, carbon dioxide is significantly more abundant in the air during the day than at night

B. cactuses that have quintral plants growing as parasites on them do not absorb as much carbon dioxide from the air as do cactuses of comparable size that are free of parasites

C. quintral plants are the only kind of parasites that grow on such kinds of cactuses

D. in areas where quintral plants are common, individual cactuses often have several such plants growing on them

E. nearly all of the carbon dioxide absorbed from the air by quintral plants is absorbed during the day

Passage 316

Historical demographers have generally agreed on two interrelated features of the urban populations in early-modern Germany. First in accordance with the law of natural decrease, extremely high mortality rates in cities (urban areas with more than 10,000 inhabitants) meant that their populations could not be sustained by reproduction alone. Population density, inadequate sanitary conditions, and poor housing made cities too vulnerable to disease and death. Second, when city populations did increase, it was as a result of in-migration sufficient to overcome the population losses caused by the high mortality. But because the parish registers of urban communities with fewer than 10,000 inhabitants show that the annual number of births usually equaled or exceeded that of deaths, historical demographers assume that the law of natural decrease did not apply to small towns. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author suggests that according to historical demographers, the birth rate in early-modern German cities

- A. was affected by sanitary conditions
- B. increased as a result of in-migration
- C. was lower than the annual death rate
- D. decreased as population density increased
- E. was lower than the rate in communities with fewer than 10,000 inhabitants

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. It can be inferred that historical demographers generally believe which of the following about communities of fewer than 10,000 people in early-modern Germany?

- A. mortality rates were lower than those in cities of over 10,000 inhabitants.
- B. in-migrations were not a significant factor in population trends.
- C. population levels remained quite stable for extended periods.

Passage 317

Most of the studies of the effect of aging on short-term memory have led researchers to conclude that younger adults perform short-term-memory tasks better than people over the age of 65. But these studies were all conducted in afternoon sessions. In a recent study conducted both in morning and in afternoon sessions, the older participants performed much better in morning sessions than in afternoon sessions. The younger participants did not, however, perform any better in the morning. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The statements given are structured to lead to which of the following conclusions?
- A. Most previous studies led researchers to underestimate the ability of older adults to perform short-term-memory tasks
 - B. In the morning, people over 65 perform short-term-memory tasks better than younger adults do
 - C. There is no significant overall difference in long-term memory between older adults and younger adults.
 - D. The results of most previous studies of the effect of aging on short-term memory are best interpreted as showing that age has no effect on the ability to perform short-term-memory tasks.
 - E. Younger adults are able to perform short-term-memory tasks better if they perform them in the afternoon than if they perform them in the morning.

Passage 318

Early scholars described square dances as a type of ancient English country dance carried to the southern Appalachian Mountains and preserved unchanged for generations. However, while the Appalachian fiddle repertoire does include traditional reels that can be traced back to the British Isles, it also includes breakdowns, rags, and other musical features native to America. Appalachian songs similarly range from British ballads to African American blues. Given this musical diversity—not to mention the iconic presence of the banjo, an instrument with African roots—it would be naive to think the accompanying dances are purely English forms. While sections of Appalachia are relatively isolated, trade, travel, and immigration have continually introduced new cultural elements, including innovations in social dances, into the region's rural traditions. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage suggests that which of the following was true of “early scholars”?
 - A. They downplayed the African influence on traditional English dance forms.
 - B. They overlooked the importance of migration in Appalachian history.
 - C. They may have been unaware of the complexity of Appalachia’s musical traditions
 - D. They underestimated the prominence of the fiddle in Appalachian dance music.
 - E. They neglected the social context in which Appalachian square dances were performed
2. According to the passage, Appalachian square dancing differs from English country dancing in that Appalachian square dancing
 - A. is closely associated with the banjo
 - B. is particularly common in rural settings
 - C. can be performed to the tune of a reel
 - D. developed in isolation from outside influences
 - E. has changed significantly since it first emerged

Passage 319

That sales can be increased by the presence of sunlight within a store has been shown by the experience of the only Savefast department store with a large skylight. The skylight allows sunlight into half of the store, reducing the need for artificial light. The rest of the store uses only artificial light. Since the store opened two years ago, the departments on the sunlit side have had substantially higher sales than the other. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the argument?

- A. On particularly cloudy days, more artificial light is used to illuminate the part of the store under the skylight.
- B. When the store is open at night the departments in the part of the store under the skylight have sales that are no higher than those of other departments
- C. Many customers purchase items from departments in both parts of the store on a single shopping trip.
- D. Besides the skylight, there are several significant architectural differences between the two parts of the store.
- E. The departments in the part of the store under the skylight are the departments that generally have the highest sales in other stores in the Savefast chain.

Passage 320

Calculating hydroelectric plants' environmental impact is not simple. Dam building requires steel and cement, the manufacture of which entails greenhouse gas emissions. **Estimates for these emissions are relatively straightforward to make and show that the consequences are small compared to the benefits of generating greenhouse gas-free hydroelectric power.** But more difficult-to-estimate greenhouse gas contributions occur during the plants operation. The submerging of large areas behind dams results in the microbial decomposition of vegetation, which produces substantial quantities of methane—a potent greenhouse gas. Furthermore, eradicating vegetation eliminates the consumption of the greenhouse gas CO₂ by that vegetation. Estimating amounts of these gases is difficult, and amounts vary depending upon the specific location, terrain, and power intensity of the dam with its associated lake. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author would most likely agree with which of the following assertions about the environmental impact of hydroelectric power plants?
 - A. It cannot be inferred from calculations of the environmental impact of a few hydroelectric plants.
 - B. It is not primarily determined by the effects of dam building on vegetation.
 - C. It cannot be calculated with sufficient accuracy to justify the requirement of environmental impact studies prior to plant construction.
 - D. It could be significantly improved if the amounts of steel and cement used for dam building could be decreased.
 - E. It is too substantial, when all factors are considered, to justify the building of new dams.
2. The highlighted sentence serves primarily to
 - A. support a claim made at the beginning of the passage
 - B. acknowledge a problem inherent in a particular kind of calculation
 - C. anticipate and respond to a possible criticism of the author's overall argument
 - D. introduce a problem that will be explored later in the passage
 - E. point out an exception to a general claim

Passage 321

African American musicians in the 1950s faced a dilemma regarding classical music. A cosmopolitan display of knowledge about modern classical music enabled artists such as Duke Ellington to counter **misconceptions** that jazz musicians were untutored. Yet jazz musicians' interest in classical music was often taken as an admission that jazz innovations were derived from European sources. After Charlie Parker expressed admiration for Bartok, an interviewer asked if Parker's musical innovations were adaptations of classical predecessors' ideas. Often, comparisons with modern European composers connected jazz to the presumed superior standards of classical music without recognizing that jazz articulated its own musical vision—by developing expressive and improvisational principles rooted in a wide variety of African American musics—that challenged the hegemony of European standard in American music. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author mentions Bartok primarily in order to
 - A. emphasize the cosmopolitanism of some African American musicians
 - B. contrast innovations in jazz with innovations in classical music
 - C. provide an example of a presumption about jazz
 - D. highlight a jazz musician's interest in modern classical music
 - E. note a European influence on American jazz musicians
2. The author would be most likely to agree with which of the following assertions about the “misconceptions”?
 - A. They were fostered by those who assumed that innovations in jazz reflected the influence of European classical composers.
 - B. They were inadvertently perpetuated by some jazz musicians who expressed admiration for classical composers.
 - C. They were particularly prevalent among listeners who were familiar with jazz but not with European classical music.
 - D. They were incompatible with a thorough understanding of many jazz musicians' musical backgrounds.
 - E. They were beginning to wane by the time that Duke Ellington emerged as a prominent figure in the world of jazz.

Passage 322

The following passage comes from a study of the relationship between habitat and disease.

In a set of small, northern, temperate lakes, large epidemics of a common, virulent fungus in host populations of the zooplankton *Daphnia dentifera* are more common in steep-sided U-shaped lakes than in gently sloped V-shaped lakes. According to one hypothesis, this is due to differences in host susceptibility. However, in a study of twelve lakes we found no relationship between basin shape and host susceptibility in an in situ microcosm experiment in which hosts from each lake were incubated with spores. Thus, hosts were not dramatically less susceptible to this virulent fungal parasite in V-shaped lakes where epidemics are uncommon. This result echoes those from more controlled lab experiments with genetically similar organisms from fewer lakes. We continued to find no relationship between host susceptibility and basin shape even when we controlled for slight variation of temperature between lakes (since temperature elevates transmission) and mean bod size of adults among lakes (since size also elevates transmission). If anything, hosts collected in summer 2005 from lakes that had epidemics in the previous year were marginally less susceptible to infection than hosts collected from lakes without epidemics in 2004, a result consistent with previously observed rapid evolution of hosts in response to epidemics. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. formulate a new interpretation of existing data
 - B. reconcile two competing theories
 - C. consider and reject an explanation
 - D. discuss the importance of a novel hypothesis
 - E. suggest a direction for future research
2. According to the passage, which of the following was true in 2005 of *Daphnia dentifera* from lakes that had had epidemics in 2004?
 - A. They were slightly less susceptible to infection than *Daphnia dentifera* from lakes that had had no epidemic.
 - B. They were slightly smaller in size than *Daphnia dentifera* from lakes that had had no epidemic.
 - C. They were more likely to have been involved in the experiment than *Daphnia dentifera* from lakes that had had no epidemic.
 - D. They could probably tolerate cooler water temperatures than *Daphnia dentifera* from lakes that had had no epidemic.
 - E. They were more likely to act as hosts for the virulent fungus than *Daphnia dentifera* from lakes that had had no epidemic.
3. The passage suggests which of the following about virulent fungus outbreaks?
 - A. They are more likely to occur in lakes where *Daphnia dentifera* have greater genetic diversity.
 - B. They are less likely to happen in lakes where *Daphnia dentifera* are larger in size.
 - C. They tend to happen in the same lakes year after year.
 - D. They are less likely to happen in steep-sided lakes.
 - E. They are more likely to occur in comparatively warmer lakes.

Passage 323

The Wall Street millionaire Alfred Loomis was an amateur physicist who made significant contributions to scientific research. In 1928 he purchased three identical clocks, the most accurate available at that time. Loomis set up the clocks in a triangular orientation to one another, to break the gravitationally induced synchronic action among their pendulums, and by analyzing their minute variations, verified a theoretically predicted tidal effect of the Moon on clocks. These results later contributed to the development of LORAN (Long-Range Navigation), which triangulates the positions of ships and aircraft by comparing the difference in arrival times of signals coming from multiple radio beacons at various groundbased locations, a calculation that depends on accurate timekeeping. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred from the passage that the development of LORAN was made possible in part by
 - A. Loomis' refutation of previously accepted theoretical predictions about the tidal effect of the Moon
 - B. Loomis' ability to finance multiple major research efforts with his own money
 - C. the ability to direct multiple radio beacons from an aircraft or ship to various locations on land
 - D. the ability to measure discrepancies between timekeeping instruments caused by the Moon
 - E. the ability to synchronize a clock on board an aircraft with one on board a ship
2. According to the passage, Loomis' clock experiment accomplished which of the following?
 - A. It enabled Loomis to achieve his goal of using highly accurate timekeeping to make scientific advances in navigation.
 - B. It provided confirmatory evidence for an effect for which a scientific explanation had already been proposed.
 - C. It enabled Loomis to refine his theory about the tidal effect of the Moon on clocks.
 - D. It spurred the development of clocks that are not affected by gravity.
 - E. It brought Loomis' work to the attention of professional physicists.

Passage 324

People who suffer a heart attack on an airplane are at particular risk because of the relatively long time it takes to get them to a hospital. Last year Minerva Airlines trained its cabin crews in the use of on-board defibrillators to restart the heart. Since then, the survival rate for passengers who suffer heart attacks on Minerva flights has increased. Even so, the training might not have contributed to this increase, because _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following most logically completes the passage?

- A. The risk of suffering a heart attack increases with age and the average age of passengers has decreased somewhat since last year.
- B. Few other airlines equip their planes with defibrillators or train their cabin crews in the use of them.
- C. Minerva now offers fewer transoceanic flights than it did last year.
- D. The electrical impulse delivered by a defibrillator can, if administered to a person with a normal heart rhythm, induce an abnormal heartbeat.
- E. Heart attacks can sometimes be triggered by stress, which is increased by airline travel.

Passage 325

While Gayl Jones's fiction has received significant critical attention, her comparably quiet, yet formidable, corpus of poetry has been virtually ignored by scholars. Significantly, Jones's first publication appeared in verse, and her literary production from 1969 through the early 1980s includes nearly as many poems as short stories, betraying a formative and consistent involvement with poetry. Jones's lack of critical recognition as a poet is at least partially traceable to her documented ambivalence regarding genre boundaries and artistic identity: "I've never really considered myself a poet. I've written what I call poetry but I've always thought of myself as primarily a fiction writer and so I write poetry from the viewpoint and interest of a storyteller." Consistent with this self-conceptualization, Jones's critical observations regarding the work of other poets often focus on techniques traditionally associated with fiction writing: narrative and its rendering usually appear to outweigh the various poetic conventions of prosody and form. While reviewing the work of Sterling Brown, Jones provides a **checklist** of what chiefly attracts her in poetry: characterization and narrative voice are foregrounded, accompanied by such structural concerns of fiction as dramatic forms and scenes, all of which combine to reveal a sensibility interested primarily in formulating a poetics of effective storytelling. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, the "checklist" provides a record of which of the following?
 - A. The features of Sterling Brown's poetry that Jones finds unique
 - B. The techniques that Jones believes distinguish poetry from fiction
 - C. Jones's effort to distinguish herself from other poets
 - D. Ways in which Jones influenced Sterling Brown
 - E. The qualities in poetry that most interest Jones
2. Which of the following can be inferred from the passage regarding the nature of Jones's poetry?
 - A. It reflects her self-identification as a teller of stories.
 - B. It is more assertive than her poetry criticism.
 - C. It is acclaimed more as storytelling than as actual poetry.
 - D. It uses dramatic forms and scenes in unprecedented ways.
 - E. Its concern with narrative voice is greater than that of most fiction of the period.
3. The passage suggests which of the following regarding critics of Jones's work?
 - A. Their lack of interest in Jones's poetry has been prompted by their unawareness of the extent of her poetic production.
 - B. They have tended to judge Jones's work in different genres according to the definitions of those genres accepted by Jones's contemporaries.
 - C. The nature of their focus on Jones has been influenced by Jones's own characterizations of her work.
 - D. They have discounted Jones's observations regarding the work of other poets as narrow-minded.
 - E. They have foregrounded Jones's explorations of prosody and form at the expense of her interest in narrative.

Passage 326

Some recently discovered Hittite tablets corroborate many of the descriptions of ancient life that appear in the Iliad and even list Greek cities that reportedly sent ships to Troy. What this find entails is that the Iliad is not simply creative literature, as is commonly believed, and hence not a matter for literary discussion alone. Rather, it is also history and should be examined by historical science. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

The argument given relies on which of the following as an assumption?

- A. The cities and events that were mentioned in the Iliad but not in the tablets are fictitious.
- B. The Hittite tablets and the Iliad are not derived from a common source that had no basis in historical fact.
- C. Before the discovery of the tablets, historians had never examined the Iliad.
- D. Purported works of creative literature should be examined by historians to find out whether they record historical facts.
- E. A work that does not contain historical facts is a matter for literary discussion.

Passage 327

The scientific method is not radically different from the rational attitude in everyday life or in other domains of human knowledge. Historians, detectives, and plumbers—indeed, all human beings—use the same basic methods of induction, deduction, and assessment of evidence as do physicists or biochemists. **Modern science tries to carry out these operations in a more careful and systematic way by using controls and statistical tests, insisting on replication, and so forth.** Moreover, scientific measurements are often much more precise than everyday observations; they allow us to discover hitherto unknown phenomena, and they often lead to discoveries that conflict with "common sense." But the conflict is at the level of conclusions, not the basic approach. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage implies that one difference between modern science and "the rational attitude in everyday life" is that modern science
 - A. is often undermined by everyday observations
 - B. is more likely to yield new discoveries
 - C. is undervalued by the nonscientific community
 - D. utilizes induction and deduction
 - E. calls for evaluation of relevant evidence
2. Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted sentence in the context of the passage as a whole?
 - A. It qualifies a statement made earlier in the passage.
 - B. It questions the validity of evidence presented earlier in the passage.
 - C. It contradicts a commonly held opinion.
 - D. It implies that there is a similarity between two processes of reasoning.
 - E. It advocates for a particular methodological approach.

Passage 328

As a classic text on alchemy, George Ripley's *Compound of Alchemy* (1471) has received substantial scholarly attention, primarily focused on the English print editions published by Ralph Rabbards (1591). However, the work known to sixteenth- and early seventeenth-century Europe was not the *Compound* known today from Rabbards' editions. Rabbards strived to produce the fullest possible version of the text, including two prefatory poems, "Prologue" and "Preface", and an associated dedicatory poem. Yet no authoritative master text dates from Ripley's lifetime in which all of these elements are preserved. Rather, the *Compound's* text was adapted over a century of circulation in the form of multiple copies, later reassembled by diligent scribes—a process that continued even after the work's translation into Latin and European vernaculars. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage suggests which of the following about "Prologue" and "Preface"?
- A. They may have been originally written by someone other than George Ripley.
 - B. They were not included in copies of the *Compound* until long after Ripley's death.
 - C. They have been largely ignored by scholars who focused on the Rabbard's editions.
 - D. They may not have appeared together in every sixteenth-century copy of the *Compound*.
 - E. Their overall content and style changed considerably over a century of circulation.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The passage suggests which of the following about "diligent scribes"?
- A. They were instrumental in translating the *Compound* into Latin in the seventeenth century.
 - B. Their efforts had a considerable impact on later scholarly investigations of the *Compound*.
 - C. Many of them were guided in their work by Ralph Rabbards' print editions of the *Compound*.

Passage 329

The distinction between the nutritional quality and quantity of prey is one component of the hypotheses that attempt to explain the declining populations of Steller sea lions in the Gulf of Alaska beginning in the 1970s. One view holds that the quantity of prey available was high overall, but because of the species composition of available prey (primarily non-fatty fish of the gadid family), the diet was nutritionally inferior—the junk food hypothesis. **An alternative view is that gadids are nutritionally adequate but were not available in sufficient numbers because of fishing or some other factor.** In either case, juvenile sea lions would be affected more than mature individuals because of the younger animals' higher energy requirements and relative inexperience at foraging. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage indicates that proponents of the junk food hypothesis assert which of the following about non-fatty fish of the gadid family?

- A. They provide adequate nourishment for sea lions when supplemented with a small number of other species.
- B. They provide adequate nutrition for adult sea lions but not for juveniles.
- C. They have been steadily declining in quantity in the Gulf of Alaska since the 1970s.
- D. They are inadequate to satisfy sea lions' nutrition requirements even when available in abundance.
- E. They are too challenging for juvenile sea lions to catch in significant numbers.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The highlighted sentence performs which of the following functions in the passage?

- A. It demonstrates that over-fishing in the Gulf of Alaska is the likely cause of Steller sea lion decline.
- B. It supports an argument that the reason for the Steller sea lion decline in the Gulf of Alaska is unlikely to be determined.
- C. It gives an explanation for the decline in Steller sea lions in the Gulf of Alaska that is at odds with the junk food hypothesis.

Passage 330

Recent archaeological excavations of the massive warehouses of Huánuco Pampa—an important city in the Incan empire of the twelfth to sixteenth centuries—initially led archaeologists to believe that the city was a center for the distribution of food and goods to settlements in the surrounding region. However, excavations in those settlements have yielded few traces of the pottery containers used to store goods in Huánuco Pampa's warehouses. This absence of pottery traces is inconclusive since goods may have been distributed in containers other than those belonging to the warehouses.

One sixteenth-century Spanish document may inadvertently reveal the answer: while detailing countless instances of goods being brought to the warehouses from the surrounding region, the document says nothing about goods being distributed throughout the surrounding region from the warehouses. Thus initial suggestions about the city's role as a distribution center may be incorrect: Huánuco Pampa's reason for maintaining these huge warehouses may have been simply to ensure its own well-being during periods of hardship. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is primarily concerned with

- A. comparing the merits of different kinds of historical evidence
- B. tracing the origins of a widely held belief about a body of historical evidence
- C. citing evidence that suggests a new interpretation of archaeological remains
- D. evaluating the usefulness of particular historical sources
- E. correcting a misperception by reexamining historical data

2. The author suggests which of the following about the sixteenth-century Spanish document discussed in the passage?

- A. Although the document was initially used by archaeologists to support a particular theory about Huánuco Pampa's warehouses, it was subsequently interpreted as contradictory of that theory.
- B. Although the document intends to record the flow of food and goods between Huánuco Pampa and the surrounding region, it provides a wealth of information about Huánuco Pampa's political life.
- C. Although it discusses warehouses in very general terms, the document reveals much information about how Huánuco Pampa allocated its warehoused supplies throughout the region.
- D. Although the document does not discuss whether Huánuco Pampa distributed food and goods throughout the surrounding region, the fact that it does not implies that the city did not perform this function.
- E. Although the document was known to archaeologists prior to the excavation of Huánuco Pampa, that excavation revealed the document to be more accurate about Huánuco Pampa's daily life than was previously thought.

3. Which of the following, if true, would cast the most doubt on the author's reasoning about the probable purpose of the Huánuco Pampa warehouses?

- A. Further examination reveals that the sixteenth-century Spanish document cited by the author was intended solely to record the amount of food and goods farmers and artisans in the surrounding region contributed to Huánuco Pampa's warehouses each year.
- B. Several large warehouses similar to those of Huánuco Pampa are unearthed in subsequent archaeological excavations in the region surrounding Huánuco Pampa.
- C. A contemporaneous document is discovered establishing that Huánuco Pampa's political influence in the surrounding region was far greater than archaeologists and historians had previously supposed.

- D. Traces of pottery storage containers similar in style to those of the Huánuco Pampa warehouses are discovered in a section of the Incan empire remote from Huánuco Pampa.
- E. Archaeologists discover that Huánuco Pampa was able to maintain constant stores of goods in its warehouses despite fluctuations in agricultural conditions in the surrounding region.

Passage 331

Simulations indicate, and observations confirm, that the particles constituting Saturn's rings are giving up angular momentum to moons of the planet. The simulations predict that over just a few hundred million years, the related **energy transfer** will cause the rings' collapse. An analogous process occurs around young stars in the disks of matter from which planets emerge, and these protoplanetary disks do vanish that quickly, computer models show. Yet if Saturn's rings are so short-lived, a large comet or moon—the rings' presumed source—must have broken apart in Saturn's vicinity within the past several hundred million years. That is quite unlikely. It would have been much more probable in the young solar system—4 billion years ago or more. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred that the author of the passage mentions protoplanetary disks because
- A. the computer modeling techniques used to study them were later applied to Saturn's rings
 - B. conclusions about them might reasonably be applied to Saturn's rings
 - C. the accepted understanding of them is challenged by observations of Saturn's rings
 - D. the material of which Saturn's rings are composed must at one time have been in a protoplanetary disk around the Sun
 - E. observations of Saturn's rings may serve as a substitute for observations of protoplanetary disks

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The passage suggests which of the following about the "energy transfer"?
- A. Its effects are obscured by the angular momentum of Saturn's moons.
 - B. It is part of a process that also imparts angular momentum to at least some of Saturn's moons.
 - C. It proceeds more slowly than does an analogous energy transfer that occurs in the vicinity of young stars.

Passage 332

The seemingly unrelated aims of functional strength and aesthetic appeal had been not only successfully integrated in many of the classic suspension bridges of the past two centuries but also commonly achieved by engineers alone or leading teams. Thomas Telford was in fact both engineer and architect of his Menai Suspension Bridge, and John Roebling was both engineer and architect of his Brooklyn Bridge. That these engineering structures especially have come to be regarded as architectural icons demonstrates the aesthetic heights that an engineer can achieve.

Engineers less artistically confident than Telford and Roebling have engaged consulting architects to advise them on the design of everything from the facades placed on massive anchorages and skyscraper-high towers to the finishing details like deck railings and lampposts. Othmar Ammann, the chief engineer of the George Washington and many other New York City bridges, often sought the help of famous architects. When the George Washington was but an idea on paper, Ammann engaged Cass Gilbert, the architect of the Woolworth Building and other landmarks, to depict how the towers might be finished in stone. Since money was tight when the bridge was being completed, however, the steel-framed towers were left bare—a look that the Swiss architect Le Corbusier found extremely appealing—and bare steel became the new aesthetic standard for monumental bridge towers. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to

- A. explore the interplay between two professional disciplines
- B. discuss the personal qualities needed to succeed in a particular endeavor
- C. consider what qualities give aesthetic appeal to structures of a particular kind
- D. present the evolution of a relationship between competing goals
- E. explain how apparently disparate goals actually support each other

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The passage implies that Othmar Ammann was

- A. responsible for a design that became an aesthetic touchstone for later bridges
- B. financially constrained from hiring the architects he wished for the George Washington Bridge
- C. less certain of his aesthetic design abilities than Telford and Roebling were of theirs

3. According to the passage, which of the following is true of Cass Gilbert's ideas for finishing the towers of the George Washington Bridge?

- A. They had to be abandoned during construction.
- B. They impressed Le Corbusier.
- C. They were judged to be too costly when the project was initially proposed.
- D. They derived from themes Gilbert had explored in the Woolworth Building.
- E. They started a fashion that was followed in later bridge towers.

Passage 333

Most Oakville residents want a community swimming pool to be built but do not want to finance it with local tax revenues. Oakville's mayor argues that although the town has no financial reserves, building pool will not lead to higher taxes, since an unused town-owned land parcel is available and admission fees will cover the entire cost of operating the pool as well as repayment of the \$3 million debt for construction. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the mayor's argument?

- A. Admission to the community pool will cost most residents who frequently use it more than they would have paid in increased taxes for pool open to residents free of charge.
- B. Because of the types of accidents that can happen in and around swimming pools, the largest part of the operating expenses for the community pool will be lifeguards' salaries and liability insurance.
- C. The operation of a pool would bring increased traffic to the road leading to the site of the proposed pool and would require the town to fund costly road improvements.
- D. The same survey that established that a majority of Oakville's residents would use a community pool also found that over one-third of the town's residents would have preferred that it be built at a different site.
- E. Opponents of the pool have not advanced any other proposals for the use of the currently unused town-owned land parcel.

Passage 334

Isobel Grundy rightly argues that in researching pre-nineteenth-century women's historical writing, scholars must define history broadly and include historical fiction, biography, court memoirs, and family history. Grundy also believes that these writings provide "a history of a whole female culture, while embodying a pre-nineteenth-century feminine" relationship to history. On this point, I am skeptical, as I do not believe there was a characteristic women's relationship to history. Instead, my research suggests that pre-nineteenth-century British women writers' engagement with historical discourse depended on such things as their political commitments and class affiliations and their perceptions of developing historical genres and markets. We must give sufficient attention to the myriad individual authors and texts before generalizing widely about women writers' engagements with history. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage implies that its author would agree with which of the following statements about "historical fiction, biography, court memoirs, and family history"?

- A. These genres had their origins primarily among pre-nineteenth-century British women writers.
- B. These genres were probably more reflective of women's views in pre-nineteenth-century Britain than they were in later periods.
- C. These genres can help scholars develop a comprehensive view of British women's historical writing.
- D. These genres have generally been regarded by scholars as more reliable sources of information about pre-nineteenth-century women than have other genres of historical writing.
- E. These genres are remarkably homogeneous in the way they represent the lives of pre-nineteenth-century women in Britain.

2. Which of the following describes a difference between the author and Grundy regarding British women writers' engagement with historical discourse?

- A. The author thinks the engagement was determined primarily in response to developing literary markets; Grundy thinks it had little to do with such markets.
- B. The author believes the engagement is reflected in numerous genres; Grundy thinks that one genre is specifically feminine.
- C. The author emphasizes the heterogeneity of factors that influenced the engagement; Grundy suggests that the engagement was unified by one particular factor.
- D. The author thinks the engagement was limited to women in certain social classes; Grundy thinks it was common to all classes.
- E. The author believes the engagement was just beginning in the late 1700s; Grundy thinks it reached its peak then.

Passage 335

Much of ecological theory consists of models that are so highly idealized that they are of little real-world predictive value. In addition, many of the parameters used in models—such as birth and death rates—are exceedingly difficult to estimate accurately in the field. **Consequently, ecological theory is rarely directly relevant to the practice of conservation biology.** One notable exception is MacArthur's theory of island biogeography, which predicts the species richness of an island on the basis of its size and degree of isolation. This theory could provide important insights into nature preserves, which can be analogous to islands, often consisting of relatively undisturbed ecosystems surrounded by biologically distinct areas. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describe the function of the sentence highlighted in the passage?
- A. It suggests direction for future presented earlier in the passage.
 - B. It presents evidence that will support the theory that is introduced in the following sentence.
 - C. It questions the usefulness of a particular version of the theory.
 - D. It clarifies an ambiguous statement made earlier in the passage.
 - E. It presents a general rule to which the passage will identify exception.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. It can be inferred from the passage that the author would probably agree with which of the following statements?
- A. The practice of conservation biology may be directly affected by MacArthur's theory of island biogeography.
 - B. Undisturbed systems surrounded by biologically distinct areas be helpful in estimating birth and death rate parameters more accurately.
 - C. The similarity between nature preserves and the island studied in MacArthur's biogeography theory may help predict species richness in nature preserves.

Passage 336

Archaeologists recently excavated a collection of copper tools from a grave in India. Although the tools were similar to others from the same culture, each tool found in the grave was significantly larger than any other known tool of the corresponding type produced by the same culture. Since the larger size would have made many of the tools extremely unwieldy, **the tools were probably made specifically for ceremonial burial**. Tools made for ceremonial burial would be expected to have none of the wear that comes from use, and **indeed these tools showed no such wear**. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

In the argument given, the two highlighted portions play which of the following roles?

- A. The first is introduced as evidence that apparently supports a position the argument opposes, the second is that position.
- B. The first is introduced as evidence that apparently supports a position the argument opposes, the second is the position the argument seeks to support.
- C. The first is the position the argument seeks to support, the second provides evidence to support that position.
- D. The first provides evidence for the position the argument seeks to support, the second is a position that the argument seeks to disprove.
- E. The first provides evidence for the position the argument seeks to support, the second is that position.

Passage 337

The theory of motivated reasoning suggests that, in legal decisions, different judges will assess the same information differently, depending on their backgrounds and fundamental values. Attitudinalists (theorists who contend that judges' decisions are driven by their own policy preferences) have concurred that their findings on ideological decision making could be explained by the "human reflex" to "convince oneself of the propriety of what one prefers to believe—motivated reasoning."

Motivated reasoning, however, is subject to "reasonableness constraints." For example, the accuracy of decision making is enhanced when the stakes for the decision are higher, when the decision must be justified, and when the decision will be made public. Such circumstances often apply to judicial decisions. The presence of stronger arguments contrary to preferences reduces the influence of motivations. The limitations of the power of motivated reasoning are apparent from the numerous unanimous opinions of the United States Supreme Court (whose members generally represent a range of ideological predispositions) and other cases in which justices appear to vote contrary to their ideological preferences. One would anticipate that the influence of such motivated reasoning is at its apex when the law is relatively less determinate, which is consistent with the findings of empirical research. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author suggests which of the following about motivated reasoning?

- A. It allows judges to take into consideration on a wide range of views beyond those that they themselves hold.
- B. It has a greater impact on the decision of judges with certain kinds of policy preferences than on the decisions of judges with other preferences.
- C. It is unlikely to result in ideologically biased judicial decisions in cases where the law is open to multiple interpretations
- D. Its effects on a decision may be mitigated by exposure to compelling arguments that challenge the decision maker's biases.
- E. Its impact on judicial decision making may be more evident in decisions rendered by the United States Supreme Court than in decisions rendered by other courts.

2. It can be inferred that the author uses the United States Supreme Court to illustrate the argument because of a belief that the

- A. Supreme Court is obligated to render its decisions without regard to its members' ideological predispositions
- B. record of the Supreme Court shows it to be roughly similar to other courts in the frequency with which its decision particular policy preference
- C. extent to which decisions made by the Supreme Court are affected by reasonableness constraints is relatively easy to determine
- D. unanimous decisions sometimes handed down by the Supreme Court would be unlikely to come from an ideologically diverse court if motivated reasoning were unchecked
- E. members of the Supreme Court provide clear and extended explanations of the reasoning that has informed their decisions

3. The author suggests which of the following about the "circumstances" mentioned in the passage?

- A. They allow decision makers to rationalize lapses in their objectivity.
- B. They tend to undermine the efficacy of reasonableness constraints.
- C. They may weaken the effect of policy preferences on decisions.
- D. They are insufficiently distinguished from one another by attitudinalists.
- E. They can disguise the extent to which a decision has been influenced by motivated reasoning.

Passage 338

Astronomers can measure any given star's radial velocity by examining its spectrum—light spread out into its constituent wavelengths. If an object is moving toward us, its spectral lines shift to shorter wavelengths; if it's moving away, the lines swing to longer wavelengths. The higher the velocity, the greater the shift. Although this sort of spectral analysis is straightforward for nearby stars, it becomes far more difficult for distant stars in the Milky Way's outer halo. Even large telescopes can't gather enough of their light. For this reason, astronomer Ulrich Heber conjectures that there are probably several low-mass hypervelocity stars yet to be discovered. Although these diminutive objects live longer than B-type stars, which are extremely luminous and blue, they radiate much less light. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following statements best describes the organization of the passage?
 - A. An astronomical phenomenon is described, then an exception to that phenomenon is identified.
 - B. A method of data collection is outlined, then its accuracy is challenged.
 - C. An innovative method of analysis is described, then new findings based on this method are summarized.
 - D. A problem with an instrument is identified, then a suggestion for correcting that problem is presented.
 - E. A technique and its limitations are explained, then a prediction is stated.
2. The passage indicates that compared to low-mass hypervelocity stars, B-type stars
 - A. are less numerous in the Milky Way's outer halo
 - B. burn out more quickly and are more luminous
 - C. are in closer proximity to Earth's solar system
 - D. are larger in size but emit light at similar wavelengths
 - E. emit a more complex spectrum

Passage 339

Crows, herring gulls, and sparrows all live on the island of Firsten. Crows feed on sparrow eggs and therefore pose a threat to the sparrow population. Although gulls are not nearly as good at finding sparrow nests as crows are, sparrows typically also lose some eggs to gull predation. Nevertheless, sparrows that nest near gull nests tend to lose fewer eggs to predators than sparrows nesting far away from gull nests, since _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following most logically completes the argument?

- A. The presence of gulls frightens away Crows.
- B. Crows pose no threat to adult sparrows.
- C. Gulls find sparrow nests by watching female sparrows enter the nest.
- D. There are far more crows on Firsten than there are sparrows.
- E. Sparrows on Firsten typically hide their nests very carefully.

Passage 340

Many scholarly discussions of novelist Willa Cather (1873-1947) debate whether Cather belongs more to the nineteenth-century realist tradition or to the modernist revolution of the early twentieth century. While Cather's **preoccupation with nineteenth-century agrarian culture** has won her the respect of readers and critics, her distrust of modernity left her with a historically unstable position in the modernist canon. Resistance to the changes wrought by the twentieth century, of course, does not necessarily disqualify one from the "modernist" label. The impulse to reconnect with more primitive, earlier times is a hallmark of modernist aesthetics, shaping the search for meaning in a fragmented, disenchanted, mechanized world. Yet more often than not, [literary critic] Phyllis Rose explains, the early twentieth-century atmosphere of experimentation and "making it new" and an attendant **critical discourse** that "valued complexity, ambiguity, even obscurity" resulted in Cather's labeling as "naively traditional" and "essentially nostalgic and elegiac." In effect in modernist studies she has been treated as a romantic regional writer, unconcerned with the international terrain so integral to modern thinking—at least until scholars, in the 1980s and 1990s, began reevaluating the historical record, demonstrating her innovative departures from nineteenth-century fiction, including antiheroism, gender-bending episodic narrative, antirealism, simple prose, emphasis on memory and time, and the exploration of immigration, empire, and race. Today it is not uncommon to encounter critics announcing Cather's newfound canonical status as a modernist—indicated most clearly by her inclusion in works such as *The Cambridge Companion to American Modernism* published in 2005. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author would be most likely to agree with which of the following claims about Cather's "preoccupation with nineteenth-century agrarian culture"?
 - A. It is regarded by some as evidence of an attitude toward the modern world that is characteristic of many modernist writers.
 - B. Its definitive role in Cather's writing distinguishes Cather from most authors who were considered to be central to the modernist literary tradition.
 - C. It was clearly an important element of Cather's early fiction but played little role in her later, more mature novels.
 - D. It has frequently been misinterpreted by the very readers and critics who are most strongly drawn to Cather's fiction.
 - E. Divergent interpretations of it have led critics to form diametrically opposed conclusions about the overall quality of Cather's literary output.
2. The author mentions the "critical discourse" primarily to
 - A. explain why some critics rejected the idea that any particular literary style was uniquely modernist
 - B. challenge an assumption about the extent to which Cather's novels express a nostalgic view of the past
 - C. suggest that most of Cather's readers have little in common with the scholarly commentators who have written about her work
 - D. demonstrate that literary critics' views about Cather's fiction diverge widely on certain points
 - E. introduce an explanation of criteria used to determine whether Cather belonged in a particular literary category
3. The reference to the highlighted work serves primarily to
 - A. suggest that no major advances in Cather scholarship have been made since 2005
 - B. describe an important milestone in a scholarly trend that began in the 1980s

- C. cite a publication that has significantly influenced many scholars' views of Cather
- D. question the current critical consensus regarding a defining quality of modernism
- E. acknowledge that an author's canonical status can be subject to arbitrary shifts

Passage 341

Because densely populated urban centers concentrate human activity, we think of them as pollution crisis zones. Ecology-minded discussions often focus on ways to make cities seem somewhat less oppressively man-made, such as increasing the area devoted to parks or easing the intensity of development. But most such changes would actually undermine cities' extraordinary energy efficiency. Per unit of area, cities in the United States generate more greenhouse gases, use more energy, and produce more solid waste than most other American regions of comparable size. On a map depicting negative environmental impacts in relation to surface area, therefore, cities would look like intense hot spots. If you plotted the same negative impacts by resident or household, however, the reverse would hold. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best expresses the main idea of the passage?
 - A. Increasing the space devoted to parks in urban areas would not necessarily make cities seem less man-made.
 - B. Because they are densely populated, cities tend to have a disproportionately negative impact on the environment.
 - C. Although densely populated cities are relatively energy efficient, they are still the largest contributors to environmental pollution.
 - D. Decreasing the density of urban populations might in some respects worsen their environmental impact.
 - E. The extraordinary energy efficiency of cities suggests that concerns about the environment in urban areas may be unwarranted.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. The passage implies that in the United States relatively sparsely populated areas exceed cities in per capita rate of
 - A. solid-waste production
 - B. intensity of development
 - C. greenhouse-gas emissions

Passage 342

No ambitious politician will challenge an elected public official running for reelection unless that official appears vulnerable. Nonetheless, public officials who do not appear vulnerable as they attempt to win reelection rarely run unopposed. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

If the statements given are true, which of the following is a conclusion that can be properly drawn from them?

- A. No officeholder who is vulnerable will run for reelection if an ambitious politician is likely to challenge that officeholder.
- B. If a person who is not an ambitious politician challenges an elected public official who is running for reelection, then that official does not appear vulnerable.
- C. If an elected official running for reelection appears vulnerable, that official's challengers will all be ambitious politicians.
- D. Some elected officials running for reelection are challenged by people who are not ambitious politicians.
- E. Ambitious politicians will run for election to a public office only if the holder of that office is running for reelection and appears to be vulnerable.

Passage 343

The infectious disease known as whooping cough is commonly thought to be a childhood illness, but a recent study suggests that more adults contract this illness than was previously suspected. Although the disease is life-threatening in children, in adults it typically causes only a persistent cough which, though annoying, is rarely serious. Therefore, the incidence of whooping cough in adults poses no significant public health threat. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

- A. Whooping cough is more difficult to diagnose in adults than in children.
- B. Adults with whooping cough do not readily transmit the disease to children.
- C. Most adults who contract whooping cough get the disease from children with whom they are in close contact.
- D. A disease poses no significant public health threat unless it is life-threatening.
- E. Under comparable conditions of exposure, adults contract whooping cough more readily than do children.

Passage 344

Sensationalism—the purveyance of emotionally **charged** content, focused mainly on violent crime, to a broad public—has often been decried, but the full history of the phenomenon has yet to be written. Scholars have tended to dismiss sensationalism as unworthy of serious study, based on two pervasive though somewhat incompatible assumptions: first, that sensationalism is essentially a commercial product, built on the exploitation of modern mass media, and second, that it appeals almost entirely to a simple, basic emotion and thus has little history apart from the changing technological means of spreading it. An exploration of sensationalism's early history, however, challenges both assumptions and suggests that they have tended to obscure the complexity and historicity of the genre. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. According to the passage, scholars have not given sensationalism serious consideration because they believe sensationalism

- A. possesses largely emotional rather than rational content
- B. is produced with an eye to making money
- C. lacks historical complexity

2. In the context in which it appears, “charged” most nearly means

- A. electrified
- B. accused
- C. attacked
- D. fraught
- E. admonished

Passage 345

Some economists suggest that all firms would be expected to pay workers doing identical jobs the same wage. However, studies show that high-profit industries tend to pay more. While some of this observed wage gap could be due to difficulties in measuring workers' talent, it is unlikely that such measurement problems can explain everything. Although talent is hard to measure, factors with which it is presumably correlated, such as education and tenure, are not. Yet studies that control for those factors still find big wage disparities. **Moreover, although receptionists, for example, do not become less talented when they leave a high-profit industry to work in an industry with lower profits, their pay tends to drop in line with the wage gap between the two.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. According to the passage, which of the following is true regarding difficulties in measuring workers' talent.

- A. These difficulties cannot fully explain the observed wage gap.
- B. These difficulties are greater in high-profit industry than in low-profit industries.
- C. These difficulties can be eliminated by controlling for education and tenure.

2. Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted sentence in the context of the passage as a whole?

- A. to analyze an unusual trend regarding measurement problems that was referred to earlier in the passage
- B. to offer a hypothesis that explains the measurement problems referred to earlier in the passage
- C. to cite an instance that supports an assumption about measurement problems that was made earlier in the passage
- D. to evaluate an assertion regarding the wage disparity that was mentioned in the preceding sentence
- E. to qualify the claim regarding workers doing identical jobs that was made in the first sentence

Passage 346

As they unearth long-ignored women's writings, some feminist literary scholars have a tendency to evaluate those writings according to current ideological standards. This tendency, however understandable, has certain pitfalls, as feminist response to three late seventeenth and early eighteenth-century English female playwrights demonstrates. Mary Pix, Catharine Trotter, and Delarivier Manley each wrote at least four plays and were known collectively as the "Female Wits". These women saw themselves as participating in a common endeavor, but feminist scholars have evaluated their works in very different terms. Trotter and Manley have been praised for their depiction of "feminist" themes. Trotter because of her insistence on feminine virtue, and Manley because of her depiction of strong, if sometimes villainous, heroines while Pix's works, because they depict women in ways now considered stereotypically "feminine", are often dismissed.

Yet Pix is conservative only within a present-day context: within the context of late seventeenth and early eighteenth-century English drama, Pix's plays were more formally innovative than Manley's and more successful than either Manley's or Trotter's. She also broke new ground regarding subject matter, **addressing contemporary social issues such as class upheaval**. However, these acts are rarely acknowledged by scholars of the Female Wits. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. consider the consequences of a scholarly oversight
 - B. question the ideological consistency of certain literary critics
 - C. show the shortcomings of a critical propensity
 - D. discuss the contradictions inherent in a literary movement
 - E. demonstrate certain difficulties involved in unearthing obscure literary works
2. According to the passage, feminist literary scholars of the Female Wits have a tendency to
 - A. overlook the originality of certain features of Pix's plays
 - B. exaggerate the stereotypically feminine characteristics of Pix's heroines
 - C. dwell on the progressive nature of Pix's views on social issues
 - D. downplay the villainous nature of some of Manley's heroines
 - E. misinterpret Trotter's insistence on feminine virtue
3. The author's reference to Pix's "addressing contemporary social issues such as class upheaval" serves primarily to
 - A. suggest that Pix's political and social views were stereotypically "feminine"
 - B. identify a Pixian subject that feminist scholars have consistently misinterpreted
 - C. help explain why Pix's plays proved to be more successful than either Manley's or Trotter's
 - D. support the claim that Pix's plays pursued previously unexplored topics
 - E. identify a factor that contributed to the formal innovativeness of Pix's plays

Passage 347

In European lowland heathlands, heather bushes, grasses, and bracken compete with one another for the sandy soil's scarce nutrients, with none acquiring permanent dominance. In Dutch heathlands, however, atmospheric nitrogen pollution produced by intensive animal farming has turned heathlands into grassland, the result of an interaction between nitrogen pollution and heather-eating beetles. Additional nitrogen usually increases growth of both grass and heather, and at first heather usually thrives because the grasses cannot penetrate the canopy of its bushes. **Heather beetle population size, like that of many herbivorous insects, varies from year to year.** When heather beetles are abundant, their larvae grow particularly well on the nitrogen-enriched heather shoots. Voraciously feeding larvae and adults then defoliate the bushes, tipping the competitive balance between heather and grasses irrevocably. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred from the passage that an abundance of heather beetles in Dutch heathlands
 - A. may be prevented by the proper management of heathlands
 - B. can be caused by a lack of atmospheric nitrogen
 - C. can result in grasses gaining increased access to sunlight
 - D. helps check the growth of a wide variety of plants
 - E. will inevitably be followed by years of heather beetle scarcity
2. Which of the followings best describes the function of the highlighted sentence in the author's explanation?
 - A. It supplies information to explain changes in atmospheric nitrogen pollution.
 - B. It emphasizes the extent to which Dutch heathlands are ecologically fragile environments.
 - C. It provides an example of a factor beyond the control of those seeking to preserve heather bushes.
 - D. It suggests that the presence of intensive animal farming has been unfairly blamed for the demise of Dutch heathlands.
 - E. It explains why there might be a lag between increases in atmospheric nitrogen and damage to heather.

Passage 348

To evaluate any given intellectual property policy, we must weigh the costs and benefits of awarding copyright protection. If an innovation, then the benefits of the protection are nonexistent, and so, by the cost-benefit criterion it is unwarranted. Such a situation arose in 1998, when the United States Congress extended the term of copyright from 50 years after an author's death to 70. Book buyers are harmed by this. A book's price is higher under copyright because the publisher continues to owe **royalties** to the author's heirs and does not compete with others printing the same book. Against that drawback, there is no countervailing benefit. **Authors are hardly likely to find motivation in the prospect of earnings that will arrive more than 50 years after their death.** Moreover, the extension was applied retroactively to existing copyrights but authors do not need incentives to write books they have already written. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. argue that intellectual property policies are often unwarranted
 - B. show how a particular criterion can be used to evaluate an intellectual property policy
 - C. summarize the costs and benefits of introducing intellectual property policies
 - D. approve the reasoning that was used to justify a particular intellectual property policy
 - E. challenge a claim that the benefits of intellectual property policies outweigh the costs
2. The author mentions "royalties" primarily in order to identify
 - A. a benefit that is likely to motivate authors
 - B. a way in which publishers compete with one another
 - C. a factor that contributes to a negative effect of copyright
 - D. a reason underlying Congress' actions regarding copyright
 - E. an unintended effect of extending the term of copyright
3. It can be inferred that which of the following assumptions underlies the statement in the highlighted sentence?
 - A. Concern for their heirs is not a factor that motivates authors to publish.
 - B. Authors are motivated by factors other than the prospect of financial gain.
 - C. Sales of a book are unlikely to change after its author's death.
 - D. Publishers tend to act in their own best interest rather than in the author's
 - E. The earnings of most authors tend to decline over time.

Passage 349

Mayor: Vehicle exhaust produces dangerously high ozone levels in our city in hot, humid weather. As an incentive for people to commute by bus rather than by car, special free commuter buses will be scheduled on hot, humid days. Since a bus can carry about 40 people but produces only about 20 times as much exhaust as a car, ozone levels will be lower as long as the buses are more than half full. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument?

- A. Most of the people who would take the special free buses are currently members of carpools.
- B. The city does not currently have enough buses to transport all of the commuters who normally commute by car.
- C. Buses that would be operating on hot, humid days would rarely, if ever, be filled to capacity.
- D. The amount of vehicle exhaust produced in the city is not significantly higher on hot, humid days.
- E. Not all commuter routes are used by enough people to warrant providing bus service for them.

Passage 350

Sensations of nausea in people are accompanied by higher-than-normal blood levels of a particular hormone, vasopressin. Therefore, either nausea triggers the production of vasopressin or abnormally high levels of vasopressin cause nausea. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument relies?

- A. Sensations of nausea are never present when vasopressin is at low levels.
- B. High levels of vasopressin have no effect on the body other than to cause sensations of nausea.
- C. Sensations of nausea and high levels of vasopressin do not have a common cause that makes them occur together.
- D. Mild nausea causes the release of small quantities of vasopressin, and high levels of vasopressin cause intense nausea.
- E. People differ in the blood level of vasopressin that is normal for them.

Passage 351

During the spring months of last year, 510 drivers who were stopped by Fisk County's police and given breath tests failed the tests, having blood-alcohol levels above the legal limit for driving. This spring, after a vigorous advertising campaign against driving while intoxicated, only 320 drivers failed the tests. It cannot be concluded, however, that the campaign was responsible for the decrease, because the breath tests were administered to far fewer individuals this spring than last spring. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument?

- A. Between last spring and this spring, the legal limit of blood alcohol for driving in Fisk County remained unchanged.
- B. In Fisk County, breath tests are administered only to drivers whose behavior makes police suspect that they are intoxicated.
- C. The police of Fisk County do not generally test drivers for any intoxicating substances other than alcohol.
- D. A similar advertising campaign conducted ten years ago was credited with temporarily reducing the incidence of driving while intoxicated.
- E. The number of police patrolling Fisk County's roads and highways was significantly lower this spring than last spring.

Passage 352

Academics have been reconsidering the meaning of “wilderness” and its usefulness to conservation strategies. The idea of pristine wilderness is historically inaccurate, argue scholars of Native American history, who have demonstrated that Native Americans shaped their environments with their agricultural practices and residential patterns. **Other scholars argue that wilderness is simply a cultural construct created in opposition to modern society, not a real place untouched by humans.** Scientists in turn, have argued that the goal of wilderness preservation is based on a model in which ecosystems progress toward a stable equilibrium state, a model replaced in the 1970s with one **stressing constant change**. These insights complicate wilderness management which critics charge aims to preserve a supposedly stable environment that existed prior to human disturbance. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following statements best describes the function of the highlighted sentence?
 - A. It undermines a claim made in the previous sentence.
 - B. It introduces a perspective that the author disputes.
 - C. It elaborates on a claim made earlier in the passage.
 - D. It introduces a traditional point of view.
 - E. It describes a recent scholarly controversy.
2. The author suggests that the model “stressing constant change” is significant because it
 - A. points to a way in which wilderness management can be conducted in modern society
 - B. undermines an assumption underlying wilderness management
 - C. helps to explain why wilderness management efforts have been unsuccessful
 - D. calls into question the idea that wilderness is a cultural construct
 - E. suggests that wilderness areas are more threatened than was previously thought

Passage 353

Union Official: Several workers who operate a certain type of machine have developed repetitive-motion injury, which is often caused by operating poorly designed machinery. Because physiologists employed by the machine's manufacturer have found that **workers who maintain good posture while using the machine do not risk developing the condition**, the manufacturer contends that the machine's design is not responsible for the workers' condition. New evidence leads us to reject the manufacturer's contention. however. When our own experts conducted careful trials with both new and experienced machine operators, they concluded that **the machine's design makes it difficult for workers to maintain good posture while operating it over long periods.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. In the union official's argument, the two highlighted portions play which of the following roles?
- A. The first identifies evidence that was offered in support of the position opposed by the union official; the second gives information to undermine that support.
 - B. The first evaluates evidence that the manufacturer offers to support a claim; the second casts doubt on the impartiality of the experts cited by the manufacturer.
 - C. Each provides independent evidence in support of the conclusion of the argument as a whole.
 - D. The first provides evidence in support of the conclusion of the argument as a whole; the second states that conclusion.
 - E. The first states the position that the argument as a whole opposes; the second provides evidence against that position.

Passage 354

Years ago, consumers in Frieland began paying an energy tax in the form of two Frieland pennies for each unit of energy consumed that came from nonrenewable sources. Following the introduction of this energy tax, there was a steady reduction in the total yearly consumption of energy from nonrenewable sources. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

If the statements in the passage are true, then which of the following must on the basis of them be true?

- A. There was a steady decline in the yearly revenues generated by the energy tax in Frieland.
- B. There was a steady decline in the total amount of energy consumed each year in Frieland.
- C. There was a steady increase in the use of renewable energy source in Frieland.
- D. The revenues generated by the energy tax were used to promote the use of energy from renewable sources.
- E. The use of renewable energy sources in Frieland greatly increased relative to the use of nonrenewable energy sources.

Passage 355

This passage is adapted from an essay published in 2010.

As I write, the Large Hadron Collider, the world's biggest atom-smasher at CERN in Geneva, has switched on with almost unprecedented media jamboree. Asked about the practical value of it all, Stephen Hawking has said that "modern society is based on advances in pure science that were not foreseen to have practical applications." It's a common claim, and it subtly reinforces the hierarchy that Medawar identified: technology and engineering are the humble offspring of pure science, the casual cast-offs of a more elevated pursuit.

I don't believe that such pronouncements are intended to denigrate applied science as an intellectual activity; they merely speak into a culture in which that has already happened. Pure science undoubtedly does lead to applied spin-offs, but this is not the norm. Rather, most of our technology has come from **explicit and painstaking efforts** to develop it. And this is simply a part of the scientific enterprise. A dividing line between pure and applied science makes no sense at all, running as it does in a convoluted path through disciplines, departments, even individual scientific papers and careers. Research aimed at applications fills the pages of the leading journals in physics, chemistry, and the life and Earth sciences; curiosity-driven research with no real practical value is abundant in the "applied" literature of the materials, biotechnological, and engineering sciences. The fact that "pure" and "applied" science are useful and meaningful terms seduces us sometimes into thinking that they are real, absolute, and distinct categories. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. In the context of the passage, the mention of the Large Hadron Collider primarily serves to
 - A. demonstrate the attention that is paid to what some consider pure science
 - B. introduce a change in the prevailing attitude toward science
 - C. call into question the currently existing priorities for scientific research
 - D. illustrate the contributions that applied science has made to pure science
 - E. cast doubt on the hierarchy identified by Medawar
2. According to the passage, the "explicit and painstaking efforts" are
 - A. part of the same overall endeavor as pure science research
 - B. the foundation of the techniques that allow advances in pure science
 - C. needed before the findings of pure science have practical benefit
 - D. in danger of dying out because of the attractions of pure science
 - E. ultimately of greater importance than the great majority of work in pure science
3. The passage implies that the statement made by Stephen Hawking has which shortcoming?
 - A. It overstates the importance of technology for modern society.
 - B. It fails to recognize the distinct goals of pure and applied science.
 - C. It ignores the work involved in turning initial insights into useful technology.
 - D. It treats somewhat unusual cases as if they were the general rule.
 - E. It inappropriately understates the value of pure science.

Passage 356

The writings of seventeenth-century philosopher and poet Margaret Cavendish are filled with tensions. She often seems torn between conflicting endorsements. For example, in some places she argues that it is not a woman's place to rule, but empowered female characters in other texts are competent leaders. Her corpus is also filled with forensic tensions [tensions in which fictional characters engage in debates within a single text] presenting arguments for both sides of ethical issues. Cavendish herself, however, rarely intrudes to decide the issue. **Some commentators** claim this demonstrates that she did not intend her literary works to serve serious philosophical purposes. But perhaps the use of tensions was deliberate and helps explain her choice of fictional genres to explore ethical issues. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describes the organization of the passage?
 - A. It makes an observation and provides two possible interpretations of it.
 - B. It introduces a historical phenomenon and provides a narrative for it.
 - C. It cites an empirical observation as an explanation for a hypothesis
 - D. It presents a deductive argument in the form of premises and a conclusion.
 - E. It discusses the significance of a particular episode in its subject's career.
2. It can be inferred that "some commentators" assume a text can serve serious philosophical purposes only if its author
 - A. avoids using fictional characters to explore ethical issues
 - B. uses fictional characters to convey forensic tensions
 - C. takes an unambiguous position on philosophical issues
 - D. carefully considers the audience's perspective
 - E. impartially presents arguments for both sides of ethical issues

Passage 357

When armyworm caterpillars feed on maize plants, the caterpillars are often attacked by a certain species of wasp. Armyworm caterpillars that are present on a maize plant but have not fed on it are not attacked by the wasps, which are attracted by a chemical signal released by the injured maize plants. It is likely that the trigger for the release of this signal is in the oral secretions the caterpillars produce while feeding, since _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following most logically completes the argument?
 - A. armyworm caterpillars feeding on plants other than maize are seldom attacked by wasps
 - B. a caterpillar must actually start producing these oral secretions before it can begin feeding on a maize plant
 - C. caterpillars that have been feeding on a maize plant are a richer source of nutrients for predators than are caterpillars that have not been feeding on a maize plant
 - D. the wasps do not come to maize plants if the only damage to the plants is mechanical damage deliberately caused by experimenters
 - E. large numbers of the wasps arrive whenever the chemical signal is produced artificially near maize plants

Passage 358

Studies comparing children's memory for television news stories with their recall of print versions containing exactly the same verbal information generally show that television news is remembered best. Paivio's dual-coding hypothesis, a frequent explanation, suggests that audiovisual information is stored in memory as two separate but associated codes—one verbal and one visual—whereas text-only information is stored as a verbal code only. During recall, the visual-memory code serves as an extra retrieval cue, which could account for the superior recall of television stories.

However, experiments show that learning is enhanced only by the addition of “redundant” pictures, which convey the same basic meaning as the words. When pictures and words do not coincide, children do not remember more and sometimes remember less from television presentations than from purely verbal presentation. Theories based on the concept of “limited attentional capacity” posit that when verbal and visual information do not correspond, viewers' attentional capacity is exceeded and part of the information is lost. In the case of nonredundant audiovisual information, viewers tend to direct their attention to the visual images because meaning is conveyed more readily through pictures; this preference may hinder learning because the main message in television news is usually provided in the spoken commentary. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. illustrate the processes through which a particular phenomenon takes place
 - B. introduce additional information in order to qualify a particular explanation for a phenomenon
 - C. explain an apparent contradiction in the results of an experiment concerning a particular phenomenon
 - D. describe two experiments concerning a particular phenomenon in order to compare opposing theories about that phenomenon
 - E. outline the types of evidence that are typically used to support a particular theory about a phenomenon
2. According to the passage, Paivio's dual-coding hypothesis suggests that the difference between viewers' ability to recall television news stories and their ability to recall print versions of the same stories is primarily the result of the fact that viewers can do which of the following?
 - A. Reduce information conveyed in two different forms to a single type of memory code.
 - B. Remain within their attentional capacity by avoiding the storage of redundant information.
 - C. Translate text-only information into both verbal-memory and visual-memory codes.
 - D. Determine whether the pictures and words in a television news story coincide.
 - E. Retrieve information through the use of more than one type of memory code.
3. If theories of limited attentional capacity, as described in the passage are correct, which of the following is most likely to be true of the news stories used in the “studies comparing children's memory”?
 - A. The main message in the television news stories was provided through visual images.
 - B. The effort required to process the print versions of the news stories exceeded the attentional capacity of the children in the studies.
 - C. The visual component of the television news stories provided information that was redundant with the spoken commentary.
 - D. The difficulty of the print versions of the news stories prevented the children from storing the information presented in the stories as a verbal code.
 - E. The television news stories included less verbal information than did the print versions of the stories.

Passage 359

The manuscript of a previously unknown ragtime piano piece recently been discovered. The manuscript is unsigned and has the notation "New York City, 1899" written on it. In 1899 Ben Harney was the New York musician most closely associated with ragtime. The style of the piece, however, is closer to that of Scott Joplin, but scholars believe that Joplin did not visit New York before 1906. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Form the information given, which of the following can properly be concluded?

- A. If Scott Joplin wrote the piece, either he did visit New York before 1906 or the notation on the manuscript does not reflect the place and date of composition of the piece.
- B. Ben Harney was stylistically influenced by Scott Joplin's music before Joplin ever visited New York
- C. If Scott Joplin did not visit New York before 1906, then neither Ben Harney nor Scott Joplin composed the work
- D. The notation on the manuscript was intended to signify something other than the place and date of composition of the piece.
- E. If the dating on the manuscript accurately reflects when and where the piece was composed, then Scott Joplin visited New York earlier than scholars have believed.

Passage 360

The most common type of fishing gear found in Chumash archaeological sites in present-day coastal California is the single-piece curved fishhook made from bone or shell. The best archaeological evidence that the Chumash also used nets are grooved and notched stones. Such stones could have weighted nets and have been found at a number of late period sites, although ethnographic sources suggest that these **apparent** sinkers may have been attached to a line for a fishhook. At one Chumash site, the 7,655 identified otoliths (ear bones) from white croaker fish were close to the same size. Archaeologists have proposed that the uniformity of the otoliths indicates that the croakers were captured with gill nets, which would trap fish within a narrow size range. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. From the passage, it can be inferred that items found at Chumash archaeological sites did NOT include
 - A. multipiece fishhooks
 - B. gill nets
 - C. fish remains other than otoliths
 - D. remains of boats
 - E. weights for fishing lines
2. In the context in which it appears, "apparent" most nearly means
 - A. clear
 - B. illusory
 - C. ostensible
 - D. visible
 - E. specious

Passage 361

Serotonin is a chemical continuously released by brain cells. Because serotonin decomposes extremely quickly into other chemicals, including 5-HIAA, researchers measure levels of 5-HIAA as an indicator of serotonin levels in the body. Recently, people convicted of arson have been found to have consistently low levels of 5-HIAA. Therefore, researchers who regard the tendency to commit arson as an illness hypothesize that the illness could be cured if arsonists' serotonin levels could be raised. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The researchers' hypothesis would be most seriously undermined if it were discovered that
 - A. none of the other chemicals into which serotonin decomposes is present in the body in sufficient quantities to be a useful indicator of serotonin levels in the brain
 - B. levels of 5-HIAA in the brain normally fluctuate throughout the course of a single day
 - C. 5-HIAA itself eventually decomposes into other chemicals
 - D. many people who have low levels of 5-HIAA in the brain and who commit arson commit no other serious crimes of any sort
 - E. arsonists tend to be deficient in the enzyme necessary to decompose serotonin

Passage 362

Until the mid-1980s, Swedish workers' wages were largely determined through centralized collective bargaining at a national level, a policy aimed at achieving equal pay for equal work across companies and industries. This policy, designed to raise the relative wages of low-wage workers, resulted in a **decrease** in overall wage inequality in Sweden's labor market. Furthermore, this policy may have indirectly resulted in a relatively small gender wage gap (difference between women's wages and those of similarly qualified men): several recent **studies** have demonstrated that decentralized wage bargaining produces relatively large wage inequality in general and large gender wage differentials in particular, and international comparisons show that a society's overall wage inequality is positively related to the gender wage gap.

Therefore, in designing a study of organizational factors that perpetuate inequities in women's wages, researchers decided to gather data on the current situation in Swedish companies. The researchers reasoned that the occurrence of discriminatory wage-setting practices in Swedish companies could provide a conservative estimate of the prevalence of such practices in other developed countries. Despite increasing decentralization of Sweden's wage-bargaining process since the mid-1980s, they reasoned, the effects of the earlier policy on current wages should still be evident to some extent. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred that the highlighted "studies" lend support to which of the following statements about women workers wages?
 - A. In most countries, women workers' wages would not likely be affected by centralized collective bargaining in the same way as they were in Sweden prior to the mid-1980s.
 - B. In most countries, women workers' wages are closer to the wages of similarly qualified men than they are in Sweden.
 - C. Women workers' wages are generally less affected by centralized collective bargaining than are men's wages.
 - D. Women workers' wages are sometimes adversely affected by wage-setting practices that are intended to remedy overall wage inequality.
 - E. Women workers' wages are generally closer to the wages of similarly qualified male workers where wages are set through centralized wage bargaining than where they are set through decentralized wage bargaining.
2. The author of the passage attributes the highlighted "decrease" to which of the following?
 - A. A decline in Sweden's gender wage gap
 - B. A decline in low-wage workers' wages in Sweden
 - C. A decline in women's wages in Sweden.
 - D. A policy governing wage bargaining in Sweden
 - E. A change in Sweden's wage-bargaining practices initiated in the mid-1980s
3. If the researchers' reasoning presented in the last paragraph of the passage is correct, then which of the following would be most likely to be true?
 - A. Organizational factors that perpetuate inequities in women's wages are less prevalent in Swedish companies today than they were prior to the mid-1980s.
 - B. The gender wage gap in Sweden is larger today than it was prior to the mid-1980s but smaller than that in many other developed countries.
 - C. Discriminatory wage-setting practices have declined in Sweden since the mid-1980s but not as sharply as they have declined in many other developed countries.
 - D. Overall wage inequality in Sweden has declined more sharply since the mid-1980s than it did during the period when centralized wage-bargaining processes prevailed in Sweden.
 - E. Women workers occupy more high-level positions in Swedish companies than they do in companies in many other developed countries.

Passage 363

In northern Senland, the number of motor vehicle accidents is about twice as high in January, when icy conditions on the roads are most frequent, than it is in June, when the weather is usually warm and dry. However, in northern Senland, the risk that a vehicle driven in January will be involved in an accident is probably even more than twice as high as it is for one driven in June, since _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following most logically completes the argument?

- A. Cities in northern Senland are notoriously inefficient at clearing residential roads of snow and ice.
- B. People are much less likely to drive when the roads are icy than when the roads are dry.
- C. When the roads are icy, drivers tend to drive at considerably lower speeds than they do when the roads are dry.
- D. Even when the roads are icy, most commuters in northern Senland have no choice but to commute by car.
- E. An unusually high proportion of northern Senland's roads are mountain roads.

Passage 364

Conspicuous structural inconsistencies distinguish the Ephesiaka of Xenophon from other ancient Greek novels. Its narrative texture is uneven, the story's pace varies erratically, and compared with other novels, it is inferior in composition. The quality of the Ephesiaka was first questioned by Burger who maintained that much of the work is an epitome (summary). This idea was used to account for the work's narrative shortcomings the choppy pace, the lack of motivation for certain events, the abrupt introduction of characters. However, it is doubtful that Ephesiaka is an epitome because, as an epitome, it is a worse job than it is as a novel. Even in passages Burger thinks are epitomized, inconsequential details such as Anthia feeding her dogs are retained, but potentially significant actions of gods are excised. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author mentions "Anthia feeding her dogs" primarily in order to support

- A. a comparison between the Ephesiaka and other ancient Greek novels
- B. a criticism of Burger's view about what the Ephesiaka is
- C. an explanation of the Ephesiaka's narrative shortcomings
- D. reassessment of the Ephesiaka's quality as a work of literature
- E. a claim about the effect of inconsequential details on the overall quality of Ephesiaka

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. It can be inferred that the author of the passage disagrees with Burger about which of the following?

- A. whether it can be determined which ancient Greek texts are epitomes
- B. the explanation for some apparent deficiencies in the Ephesiaka
- C. the overall literary quality of the Ephesiaka

Passage 365

When people suffering from zencolia, a highly infectious disease, are given the drug nartol, their symptoms cease and the zencolia virus can no longer be detected. But when some zencolia patients discontinue treatment with nartol, they exhibit zencolia symptoms once more just months later, and the virus is again detectable. This result shows that treatment with nartol sometimes suppresses the zencolia virus below detectable levels without entirely eliminating the virus from the body. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the argument?

- A. When the zencolia virus enters the body of a person free of the virus, it takes several years from the time of infection before any zencolia symptoms appear.
- B. There is no drug that is more effective than nartol in treating the symptoms of zencolia.
- C. Taking nartol prevents a patient from becoming infected by the zencolia virus for as long as the drug is used.
- D. Researchers have so far not been able to develop a vaccine that would reliably prevent infection or reinfection with the zencolia virus.
- E. Some people are allergic to nartol but, thanks to the availability of a simple and effective allergy test, run little risk of having it prescribed for them if they contract zencolia.

Passage 366

Public schools in the United States do not collect data on the financial status of their students' households. This creates difficulty for researchers wishing to ascertain, for a given school, the proportion of students coming from low-income households. A nationwide program, however, guarantees free school lunches for students who apply and can demonstrate economic need. Therefore, the desired information can be obtained using data on the number of students at each school who take free school lunches. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

- A. Nearly all students eligible for the free lunches apply and are approved for them.
- B. Ascertaining the proportion of individual schools' students coming from low-income households can help school officials allocate funds for free school-lunch programs.
- C. The distinction between students who are from low-income households and those who are not is the only economic distinction among public school students in which researchers are interested.
- D. Without data on participation in free school-lunch programs, researchers cannot determine what proportion of a school's students came from low-income households.
- E. There are no available statistics other than participation in the free school-lunch program that would enable researchers to gauge the proportions of students from low-income households at different schools.

Passage 367

Some historians argue that users of oral history should not have to learn special uses of symbols to understand interview transcripts easily; these historians advocate a strong role for editing in making transcripts readable and easily understood. Proponents of this approach recommend changing punctuation, rearranging words, and editing out false starts, crutch words, and the like to enhance the transcript's **conveyance** of meaning. Others argue for a more cautious approach, asserting that deleted linguistic phenomena are important clues to understanding the meaning conveyed during the interview. They urge editors to conform as closely as possible to the original tape, making only those changes absolutely necessary to clarify for the reader what was said in the interview. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage implies that oral historians who advocate cautious editing of interview transcripts believe that

- A. the words of the interviewer, but not those of the interviewee, may be changed for increased clarity
- B. the original tape of an interview is preferable as oral history to a transcript of the interview
- C. there is little consensus among editors regarding what constitutes a necessary change
- D. false starts and crutch words can help readers of interview transcripts understand what the speaker really means
- E. False starts and crutch words do not constitute genuine linguistic phenomena

2. In the context in which it appears, "conveyance" most nearly means

- A. assignment
- B. transportation
- C. agreement
- D. transmission
- E. appropriation

Passage 368

Low bone density is the primary risk factor for bone fractures. People with a physically inactive lifestyle provide a case in point: their bone density decreases and, as a result, they become increasingly prone to bone fractures. People who routinely take Omega sleeping pills are also uncommonly prone to bone fractures, even as compared to users of other sleeping pills. Clearly, when data on Omega users' bone density are collected, what they will show is below-average bone density. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, casts most doubt on the prediction?

- A. When taken regularly, Omega sleeping pills, more than other sleeping pills, cause people to be unsteady on their feet.
- B. Omega sleeping pills, when taken regularly, can be taken in gradually decreasing dose without any diminution of the desired effect.
- C. Measuring a person's bone density is not currently a part of a routine medical checkup.
- D. In people whose bone density decreases, the likelihood of a hip fracture increases at a greater rate than does the likelihood of any other kind of bone fracture.
- E. People who regularly take Omega sleeping pills are no more likely than people in general are to have a physically inactive lifestyle.

Passage 369

The emphasis on intimate conversation in political discourse originated with Saul Alinsky (1909-1972) but became American labor leader Cesar Chavez's (1927-1993) supreme contribution to political theory and practice. Such one-on-one organizing, like the **feminist consciousness-raising groups** that share its spirit, was promoted not just as a way of discussing politics, but as a way of doing politics. Its opposite was political oratory, the great transforming speech before a gathering of listeners. This view was an enormous departure in democratic theory: **the leader's ability to inspire a crowd had long been a touchstone of popular politics**, but now such speeches and speechmakers seemed suspect, even essentially undemocratic, because they were frequently full of bombast, and because they talked at the people instead of listening to them. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred from the passage that members of "feminist consciousness-raising groups"

- A. distanced themselves from a theory that originated with Saul Alinsky
- B. typically prioritized conversations about personal issues over political activism
- C. developed a specialized rhetorical style that was inaccessible to outsiders
- D. considered some traditional modes of political engagement to be inadequate
- E. were skeptical about whether political discussion could lead to lasting change

2. In the context of the passage, the highlighted portion serves primarily to

- A. shed light on the validity of a theory
- B. question the reasonableness of a claim
- C. identify an untenable assumption
- D. cast doubt on an outmoded idea
- E. highlight the radical nature of an approach

Passage 370

Large groups of workers are unlikely to continue, generation after generation, to remain loyal to an occupation that significantly underrewards them relative to their efforts and the risks accepted, and which reduces their standard of living below that available from possible alternative forms of employment. Yet the established social history of nineteenth-century Cornish miners embraces a view that the nature of their labor made their lives particularly “nasty, brutish, and short”; that highly volatile earnings levels frequently plunged them into abject poverty; and that they were trapped in the industry by unbreakable cultural bonds. But Burt and Kippen argue that complex “cultural entrapment” explanations of miners’ continuing attachment to the industry are largely unnecessary. Their comparative analysis of Cornish miners with similar laboring groups shows that while mining did have deleterious health effects, average earnings were relatively high and probably more than compensated for any reduction in the total length of miner’s working career. Thus Cornish miners’ career choice was a rational economic one, and continued loyalty to the industry was soundly based on economic self-interest. Cultural issues may admittedly have been significant to individuals, but were not an inevitable part of the decision-making process. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. defend a theory against criticism
 - B. challenge a generally accepted position
 - C. point out an oversimplification
 - D. describe the benefits of a certain economic decision
 - E. express doubt about the validity of a particular study
2. According to the passage, the generally accepted social history of Cornish miners claims that these miners
 - A. often lived in impoverished conditions
 - B. often changed careers in midlife when they were no longer strong enough for mining work
 - C. defied cultural bonds by continuing to work as miners despite the many health risks
 - D. underestimated the seriousness of the health risks associated with mining
 - E. made their career choices based on rational economic considerations
3. The author of the passage would probably agree that if the working conditions and earnings of the nineteenth-century Cornish miners were as the established social history depicts, it would mean that the miners were
 - A. devoted to their industry primarily for reasons of financial gain
 - B. unusual in their continued loyalty to the mining industry
 - C. uninfluenced by traditional cultural bonds
 - D. relatively unaware of the health risks associated with mining
 - E. convinced that mining offered more job security than did other available occupations

Passage 371

That the narrator in George Eliot's novel *Middlemarch* (completed 1871) displays an astonishing breadth of knowledge may be partly explained by Eliot's reaction to specializing division of labor that threatened an **extinction** of generalists. Some of Eliot's **contemporaries** attributed the nineteenth century's rapid specialization to an accelerating pace of knowledge production. But specialization, Eliot recognized, was not simply an effect of proliferating information. The notion that specialization was essential to an individual's credibility was also an ideological product of professionalization. Nineteenth-century professional organizations actively fostered public distrust of nonprofessionals, and effect, Eliot feared, that might pressure laypersons, confronted with unfamiliar fields, to resign their curiosity and abdicate moral authority, conceding decision-making to professionals. Eliot's narrator serves as her rejoinder: an ideal of intellectual expansiveness. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, Eliot differed from some of her "contemporaries" in that she
 - A. considered the cultivation of intellectual breadth to be an unrealistic endeavor
 - B. ascribed certain intellectual advances of her time to profound changes in the division labor
 - C. doubted whether the accelerating pace of knowledge production was inevitable
 - D. perceived increasing specialization as driven partly by the self-interest of particular groups
 - E. anticipated the potential negative effects of rapidly expanding knowledge on professionals
2. The author mentions the "extinction" primarily to
 - A. help explain why generalists were impressed by the narrator in Eliot's novel *Middlemarch*
 - B. qualify a claim about the effect of specialization on the nineteenth-century division of labor
 - C. cite a potential outcome that may have influenced an aspect of Eliot's writing
 - D. note a nineteenth-century trend that worried many of Eliot's contemporaries
 - E. suggest that certain social changes in the nineteenth century may have impeded the expansion of knowledge

Passage 372

Many traffic accidents occur when deer cross roads. When reflectors are set up that reflect light from oncoming cars toward the side of the road, the number of deer crossing at night drops considerably. However, it is unlikely that the number of traffic accidents involving deer would be significantly reduced by installing such reflectors wherever deer are numerous, since a deer that is deterred from crossing a road at night will probably cross it the next day. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weaken the reasoning?

- A. On any given road, the average number of traffic accidents involving deer tends to vary widely from one season of the year to another.
- B. It is easier for drivers to safely avoid hitting a deer crossing the road in day light than in darkness.
- C. Even where there are no reflectors to deter them, deer are far more likely to cross a road at night in some places than in others.
- D. Reflectors are less likely to significantly reduce the number of deer crossing the road at night on lightly traveled roads than on heavily traveled ones.
- E. Where there are no reflectors, deer are less likely to cross a road in daylight than at night.

Passage 373

The late zoologist Sidnie Manton acknowledged that arthropods—animals with jointed exoskeletons, such as flies, crabs, and spiders—are all descended from soft-bodied segmented worms. Yet he maintained that differences in limb forms, musculature, and embryonic development indicate that these three arthropod groups—insects, crustaceans, and chelicerates, respectively—evolved independently from worms rather than from a common arthropod ancestor. Consequently, according to Manton, **shared characteristics** such as a jointed exoskeleton and large compound eyes represent cases of convergent evolution—similar yet independent developments—in these organisms. But if they evolved convergently, then one would expect significant differences in the neurological systems supporting sight. In fact, however, many nerve cells play virtually identical roles in supporting complex visual responses in both insects and crustaceans, suggesting that their common ancestor already possessed highly developed eyes, and therefore was probably already an arthropod. Yet the compound eyes of chelicerates differ neurologically from those of insects and crustaceans, suggesting that the eyes of chelicerates did evolve independently and providing practical confirmation of Manton's views. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. explain how insects and crustaceans differ from chelicerates
 - B. evaluate an account of the evolution of various types of arthropods
 - C. illustrate a case of convergent evolution among different types of arthropods
 - D. discuss various physiological features of insects, crustaceans, and chelicerates
 - E. identify underlying similarities in two contrasting theories regarding the evolution of certain arthropods
2. It can be inferred that the author of the passage and Manton would be most likely to disagree over which of the following claims?
 - A. Insects and crustaceans are both descended from segmented worms.
 - B. Insects and crustaceans each have unique limb form, musculature, and embryonic development.
 - C. The compound eyes of insects and crustaceans are a case of convergent evolution.
 - D. None of the characteristics common to insects and crustaceans can be found in segmented worms.
 - E. Insects and crustaceans are the most closely related of all the arthropod groups.
3. It can be inferred from the passage that Manton believed which of the following about the “shared characteristics” mentioned in the passage?
 - A. The shared characteristics are not all present in any single ancestor of these three arthropod groups.
 - B. The shared characteristics could be used to determine which of these three arthropod groups gave rise to the other two groups.
 - C. The shared characteristics are a good indication that all three groups of arthropods descended from segmented worms.
 - D. The shared characteristics are the most compelling evidence to date for the theory of convergent evolution.
 - E. The shared characteristics do not justify classifying all three animal groups as arthropod.

Passage 374

Margaret Bayard Smith's 1836 biographical sketch of Dolley Madison extensively quotes a letter Madison allegedly wrote to her sister in 1814 detailing her last hours in the White House before it was burned by invading troops. Madison, who gave Smith a copy of the letter, provided conflicting accounts of the original document's whereabouts. It is possible that in 1814 Madison wrote the letter Smith quoted, or one very similar: **other authenticated documents** she later wrote agree with its account. More likely, Madison may have edited or embellished the original letter for publication. In contrast to her typically slapdash style, the letter given to Smith unfolds like a novel, in uncharacteristically formal and flowery language. The text also includes details unnecessary in a letter between sisters, though useful to general readers. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage mentions "other authenticated documents" primarily in order to
 - A. corroborate Smith's account of how she came into possession of a copy of Madison's letter
 - B. point out the contrast between the verifiability of the copy of the letter Madison wrote
 - C. show that Madison did not usually give conflicting accounts of the whereabouts of documents she had produced
 - D. suggest that the account in the copy of the letter Madison gave to Smith is consistent with the account in the original letter
 - E. provide evidence that supports the passage's characterization of Madison's usual writing style

2. Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

It can be inferred that the author of the passage finds which of the following factors relevant in evaluating the letter Madison gave to Smith?

- A. Inconsistencies in Madison's statements about the original letter
- B. The writing style of the letter that Madison gave to Smith
- C. The apparent intended audience of the letter that Madison gave to Smith

Passage 375

French filmmakers of the 1920s emphasized visual style rather than narrative continuity, which was already dominant in the United States and elsewhere. **Some critics have asserted that since these films flout the cinematic conventions of Hollywood, they should be regarded as important modernist cinema.** While a welcome departure from the traditional denigration of 1920s French cinema, this **claim** overestimates or distorts the achievement of such directors as Gance and L'Herbier, since the Hollywood conventions they did not use were not yet fully established in France, where the Hollywood-style production practices that would have supported these conventions were lacking. Moreover, though 1920s French films should indeed be judged by criteria other than those underlying the Hollywood aesthetic, their slighting of Hollywood conventions does not, by itself, make them modernist or genuinely revolutionary, since the weight of nineteenth-century traditions of art and literature on these films—especially in subject matter and ideological assumptions—cannot easily be disregarded. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. In regard to 1920s French cinema, the passage is primarily concerned with
 - A. critiquing an assessment of it
 - B. refuting a traditional view of it
 - C. defending it against certain criticisms
 - D. assessing its various merits
 - E. evaluating opposing views of it
2. The author of the passage suggest which of the following about the critics mentioned in the highlighted sentence?
 - A. They have failed to identify the real merits of such directors as Gance and L'Herbier.
 - B. They have neglected to note the influence of prior aesthetic traditions on 1920s French cinema.
 - C. They have overestimated the degree to which modernist cinema diverges from Hollywood conventions.
 - D. They have been successful in revising the traditional view of 1920s French cinema.
 - E. They have demonstrated that modernist cinema has been partly influenced by the rediscovery of 1920s French cinema.
3. Which of the following statements about the “claim” is most consistent with the view expressed by the author of the passage?
 - A. The claim has a certain amount of validity but is undermined by its failure to define the qualities that actually characterize modernist cinema.
 - B. The claim overestimates the achievements of 1920s French cinema to approximately the same degree that earlier assessments underestimated those achievements.
 - C. The claim tends to be more accurate regarding certain directors than regarding other directors.
 - D. The claim represents a welcome revival of interest in 1920s French cinema, but it is overly concerned with the types of influences that shaped these films.
 - E. The claim is an improvement upon an earlier assessment of 1920s French cinema, but in several respects it is mistaken.

Passage 376

Carol Oja has three related authorial agendas in her book about American musical modernism. The first is self-consciously revisionist: her book restores to major prominence Leo Ornstein, George Antheil, and Dane Rudhyar, three composers almost always neglected in recent accounts of modernism. The second agenda is one of synthesis, and Oja tackles two kinds of synthesis successfully. One involves incorporating her revisionist history into the more standard historical narratives of the period, and the other involves incorporating an effective critical overview of significant recent research by others into her own narrative. The final agenda is largely implicit but follows directly from the second: to suggest that direction of further search and new critical syntheses to follow. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Select the sentence that presents an issue about which Oja and other scholars of American musical modernism disagree.
2. Oja's final agenda, as it is discussed in the passage, can best be described as
 - A. argumentative
 - B. preventive
 - C. prescriptive
 - D. inquisitive
 - E. summative

Passage 377

The graphic elements of Mesoamerican codex writing appear as figural representations, icons, and symbols that signify thought, ideas, and imagery rather than visible speech. Although ancient Mexicans designated some symbols to voice specific words, their larger graphic system did not correspond directly with spoken language. Because the symbols did not replicate any single linguistic system, speakers of various languages could translate the pictographs into their own respective tongues. Readers evaluated a combination of naturalistic images, pictorial conventions, and abstract symbols recorded within an organized structure. By knowing the basic conventions and the meanings of the symbols and recognizing their general arrangement, readers interpreted the pictographs messages. Precise reading orders are not always set, however, thus, different readings and interpretations remain possible. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, which of the following is true regarding the symbols of the Mesoamerican codex graphic system?

- A. Some of the symbols represent multiple concepts.
- B. Some of the symbols correspond with particular words.
- C. Most of the symbols originate from a single spoken language.
- D. The symbols were primarily made up of abstract images.
- E. The individual symbols were hard to translate because their arrangement varied.

2. Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

It can be inferred from the passage that the nature of the Mesoamerican codex graphic system enabled which of the following?

- A. The sharing of the system among speakers of different languages.
- B. The visible representation of different language systems.
- C. The changing of the system's conventions by speakers of different languages.

Passage 378

While economic historians have generally given far more attention to male than to female industrial workers in eighteenth-century England, an imbalance that is being corrected by recent studies of female industrial laborers, **scholars** of the period's consumer revolution have focused on women's crucial role as consumers of mass-produced goods. Cultural historians, for example, have generated an impressive body of work on eighteenth-century women and consumption, studying records of women's purchases of such items as cloth, table linens, and china and showing how women used such items as expressions of their taste and status. However, this attention to women's role in the demand side of England's industrial economy has tended to overshadow the importance of men's role as shoppers. Many historians have taken the view that women were far more likely than men to purchase and to attach emotional significance to consumer goods, finding support for this view in men's wills from the period, which rarely mentioned household consumer items in any detail. Yet, research on eighteenth-century **advertising** demonstrates that merchants often targeted male consumers, regarding them as important customers, and studies of inventories of eighteenth-century estates have failed to show differences between men's and women's consumer activities. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. examine new evidence about a particular historical phenomenon.
 - B. account for a change in the focus of a particular field of research.
 - C. call attention to an erroneous assumption that has guided a particular field of scholarship.
 - D. compare two competing perspectives on a particular historical period.
 - E. examine a controversy surrounding research into a particular era.
2. The author of the passage mentions eighteenth-century advertising primarily in order to
 - A. support a claim about the value of a particular kind of historical evidence
 - B. identify evidence that supports many historians' views about eighteenth-century consumer behavior
 - C. contrast merchants' assumptions about male shoppers with their assumptions about female shoppers
 - D. suggest a direction for future research on the consumer activities of eighteenth-century men
 - E. question a conclusion drawn from the analysis of a particular kind of historical evidence
3. The passage suggests which of the following about the "scholars"?
 - A. Their conclusions challenge the view of most previous historians about eighteenth-century female industrial laborers.
 - B. Their methodology represents a significant departure from that of earlier economic and cultural historians.
 - C. Their findings are suggestive, but are not necessarily reliable indicators of eighteenth-century women's behavior.
 - D. Their work has resulted in an unbalanced picture of the demand side of eighteenth-century England's industrial economy.
 - E. Their studies have helped to correct an imbalance in the research on eighteenth-century England's industrial workforce.

Passage 379

It is common to quote David Hume arguing against the possibility of reasoned ethics—for example, his observation that “the rules of morality are not conclusions of our reason.” Hume’s remarks on the relation between reason and ethics are so myriad that it would be presumptuous to seek a definitive clarification of his position. But it is worth noting that immediately preceding the remark just quoted, Hume declares: “Morals excites passions, and produce or prevent actions. Reason of itself is utterly impotent in this particular.” The qualification “of itself” is important to note. This is, in fact, not an argument that reason is unimportant for morality or for motivating action. It argues only that reason cannot accomplish this entirely on its own. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. argue that contrary to the conventional interpretation, Hume saw reason as playing the central role in ethical decisions
 - B. suggest that Hume viewed reason and morality as being equally strong motivations for action
 - C. criticize Hume for failing to provide a definitive clarification of his position on the relationship between reason and ethics
 - D. explain why Hume’s view of the relationship between reason and ethics has been widely misunderstood
 - E. contend that Hume’s view of the relationship between reason and ethics is more complicated than is often suggested
2. The author quotes Hume in the first sentence of the passage primarily to
 - A. illustrate the claim that Hume’s view of reason’s role in ethics has been misconstrued
 - B. acknowledge a remark made by Hume that seems to indicate that Hume saw reason as inextricable from ethics
 - C. demonstrate that Hume’s writings are sometimes ambiguous with respect to the relationship between reason and ethics
 - D. show why someone might see Hume as unsympathetic to the notion that reason plays a role in ethics
 - E. provide evidence that supports the author’s interpretation of Hume’s ethical philosophy

Passage 380

Due to the importance they accorded roads, railways, rivers and bridges, the French Impressionist painters were able to create a new iconography of landscape for the industrial age. Most contemporaries saw nothing in these paintings but trivial subjects and retained only the visual shock of the Impressionists' completely new technique and style. The Impressionist canvases were, however, much more complex than their apparent simplicity indicated: Impressionist landscapes balanced traditional images of France with elements representing industrial progress and thereby introduced modernity into painting. While retaining a part of the heritage they had received from their artistic predecessors, who had painted virgin forests and quaint old mills and farms, the Impressionist did not hesitate to place these traditional motifs next to factories and other signs of modernity in order to give as complete a vision as possible of their land. In their own way they were helping to celebrate the reconstruction of France that followed the Franco-Prussian War. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is primarily concerned with

- A. examining the reaction of nineteenth-century critics to French impressionist painting
- B. analyzing the influence of French impressionists on modern landscape painting.
- C. pointing out certain negative effects of modernization and industrialization on French painting
- D. discussing French impressionists' use of traditional and innovative elements in landscape painting.
- E. explaining some of the reasons for the French impressionists' lack of early success.

2. Which of the following does that passage imply about the nineteenth-century reaction to French Impressionist landscape paintings?

- A. The majority of viewers regarded landscape as a relatively uninteresting genre of painting.
- B. Most viewers regarded the French Impressionists' style and technique as innovative, but they found the subject matter to be conventional.
- C. The French impressionists' failure to achieve wide acceptance was due to a widespread distrust of industrial progress.
- D. Even those favorable to the French Impressionists' visual techniques deplored the painters' new subject matter.
- E. Very few viewers appreciated the significance of the choice of subject matter in such paintings.

3. Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

The passage suggests which of the following about French Impressionist painters of landscapes?

- A. They produced paintings with certain aspects that many of their contemporaries found shocking.
- B. They presented a more comprehensive image of their time and place than many of their contemporaries recognized.
- C. They incorporated into their paintings the sorts of pastoral images that were common in works by earlier artists.

Passage 381

Historian Sheilagh Ogilvie challenges the view that training by European craft guilds from 1560 to 1760 was necessary. Her main evidence, however, is based only on female employment in one guild. Like most other guilds, the Wildberg weaver's guild banned women from becoming masters; however, it exempted master's widow. Indeed, widows accounted for 14 percent of all masters. Ogilvie claims that these "untrained" widow prove "the irrelevance of training." But Wildberg master-widows were not untrained for, as Ogilvie notes elsewhere, wives and children worked with masters; their training may have been informal, but it existed nevertheless. At least 80 percent of widows were married to masters for longer than the standard six-year apprenticeship; an unknown proportion of the remainder had grown up in weaving families. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. In context, the primary function of the final sentence of the passage is to
 - A. provide evidence to undermine a central claim in Ogilvie's argument
 - B. summarize the most important aspects of the data Ogilvie cites to support her analysis.
 - C. illustrate how the Wildberg weavers' guild differed from other craft guilds of the period.
 - D. quantify the amount of formal training typically received by Wildberg master weavers.
 - E. clarify an ambiguity in the status of master-widows as guild members.
2. The author's evaluation of Ogilvie's argument focuses primarily on Ogilvie's
 - A. overgeneralization of a study of an atypical industry
 - B. failure to differentiate between formal apprenticeship training and subsequent practical experience
 - C. assumptions that certain guild members had no training
 - D. insufficient acknowledgement of certain exceptions to a guild's rules
 - E. attempt to impose an artificial uniformity on an extended period in history

Passage 382

Many scholars believe that it was Granziera who actually wrote the politically charged plays attributed to Urbani. But a comparison of the texts of those plays with Granziera's known works shows a distinct difference in style: the frequency of words with at least three syllables in these plays is much lower than in the works known to have been written by Granziera. Therefore, Granziera is probably not the author of the plays attributed to Urbani. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument?

- A. All of the works known to have been written by Granziera are scholarly essays in political theory.
- B. In the period in which Granziera and Urbani wrote, many works were published anonymously.
- C. Whereas most of the plays attributed to Urbani are short, a few are very long.
- D. Granziera and Urbani are known to have held similar political views.
- E. It is relatively rare for an author to employ substantially different styles in different published works.

Passage 383

Fuel cells produce energy by reaction between hydrogen and atmosphere oxygen. Automobiles powered by fuel cells are touted as gasoline-conserving alternatives to conventional automobiles. However, automobiles cannot safely carry tanks of hydrogen. One type of fuel cell solves this problem by extracting hydrogen in small quantities, as needed, from gasoline. Although such fuel cells perpetuate gasoline usage, their widespread adoption would have a moderating effect on the country's total gasoline consumption, since _____.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following most logically completes the passage above?

- A. Automobile powered by fuel cells of the type travel farther per gallon of gasoline than automobile powered by conventional engine.
- B. There are other types of fuel cells that avoid the use of gasoline altogether by extracting hydrogen from alcohol.
- C. Automobile powered by this type of fuel cells would be outnumbered by those powered by those conventional gasoline engines for many years.
- D. Carbon dioxide, an atmosphere pollutant, is emitted by both the extraction of hydrogen from gasoline and the combustion of gasoline in a conventional automobile engine.
- E. Automobiles powered by conventional engines cannot readily converted to run on fuel cells.

Passage 384

Despite regional differences in writing styles and thematic concerns, certain trends have emerged in African novels that demarcate their difference from the Western novel. Most notable is the influence of oral tradition. Stylistically, the African novel begins with a prose narrative, but allows for insertions of oral traditions such as folktales and songs. For example, in Chinua Achebe's *Things Fall Apart*, when an elder recounts a folktale, Achebe inserts the actual folktale, enveloping an oral narrative within a written one. The easy transitions between oral traditions and the authorial voice consequently undermines the novelist's claim to originality while **bolstering the text with communal authority**. Thus the African novel is often the work not of a single author, but a writer and a community. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. In the context of the passage, the highlighted text serves primarily to
 - A. indicate a problem with Achebe's use of an actual folktale
 - B. identify a feature that distinguishes certain African novels from other African novels
 - C. analyze the nature of original prose narratives in African novels
 - D. point to one of the effects of including actual folktales within an otherwise original narrative
 - E. acknowledge a counterclaim to a point about the effects of inserting oral tradition into novels
2. Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.
The author implies that Chinua Achebe's inclusion of a folktale within his novel has which of the following effects?
 - A. It distinguishes Achebe's work from that of other African novelists.
 - B. It makes the novel more of a collectively authored work.
 - C. It introduces a new thematic concern to the narrative.

Passage 385

The thylacine, a slender, wolf-like predator, lived on mainland Australia until about 3,000 years ago. The thylacine disappeared from the mainland shortly after the dingo, a kind of wild dog, was first brought to Australia. Dingoes flourished in Australia and preyed on many of the same animal species on which the thylacine relied. Thus, the introduction of the dingo probably caused the thylacine's disappearance there. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the argument?

- A. Dingoes also preyed on animal species that thylacines did not prey on.
- B. On the Australian island of Tasmania, which was never inhabited by dingoes, thylacines survived into the 1900s.
- C. The largest thylacines in Australia were much larger than dingoes.
- D. Much of the dingo's diet today consists of animal species that were not found in Australia 3000 years ago.
- E. Thylacines relied on their stamina rather than their speed to capture prey.

Passage 386

Dorothy Mermin's 1989 discussion of the ballads in Elizabeth Barrett Browning's *Poems* (1844) reflects an anti-sentimental bias common among twentieth-century scholars. Mermin notes that modern readers tend to find the ballads uncomfortably mawkish. Forced to admit the ballads' popularity with **Barrett Browning's contemporaries**, Mermin dismissively remarks that "[their] main appeal is to the feelings." Mermin's aesthetic principles are revealed in her description of some of Barrett Browning's political writings as "aesthetically more attractive" than the ballads because they are detached, analytical, and complex. Acknowledging that Barrett Browning took "the essence of poetry to be feeling," aesthetic value might arise from their sentimentality. Yet Victorian critics recognized in these sentimental verses both poetic force and intellectual power. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following most accurately represents the author's central point in the passage?

- A. Twentieth-century scholars tended to give disproportionate emphasis to only one part of Barrett Browning's literary output.
- B. An essential virtue of poetry is its ability to appeal strongly and directly to the feelings of readers.
- C. A lack of sympathy for certain literary qualities may limit a critic's assessment of Barrett Browning's work
- D. Barrett Browning has been unfairly dismissed by critics who fail to recognize the sentimentality of the ballads in *Poems* (1844).
- E. Twentieth-century scholars and Victorian critics disagree about whether the ballads in *Poems* (1844) are representative of Barrett Browning's aesthetic goals.

2. The author mentions "Barrett Browning's contemporaries" partly to

- A. criticize their evaluation of the ballads in *Poems* (1844).
- B. call into question the objectivity of some of Mermin's views about the literary tastes of Victorian readers.
- C. qualify an assertion made earlier in the passage about an anti-sentimental bias shared by many twentieth-century scholars.
- D. demonstrate Mermin's strategy for responding to facts that might appear to be at odds with her argument.
- E. establish that literary taste cannot be fully understood unless situated in a historical context.

Passage 387

The expectation that science is a stable body of relatively objective knowledge on which the law can draw to settle legal controversies may seem benign. However, this expectation often corresponds to a romantic notion of the scientific enterprise and thereby eclipses not only the instabilities and controversies within science itself, but also the social and rhetorical aspects of even the best science. We see the idealization of science in law whenever there is a presumption that if two scientific experts disagree, one of them must be a “**junk scientist**”. This presumption ignores the theoretical presuppositions and limitations of data that lead to genuine scientific disputes. We also see the idealization of science in law whenever we associate “bias, interest, and motivation” with unreliable expertise. This association missed the practical advances made by **scientists who have strong theoretical biases, institutional interests, and financial motivations**. Finally, we see the idealization of science in law whenever a legislator, administrator, or judge demands certainty from science, not recognizing its probabilistic nature and dynamic history. It is neither a critique of scientific progress nor an exaggeration to acknowledge scientific debates, the conventional aspects of scientific methodology, the importance of networking and “social capital” with respect to publications and grants, and the persuasive elements in scientific discourse. To think that these features are somehow markers of bad science is to idealize science. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. explain why a particular view of science is problematic
 - B. account for the prevalence of a particular view of science
 - C. present a debate about the nature of scientific knowledge
 - D. suggest that scientific evidence cannot resolve legal disputes
 - E. examine flaws in a particular approach to resolving scientific disputes
2. The author suggests that which of the following can lead to the dismissal of a scientific expert as a junk scientist?
 - A. An expert misrepresents the conclusiveness of the data presented in support of a particular claim.
 - B. An expert is asked to testify in a dispute that most nonscientists find overly technical.
 - C. An expert is asked to testify in a dispute involving questions that arguably lie outside the realm of scientific knowledge.
 - D. There is a general belief that sound science resolves contradictions in favor of a single valid conclusion.
 - E. There is a general view that most scientists often manipulate evidence to achieve a desired outcome.
3. The author mentions “scientists who have strong theoretical biases, institutional interests, and financial motivations” primarily in order to
 - A. explain why an idealistic view of science has value even if it sometimes leads to untenable assumptions
 - B. point out that even well-intentioned scientists may underestimate factors that can skew their conclusions in a particular direction
 - C. suggest that tendencies often assumed to contaminate scientists’ work need not preclude valuable scientific achievements
 - D. distinguish the kinds of researchers often dismissed as “junk scientists” from those whose work has produced valuable scientific advances
 - E. underscore the point that scientific evidence can be used to support claims that cannot be reconciled with one another

Passage 388

Current studies of early modern absolutism—rule by one person with absolute authority—emphasize continual negotiations between ruler and ruled. The same rulers who often staged spectacular displays of their rule might spend much of their time arranging deals and forestalling opposition, negotiating constantly with nobles and others for acceptance of their rule. The effective ruler was not the one who brusquely subdued opponents, but **the one who both avoided antagonizing those opponents who could not be easily subdued and who gradually lured most others into his court with political appointments**. The rule of Cosimo I de' Medici, a sixteenth-century duke of Tuscany, exemplifies this **strategy**. Beginning from a weak position, Cosimo became one of Europe's most powerful rulers, founding a dynasty that lasted well beyond his lifetime. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following actions by a ruler would best serve as an example of the “strategy” referred to in the passage?

- A. marrying the son or daughter of the ruler of a neighboring territory despite parental opposition
- B. putting on a spectacular parade to celebrate a recent military victory
- C. installing one's heirs in positions of power before they reach adulthood
- D. seizing the properties of the local nobility in order to increase personal holdings
- E. awarding a potential competitor a coveted position in the royal palace in exchange for allegiance

2. Which of the following best describe the purpose of the underlined sentence?

- A. It rejects a view of early modern absolutism represented in many current studies.
- B. It points to a truth about early modern absolutist ruler that is often overlooked by contemporary scholars.
- C. It formulates a method of governing that current scholars see as typical of early modern absolutist rulers.
- D. It challenges a view of early modern absolutist rulers for which the author believes there is insufficient evidence.
- E. It raises questions about a strategy used by an early modern ruler whom the author regards as having been particularly successful.

Passage 389

Water shrews—small mammals that live in wetlands—are skilled at finding prey underwater. With peak feeding periods occurring at night, when vision is of limited use, water shrews, researchers have found, surprisingly locate prey by smell. Logically that appears impossible: it is air that transports odorants to the olfactory receptors in the nasal cavity, and there is no air underwater for a mammal to inhale. But water shrews exhale air bubbles while foraging underwater, often directly onto objects they are investigating. They then inhale the same bubbles to collect odorants. Researchers had long overlooked this ability because the sniffing occurs so quickly, it requires slow-motion video to observe, and not many shrews have been filmed underwater with high-speed cameras. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following statements about the “researchers” mentioned in the second sentence can be inferred from the passage?

- A. They failed to perform adequate experiments to validate their hypotheses.
- B. They noticed an unusual behavior that led to a new explanation.
- C. They did not fully appreciate the advantages of using high-speed cameras.
- D. They overlooked new evidence because it contradicted widely held beliefs.
- E. They had not considered how mammals breathe underwater.

2. The passage implies which of the following about the timing of water shrews’ peak feeding periods?

- A. It led researchers to rule out vision as water shrews primary means of finding prey.
- B. It gives water shrews a competitive advantage over predators that are most active during the day.
- C. It discouraged researchers from filming water shrew underwater.
- D. It allows water shrew to approach prey during relatively unguarded moments.
- E. It provides the possible conditions for the transmission of odorants.

Passage 390

Eighteenth-century women played a significant part in British political life. Up and down the social scale they performed a variety of political acts, everything from purchasing political artifacts such as plates, handkerchiefs, and fans to penning political pamphlets, starving in civic processions, sponsoring boycotts, arguing over public issues in their own debating societies, rioting, and uttering seditious words. Whereas historians used to see female political involvement in this century as isolated or aberrant, they now stress the continuity and normalcy of such activity, especially for aristocratic women. Given the familial nature of aristocratic politics, noble women were actually expected to act as political advisors and agents for their husbands, to canvass in elections, to serve as political hostesses, to seek and dispense political patronage. They did so routinely long before the eighteenth and deep into the nineteenth century. Patrician women had such far reaching political influence, it has been argued recently, that they actually stood to lose by **expansion of the electorate to include women**. Fruitful as this new historiography has been, however, it has also been criticized for its focus on the machinations of high politics and its inattention to ideology. Given the widespread hostility to “public” women in the eighteenth century, was female political activity quite so unproblematic as these new studies tend to assume? **Anna Clark has pointed out that celebration of elite politicizing neglects both the condition of ordinary women and the nitpicking contemporary attacks on just this sort of upper-class influence peddling.**

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author would most likely agree with which of the following statements about political acts performed by eighteenth-century women?

- A. They had little influence on the outcome of elections.
- B. They were aimed largely at the expansion of the electorate.
- C. They probably were discouraged by men with political aspirations.
- D. They represented a new development in British society.
- E. They were sometimes perceived as being negative.

2. The author suggested which of the following about the “expansion of the electorate to include women” in the eighteenth-century Britain?

- A. It might have reduced women's incentives to engage in such political activities as boycotts and riots.
- B. It might have reduced the political power of some people who had exerted great influence.
- C. It would have been unlikely to overturn the aristocracy's political control of the country.
- D. It would likely have extended the vote only to aristocratic women.
- E. It was not an issue addressed by men who were engaged in politics.

3. Which of the following statements best describes the function of the highlighted sentence?

- A. It reinterprets an explanation originated by historians who contributed to the “new historiography”.
- B. It questions the accuracy of evidence presented in the service of the “new historiography”.
- C. It identifies issues that have been overlooked by the “new historiography”.
- D. It highlights claims of the “new historiography” that have been neglected.
- E. It defends the “new historiography” against an unwarranted criticism.

Passage 391

Study of the geological history of the Moon is based on the law of superposition, which states that younger rocks and geological features visibly overlie older rocks and features. For example, lines—or “rays”—radiate outward from the crater Copernicus and overlie the rim of the neighboring crater Eratosthenes, demonstrating that Copernicus is younger. Both of these craters are younger than the dark lava plain, Mare Imbrium, upon which they lie. In contrast, the crater Archimedes is filled with and surrounded by this dark lava, from which its rim protrudes; thus, the impact that created Archimedes predates the lava eruption that flooded the whole region to create Mare Imbrium. All the foregoing features occur inside the giant Imbrium basin, itself a kind of colossal impact crater. Thus, the relative ages of surface features in the Imbrium-Copernicus region were unambiguously derivable from photographs taken from Earth well before any lunar missions. Their absolute ages, however, were only later inferred from physical samples of lunar rock. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. explain how a scientific law was inferred from processes that were first revealed by photographic evidence
 - B. reconstruct a chronology of events in order to explain the absence of certain expected lunar features
 - C. show how physical evidence has been used to substantiate inferences based on the application of a particular methodology
 - D. suggest how conclusions are formed about the absolute ages of geological features
 - E. illustrate how a general principle has been used to draw certain specific conclusions
2. It can be inferred from the passage that which of the following geological events occurred first?
 - A. The impact that formed the rays of Copernicus
 - B. The impact that formed Eratosthenes
 - C. The eruption that flooded Archimedes
 - D. The formation of the Imbrium basin
 - E. The creation of Mare Imbrium
3. It can be inferred from the passage that a medium-sized lunar impact crater could be clearly determined to predate a smaller lunar impact crater if which of the following were observed in a photograph of the two craters?
 - A. The smaller crater is entirely contained within the rim of the medium-sized crater.
 - B. The medium-sized crater partially obscures the rim of the smaller crater.
 - C. Lava surrounds the medium-sized crater on all sides, but does not surround the smaller crater.
 - D. The rim of the smaller crater is an unbroken circle, but the rim of the medium-sized crater is incomplete in places.
 - E. The smaller crater is streaked with the rays of the medium-sized crater.

Passage 392

A longstanding scholarly neglect of the subject of cooking is partly attributable to the antiquated “separate spheres” schema that differentiated a private female sphere, which included food preparation and consumption, from a public male sphere, which included food production. While this concept never reflected most women’s daily realities—women are major food producers worldwide—the ideological polarization certainly influenced the development of academia: it effectively segregated women into working in low-status “domestic” disciplines such as dietetics and home economics, while the male-dominated realms of industrial agriculture, food technology, mass retailing, and corporate management enjoyed public respect and academic prestige. This institutionalized bias delayed serious attention to cooking even after **feminists** in the 1960s obliterated the notion of separate spheres and more women entered all areas of academia. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. examine the origins of an influential theory
 - B. account for the dearth of research on a particular subject
 - C. contrast two scholarly approaches to the study of a phenomenon
 - D. explain how a certain distinction came to dominate an academic discipline
 - E. question the aptness of a particular schema for understanding a development
2. The author mentions “feminists” primarily in order to
 - A. elaborate on a particular rift in scholarly circles
 - B. answer a particular challenge to the “separate spheres” schema
 - C. cite a cultural development that influenced the study of food
 - D. help account for an ideological shift within academia
 - E. underscore the tenacity of an attitude that constrained scholarly inquiry

Passage 393

In North America, crows have historically antagonized humans by ravaging corn crops, but advancing urbanization has recently made humans more tolerant of crows, and crows' wariness has accordingly diminished. The future demeanor of the American crow (*Corvus brachyrhynchos*) is suggested by intercontinental analogy to India's house crow (*Corvus splendens*), which has lived for many centuries in an essentially unarmed, animal-friendly, and densely populated culture. Its audacity extends to stealing food from street vendors and entering dwellings to remove food from the table. The extreme watchfulness of the American crow has grown out of a long history of persecution. As people treat crows with **insouciance** rather than aggression, less wariness results in reproductive success, and another kind of corvine conduct asserts itself. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following generalizations most directly underlies the author's central point?

- A. Two different species of the same genus of birds may differ greatly in their characteristic behavior for reasons that have nothing to do with the environment in which they live.
- B. Degrees of wariness tend to differ significantly among individuals of the same animal species as well as between different species within the same genus.
- C. As human populations become more urbanized, humans become less attuned to the behavior of animals in their environment in ways that can negatively affect animals' reproductive success.
- D. A given behavioral trait can have either a positive or negative effect on an animal's reproductive success depending on the behavior of humans in the animal's environment.
- E. Human attitudes toward a given animal species tend to be somewhat arbitrary and are subject to change over time.

2. The author implies which of the following about the "insouciance" mentioned in the passage?

- A. It reflects an advance in our understanding of crows' behavior.
- B. It has increased in one region of the world as urbanization has grown.
- C. It is likely to increase in a particular region as farming in that region increases.
- D. It reflects the influence of one culture's attitudes toward animals on those of another culture.
- E. It can have a positive influence on a given species' reproductive success in some contexts but a negative effect in others.

Passage 394

The source of vitamin C in the traditional Inuit diet was long a mystery. Most animals can synthesize vitamin C in their livers, but humans are among the exceptions. If humans do not ingest enough vitamin C, the result is scurvy, a potentially fatal connective-tissue disease. Most Americans today get ample supplies from orange juice, citrus fruits, and fresh vegetables. But getting enough vitamin C from a ship's provisions was especially tricky for explorers voyaging to the Inuit's native polar regions, and scurvy plagued European and United States expeditions there even in the twentieth century. However, Arctic peoples were free of the disease, even in the long winter, when they subsisted entirely on meat and fish they caught, often eaten raw. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The passage suggests which of the following about humans' need for vitamin C?
 - A. Humans can rely on vitamin C stored in the body for as long as a year.
 - B. Humans need vitamin C to maintain the health of connective tissue in the body.
 - C. The only way to meet the need for vitamin C is to consume fruit, fruit juices, and vegetables.
2. Which of the following, if true, most helps to resolve the mystery of the source of vitamin C in the traditional Inuit diet?
 - A. American and European Arctic explorers who adopted an Inuit diet did not develop scurvy.
 - B. American and European expeditions generally relied on salted or canned meat and dried provisions, none of which provide vitamin C.
 - C. With the progressive abandonment of their traditional diet, the Inuit have become more susceptible to scurvy.
 - D. Vitamin C is present in meat and the connective tissue of animals but is destroyed by extended cooking.
 - E. The fact that fresh fruit and vegetables can ward off scurvy was recognized more than 150 years before vitamin C was identified.

Passage 395

According to Helen Vendler, the value of any poetry anthology is measured by its representation of major poets. However, Brad Leithauser argues that an anthology has the greatest impact through its handling of minor poets. Were the editors of an anthology of twentieth-century American poetry to exclude T. S. Eliot, Eliot's reputation would be unaffected, though the anthology itself would be handicapped by excluding one of the most influential English-language poets of the period. The situation is quite different with figures who are considered secondary, like Sara Teasdale or Allen Tate: because publishers rarely keep in print volumes by poets who sell in modest numbers, most such poets have no noteworthy existence outside of anthologies.

Furthermore, anthology editors' selections of particular poems may significantly benefit or harm the reputations of minor poets. If notable works by major poets are omitted, serious readers will easily find those poets' collected works elsewhere, but editors' choices of minor poets' works may make the critical difference in whether or not readers choose to seek out more of such poets' work. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred from the passage that Leithauser would be most likely to agree with which of the following statements about Vendler's view of poetry anthologies?

- A. Vendler's concern for the adequacy of an anthology's representation of the works of major poets is based on a mistaken assumption about how editors select poems for inclusion in anthologies.
- B. Vendler's view of poetry anthologies would be more persuasive if it referred only to anthologies of pre- twentieth-century poetry.
- C. The kind of poetry anthology that Vendler prefers does not reflect the preference of most serious readers.
- D. Vendler is correct about how the value of poetry anthologies ought to be measured but mistaken about how that value is in fact generally measured.
- E. The standard that Vendler uses to judge the value of a poetry anthology is not a complete measure of that anthology's impact on readers and poets.

2. It can be inferred from the passage that Vendler would be most likely to agree with which of the following statements about the poet Sara Teasdale?

- A. She deserves wider recognition through the publication of volumes devoted exclusively to her work.
- B. Her poems are more likely to be of interest to those who prefer to read a volume devoted to a single poet's work than to those who prefer to read a poetry anthology.
- C. Her poems have been given undue prominence by the editors of some anthologies of twentieth-century American poetry.
- D. The appeal of her poems to serious readers is unlikely to be affected by whether or not her work is well represented in anthologies.
- E. Her exclusion from an anthology of twentieth-century American poetry would not be an important criterion for measuring that anthology's value.

3. According to the passage, Leithauser believes that anthology editors have a significant impact on the reputations of minor poets partly due to

- A. publishers' assumptions about which anthologies are likely to sell well
- B. publishers' tendency not to keep in print books with modest sales
- C. the tendency of most anthology editors to select works by the same poets for inclusion in their anthologies
- D. anthology editors' lack of interest in encouraging readers to seek out individual poems not included in their anthologies
- E. the way in which anthology editors decide which poets should be considered major ones

Passage 396

A central question in comparative politics is whether or not the state is necessary, a question that can be answered empirically in the negative on the evidence that some societies have no state. Stateless societies, however, are characterized by political processes; for that reason they can be said to share to a more or less degree some of the features of states. A more useful and accurate assertion than the empirical is that "stateness" is a quality that prevails in more or less quantity or intensity in all human communities. If one is concerned with the values of security, material well-being, the maintenance of social order, and risk-sharing, one must conclude that more stateness is better than less. On the other hand, when one is concerned with equality, freedom, justice, and self-esteem, one concludes that less stateness is better than more. Certainly none of these values can be discussed intelligibly without some degree of assumption of stateness. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the author, a problem with the empirical answer to the question of whether or not a state is necessary is that this answer fails to
 - A. explain why the state has evolved in some societies but not others
 - B. establish that the state is desirable but not necessary
 - C. provide grounds that make possible intelligible discussion of social values
 - D. reflect the fact that stateless societies have political processes
 - E. inspire political analysts to conduct further investigations
2. The author implies that where there is more state than less, citizens are likely to experience which of the following?
 - A. An excess of political activity that corrodes trust and impedes material advancement
 - B. Protective security to an extent that impedes economic growth and risk-sharing
 - C. A measure of prosperity in a highly ordered social environment
 - D. Strong governmental protection of property and of individual liberties
 - E. State indifference to or disregard for preservation of aspects of culture
3. Which of the following would be a problem with using the author's approach to stateness, as it is presented in the passage, when doing comparative political analysis?
 - A. There is too much overlap between the values associated with more and less stateness for comparison to be possible.
 - B. The author's descriptors favor less stateness to an extent that makes comparison pointless.
 - C. Societies cannot be compared because they differ as to the values that are deemed important.
 - D. The author does not specify whether the stateness discussed is totalitarian, democratic, or socialistic.
 - E. There is insufficient information concerning the criteria by which the author determines whether a country possesses more or less stateness.

Passage 397

When aspirin relieves pain, it does so partly by blocking the body's output of prostaglandins, chemicals that can produce inflammation and pain in the joints. Unfortunately, prostaglandins also produce a coating that protects the stomach from stomach acid, so taking aspirin can cause stomach upset. A recently developed medication promises to relieve pain without blocking prostaglandin production. Therefore, if this promise is fulfilled, the new medication will relieve pain without causing stomach upset. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

The argument is most vulnerable to criticism on which of the following grounds?

- A. It relies on using a crucial term in two different senses.
- B. It relies on vague suppositions about future developments in order to gloss over a current difficulty.
- C. The fact that a certain effect can be produced in one way is taken to mean that the effect cannot be produced in any other way.
- D. The fact that a substance is known to produce a certain effect some of the time is taken to mean that the substance produces the effect all of the time.
- E. A substance that is said to have both positive and negative effects is treated as if it had only a negative effect.

Passage 398

The cooling effect on Earth's climate from aerosols injected into the stratosphere by large volcanic eruptions remains a topic of debate. While records of past Arctic ice-cap growth indicate that large, successive eruptions have triggered cooling episodes that persisted over several decades, other simulation and field data show that these effects are short term. For example, **temperature-sensitive millennial tree-ring chronologies from the Northern Hemisphere** suggest that **the strongest eruptions** caused cooling episodes lasting less than about 10 years. Recently, however, Gennaretti et al. have used a **new network** of millennial tree-ring chronologies from the high-latitude North American forests to argue that, during the last millennium, persistent shifts toward lower average temperatures in this region coincided with series of large eruptions. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

Which of the following, if true, might help explain the differences between results from "temperature-sensitive millennial tree-ring chronologies from the Northern Hemisphere" and those from the "new network"?

- A. Cooling episodes last longer at high latitudes than they do at low latitudes.
- B. Some tree species that are long-lived at high latitudes have shorter life spans at low latitudes.
- C. Trees at higher latitudes are more susceptible to small temperature changes than are trees at lower latitudes.

2. The author of the passage refers to "the strongest eruptions" primarily to

- A. argue that major eruptions could occasionally produce persistent shifts toward lower average temperatures
- B. explain why minor eruptions paradoxically produce the longest cooling episodes
- C. imply that most eruptions would produce only short-term cooling effects
- D. note a factor in selecting Eurasian sites for constructing the Northern Hemisphere network of tree-ring chronologies
- E. undermine the assumption that the severity of volcano-induced cooling episodes depends on the magnitude of the eruption

Passage 399

The following passage is adapted from material published in 1997.

In his biography of James Baldwin, Leeming generally analyzes the sociopolitical, economic, and cultural significance of Baldwin's principal literary works, even using several of their titles as chapter headings. In spite of these meritorious features, the book suffers somewhat from an **uneven treatment** of Baldwin's writing. For example, *The Fire Next Time* has been widely, and appropriately, acknowledged as one of the great essays of the past half century. But rather than an analytical and interpretive discussion, Leeming provides only a summary stitched together from quotations and paraphrases. He expends considerably more time and space on the play *Blues for Mister Charlie*, even though Baldwin does not enjoy a widespread reputation as an innovative and substantial dramatist. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best characterizes what the author of the passage means by "uneven treatment"?

- A. The critical standards that Leeming applies to Baldwin's writing are different from those that he has applied to the work of other writers.
- B. The attention that Leeming devotes to certain works by Baldwin contrasts sharply with the conventional evaluation of those works.
- C. Leeming is more concerned with the sociopolitical, economic, and cultural significance of Baldwin's works than he is with their literary merit.
- D. Leeming devotes inordinate space to some of Baldwin's shorter works while giving short shrift to many of his longer works.
- E. Leeming devotes more space to summarizing Baldwin's dramatic works than to subjecting those works to analysis and interpretation.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. It can be inferred that the author of the passage would agree with which of the following statements about Baldwin's literary output?

- A. *Blues for Mister Charlie* is a less important work than is *The Fire Next Time*.
- B. Baldwin was more influential as a dramatist than as an essayist.
- C. Baldwin's reputation as an essayist is not fully justified by the quality of his essays.

Passage 400

The need for kin recognition in bank swallows arises only toward the end of the nestling period, because adults never mistakenly visit the wrong burrow to provision chicks. However, when offspring are about sixteen or seventeen days old, and before they fledge, they **start to move between nests**. Females commonly evict foreign chicks from their burrows, but males are prone to misfeeding strangers. Experiments suggest that females are able to recognize their own young only when the young reach sixteen or seventeen days of age, at which point offspring start making a distinctive two-note call.

In cliff swallows visual cues might be used in addition to vocal signatures for identification of offspring, as faces of cliff swallow nestlings become distinctive at about thirteen days. Why does the cliff swallow need two recognition modalities when the bank swallow gets by with only one? Family-specific calls of bank swallows are localized to individual nests because the sandy banks in which they nest absorb sound so effectively that birds are unlikely to hear the calls of neighboring families. Thus the risk of recognition error is remote. The mudcups in which cliff swallows nest are more reverberant, however, so nestling calls can easily be overheard by neighbors. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Why does the author note that bank swallow offspring "start to move between nests"?
 - A. To identify a feeding strategy of bank swallow chicks
 - B. To suggest how soon bank swallow clutches begin to fledge
 - C. To identify a behavioral oddity of bank swallow chicks
 - D. To indicate how close bank swallow nests are to each other
 - E. To indicate how the need to recognize bank swallow chicks arises
2. The author implies which of the following about bank swallow chicks compared with cliff swallow chicks?
 - A. Their faces are less individualized than are those of cliff swallow chicks.
 - B. Their two-note calls are louder than the calls of cliff swallow chicks.
 - C. They are more likely to move from nest to nest than are cliff swallow chicks.
 - D. They are less dependent on adults than are cliff swallow chicks.
 - E. They have a longer nestling period than do cliff swallow chicks.
3. Which of the following, if true, would also explain why bank swallows need only one recognition modality?
 - A. Bank swallow chicks have a shorter nestling period than do cliff swallow chicks.
 - B. Bank swallows have smaller clutches of eggs than do cliff swallows.
 - C. Bank swallow nests are much farther apart than are cliff swallow nests.
 - D. Bank swallow nests are less prone to predation than are cliff swallow nests.
 - E. Bank swallow chicks tend to be older when they begin moving from nest to nest.

Passage 401

Accepted dogma holds that architecture developed subsequent to agriculture because of the need for storage of domesticated crops and animals. Yet storage technology must have been present before people domesticated animals and plants. Enclosure must also have been present; if you have animals or plants suitably separated by a **border, fence, or corral**, then you have the means to control their breeding. It does not matter how much you know about hybridization or crossbreeding; to preserve and continue what you have done, some sort of barrier is the absolute prerequisite. Experiments, or lucky findings, have to be repeated if they are to be successful, in which case there must be a special place where what has been achieved can be preserved. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author would be most likely to agree with which of the following assertions about agriculture?
 - A. Early agriculture was not highly dependent on the ability of humans to hybridize plants.
 - B. Agriculture required people to develop tools that subsequently contributed to early experiments in architecture.
 - C. The advent of agriculture was an essential prerequisite for people to develop technologies for building enclosures and storage areas.
 - D. The beginnings of agriculture depended less on experiments and luck than adherents of the accepted dogma appear to believe.
 - E. The development of agriculture depended on people's ability to segregate spaces in which plant and animal breeding could be controlled.
2. The author mentions a "border, fence, or corral" primarily to
 - A. acknowledge a plausible aspect of the accepted dogma
 - B. illustrate a point that is being made
 - C. introduce evidence for a conclusion set out in the following sentence
 - D. anticipate an objection to the author's central argument
 - E. establish a distinction between storage and enclosure

Passage 402

Over the last 20 years, both the total amount of grain produced in Andesara and the total amount of grain consumed by the Andesaran population have increased. Over the same period, however, although the amount of grain produced has increased more than the total amount of grain consumed by Andesara's inhabitants has increased, Andesara has gone from exporting more grain than it imports to importing more grain than it exports. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

In light of the information given, which of the following, if true, most helps to account for Andesara's now importing more grain than it exports?

- A. The population of Andesara is substantially larger today than it was twenty years ago.
- B. The proportion of Andesara's annual grain production that is exported to neighboring countries is substantially smaller today than it was twenty years ago.
- C. The proportion of Andesara's annual grain production that is fed to cattle is substantially greater today than it was twenty years ago.
- D. The proportion of Andesarans for whom grain is a major component of their diet is substantially smaller today than it was twenty years ago.
- E. In some countries to which Andesara once exported grain, agricultural advances during the last twenty years have led to dramatic increases in food production.

Passage 403

Modern scholarship's view of women's labor in Han dynasty China(206B.C.- A.D. 220) shows women performing a wide variety of work roles. According to most modern scholars, for a household (the main economic organization in early Chinese society) to succeed economically, a man and a woman each had to work at many different kinds of gendered tasks. In contrast, writers during the Han dynasty, rather than emphasizing the multitude of daily tasks women performed, constructed an idealized **representation** of female labor, singling out cloth production as the most important job and linking it to the concept of successful womanhood. In reality, however, a woman who devoted herself to making cloth, ignoring other work, would have been considered irresponsible. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. According to the passage, which of the following is true of Han dynasty writers' attitudes toward women and cloth production?

- A. These writers presented cloth production as a woman's most important job.
- B. These writers believed that women who devoted significant time to tasks other than cloth production were irresponsible.
- C. These writers linked cloth production with the concept of successful womanhood.

2. In the context in which it appears, "representation" most nearly means

- A. substitution
- B. depiction
- C. symbol
- D. statement
- E. reproduction

Passage 404

A significant proportion of meteorites contain chondrules, small, glassy silicate spheres. The importance of chondrules is that they show that at some time the temperature was so high that the chondrule material was vaporized. The vapor then cooled quickly and the liquid silicates, condensing out of the vapor, formed small silicate spheres under the influence of surface tension. When these spheres solidified, they were incorporated into silicate fragments, and the material was eventually compressed into rock by gravitational forces. The fact that the chondrules cooled very quickly is revealed by the composition of the minerals within them. **In the vapor phase, whole minerals would not have existed, but there would have been components that, combined in various ways, can form different minerals.** Combinations of these components produced an initial collection of minerals within chondrules when they formed and, while the silicate was hot, the components changed partners to form more stable minerals—meaning ones of lower energy. Given enough time, the minerals in chondrules would have had the lowest possible energy consistent with using all available components; the mixture of minerals would then be equilibrated. However, the mixtures of minerals in chondrules are nonequilibrated—corresponding to a total energy far greater than the minimum possible. This shows that the chondrules became solid and cooled so quickly that the nonequilibrated state became frozen in, since individual components did not have enough energy to jostle their way through the material to form more stable minerals. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred from the passage that if a newly formed chondrule were to cool slowly, then
 - A. its surface tension would be dissipated
 - B. it would be less susceptible to compression by gravitational forces
 - C. it would contain different minerals than if it had cooled quickly
 - D. its final mixture of minerals would closely resemble the initial collection
 - E. its components would lack sufficient energy to form minerals
2. According to the passage, chondrules are significant because they
 - A. facilitate a better understanding of the chemical properties of silicates
 - B. explain why silicate fragments are common in meteorites
 - C. illuminate the interactions between chemical and gravitational forces
 - D. provide information about the mineral components present at the time of their formation
 - E. point to episodes involving extremely high temperatures
3. Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted sentence in the context of the passage as a whole?
 - A. It describes a condition that is required for a critical process discussed in the passage.
 - B. It discusses an empirical possibility that is ruled out later in the passage.
 - C. It presents evidence that confirms a suggestion made earlier in the passage.
 - D. It helps reconcile two seemingly contradictory findings described in the passage.
 - E. It outlines a feature common to several physical processes mentioned in the passage.

Passage 405

Willa Cather's **ability to adopt different narrative personae** in her fiction was significantly informed by her earlier journalistic writings, in which she used pseudonyms to navigate between a feminized domestic sphere and a masculinized professional sphere, widening her audience appeal. But Cather grew much more ambivalent about her magazine work as she began to write fiction: while early on journalism was crucial to her financial independence and vital to the cultivation of her developing writing skills, she eventually saw it as a threat to her artistic autonomy as a writer of literary fiction. It may thus not be surprising that the same author who claimed that writing "has to be gone at like any other trade" would also condemn journalism as the "vandalism of literature." 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. examine the role of journalism in Cather's success as a writer
 - B. suggest that Cather's journalism made her fiction writing possible
 - C. reveal the sources of Cather's financial independence
 - D. discuss Cather's conflicted attitude toward journalism
 - E. document the evolution of Cather's writing style
2. The author of the passage discusses Cather's "ability to adopt different narrative personae" primarily in order to
 - A. show how Cather's fiction writing differed from her journalism
 - B. explain why Cather made statements that may appear contradictory
 - C. describe how Cather benefited from her work as a journalist
 - D. examine some of Cather's strengths as a writer
 - E. consider how Cather matured as a writer

Passage 406

According to one current hypothesis, the typical evolutionary history of a species involves a quick origin, followed by a long period of stability of form, or stasis, and then rapid disappearance. The sudden appearance of new species, once attributed to supposed gaps in the fossil record, is thought to represent accurately the histories of species.

There is, however, **doubt** about some of the scientific evidence for this evolutionary **pattern**, particularly the extent to which species exhibit stasis. For example, species with a large population are more likely to exhibit relative stasis, but they are also more likely to be found in the fossil record. Moreover, it is invariably only the hard body parts of any organism that are fossilized. Variations over time in soft body parts, in biochemistry, and in behavior largely escape the fossil record; thus, fossil traces preserve only a minute portion of a species' traits. Furthermore, since so few individual organisms leave fossils, the record of a species is likely to understate variation in that species. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage provides evidence to refute which of the following aspects of the hypothesis described in the first paragraph?

- A. The belief that species disappear rapidly
- B. The contention that form remains stable over long periods of time
- C. The notion that gaps occur in the fossil record
- D. The assertion that new species appear suddenly
- E. The presumption that an evolutionary history can be typical

2. Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

Regarding the "doubt" mentioned in the passage, the author would probably agree that it

- A. will be resolved once scientists have gathered more data relevant to certain critical cases
- B. arises only because scientists assume that the sudden appearance of new species in the fossil record accurately represents the speed with which new species arose
- C. results partially from tendencies in the fossil record that allow for uncertainty

3. In the context in which it appears, "pattern" most nearly means

- A. archetype
- B. precedent
- C. model
- D. relationship
- E. grouping

Passage 407

In the Lake Ontario food chain, small fish called alewives are prey for predator fish such as salmon. Any successful effort to reduce pollution in Lake Ontario will also result in a reduced alewife population, but reductions of that population will not, as some have feared, lead to smaller populations of salmon in Lake Ontario, since _____.

Which of the following most logically completes the argument?

- A. salmon cannot readily compensate for reduced numbers of alewives by finding other prey
- B. lower pollution in Lake Ontario is unlikely to eliminate alewives from the lake entirely
- C. the impact of pollution reduction on the population of other fish on which salmon prey in Lake Ontario will be similar to the impact it will have on alewives
- D. changes in the size of a prey population sometimes cause substantial erratic fluctuations in the populations of the prey and their predators
- E. alewives are a principal predator of baby salmon

Passage 408

Critics have traditionally reacted with ambivalence to the structure of American author William Wells Brown's novel *Clotel* (1853), noting, for instance, that the book contains "enough material for a dozen novels." This comment is accurate in stating, hyperbolically, the richness of the novel, but its negative connotations need to be reinterpreted. Rather than a shortcoming, this wealth of material is in fact a crucial, deliberate element of Brown's aesthetic. Brown's narrative strategy is a finely tuned literary tool to re-create on the page—and to make readers experience, albeit mildly—the overwhelming, absurd, brutal, uncertain qualities of slavery. **Brown mirrors in the very structure of the novel the uncertainty and limited control endemic to his characters' lives.** 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. According to the passage, certain narrative strategies employed by Brown in *Clotel*
 - A. are characteristic of the author's fictional works
 - B. are at odds with the novel's overarching themes
 - C. anticipate the novel's dramatic resolution
 - D. are directly related to the novel's subject matter
 - E. are based on conventions used by early-nineteenth-century American writers
2. Which of the following best describes the function of the highlighted sentence?
 - A. It qualifies the claims for the novel made previously in the passage.
 - B. It validates traditional criticisms of the novel mentioned earlier in the passage.
 - C. It compares the novel's structure to that of other contemporary works.
 - D. It elaborates upon an idea expressed in the previous sentence.
 - E. It concedes that certain qualities in the novel's style could be considered flaws.

Passage 409

Research shows that people often retain beliefs based on prior incorrect understanding when reading texts that contradict those beliefs. Yet readers do not reliably call upon accurate prior knowledge when reading false statements. Prentice, Gerrig, and Bailis asked subjects to read a narrative that included some obviously false statements presented as though true. Participants were later asked to verify the truth of various statements and took longer than expected to reject false ones. Studies of this type suggest that readers may initially accept everything they read as true and only afterward reconcile false propositions with respect to their prior knowledge. In some cases, this reconciliation may be far from perfect, such that readers believe new false information may have actually been derived from their prior knowledge. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following assertions about readers can be inferred from the passage?
 - A. The initial credence given by readers to written statements is not necessarily dependent on the plausibility of those statements.
 - B. The amount of time it takes for readers to read a written text depends in part on whether information in the text is consistent with the readers' prior beliefs.
 - C. Readers are more likely to understand a written text that confirms their prior beliefs than one that does not.
 - D. Readers have better recall of written texts that contradict their prior beliefs than of written texts that are consistent with their prior beliefs.
 - E. Readers are apt to misremember a text they have just read if that text contains information inconsistent with readers' prior beliefs.
2. Which of the following can be inferred about the study conducted by Prentice, Gerrig, and Bailis?
 - A. They set out to study one phenomenon and ended up examining a phenomenon that was related but different.
 - B. They conducted their study by asking participants to read texts that discussed subject matter on which the participants were unlikely to have strong views.
 - C. They found evidence that people are more likely to retain incorrect beliefs that are contradicted by a written text than to reject false statements in a written text.
 - D. They designed their study to test a particular hypothesis that their findings did not ultimately support.
 - E. They began with an estimate of the time that participants would take to evaluate and reject false statements that were contrary to participants' prior knowledge.

Passage 410

The following passage comes from a study of gull bill markings.

Some species of gulls have uniformly colored bills, but many (62 percent in our sample) have beaks with differently colored tips, stripes, or spots that act as a focus for the pecking of newly hatched chicks as they beg for food. In an attempt to understand why, we determined whether adult gulls of those species with newly hatched chicks that are small in relation to the size of the adult are more likely to have such patterned beaks. This work is based on Hailman's (1967) suggestion that gulls with greater bill depths (large species) tend to have only a restricted area of red on the bill (i.e., a red tip or spot), whereas smaller-billed species have uniform bills. We suggest that the most plausible reason for any size-related difference is that concentrating a small chick's pecking on a particular part of the bill is more effective than is unfocused pecking in stimulating the adult to regurgitate food. As well as encouraging the chick to peck, the tip of the bill, or the gonys (where stripes and spots are located), might be more sensitive than are other parts of the beak to the feeble pecking of a small chick, or a small chick might more effectively occupy **the parent's visual field** when pecking there. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage implies which of the following about food regurgitation in adult gulls as a chick-feeding behavior?
 - A. It occurs most frequently when chicks are newly hatched.
 - B. It is at least partly prompted by tactile signals.
 - C. It is one of several means of feeding newly hatched chicks.
 - D. Its effectiveness is related to chick size.
 - E. Its occurrence is related to species' bill depth.
2. In the context of the passage, the reference to "the parent's visual field" serves primarily to
 - A. propose a reason that red is found on gull bills more commonly than are other colors
 - B. describe the second of two mutually exclusive explanations for the coloration of gull bills
 - C. explain why it might be advantageous for gull bills to be marked in a particular way
 - D. explain why gull parents may give preference to certain chicks when feeding them
 - E. explain how a chick's size may contribute to its effectiveness at begging for food
3. According to the passage, a gull species' bill depth is associated with which of the following characteristics of the species?
 - A. Chick feeding frequency
 - B. Chick survival rate
 - C. Parent longevity
 - D. Overall chick size
 - E. Overall adult size

Passage 411

To provide extra revenue for improving city bus service, the mayor of Greenville proposed a fare increase. The director of the bus service, however, pointed out that the previous bus fare increase had resulted in so many regular riders' quitting the bus system that revenues from bus service had decreased. Another fare increase, the director argued, would only lead to another revenue drop.

The director's argument depends on which of the following as an assumption?

- A. The previous fare increase was the same amount as the proposed fare increase.
- B. The previous fare increase did not cause people who rode the bus only occasionally to use bus service even less frequently.
- C. A decrease in fares would result in increased ridership and increased revenues from bus service.
- D. Many of the people who stopped using the bus system on account of the previous fare increase have in the meantime gone back to using it.
- E. As compared to regular bus riders at the time of the previous fare increase, regular bus riders today are not significantly less likely to have alternative means of transportation available to them.

Passage 412

The participation of women in the economy of Britain's North American colonies in the eighteenth century has been underrated because of the assumption that household production could not become commercial. Such an assumption ignores the reality that women produced goods at home for exchange and sale. Barter among neighbors knitted the women of a community into vital trade networks that constituted the **underground** economy of eighteenth-century colonial North America. Unlike other informal local trade networks in early America, the economy of women never totally ceased to exist. The informal nature of the transactions did not provide the women who made them with much economic power, but it did allow them a small measure of control over how they spent their time. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

The author of the passage suggests that the participation of women in the economy of Britain's North American colonies in the eighteenth century had which of the following effects on women's lives?

- A. It provided women with slightly more economic power than they would otherwise have had.
- B. It provided women a larger amount of leisure time than they would otherwise have had.
- C. It bound the women of a community together through activities that were mutually beneficial.

2. In the context indicated, "underground" most nearly means

- A. subversive
- B. secretive
- C. subterranean
- D. alternative
- E. antiestablishment

Passage 413

Scholars generally estimate subscribers to Freedom's Journal (1827-1829), the United States' first African American newspaper, at around 800, based on subscriptions to The Rights of All, an African American newspaper founded in 1829 as a successor to Freedom's Journal by a former editor of that newspaper. **But Gross argues that many more than 800 readers probably subscribed to Freedom's Journal** because many of its subscribers, dissatisfied with the direction ultimately taken by the paper, refused to subscribe to The Rights of All. In any case, the figure of 800 subscribers would make the circulation of Freedom's Journal close to that of other weekly papers of the time. Its number of readers, however, would have been much larger: copies were often shared, and African American organizations **subscribed to Freedom's Journal**, providing nonsubscribers access to the paper. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. African American organizations' subscriptions to Freedom's Journal are mentioned in the passage primarily in order to

- A. dispute Gross's claim about the probable number of readers of Freedom's Journal
- B. identify the primary subscribers to both Freedom's Journal and The Rights of All
- C. help account for a possible difference between the number of subscribers to Freedom's Journal and to The Rights of All
- D. cite a factor that casts doubt on most scholars' assumptions about the number of subscribers to Freedom's Journal
- E. illustrate why the readership numbers for Freedom's Journal should be distinguished from the subscribers numbers

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. Which of the following, if true, would tend to undermine Gross's argument mentioned in the highlighted portion of the passage?

- A. A larger number of African American organizations subscribed to Freedom's Journal than to The Rights of All.
- B. Many people who had not subscribed to Freedom's Journal bought subscriptions to The Rights of All.
- C. Copies of The Rights of All were shared more frequently with nonsubscribers than were copies of Freedom's Journal.

Passage 414

Scientists' view of climate variability during the Holocene era (the geological period extending from about 11,000 years ago to the present) is rapidly changing, based in part on increased knowledge of large-scale climate systems such as the Southern Oscillation ("El Nino"), the North Atlantic Oscillation, the Asian monsoon, and the Pacific-North American pattern—all of which interact and impart climate variability to far-flung areas of the globe. There is also a greater appreciation for the diversity of climate variability. Early notions of globally synchronous cooling and warming, such as the Little Ice Age and Medieval Warm Period, have given way to a **better-documented view** that late Holocene climate variability is expressed as multidecadal temperature anomalies that tend to be region-specific. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following most accurately characterizes the "better-documented view"?
 - A. Periods of cooling and warming throughout the Holocene have been characterized by small variations in temperature.
 - B. Climate variability during the late Holocene era was not globally synchronous.
 - C. The Little Ice Age and Medieval Warm Period were typical of periods of global climate change that have occurred within the last 11,000 years or so.
 - D. The notion that climate variability is region-specific rather than global is based on an inaccurate understanding of how large-scale climate systems interact.
 - E. Large-scale climate systems have had much less impact on global climate than earlier research suggested
2. The author mentions the Little Ice Age and the Medieval Warm Period primarily as examples of
 - A. global temperature changes that occurred during the Holocene era
 - B. the diversity of climate variability during the Holocene era
 - C. now-unsupportable interpretations of climatic events that occurred in the Holocene era
 - D. temperature anomalies in the Holocene era that scientists have linked to the interaction of large-scale climate systems
 - E. evidence for the claim that most temperature anomalies in the Holocene era have tended to be region-specific

Passage 415

All the music from fourteenth-century Europe for which written scores survive is so complex and is written in such difficult notation that it could have been played only by musicians whose lives were dedicated solely to such performance. Yet fourteenth-century European accounts, which in this respect probably give accurate portrayals of their times, describe many members of the nobility who excelled not only in musical performance, but also in dancing, poetry, and painting. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

The statements given, if true, most strongly support which of the following?

- A. Some members of the nobility in fourteenth-century Europe abandoned other activities in order to become professional musicians.
- B. There were styles of music performed in the fourteenth century for which no written scores survive.
- C. Professional musicians in fourteenth-century Europe had more highly developed skills than do the most skilled professional musicians today.
- D. The fourteenth-century European accounts that describe members of the nobility as excelling in musical performance do not specify the amount of time these members devoted to music.
- E. Professional musicians in fourteenth-century Europe did not perform for gatherings of members of the nobility.

Passage 416

Although American jazz musician John Coltrane reportedly wrote other poems, the fact that to date only "A Love Supreme" has been made available to the public assures its literary significance: cast in relief as an accompaniment to his best-selling and most celebrated recording, the poem represents the sole authorized and generally accessible discursive component of what would otherwise be a wholly abstract body of creative output. This has had the effect of heightening its perceived significance for interpreting Coltrane's artistic motivations and his larger spiritual and intellectual interests. The effect seems to have been at least partly by design: by this point in his career, Coltrane was suspicious of any kind of verbal framing for his music, saying he preferred to put out his albums without liner notes and let the music "speak for itself." He declined, for instance, to be profiled in what became **Spellman's widely discussed 1966 volume** of jazz biography as social critique, *Four Lives in the Bebop Business*. **In this respect he contrasted with, for instance, his contemporaries and labelmates Charles Mingus and Archie Shepp, older and younger representatives of the jazz avant-garde, respectively, who were much more apt to frame, their music with expository text, and even to integrate the latter into the former.** So the inclusion of the poem in the liner notes to *A Love Supreme*, a suite in four parts for Coltrane's working quartet, represented a deliberate and conspicuous gesture of artistic self-definition. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author mentions "Spellman's widely discussed 1966 volume" primarily to
 - A. compare Coltrane's influence to that of his peers
 - B. point to a source of misconception about Coltrane
 - C. cite a pattern to which Coltrane was an exception
 - D. comment on a change in Coltrane's musical style
 - E. evaluate the social impact of Coltrane's recordings
2. The highlighted sentence includes evidence for which of the following statements?
 - A. Coltrane later regretted his decision not to be profiled in Spellman's book of jazz biography.
 - B. Recordings that included expository text were generally better received than those that did not.
 - C. Coltrane's reluctance to speak about his music did not represent a generational shift in jazz.
 - D. Members of the jazz avant-garde differed in their creative approach from other jazz musicians.
 - E. The inclusion of a poem with *A Love Supreme* was due to the influence of Coltrane's peers.
3. In the context in which it appears, "frame" most nearly means
 - A. direct
 - B. prescribe
 - C. enclose
 - D. contextualize
 - E. negotiate

Passage 417

Harrison has argued that nineteenth-century French government administrators generally ignored the activities of women's associations, and most historians agree that female groups appear to have garnered little notice from authorities. While Grange suggests that this may be because so few female associations existed throughout much of the nineteenth century, Duprat has uncovered numerous female societies, especially sociétés de bienfaisance [charitable societies], many of which received more generous treatment from municipal and national officials than their male counterparts. However, she suggests that their official "silence"—the absence of general assemblies and of frequent publications, as well as their careful cultivation of the traditional, nonthreatening image of dames de charité [charitable women]—kept these associations largely out of public view. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Duprat would most likely agree that certain nineteenth-century French female societies
- A. sometimes took unfair advantage of their charitable status
 - B. hoped to change public perceptions of the activities of dames de charité
 - C. strategically misled government officials about their activities
 - D. were not consistent in representing their members' values
 - E. conducted themselves in a way that contributed to their neglect by government officials

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. As represented in the passage, the views of which of the following scholars are consistent with one another with regard to the official notice received by women's associations?
- A. Harrison and most historians
 - B. Harrison and Grange
 - C. Grange and most historians

Passage 418

This passage is adapted from material published in 1996. Hip-hop music has emerged as a powerful African American cultural form addressing a broad spectrum of social issues. Yet hip-hop's breadth is belied by hip-hop criticism, which has focused primarily on **controversies** about the antisocial content of some of its lyrics. Such discussions have almost preempted more sophisticated critical analysis. For example, little has been written about hip-hop's relationship to its artistic precursors. Critics might examine parallels between hip-hop and the Black Arts Movement of the 1960s. Both movements produced art expressing the alienation felt by many African Americans. Furthermore, like the Black Arts Movement, hip-hop artists have collided with the profit-oriented nature of institutions of cultural production. Black artists continue to face restrictive conventions that the writers Zora Neale Hurston and Langston Hughes faced in the Harlem Renaissance of the 1920s: commercial publishers' tendency to favor particular themes, subjects, or treatments for Black artists' work. The Black Arts Movement dealt with this dilemma by seeking outlets for autonomous cultural production, including theater companies and publishing houses. Hip-hop is similarly threatened by mainstream commercialism. As Palmer notes, many commercialized hip-hop lyrics are light and innocuous. **Committed hip-hop artists** have therefore sought out alternatives to mainstream commercial venues. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. provide evidence to support a conventional view regarding an artistic movement
 - B. challenge a particular view about the impact of commercialism on an artistic movement
 - C. present a debate about possible parallels between two artistic movements
 - D. distinguish the concerns of certain contemporary artists from those of earlier artists
 - E. demonstrate that a particular field of criticism has neglected potentially interesting issues
2. The passage suggests which of the following about "committed hip-hop artists"?
 - A. Those who are commercially successful carefully balance controversial material with innocuous material in their lyrics.
 - B. Those who have sought out alternatives to mainstream commercial venues have had a considerable degree of financial success.
 - C. They have been viewed by hip-hop critics as artists whose artistic and commercial goals are constantly in conflict.
 - D. They tend to express feelings and ideas that put them in conflict with the interests of mainstream venues.
 - E. They recognize parallels between themselves and those active in the Black Arts Movement.
3. It can be inferred that the author of the passage would be most likely to agree with which of the following statements about the "controversies" mentioned?
 - A. They arose because hip-hop lyrics address a broad spectrum of social issues.
 - B. They are no longer as heated as they were when hip-hop first emerged as a cultural form.
 - C. They have received a disproportionate amount of attention compared to such topics as the artistic precursors of hip-hop.
 - D. They have been perpetuated primarily by critics who lack familiarity with African American cultural forms.
 - E. They resemble controversies that arose during the 1960s in response to the output of the Black Arts Movement.

Passage 419

Faced with the paucity of surviving texts by mid-eighteenth-century American women, historians interested in women's experience have proven resourceful at using nontextual sources. Recently, Laurel Thatcher Ulrich has turned to objects hand-sewn by New England women, maintaining that objects such as sheets, pillowcases, and quilts reveal the "flow of common life" while providing a context for political events. Discerning the historical significance of these handmade objects is not easy, however. Between today and eighteenth-century New England there looms a formidable nineteenth-century mythology that romanticized that earlier, colonial era, with its household production system, as a simpler time of hard work and virtuous self-sufficiency. This **myth** emerged as compensation for the extreme wealth and poverty generated by industrialization. As household production declined, and factory-made, store-bought goods became widespread, antiquarians avidly collected and displayed the handmade objects of their idealized forebears. Attentive to the ideological distortions of nineteenth-century mythmaking, most historians are wary of trying to discern the original meaning of colonial objects, assuming that, nowadays such objects reveal more about nineteenth-century collectors than about eighteenth-century users. By contrast, rather than disparaging the mythmakers, Ulrich thanks them for saving so many objects made and used by ordinary women. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is primarily concerned with discussing
 - A. reasons that it is difficult to find sources relevant to women's past experience
 - B. the emergence of a particular historical myth during the mid-nineteenth century
 - C. attitudes regarding the usefulness of certain historical sources for studying a particular period
 - D. attempts by a historian to discern the significance of certain handmade objects
 - E. a debate among historians regarding the experience of women during a particular historical period
2. The passage identifies which of the following as a source of difficulty for historians attempting to draw conclusions from the hand-sewn objects referred to in the passage?
 - A. The relative shortage of such objects in comparison with other handmade objects
 - B. Historians' insufficient understanding of the household production system that produced these objects
 - C. Historians' disagreements over why such objects became especially prized during the nineteenth century
 - D. An interpretive context applied to these objects during the nineteenth century
 - E. A lack of textual sources that might supplement and explain such objects
3. Regarding the "myth," it can be inferred that Ulrich would probably disagree with most historians over
 - A. the extent to which this myth interferes with the use of certain objects as historical source material
 - B. the extent to which this myth emerged in response to forces unleashed by industrialization
 - C. whether this myth contains clues to the original meaning of handmade objects from the colonial period
 - D. whether this myth was especially widespread during the nineteenth century
 - E. whether this myth was able to compensate adequately for the inequities of industrialization

Passage 420

To lessen the emissions of carbon dioxide associated with the food they eat, many European consumers choose foods grown nearby over those requiring long-distance transportation. However, some crops' yields in New Zealand are far higher naturally than yields in northern Europe (because of New Zealand's abundant sunshine), so the additional energy inputs required to grow them are lower. Moreover, in New Zealand most electricity is generated by renewable sources, none of which emits significant carbon dioxide. These factors can far outweigh the carbon emissions generated by transporting crops to European markets. Similarly, importing beans from Kenya—where farms are small and tractor use limited—tends to be more efficient than growing beans in Europe, with its reliance on energy-dependent irrigation systems. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author of the passage cites which of the following factors as contributing to New Zealand's high yields of certain crops?

- A. Its superior farming methods
- B. Its sources of electricity
- C. Its climate
- D. The typical size of its farms
- E. The demands of its consumers

2. The author of the passage would most likely agree that produce grown in New Zealand

- A. is less costly to transport to northern Europe than is generally recognized
- B. can be nutritionally superior to much of the produce sent to market by local growers in European countries
- C. is typically grown on small farms that are less reliant on energy-dependent irrigation systems than are those in northern Europe
- D. requires fewer energy inputs and consequently generates far fewer emissions of carbon dioxide than comparable produce grown in the United States
- E. might be shunned by European consumers who, when making purchasing decisions, consider only those carbon emissions generated by transportation

Passage 421

American and British critics who wrote enthusiastic reviews of west African writer Amos Tutuola's 1952 book *The Palm-Wine Drinkard* typically dwelt less on his rhetorical skills and more on the text as an exemplar of naive art. While these metropolitan critics were enchanted by the book, the initial literary reception in west Africa was by contrast highly critical. Concerned to avoid stereotyping, critics there objected to what they saw as very poor writing and expressed dismay at the uncritical promotion of the book. Many protested against what they saw as a metropolitan celebration of exoticism. For example, Adeagbo Akinjogbin attributed the novel's success in the West to ignorance and a desire to believe "all sorts of fantastic tales about Africa." 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage suggests that the metropolitan critics who praised Tutuola's book would most likely agree with which of the following claims about literature?
 - A. Works that lack apparent sophistication might nevertheless have artistic value.
 - B. Poor writing is never acceptable in a literary work, even one presented as naive art.
 - C. One can only fully appreciate a work of literature that is produced within a culture that one understands thoroughly.
 - D. Nonliterary agendas often hamper the production of great literature.
 - E. The value of a given literary work is mostly determined by the rhetorical skills of the author.
2. The author cites Akinjogbin in order to
 - A. challenge a claim made by some west African literary critics
 - B. illustrate some critics' opinions about the rhetorical style of Tutuola's book
 - C. introduce an alternative explanation for the response to Tutuola's book
 - D. articulate an objection to the positive critical response to Tutuola's book
 - E. defend the promotion of Tutuola's book as an example of naive art

Passage 422

On Earth, almost all organisms derive the energy needed for growth directly or indirectly from sunlight. Certain microorganisms that live in aquifers deep underground where light cannot penetrate were thought to derive their energy from inorganic minerals. However, scientists have recently discovered that they derive their energy from the remains of other organisms. Therefore, these microorganisms _____.

- Which of the following is the most logical completion of the argument?
- A. provide an example of life that started on Earth when the condition of the seas and atmosphere made life on the surface impossible
 - B. developed from microorganisms that were not dependent on sunlight for their energy needs
 - C. must also be present in those subterranean ecologies where enough light penetrates for it to be used as the source of energy
 - D. do not ultimately have sunlight as their energy source
 - E. cannot be cited as a model of how subsurface life could exist on a planet that had never had life on its surface

Passage 423

By chronicling the revolutionary deeds of great scientists in history, the traditional scientific biography, a genre that dates at least to the early eighteenth century and is still flourishing today, embodies the notion that science is forwarded by lone mavericks whose insights change the world. Yet this paradigm exists in a state of tension with contemporary science, which has become increasingly oriented around massive, collaborative research projects. Today's insights are not so much perceived from the shoulders of giants as glimpsed from a mountain of jointly authored papers announcing results from large labs. So is the end of the traditional science biography in sight? At the least, changes in science itself may demand that science biographers adapt or become extinct. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred from the passage that the author believes that in the future, science biographers should

- A. be cautious when writing about figures from the eighteenth century and earlier
- B. author their works collaboratively to mirror the current state of scientific investigation
- C. be recruited from the ranks of working scientists so that they better understand current scientific breakthroughs
- D. forgo detailed descriptions of large-scale collaborative research projects
- E. take into account significant recent changes in the way science is conducted

2. Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

According to the passage, which of the following is true of the traditional scientific biography?

- A. It remains a popular genre.
- B. It focuses on individuals scientists whose work has had significant lasting impact.
- C. It ignores the realities of eighteenth-century scientific research.

Passage 424

Because they accumulate in an ordered manner that records changes within a lake and its drainage basin, lake sediments are particularly valuable for reconstructing ancient climate conditions. Natural material such as pollen grains, minerals, diatoms, and animals microfossils preserved in sediments can be used to infer past conditions as these materials are affected by environmental variables. Pollen grains composed of sporopollenin, for example, can be used to infer past vegetation shifts. Because both natural climate change and human agricultural practices can lead to changes in vegetation, however, differentiation of these effects using pollen alone is difficult. In many areas of **Mesoamerica**, for instance, changes in the relative abundance of pollen types after 1000 B.C. were highly influenced by human-induced land clearance. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author refers to “Mesoamerica” in the passage primarily in order to
 - A. describe an instance in which scientists were unable to determine the cause of a past vegetation shift
 - B. question the claim that both natural climate change and human agricultural practices may be responsible for past vegetation shifts
 - C. provide an example to support the contention that pollen grains are highly resistant to decay
 - D. support the contention that pollen changes captured in sediments do not reliably indicate natural climate change
 - E. identify a possible weakness in the theory that natural materials can be useful in inferring past climatic conditions
2. Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.
Which of the following does the passage present as a reason that lake sediments are of particular value in the reconstruction of ancient climate conditions?
 - A. They allow scientists to distinguish between naturally occurring and human-induced vegetation changes.
 - B. They contain natural materials that are relatively unaffected by environmental variables during accumulation
 - C. They collect over time in an ordered fashion

Passage 425

Centuries ago, the Maya of Central America produced elaborate, deeply cut carvings in stone. Given the technology available to the Maya, the carvings could only have been made with tools of stone or iron. Maya stone tools have been found, but experiments reveal that these tools are not hard enough to make anything but very small markings in the stone used for the carvings. Therefore, the Maya must have used iron tools for the carving. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

- A. Nearby cultures in North and Central America used iron tools for carving stone.
- B. The Mayans did not use tools made from softer metals than iron for other purposes.
- C. The stone from which these carvings are made is no softer than the stone used in the carvings of other Central American peoples.
- D. The stone tools that have been found are among the hardest stone tools used by the Maya.
- E. Iron tools were found at the same Maya sites at which the stone tools were found.

Passage 426

Only in the collecting sciences are raw data—specimens, fossils, artifacts—regarded as communal property, to which legitimate practitioners have rights of access. Collections are intellectual commons on which all producers depend, and the owners or keepers of collections are understood to be responsible for keeping them in good order and accessible to users. These moral precepts doubtless reflect the fact that important collections tend to end up in public museums. But I think they also derive from the reality that found objects, unlike manufactured data, are unique and irreplaceable resource, the loss of which deprives all practitioners of the means of best practice.

The moral economy of facts is quite different in sciences that generate facts artificially by measuring or experimenting. In these sciences raw data are regarded as private: because, I think, they are in principle unlimited and if lost can be produced again. Manufactured data become public only when published, and though publishing is expected, it is also understood to be selective and a personal matter, impelled more by imperatives of ambition and career than moral obligation. **Individuals may perish professionally if they neglect to publish, but if they do perish someone else can always produce equivalent data, so there is no loss to the common good.** Raw data are not an intellectual commons, as are collections. The experimental sciences operate more in a market economy than a moral one. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The passage is primarily concerned with

- A. resolving a dispute
- B. defending a practice
- C. summarize a dilemma
- D. delineating a difference
- E. explaining an anomaly

2. The author of the passage would most likely agree with which of the following statements about manufactured data?

- A. They are essential to the common good.
- B. They cannot be easily replicated.
- C. They can play a key role in career advancement.
- D. They cannot be adequately interpreted until they have been published.
- E. They are often manipulated to support the specific hypotheses.

3. In the context of the passage as a whole, the highlighted sentence serves to

- A. warn of the consequences of overlooking a point made in the first sentence of the passage
- B. cite an exception to a principle described in the preceding sentence
- C. present a conditional scenario that is confirmed in the subsequent sentence
- D. provide a rational for an assertion made in the final sentence of the passage
- E. predict an outcome that if refuted in the final sentence of the passage

Passage 427

Much of what researchers infer about the Early Preclassic period (2000-1000 B.C.E.) of the Olmec people derives from the study of monumental sculpture complemented by analogies to later Mesoamerican cultures, though not all scholars agree that **stone art** should guide interpretation or that it indicates greater sociopolitical complexity than in other societies. Indisputably, however, only the Olmec designed, created, transported, and utilized monumental sculpture in Early Preclassic Mesoamerica, which not only constitutes an important defining characteristic of their society but also reflects their unique inclination toward intense labor mobilizations. For this reason alone, sculpture should and does figure prominently in Olmec studies, just as the scale, frequency, and design of monumental architecture is used as a diachronic material measure of sociopolitical development throughout Mesoamerica. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The passage suggests which of the following about “stone art”?

- A. It no longer figures as prominently in Olmec studies as it did as one time.
- B. It interests researchers in part because of its influence on the art of non-Olmec Mesoamerican cultures.
- C. It constitutes the basis for some scholars’ views about the relative sociopolitical complexity of Olmec society.

2. The author would most likely agree with which of the following claims about Olmec monumental sculpture?

- A. It was likely produced by teams of assistant artisans carrying master sculptor’s design.
- B. It probably reflected a wide range of subject matter than can be inferred from surviving examples.
- C. It should not be given as much prominence in research on the Olmec as certain other types of archaeological evidence.
- D. It was not influenced by monumental sculpture produced by any other Mesoamerican cultures.
- E. It has given rise to a somewhat narrower range of interpretations by researchers than it should have.

Passage 428

Some **biologists** have suggested that the land-management activity of burning heather moorland, which is traditional in Ireland, creates a poor environment for the predatory and scavenging species of invertebrates such as ground beetles and spiders that normally live in heather. Yet a recent study that used pitfall trapping, the only technique that could lead to large numbers of the subject species being recorded, found that considerable numbers of these invertebrates occupy burnt heather. Admittedly, some scientists have criticized the use of pitfall traps, asserting that the number of invertebrates caught in such traps reflects the invertebrates' activity as much as their population density, and that the number of catches also depends on environmental features, such as **the amount of vegetation cover**. But other researchers have demonstrated that pitfall trapping gives an adequate representation of the populations of the spider and ground beetle species in structurally complex habitats, thus corroborating the results of the study. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. consider the importance of a research finding
 - B. analyze and find fault with a research finding
 - C. present and defend a research finding
 - D. question the use of a particular research technique
 - E. advocate the use of a combination of research techniques
2. The author mentions "the amount of vegetation cover" primarily in order to
 - A. suggest a way in which burnt heather differs from other environments
 - B. emphasize the importance of considering all relevant environmental features when designing studies of invertebrates
 - C. indicates that pitfall traps should be placed in areas of burnt heather that have relatively little vegetation cover
 - D. point out a factor that some scientists believe has created the impression that burnt heather is a poor environment for certain invertebrates
 - E. provide an example of a factor that some scientists believe undermines the reliability of pitfall trap data
3. It can be inferred that the "biologists" believe which of the following about the method of managing heather moorland described in the passage?
 - A. It decreases the number of ground beetles that can survive in the moorland.
 - B. It improves the chances for predatory species to utilize environmental resources.
 - C. It decreases the activity level of predatory and scavenging invertebrates living in the moorland.
 - D. It forces researchers to rely on pitfall traps as the only practical available technique to sample invertebrates in the moorland.
 - E. It hinders researchers' ability to sample invertebrates in the moorland over a prolonged period.

Passage 429

Most of the smog that perpetually hangs over Dordon City results not from automobile exhaust, as has long been thought, but from leaks in the hundreds of thousands of small tanks of liquefied petroleum gas that residents of Dordon City use for cooking and heating. Therefore, so long as the use of leaky tanks continues, Dordon City cannot be free of smog.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

- A. The persistent smog that hangs over Dordon City is the major environmental problem that Dordon City faces.
- B. The fossil fuels that are used for electrical power generation in Dordon City are not responsible for any of the smog in Dordon.
- C. Selling liquefied petroleum gas in small tanks is the most economically efficient way of distributing this gas to Dordon City residents.
- D. Not all the costs of making the technological changes necessary to prevent or reduce leaks of liquefied petroleum gas from the small tanks in which it is sold would be passed on to the consumers who purchased the gas.
- E. There are no feasible ways of altering the chemical composition of the liquefied petroleum gas used by residents of Dordon City that would prevent it from contributing to smog formation.

Passage 430

Although research in the 1940s showed that consuming comic books did not detrimentally affect children's reading skills or habits, educators in the United States remained concerned about this perceived threat to children's educational development. Their alarm reflected an underlying fear of losing control over children's reading choices. Before comics, children mostly read what teachers and librarians deemed appropriate; now they could purchase comics with their pocket money and swap them with friends. **Educators' anti-comics sentiment made a lasting impression on the comics industry: defining comics as inherently juvenile shifted critical attention from their illustrated format to their content.** Subsequent anti-comics activism, spearheaded by parents' and religious groups, drove publishers to adopt a regulatory code in 1954, ensuring their products would be wholesome enough for children. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. Which of the following best describes the organization of the passage as a whole?
 - A. A particular view is considered, then certain historical developments are presented as an outcome of that viewpoint.
 - B. A common misconception is corrected, then competing explanations for that misconception's popularity are compared.
 - C. Two discrete groups within an activist movement are contrasted, then process that led those groups to cooperate is outlined.
 - D. Responsibility for a change is attributed to certain persons, then reasons to doubt the accuracy of that attribution are advanced.
 - E. The findings of certain scholars are summarized, then the reception of those findings over time is analyzed.
2. The author of the passage discusses "educators' anti-comics sentiment" in the highlighted sentence primarily to
 - A. characterize the nature of a particular concern about the effects of comics on children
 - B. describe the long-term influence of the early research on comics
 - C. explain the origins of a disagreement among those opposed to comics
 - D. distinguish the strategies adopted by different groups opposed to comics
 - E. identify a historical consequence of a certain perspective on comics

Passage 431

This passage is adapted from material published in 1998.

In the book *China Men* (1980), Maxine Hong Kingston tells of Chinese Americans establishing identities in the United States. She acknowledges the importance of ethnicity (the national origins of one's ancestors or one's self), yet also the importance of geographical location aside from one's "homeland" and interactions with other cultures in identity formation. These latter ideas suggest similarity between Kingston and "border identity" theorists. These theorists challenge the arbitrariness of ethnic identities based on national boundaries, claiming that individual identity is influenced by the various cultures with which one interacts, especially in a mobile global society. Moreover, such theorists argue that identity requires redefinition either in terms of multiple of nationalities or in terms of geographic units different from nations, such as cities. Yet, redefining what it means to be an "American" without abandoning the term itself, Kingston distances herself from some border theorists. While recognizing multiple identities, she also counters border theorists' emphasis on mobility and disconnection from specific countries by emphasizing the importance of a sense of belonging for people occupying a land with others. Even so, to belong to America Kingston's world is not to have a set identity, but rather to have the opportunity to reconstruct identity through group interactions. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to

- A. analyze the effects of social mobility of global cultures
- B. explain Chinese Americans' process of establishing ethnic identities in the United States
- C. describe Kingston's concept of identity formation by comparing it to that of border identity theorists
- D. argue that Kingston's ideas about identity formation are more convincing than border identity theorists'
- E. explain the border identity theory and use Kingston's *China Men* to support the theory's claims

2. Which of the following best describes the organization of the passage?

- A. Opposing viewpoints about an author's work are debated.
- B. A problem is identified and possible solutions are presented.
- C. A literary work is described in terms of its historical context.
- D. An author's definition of a term is explained through specific examples.
- E. An author's views are compared with alternative theory.

3. Which of the following does the author mention as an important condition thought by border identity theorists to support their view?

- A. The persistence of ethnic loyalties despite globalization
- B. Populations that are very mobile on a global scale
- C. The renewed interest in national origins and ethnic heritage
- D. Tensions between ethnic groups within national boundaries
- E. Marginalization based on mobility between economic classes

Passage 432

With scientific advances and the emergence of new diamond-producing regions (e.g., the Slave craton of Canada), research into natural diamonds has become invaluable for understanding the deep Earth. Although diamond merchants typically regard diamonds with visible inclusions [foreign bodies] as flawed, such diamonds are the most valuable for research, carrying samples of mantle minerals from depths as great as 800 km beneath the surface. Diamonds provide the perfect containers for these minerals, isolating them from the high pressure and temperature reactions within the Earth for geological time spans. Because **even low elemental concentrations and minutes features in diamonds can now be analyzed** using instruments with higher sensitivity and resolution, studies combining the inclusions and their diamond hosts are powerful tools for geological research. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author's reference to the fact that "even low elemental concentrations and minutes features in diamonds can now be analyzed" serves primarily to
- A. identify characteristics of diamonds that are particularly commercially desirable
 - B. note a property that limits the use of diamonds for geological research
 - C. cite evidence to qualify a claim made earlier in the passage
 - D. point out an exception to a general rule stated earlier in the passage
 - E. explain what enables a trend described earlier in the passage

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

2. It can be inferred from the passage that natural diamonds are of geological interest because they provide information about
- A. remote periods in the history in Earth's formation
 - B. regions in the deep Earth that might otherwise be inaccessible
 - C. elements in the deep Earth that are unstable at surface pressures and temperatures

Passage 433

During the Early and Middle Ming periods in China (1368-1522), most private maritime enterprise was outlawed as piracy by the imperial government. The results was armed conflict between private traders and government forces as well as a gap in the supply of Chinese export wares into the overseas market during the Early Ming period. It is tempting to envision the tension between the private traders and the imperial government during the Early and Middle Ming periods as a conflict between **two ideologies**: an entrepreneurial spirit versus an agrarian society's conservative Confucian cosmology that despised commerce and material indulgence. A careful examination of the historical events within the empires, however, reveals that this binary view would be an oversimplification, since the tension likely created factions within the Ming bureaucracy. For instance, Governor Zhu Wan's heavy-handed crackdown on Shuangyu Island (the hub of middle Ming-period international piracy) seems to have damaged the commercial interests of so many powerful players in the Ming bureaucracy that they were able to impeach him (after which he committed suicide). Archaeological evidence indicates that there was a flood of Chinese blue-and-white porcelain to the overseas market after 1488. In contrast, an account written by Cui Bo, a Korean scholar official who was shipwrecked on the coast of Nigbo, reveals no signs of a relaxation of the maritime ban at the level of coastal defense. One can conjecture that those responsible for enforcing the maritime ban probably benefited from turning a blind eye to illicit trade under their jurisdiction. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to
 - A. describe the tension between two ideologies
 - B. analyze the nature of a historical antagonism
 - C. question the relevance of certain evidence
 - D. reveal the inconsistencies of a popular theory
 - E. defend the importance of historical research
2. The author mentions "two ideologies" primarily in order to
 - A. contrast the popular beliefs of a particular time period in Chinese history
 - B. identify the main source of tension between two groups of people
 - C. describe the economic and geopolitical context of a historical event
 - D. mention a plausible but ultimately inadequate explanation for a phenomenon
 - E. refute a widely held view about the consequences of a conflict
3. Which of the following best describes the organization of the passage?
 - A. A conflict is described and some of its ramifications are explored.
 - B. A hypothesis is proposed and the credibility of the evidence typically used to support it is questioned.
 - C. A phenomenon is considered and the accounts of the historical events surrounding it are discussed.
 - D. A view is presented and an argument that suggests its deficiency is given.
 - E. A controversy is explained and the strengths and weaknesses of both sides are considered.

Passage 434

Although African American fraternal organizations grew vigorously in the United States starting in the eighteenth century, they have received little scholarly attention. Researchers' attention to Black fraternal orders has been eclipsed by their interest in the churches, social clubs, and civil rights and political organizations they consider more central to the Black experience. The Black church, for example, is often portrayed as the incubator for other Black institutions, including fraternal orders. But the African Methodist Episcopal church actually emerged from the work of Philadelphia's Free African Society, a fraternal organization. Thus, while emphasis on the Black church and other institutions is not necessarily misplaced, increased attention to Black fraternal orders could illuminate hidden dimensions of Black civic participation.

However, the scholarly neglect of Black fraternal orders also results from scholars' inattention to secret societies of all kinds in American social history. Most historians simply perceive fraternal orders as insignificant. Moreover, twentieth-century American historians were profoundly influenced by the Chicago School of sociology, whose scholars treated fraternal orders as ineffective responses by rural folk to the city's erosion of primary rural associations. Finally, until recently, historians shared certain stereotypes of fraternal orders as unrealistic ventures into fantasy due to those organizations' use of exotic rituals and regalia. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. It can be inferred that the author of the passage would agree with which of the following statements about fraternal organizations' rituals and regalia?
 - A. They are generally less elaborate and exotic than many historians have represented them to be.
 - B. They reflect customs originally brought by rural people to cities in the United States.
 - C. They are not as widely used in African American fraternal orders as they are in some other kinds of secret societies.
 - D. They were probably not used in the earliest African American fraternal organizations in the United States.
 - E. They have been partly responsible for scholars' tendency to underestimate the social significance of fraternal organizations.
2. The passage suggests which of the following about Philadelphia's Free African Society?
 - A. Its historical relationship with the African Methodist Episcopal church runs counter to a view widely held by researchers.
 - B. Its role as a civic institution is better understood than the roles of other Black fraternal organizations because of its relationship with the African Methodist Episcopal church.
 - C. It was more historically important than any other fraternal organization in early United States history.
 - D. It is one of the few Black fraternal organizations about which extensive research has been done.
 - E. It is often cited by scholars as an example of the influence of Black fraternal organizations on other institutions.

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

3. The author of the passage attributes scholarly neglect of African American fraternal organizations to which of the following?
 - A. The influence of the Chicago School of sociology
 - B. Scholars' assumption that African American fraternal organizations have been less influential than other African American organizations
 - C. Scholars' assumption that other kinds of secret societies have been more socially significant than fraternal orders in the United States

Passage 435

Blues music speaks histories that, from the conventional perspective, originate in the experiences of African Americans. But invariably, the blues exceed rigid cultural boundaries. Ralph Ellison's definition of the blues suggests an expansive vista, limited only by a speaker's capacity to lyrically express an "autobiographical chronicle of personal catastrophe." As an idiom, the blues record histories, yet Ellison's definition privileges the personal and leaves uncertain the role of national histories, the stories that speak our collective experiences. Locating the collective histories in the personal has proved a pivotal problem for readers in the written use of the blues both in Ellison's fiction and in works by Toni Morrison, Gayl Jones, and others. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Consider each of the choices separately and select all that apply.

1. The passage suggests that which of the following is an accurate characterization of the blues as defined by Ralph Ellison?

- A. They are not limited to a specific cultural tradition.
- B. They emphasize personal experience over collective history.
- C. They must appear in written works.

2. Select the sentence in the passage that describes a particular alternative to the conventional perspective on the blues.

Passage 436

The importance of the relatively docile eland (antelope) in the diet of Middle Stone Age (MSA) people contrasted with the increased importance of aggressive wild pigs to Late Stone Age (LSA) people has been interpreted as an indication that MSA hunters were less proficient than LSA hunters. **This has been used to support the view that neurological changes dramatically modern humans.** However, alternative hypotheses have not been sufficiently examined to warrant this interpretation. The possibility that economic motives drove prey selection must first be excluded. Since eland are very large but less dangerous to hunt than wild pigs, it is likely that they would be a favored prey animal whether or not hunting strategies were sophisticated enough to tackle more aggressive prey.

1. The primary purpose of the passage is to

- A. resolve a debate about the advantages and disadvantages of certain Stone Age prey
- B. question a position on apparent changes in Stone Age hunting patterns
- C. critique the work of various researchers of Stone Age hunters
- D. suggest a reason that Late Stone Age hunters were more proficient than their predecessors
- E. provide evidence of increased behavioral complexity in Stone Age hunters over time

2. Which of the following statements best describes the function of the highlighted sentence?

- A. It acknowledges a point that the author of the passage is unable to document with evidence.
- B. It presents a conclusion that was drawn from information in the preceding sentence.
- C. It provides the basis for a challenge made in the sentence that follows.
- D. It introduces a theory that is expanded upon in the sentence that follows.
- E. It makes an argument that is supported by the final sentence of the passage.

Passage 437

Defenders of historical study often deploy some version of George Santayana's aphorism that says "Those who do not remember the past are condemned to repeat it." In **common** parlance, that opaque and paradoxical utterance becomes a utilitarian formula: an **assertion** that one can extract specific, fact-based lessons from history. But nothing could be more alien to Santayana's ironic sensibility, and so the appropriation of Santayana knew, a remembrance of things past yields an awareness of their distinctness from the present. The uniqueness of each historical moment offers resistance to utilitarians in search of practical knowledge for the present. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. On which of the following grounds would the author of the passage most likely criticize those who agree with the "assertion"?
 - A. They do not fully adhere to the lessons they derive from the past.
 - B. They assume that the past is more instructive regarding the present than is the case.
 - C. The lessons they derive from history tend to do more harm than good.
 - D. The lessons they derive from history tend not to be a fact-based as they assume.
 - E. The lessons they derive from history are based on an overly optimistic understanding of the historical record.
2. In the context in which it appears, "common" most nearly means
 - A. mutual
 - B. public
 - C. cheap
 - D. mediocre
 - E. ordinary

Passage 438

From a purely evolutionary standpoint, pet keeping is an anomalous activity. It is easy to explain, for example, why people keep chickens, pigs, or sheep: these animals are worth at least their own weight in eggs, meat, hide, or fiber. But what could possibly be the adaptive value of keeping Siamese cats or miniature schnauzers? A common response to this evolutionary puzzle, and one that keeps being regurgitated in the literature, is the idea that pets are simply social parasites who have perfected the art of releasing and exploiting our innate parental instincts—called “cute response.” Parallels are sometimes drawn with the phenomenon of brood parasitism in birds, in which the parasite’s nestling seems to exaggerate many of the care-soliciting aspects of the host’s, thus insuring that it is fed assiduously to the detriment of its foster parents and siblings. The superficially **infantile appearance of some lapdogs** lends support to this idea, but it should be emphasized that a **key difference** between people and songbirds is that the latter are presumably unaware that they are feeding and caring for a nonconspecific intruder. People may indeed find puppies or pug dogs cute, but they are certainly never in any doubt concerning their true provenance. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

1. The author mentions the “infantile appearance of some lapdogs” primarily in order to
 - A. challenge a particular claim made in the preceding sentence
 - B. acknowledge the initial plausibility of a particular explanation
 - C. defend a previously discounted hypothesis about a particular behavior
 - D. differentiate between species that do and those that do not trigger a particular response
 - E. introduce evidence to support a conclusion drawn in the following sentence
2. The author mentions a “key difference” primarily in order to
 - A. clarify an ambiguous concept
 - B. contrast two competing theories
 - C. identify a common assumption
 - D. highlight a little-known fact
 - E. undermine a popular explanation
3. It can be inferred that the author would be most likely to agree with which of the following claims about pet keeping?
 - A. Pet keeping benefits pet keepers more than it does pets.
 - B. Pet keeping many at one time have had a greater adaptive value than it does today.
 - C. Pet keeping is a behavior that is difficult to account for
 - D. Pet keeping is a natural extension of parental instincts
 - E. Pet keeping probably arose simultaneously with keeping of farm animals

Passage 439

Many criminologists argue that the chances that first-time offenders will be rehabilitated can be improved by giving them sentences rather than by sentencing them to jail. In support of this hypothesis, it is often pointed out that **whereas 10 percent of first-time offenders sentenced to community service go on to commit further crimes, fully 60 percent of first-time offenders who are imprisoned do so**. The hypothesis thus seems strongly confirmed. In actual fact, however, **the statistics cited do little to prove it**, since judges tend to impose jail sentences on those first-time offenders they consider likely to commit further crimes.

In the argument given, the two highlighted portions play which of the following roles?

- A. The first is a position that the argument rejects; the second is a judgement about the significance of evidence that has been offered in support of the position.
- B. The first is a position that the argument defends; the second is a judgement about the significance of evidence that has been used to attack that position.
- C. The first is evidence that has been offered in support of a position rejected in the argument; the second states that position.
- D. The first is evidence presented in support of a position defended in the argument; the second is a judgement about the force of other evidence that has been used to attack that position.
- E. The first is evidence whose significance is evaluated in the argument; the second is the evaluation that the argument supports.

Passage 440

Stress is a contributing factor in many illnesses, and for many people much of the stress in their lives is job-related. Purposeful leisure-time activities, as distinct from leisure time spent idly, are a good way of taking one's mind off one's job. Clearly, therefore,, people who are under much job-related stress can get some measure of protection from stress-induced illness if they engage in purposeful leisure-time activities. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the argument?

- A. For people who experience job-related stress, purposeful leisure-time activities are not generally a source of stress.
- B. Generally, the people who experience the greatest job-related stress are those who have the least amount of leisure time.
- C. Many people who are under great stress on the job have no particular desire to engage in purposeful leisure-time activities.
- D. Medical treatments for people who have fallen ill do not usually include efforts to remove the stress that might have contributed to the illness.
- E. Some inherently stressful jobs are so structured that the people holding those jobs are guaranteed adequate leisure time reasonable intervals.

答案获取方式：关注微信公众号“张巍GRE”，输入“阅读机经440篇答案”。

解析获取方式：关注微信公众号“张巍GRE”，输入“jjpassage1”代表第一篇文章的解析，以此类推。